

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting:* This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining:* This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNYCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting*: This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining*: This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from ongoing and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i, 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-40: Modelling and quantifying the impacts of open science practice

Specific conditions

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the strategies, methodologies, models, and raw and analysed data deriving from their activities. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Structured evidence of scientific, societal and economic impacts of open science practice, complemented by the new methods, tools and data required to measure them.
- Better knowledge on how impacts develop and how a diversity of benefits can be achieved at scientific, societal and economic levels.
- Better understanding on how the practice of open science can contribute to the increased reproducibility of research results.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Prioritisation of policy actions for open science, and improved policy making on open science.
- Maximised impact of open science.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Open science consists of sharing knowledge and data as early as possible in the research process, in open collaboration with all relevant actors, including citizens. The mainstreaming of open science practice⁴³ is driven by expected impacts: (i) on the research

⁴³ Open science practice includes: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

system, e.g. increased efficiency, better reliability, and better responsiveness towards societal challenges; (ii) on the innovation system, e.g. faster innovation when results are shared earlier, and innovations more directed towards societal challenges; (iii) on the interface between science and society, e.g. more productive interactions among academia and other knowledge actors, and higher trust of society in the science system when researchers and citizens are engaged. While past projects have started building an evidence base, this remains fragmented and incomplete. A broad and comprehensive evidence base would help define new policies for open science, drive further uptake and help communicate on open science.

Proposals are expected to:

- systematise and evaluate the validity and robustness of existing literature, data and evidence of impacts of open science practice, including potential legal and licensing issues;
- leverage and valorise the body of knowledge resulting from the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes;
- complement existing evidence and develop scientific methodologies and models to capture impacts, notably those relating to socio-economic, including gender equality related, environmental and public health aspects. It is in particular expected to develop and implement methods for measuring the contribution of open science practice to the reproducibility of research results, and the implications of involving citizens, civil society and end-users in R&I;
- perform cost/benefit analyses of open science practice and conduct research to identify by which causality/mechanisms the impacts develop.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-41: Global cooperation on FAIR data policy and practice

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may

	exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic, and with the EOSC Partnership⁴⁴. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries will be subject to the additional exploitation obligations: Beneficiaries must make all relevant results generated in the action available for re-use, through a well-defined mechanism, to the EOSC Partnership. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened international cooperation to increase and mainstream FAIRness⁴⁵ of data and digital objects.
- Connection of disconnected initiatives on data management, data stewardship and FAIR data practices, across borders and disciplines, as enablers of open science.
- Increased FAIR data sharing within and across scientific disciplines and innovation sectors.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Proliferation of interdisciplinary research that helps address societal challenges.
- More efficient research practices as a result of an increased reproducibility of research and reduced duplication of efforts.
- Better informed citizens and society about the results and value of research.
- Improved quality of R&I within the EU.
- Contributions to sustainable growth and faster innovation in Europe, and beyond, in the context of the global economy.

⁴⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/info/files/european-open-science-cloud-eosc_en

⁴⁵ 'FAIRness' is the compliance with the requirements of FAIR data.

Scope: Technological advancements have made science more data intensive and interconnected, with researchers producing and sharing increasing volumes of research data. To produce high quality research data, researchers have to follow good data management and data stewardship practices. Beyond proper data collection, annotation and archival, good data management and stewardship include long-term care of valuable digital assets, either alone or in combination with newly generated data. To maximise the value of science, research data should be FAIR: Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable. The FAIR principles, introduced in 2014, are a minimal set of community-agreed guiding principles that allow both machines and humans to find, access, interoperate and re-use research data. It is recognised that FAIR data play an essential role in the objectives of Open Science to improve and accelerate scientific research, to increase the engagement of society, and to contribute significantly to economic growth. Accordingly, the EU's Open Science policy⁴⁶ contains the ambition to make FAIR data sharing the default for scientific research and this can be accelerated by focusing on specific scientific disciplines. Although the FAIR principles were initially applied to research data, their coverage extends to all digital objects that are essential to research practice (e.g. algorithms, models, tools, workflows), and to other public sector data. However, initiatives for good data management and stewardship practices and FAIR practice remain fragmented across borders and disciplines. In addition, interoperability remains the least developed to date. Interoperability standards, at discipline-level first, and then across disciplines, are an essential catalyst to foster interdisciplinary science to tackle the global societal challenges of our age. Finally, FAIR digital objects related to the research process are increasingly indispensable to ensure the reproducibility, integrity and re-use of data.

Proposals should support international cooperation on the FAIRness of both data & digital objects in a discipline-specific manner. Applicants should map current initiatives and best practices, globally, within a given scientific discipline, and should facilitate the exchange of best practices across disciplines. They should support case studies and pilots to implement both domain-specific and domain-independent recommendations in FAIR practice (from the Research Data Alliance –RDA-, the Committee on Data of the International Science Council - CODATA-, etc.). They should develop, pilot and possibly deploy interoperability standards and guidelines for increasing FAIRness in specific scientific disciplines, and across different disciplines. They should also develop assessment and evaluation methodologies to appraise FAIRness within disciplines and to develop domain-specific benchmarks.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes, proposals are expected to cooperate and align with activities of the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC) Partnership and to coordinate with relevant initiatives and projects contributing to the development of EOSC. In particular, in areas such as data interoperability, metadata and vocabularies or the use of persistent identifiers, proposals should coordinate the work and establish a feedback mechanism with the awarded proposal(s) from the topic HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-05 in order to ensure alignment with EOSC policies and to identify common useful tools and resources as well as relevant data repositories that comply with EOSC guidelines.

⁴⁶ <https://ec.europa.eu/digital-single-market/en/open-science>

Proposals are also expected to engage and/or align where appropriate with projects funded under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-03 and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-04. Finally, if appropriate, proposals should further seek alignment with disciplinary use cases for FAIR as will be developed under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-06, HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-07, and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-03.

Any prospective alignments should be clearly acknowledged in the proposals, which should foresee dedicated activities and earmark appropriate resources for such activities.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved understanding of the current landscape of institutional scientific publishing activities across Europe.
- Coordination amongst institutional publishing services and initiatives across Europe at the non-technological level and improve their overall service efficiency, in particular in a multilingual environment.
- Actionable recommendations for strategies regarding institutional publishing in research performing organisations across the European Research Area.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices in the European Research Area.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Recent years have witnessed a sharp increase in open access publishing activities. Commercial scientific publishers and other service providers have turned their attention to open access publishing, responding to increased demand for open access by funders and research performing organisations. Research institutions have also developed their own open access publishing activities and services. These are either new and based on open access

publishing, or are existing publishing activities transitioning into the new digital and open access environment. Libraries are often involved, while new types of mission-driven open access university presses are also emerging in Europe and beyond. Such initiatives do not require article fees for publishing, and are often supported by their institutions. They enable open access publishing of journals and other types of outcomes in various languages and are important in supporting multilingualism in Europe. At the same time, they often have not gained the prestige bestowed on established publishing venues, usually produced in collaboration with well-known commercial scientific publishers. Moreover, institutional publishing in the social sciences and the humanities is often in languages other than English, which is both an asset and a limitation.

This action aims to support institutional publishing initiatives across Europe to improve the quality of their non-technological services to researchers, and to overcome fragmentation, specifically:

1. Activities that provide a comprehensive map of the current landscape of institutional publishing activities across Europe, through the collection of robust empirical evidence on service provision mechanisms, funding processes, gaps, among other things to be specified;
2. Activities that improve the coordination, quality and services of existing and substantial institutional open access publishing in EU member states and associated countries. This can be achieved, in particular, by establishing minimum shared standards and good practices for the non-technological aspects of their services, such as developing high quality journal policies and procedures to make services more efficient and more attractive for researchers (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), developing appropriate business/funding models that support the long-term provision of services, etc.;
3. Explicit and actionable recommendations for strategies and policies to be adopted by research institutions to support the further flourishing of their mission-driven, open access publishing activities in a coordinated fashion across Europe.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting:* This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining:* This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_e_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects ⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022				
Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting*: This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining*: This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects ⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNÝCH CINNOSTÍ AV ČR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects ⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-09: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting of FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common

priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Applicants have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-20: Towards a Europe-wide training and networking scheme for research managers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved knowledge for policy making about the training and networking patterns of research support staff and research management
- Measures to increase awareness amongst research management staff about existing training, networking and mobility opportunities at EU, national, and regional levels
- Ultimately, increased capacity and compatibility of cooperation and funding systems throughout the ERA for research management, and support to scientists.

- Improved awareness of the EU policy drivers and the EU research peculiarity in the Higher Education Institutions and Research organisations
- Preparation of the establishment of (a) central hub(s) to provide the EU research system with the most appropriate “fit for purpose” skills in EU research management, with active involvement of entities located in widening countries
- Provide recommendations aiming at facilitating a clear career path for research managers at national and EU levels, enhancing their role towards the achievement of the new ERA objectives, including those addressed in the related Council Conclusions on the New European Research Area (13567/20).

Scope: Research management can take many shapes: research policy advisers, research managers, financial support staff, data stewards, research infrastructure operators, knowledge transfer officers, business developers, knowledge brokers, innovation managers, etc. Entities and regions who are proven strong and excellent hubs in knowledge creation and innovation usually rely on a strong population of research managers.

This topic aims at improving training and skills development of research management staff, to develop better research and innovation management capacity and guidance for researchers across the entire ERA, as well as pave the way towards institutional acknowledgement of the research management profession.

Proposals are expected to map and analyse the EU landscape of research management and the financial framework to support it. They should address a wide scope of activities, such as trainings, study visits, staff exchange, internships, exchange of good practices, development of guidelines for new research managers and policy recommendations on how to deliver on research management under the new ERA.

It could include piloting a European network for research managers, including research infrastructures managers, through the integration of existing capabilities of Research Organisations, Higher Education Institutions and institutes, networks or umbrella organisations in research management. Projects are expected to generate a wide outreach to the European community of research managers, active across the ERA.

Proposals should explore the possibility to create new training paths dedicated to research support/management staff, or to optimise integration of existing recognised institutional training and certification programmes for research managers. Both these solutions should aim also at developing recommendations to strengthen existing schemes at EU level.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-30: Implementation of a new macro-economic modelling concept

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Project results are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better integration of research and innovation activities in macro-economic models, leading to better measurement of their impact and a better understanding of the channels through which research and innovation lead to impact (direct and indirect) in Europe.
- Improved macro-economic modelling for the evaluation of R&I policy, at the different levels of policy intervention (EU, national, regional), and reinforced alignment between the development of models and policy use, for example in the context of assessing policy options.
- Reinforcement of the scientific community focused on the role of research and innovation in the EU economy based on macro-economic models and increased interactions between this community and policy makers in charge of R&I policy in Europe.

Scope: This action will operationalise the recommendations of the “Expert Group to advise on further development of the macro-economic modelling agenda” run during the period 2019-2020, which can be found in the report of the Group⁴². Based on these, it will implement a renovated macro-economic modelling concept to improve the treatment of R&I and R&I policies in macroeconomic models, by developing a modelling framework consistent with the most recent empirical evidence and the theoretical state of the art.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-32: Standardisation Booster for fostering exploitation of FP-funded research results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR

⁴² The report is available here: <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/47086c5e-f249-11ea-991b-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-153127582>.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Increased participation of research performers in standardisation activities
- Increased development of new standards or revision of existing standards to reply to new industrial and market conditions through contribution of EU research performers
- Increased uptake of new technologies resulting from boosting standardisation activities

Scope: The Standardisation Booster will help beneficiaries, whose H2020 and Horizon Europe research results appear likely to lead to the revision or creation of a standard, to test the relevance of their results for standardisation activities. This booster will be open for on-going and closed H2020 and Horizon Europe projects. This service will help these beneficiaries to engage with standardisation bodies and contribute to the preparation and elaboration of standardisation activities, such as participating in a focus group, setting up a new technical committee, drafting a technical specification or a technical report, participating in awareness events.

The Standardisation Booster will serve as a standardisation proof of concept scheme. The consortium will manage the scheme and should be able to engage with high-level independent experts in standardization in order to assess the standardization potential of research results. The consortium will select H2020 or Horizon Europe projects with a high likelihood of leading to the preparation and elaboration of standardisation activities, while ensuring geographical and gender balance.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-33: R&I intensive IP management: Scenarios for the future

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A mapping of the forthcoming technology process trends and the IP framework relevant for R&I that will go with these
- An assessment of the current intellectual property methods and how fit for purpose they are taking into account the transformation of research results into markets / socio-economic benefits
- Development of scenarios with potential new protection mechanisms that will benefit both the research community and society.
- Set of guidelines to R&I actors, notably the research generators, for the protection and use of intellectual property assets.
- Set of recommendations for policy makers regarding the future needs for framework conditions relevant for R&I.
- Establishment of a communication channel with the aim of promoting an open dialogue on R&I driven intellectual property needs, bringing together various stakeholders and practitioners and providing a feedback loop between practitioners and policy makers regarding emerging needs.

Scope: Technology sovereignty requires, together with investment, an in-depth understanding of the research and innovation landscape. The current Open Innovation strategies, the ever growing Open Science practices and the artificial intelligence revolution create an ecosystem where the innovations happen faster than ever (machine learning, big data etc.). This topic will look at ways to overcome the existing gaps researchers have to face when following unconventional discovery methods (e.g. artificial intelligence, computer inventions etc.).

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-40: Modelling and quantifying the impacts of open science practice

Specific conditions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the strategies, methodologies, models, and raw and analysed data deriving from their activities. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Structured evidence of scientific, societal and economic impacts of open science practice, complemented by the new methods, tools and data required to measure them.
- Better knowledge on how impacts develop and how a diversity of benefits can be achieved at scientific, societal and economic levels.
- Better understanding on how the practice of open science can contribute to the increased reproducibility of research results.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Prioritisation of policy actions for open science, and improved policy making on open science.
- Maximised impact of open science.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Open science consists of sharing knowledge and data as early as possible in the research process, in open collaboration with all relevant actors, including citizens. The mainstreaming of open science practice⁴³ is driven by expected impacts: (i) on the research

⁴³ Open science practice includes: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

system, e.g. increased efficiency, better reliability, and better responsiveness towards societal challenges; (ii) on the innovation system, e.g. faster innovation when results are shared earlier, and innovations more directed towards societal challenges; (iii) on the interface between science and society, e.g. more productive interactions among academia and other knowledge actors, and higher trust of society in the science system when researchers and citizens are engaged. While past projects have started building an evidence base, this remains fragmented and incomplete. A broad and comprehensive evidence base would help define new policies for open science, drive further uptake and help communicate on open science.

Proposals are expected to:

- systematise and evaluate the validity and robustness of existing literature, data and evidence of impacts of open science practice, including potential legal and licensing issues;
- leverage and valorise the body of knowledge resulting from the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes;
- complement existing evidence and develop scientific methodologies and models to capture impacts, notably those relating to socio-economic, including gender equality related, environmental and public health aspects. It is in particular expected to develop and implement methods for measuring the contribution of open science practice to the reproducibility of research results, and the implications of involving citizens, civil society and end-users in R&I;
- perform cost/benefit analyses of open science practice and conduct research to identify by which causality/mechanisms the impacts develop.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-41: Global cooperation on FAIR data policy and practice

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may

	exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic, and with the EOSC Partnership⁴⁴. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries will be subject to the additional exploitation obligations: Beneficiaries must make all relevant results generated in the action available for re-use, through a well-defined mechanism, to the EOSC Partnership. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened international cooperation to increase and mainstream FAIRness⁴⁵ of data and digital objects.
- Connection of disconnected initiatives on data management, data stewardship and FAIR data practices, across borders and disciplines, as enablers of open science.
- Increased FAIR data sharing within and across scientific disciplines and innovation sectors.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Proliferation of interdisciplinary research that helps address societal challenges.
- More efficient research practices as a result of an increased reproducibility of research and reduced duplication of efforts.
- Better informed citizens and society about the results and value of research.
- Improved quality of R&I within the EU.
- Contributions to sustainable growth and faster innovation in Europe, and beyond, in the context of the global economy.

⁴⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/info/files/european-open-science-cloud-eosc_en

⁴⁵ 'FAIRness' is the compliance with the requirements of FAIR data.

Scope: Technological advancements have made science more data intensive and interconnected, with researchers producing and sharing increasing volumes of research data. To produce high quality research data, researchers have to follow good data management and data stewardship practices. Beyond proper data collection, annotation and archival, good data management and stewardship include long-term care of valuable digital assets, either alone or in combination with newly generated data. To maximise the value of science, research data should be FAIR: Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable. The FAIR principles, introduced in 2014, are a minimal set of community-agreed guiding principles that allow both machines and humans to find, access, interoperate and re-use research data. It is recognised that FAIR data play an essential role in the objectives of Open Science to improve and accelerate scientific research, to increase the engagement of society, and to contribute significantly to economic growth. Accordingly, the EU's Open Science policy⁴⁶ contains the ambition to make FAIR data sharing the default for scientific research and this can be accelerated by focusing on specific scientific disciplines. Although the FAIR principles were initially applied to research data, their coverage extends to all digital objects that are essential to research practice (e.g. algorithms, models, tools, workflows), and to other public sector data. However, initiatives for good data management and stewardship practices and FAIR practice remain fragmented across borders and disciplines. In addition, interoperability remains the least developed to date. Interoperability standards, at discipline-level first, and then across disciplines, are an essential catalyst to foster interdisciplinary science to tackle the global societal challenges of our age. Finally, FAIR digital objects related to the research process are increasingly indispensable to ensure the reproducibility, integrity and re-use of data.

Proposals should support international cooperation on the FAIRness of both data & digital objects in a discipline-specific manner. Applicants should map current initiatives and best practices, globally, within a given scientific discipline, and should facilitate the exchange of best practices across disciplines. They should support case studies and pilots to implement both domain-specific and domain-independent recommendations in FAIR practice (from the Research Data Alliance –RDA-, the Committee on Data of the International Science Council - CODATA-, etc.). They should develop, pilot and possibly deploy interoperability standards and guidelines for increasing FAIRness in specific scientific disciplines, and across different disciplines. They should also develop assessment and evaluation methodologies to appraise FAIRness within disciplines and to develop domain-specific benchmarks.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes, proposals are expected to cooperate and align with activities of the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC) Partnership and to coordinate with relevant initiatives and projects contributing to the development of EOSC. In particular, in areas such as data interoperability, metadata and vocabularies or the use of persistent identifiers, proposals should coordinate the work and establish a feedback mechanism with the awarded proposal(s) from the topic HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-05 in order to ensure alignment with EOSC policies and to identify common useful tools and resources as well as relevant data repositories that comply with EOSC guidelines.

⁴⁶ <https://ec.europa.eu/digital-single-market/en/open-science>

Proposals are also expected to engage and/or align where appropriate with projects funded under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-03 and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-04. Finally, if appropriate, proposals should further seek alignment with disciplinary use cases for FAIR as will be developed under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-06, HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-07, and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-03.

Any prospective alignments should be clearly acknowledged in the proposals, which should foresee dedicated activities and earmark appropriate resources for such activities.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved understanding of the current landscape of institutional scientific publishing activities across Europe.
- Coordination amongst institutional publishing services and initiatives across Europe at the non-technological level and improve their overall service efficiency, in particular in a multilingual environment.
- Actionable recommendations for strategies regarding institutional publishing in research performing organisations across the European Research Area.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices in the European Research Area.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Recent years have witnessed a sharp increase in open access publishing activities. Commercial scientific publishers and other service providers have turned their attention to open access publishing, responding to increased demand for open access by funders and research performing organisations. Research institutions have also developed their own open access publishing activities and services. These are either new and based on open access

publishing, or are existing publishing activities transitioning into the new digital and open access environment. Libraries are often involved, while new types of mission-driven open access university presses are also emerging in Europe and beyond. Such initiatives do not require article fees for publishing, and are often supported by their institutions. They enable open access publishing of journals and other types of outcomes in various languages and are important in supporting multilingualism in Europe. At the same time, they often have not gained the prestige bestowed on established publishing venues, usually produced in collaboration with well-known commercial scientific publishers. Moreover, institutional publishing in the social sciences and the humanities is often in languages other than English, which is both an asset and a limitation.

This action aims to support institutional publishing initiatives across Europe to improve the quality of their non-technological services to researchers, and to overcome fragmentation, specifically:

1. Activities that provide a comprehensive map of the current landscape of institutional publishing activities across Europe, through the collection of robust empirical evidence on service provision mechanisms, funding processes, gaps, among other things to be specified;
2. Activities that improve the coordination, quality and services of existing and substantial institutional open access publishing in EU member states and associated countries. This can be achieved, in particular, by establishing minimum shared standards and good practices for the non-technological aspects of their services, such as developing high quality journal policies and procedures to make services more efficient and more attractive for researchers (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), developing appropriate business/funding models that support the long-term provision of services, etc.;
3. Explicit and actionable recommendations for strategies and policies to be adopted by research institutions to support the further flourishing of their mission-driven, open access publishing activities in a coordinated fashion across Europe.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting:* This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining:* This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ege-statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects ⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Août 7, Liège 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNYCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-33: R&I intensive IP management: Scenarios for the future

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A mapping of the forthcoming technology process trends and the IP framework relevant for R&I that will go with these
- An assessment of the current intellectual property methods and how fit for purpose they are taking into account the transformation of research results into markets / socio-economic benefits
- Development of scenarios with potential new protection mechanisms that will benefit both the research community and society.
- Set of guidelines to R&I actors, notably the research generators, for the protection and use of intellectual property assets.
- Set of recommendations for policy makers regarding the future needs for framework conditions relevant for R&I.
- Establishment of a communication channel with the aim of promoting an open dialogue on R&I driven intellectual property needs, bringing together various stakeholders and practitioners and providing a feedback loop between practitioners and policy makers regarding emerging needs.

Scope: Technology sovereignty requires, together with investment, an in-depth understanding of the research and innovation landscape. The current Open Innovation strategies, the ever growing Open Science practices and the artificial intelligence revolution create an ecosystem where the innovations happen faster than ever (machine learning, big data etc.). This topic will look at ways to overcome the existing gaps researchers have to face when following unconventional discovery methods (e.g. artificial intelligence, computer inventions etc.).

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-40: Modelling and quantifying the impacts of open science practice

Specific conditions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the strategies, methodologies, models, and raw and analysed data deriving from their activities. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Structured evidence of scientific, societal and economic impacts of open science practice, complemented by the new methods, tools and data required to measure them.
- Better knowledge on how impacts develop and how a diversity of benefits can be achieved at scientific, societal and economic levels.
- Better understanding on how the practice of open science can contribute to the increased reproducibility of research results.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Prioritisation of policy actions for open science, and improved policy making on open science.
- Maximised impact of open science.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Open science consists of sharing knowledge and data as early as possible in the research process, in open collaboration with all relevant actors, including citizens. The mainstreaming of open science practice⁴³ is driven by expected impacts: (i) on the research

⁴³ Open science practice includes: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

system, e.g. increased efficiency, better reliability, and better responsiveness towards societal challenges; (ii) on the innovation system, e.g. faster innovation when results are shared earlier, and innovations more directed towards societal challenges; (iii) on the interface between science and society, e.g. more productive interactions among academia and other knowledge actors, and higher trust of society in the science system when researchers and citizens are engaged. While past projects have started building an evidence base, this remains fragmented and incomplete. A broad and comprehensive evidence base would help define new policies for open science, drive further uptake and help communicate on open science.

Proposals are expected to:

- systematise and evaluate the validity and robustness of existing literature, data and evidence of impacts of open science practice, including potential legal and licensing issues;
- leverage and valorise the body of knowledge resulting from the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes;
- complement existing evidence and develop scientific methodologies and models to capture impacts, notably those relating to socio-economic, including gender equality related, environmental and public health aspects. It is in particular expected to develop and implement methods for measuring the contribution of open science practice to the reproducibility of research results, and the implications of involving citizens, civil society and end-users in R&I;
- perform cost/benefit analyses of open science practice and conduct research to identify by which causality/mechanisms the impacts develop.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-41: Global cooperation on FAIR data policy and practice

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may

	exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic, and with the EOSC Partnership⁴⁴. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries will be subject to the additional exploitation obligations: Beneficiaries must make all relevant results generated in the action available for re-use, through a well-defined mechanism, to the EOSC Partnership. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened international cooperation to increase and mainstream FAIRness⁴⁵ of data and digital objects.
- Connection of disconnected initiatives on data management, data stewardship and FAIR data practices, across borders and disciplines, as enablers of open science.
- Increased FAIR data sharing within and across scientific disciplines and innovation sectors.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Proliferation of interdisciplinary research that helps address societal challenges.
- More efficient research practices as a result of an increased reproducibility of research and reduced duplication of efforts.
- Better informed citizens and society about the results and value of research.
- Improved quality of R&I within the EU.
- Contributions to sustainable growth and faster innovation in Europe, and beyond, in the context of the global economy.

⁴⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/info/files/european-open-science-cloud-eosc_en

⁴⁵ 'FAIRness' is the compliance with the requirements of FAIR data.

Scope: Technological advancements have made science more data intensive and interconnected, with researchers producing and sharing increasing volumes of research data. To produce high quality research data, researchers have to follow good data management and data stewardship practices. Beyond proper data collection, annotation and archival, good data management and stewardship include long-term care of valuable digital assets, either alone or in combination with newly generated data. To maximise the value of science, research data should be FAIR: Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable. The FAIR principles, introduced in 2014, are a minimal set of community-agreed guiding principles that allow both machines and humans to find, access, interoperate and re-use research data. It is recognised that FAIR data play an essential role in the objectives of Open Science to improve and accelerate scientific research, to increase the engagement of society, and to contribute significantly to economic growth. Accordingly, the EU's Open Science policy⁴⁶ contains the ambition to make FAIR data sharing the default for scientific research and this can be accelerated by focusing on specific scientific disciplines. Although the FAIR principles were initially applied to research data, their coverage extends to all digital objects that are essential to research practice (e.g. algorithms, models, tools, workflows), and to other public sector data. However, initiatives for good data management and stewardship practices and FAIR practice remain fragmented across borders and disciplines. In addition, interoperability remains the least developed to date. Interoperability standards, at discipline-level first, and then across disciplines, are an essential catalyst to foster interdisciplinary science to tackle the global societal challenges of our age. Finally, FAIR digital objects related to the research process are increasingly indispensable to ensure the reproducibility, integrity and re-use of data.

Proposals should support international cooperation on the FAIRness of both data & digital objects in a discipline-specific manner. Applicants should map current initiatives and best practices, globally, within a given scientific discipline, and should facilitate the exchange of best practices across disciplines. They should support case studies and pilots to implement both domain-specific and domain-independent recommendations in FAIR practice (from the Research Data Alliance –RDA-, the Committee on Data of the International Science Council - CODATA-, etc.). They should develop, pilot and possibly deploy interoperability standards and guidelines for increasing FAIRness in specific scientific disciplines, and across different disciplines. They should also develop assessment and evaluation methodologies to appraise FAIRness within disciplines and to develop domain-specific benchmarks.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes, proposals are expected to cooperate and align with activities of the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC) Partnership and to coordinate with relevant initiatives and projects contributing to the development of EOSC. In particular, in areas such as data interoperability, metadata and vocabularies or the use of persistent identifiers, proposals should coordinate the work and establish a feedback mechanism with the awarded proposal(s) from the topic HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-05 in order to ensure alignment with EOSC policies and to identify common useful tools and resources as well as relevant data repositories that comply with EOSC guidelines.

⁴⁶ <https://ec.europa.eu/digital-single-market/en/open-science>

Proposals are also expected to engage and/or align where appropriate with projects funded under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-03 and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-04. Finally, if appropriate, proposals should further seek alignment with disciplinary use cases for FAIR as will be developed under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-06, HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-07, and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-03.

Any prospective alignments should be clearly acknowledged in the proposals, which should foresee dedicated activities and earmark appropriate resources for such activities.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved understanding of the current landscape of institutional scientific publishing activities across Europe.
- Coordination amongst institutional publishing services and initiatives across Europe at the non-technological level and improve their overall service efficiency, in particular in a multilingual environment.
- Actionable recommendations for strategies regarding institutional publishing in research performing organisations across the European Research Area.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices in the European Research Area.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Recent years have witnessed a sharp increase in open access publishing activities. Commercial scientific publishers and other service providers have turned their attention to open access publishing, responding to increased demand for open access by funders and research performing organisations. Research institutions have also developed their own open access publishing activities and services. These are either new and based on open access

publishing, or are existing publishing activities transitioning into the new digital and open access environment. Libraries are often involved, while new types of mission-driven open access university presses are also emerging in Europe and beyond. Such initiatives do not require article fees for publishing, and are often supported by their institutions. They enable open access publishing of journals and other types of outcomes in various languages and are important in supporting multilingualism in Europe. At the same time, they often have not gained the prestige bestowed on established publishing venues, usually produced in collaboration with well-known commercial scientific publishers. Moreover, institutional publishing in the social sciences and the humanities is often in languages other than English, which is both an asset and a limitation.

This action aims to support institutional publishing initiatives across Europe to improve the quality of their non-technological services to researchers, and to overcome fragmentation, specifically:

1. Activities that provide a comprehensive map of the current landscape of institutional publishing activities across Europe, through the collection of robust empirical evidence on service provision mechanisms, funding processes, gaps, among other things to be specified;
2. Activities that improve the coordination, quality and services of existing and substantial institutional open access publishing in EU member states and associated countries. This can be achieved, in particular, by establishing minimum shared standards and good practices for the non-technological aspects of their services, such as developing high quality journal policies and procedures to make services more efficient and more attractive for researchers (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), developing appropriate business/funding models that support the long-term provision of services, etc.;
3. Explicit and actionable recommendations for strategies and policies to be adopted by research institutions to support the further flourishing of their mission-driven, open access publishing activities in a coordinated fashion across Europe.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting:* This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining:* This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects ⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

Admissibility conditions

The conditions are described in General

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷

Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

60 <http://eneri.eu/>
61 http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf
62 Ibid.
63 www.embassy.science
64 https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en
65 Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site
(<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved understanding of the current landscape of institutional scientific publishing activities across Europe.
- Coordination amongst institutional publishing services and initiatives across Europe at the non-technological level and improve their overall service efficiency, in particular in a multilingual environment.
- Actionable recommendations for strategies regarding institutional publishing in research performing organisations across the European Research Area.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices in the European Research Area.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Recent years have witnessed a sharp increase in open access publishing activities. Commercial scientific publishers and other service providers have turned their attention to open access publishing, responding to increased demand for open access by funders and research performing organisations. Research institutions have also developed their own open access publishing activities and services. These are either new and based on open access

publishing, or are existing publishing activities transitioning into the new digital and open access environment. Libraries are often involved, while new types of mission-driven open access university presses are also emerging in Europe and beyond. Such initiatives do not require article fees for publishing, and are often supported by their institutions. They enable open access publishing of journals and other types of outcomes in various languages and are important in supporting multilingualism in Europe. At the same time, they often have not gained the prestige bestowed on established publishing venues, usually produced in collaboration with well-known commercial scientific publishers. Moreover, institutional publishing in the social sciences and the humanities is often in languages other than English, which is both an asset and a limitation.

This action aims to support institutional publishing initiatives across Europe to improve the quality of their non-technological services to researchers, and to overcome fragmentation, specifically:

1. Activities that provide a comprehensive map of the current landscape of institutional publishing activities across Europe, through the collection of robust empirical evidence on service provision mechanisms, funding processes, gaps, among other things to be specified;
2. Activities that improve the coordination, quality and services of existing and substantial institutional open access publishing in EU member states and associated countries. This can be achieved, in particular, by establishing minimum shared standards and good practices for the non-technological aspects of their services, such as developing high quality journal policies and procedures to make services more efficient and more attractive for researchers (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), developing appropriate business/funding models that support the long-term provision of services, etc.;
3. Explicit and actionable recommendations for strategies and policies to be adopted by research institutions to support the further flourishing of their mission-driven, open access publishing activities in a coordinated fashion across Europe.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting*: This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining*: This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸² <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNYCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilksi Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-32: Standardisation Booster for fostering exploitation of FP-funded research results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR

⁴² The report is available here: <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/47086c5e-f249-11ea-991b-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-153127582>.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Increased participation of research performers in standardisation activities
- Increased development of new standards or revision of existing standards to reply to new industrial and market conditions through contribution of EU research performers
- Increased uptake of new technologies resulting from boosting standardisation activities

Scope: The Standardisation Booster will help beneficiaries, whose H2020 and Horizon Europe research results appear likely to lead to the revision or creation of a standard, to test the relevance of their results for standardisation activities. This booster will be open for on-going and closed H2020 and Horizon Europe projects. This service will help these beneficiaries to engage with standardisation bodies and contribute to the preparation and elaboration of standardisation activities, such as participating in a focus group, setting up a new technical committee, drafting a technical specification or a technical report, participating in awareness events.

The Standardisation Booster will serve as a standardisation proof of concept scheme. The consortium will manage the scheme and should be able to engage with high-level independent experts in standardization in order to assess the standardization potential of research results. The consortium will select H2020 or Horizon Europe projects with a high likelihood of leading to the preparation and elaboration of standardisation activities, while ensuring geographical and gender balance.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-33: R&I intensive IP management: Scenarios for the future

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A mapping of the forthcoming technology process trends and the IP framework relevant for R&I that will go with these
- An assessment of the current intellectual property methods and how fit for purpose they are taking into account the transformation of research results into markets / socio-economic benefits
- Development of scenarios with potential new protection mechanisms that will benefit both the research community and society.
- Set of guidelines to R&I actors, notably the research generators, for the protection and use of intellectual property assets.
- Set of recommendations for policy makers regarding the future needs for framework conditions relevant for R&I.
- Establishment of a communication channel with the aim of promoting an open dialogue on R&I driven intellectual property needs, bringing together various stakeholders and practitioners and providing a feedback loop between practitioners and policy makers regarding emerging needs.

Scope: Technology sovereignty requires, together with investment, an in-depth understanding of the research and innovation landscape. The current Open Innovation strategies, the ever growing Open Science practices and the artificial intelligence revolution create an ecosystem where the innovations happen faster than ever (machine learning, big data etc.). This topic will look at ways to overcome the existing gaps researchers have to face when following unconventional discovery methods (e.g. artificial intelligence, computer inventions etc.).

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-40: Modelling and quantifying the impacts of open science practice

Specific conditions

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the strategies, methodologies, models, and raw and analysed data deriving from their activities. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Structured evidence of scientific, societal and economic impacts of open science practice, complemented by the new methods, tools and data required to measure them.
- Better knowledge on how impacts develop and how a diversity of benefits can be achieved at scientific, societal and economic levels.
- Better understanding on how the practice of open science can contribute to the increased reproducibility of research results.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Prioritisation of policy actions for open science, and improved policy making on open science.
- Maximised impact of open science.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Open science consists of sharing knowledge and data as early as possible in the research process, in open collaboration with all relevant actors, including citizens. The mainstreaming of open science practice⁴³ is driven by expected impacts: (i) on the research

⁴³ Open science practice includes: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

system, e.g. increased efficiency, better reliability, and better responsiveness towards societal challenges; (ii) on the innovation system, e.g. faster innovation when results are shared earlier, and innovations more directed towards societal challenges; (iii) on the interface between science and society, e.g. more productive interactions among academia and other knowledge actors, and higher trust of society in the science system when researchers and citizens are engaged. While past projects have started building an evidence base, this remains fragmented and incomplete. A broad and comprehensive evidence base would help define new policies for open science, drive further uptake and help communicate on open science.

Proposals are expected to:

- systematise and evaluate the validity and robustness of existing literature, data and evidence of impacts of open science practice, including potential legal and licensing issues;
- leverage and valorise the body of knowledge resulting from the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes;
- complement existing evidence and develop scientific methodologies and models to capture impacts, notably those relating to socio-economic, including gender equality related, environmental and public health aspects. It is in particular expected to develop and implement methods for measuring the contribution of open science practice to the reproducibility of research results, and the implications of involving citizens, civil society and end-users in R&I;
- perform cost/benefit analyses of open science practice and conduct research to identify by which causality/mechanisms the impacts develop.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-41: Global cooperation on FAIR data policy and practice

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may

	exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic, and with the EOSC Partnership⁴⁴. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries will be subject to the additional exploitation obligations: Beneficiaries must make all relevant results generated in the action available for re-use, through a well-defined mechanism, to the EOSC Partnership. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened international cooperation to increase and mainstream FAIRness⁴⁵ of data and digital objects.
- Connection of disconnected initiatives on data management, data stewardship and FAIR data practices, across borders and disciplines, as enablers of open science.
- Increased FAIR data sharing within and across scientific disciplines and innovation sectors.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Proliferation of interdisciplinary research that helps address societal challenges.
- More efficient research practices as a result of an increased reproducibility of research and reduced duplication of efforts.
- Better informed citizens and society about the results and value of research.
- Improved quality of R&I within the EU.
- Contributions to sustainable growth and faster innovation in Europe, and beyond, in the context of the global economy.

⁴⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/info/files/european-open-science-cloud-eosc_en

⁴⁵ 'FAIRness' is the compliance with the requirements of FAIR data.

Scope: Technological advancements have made science more data intensive and interconnected, with researchers producing and sharing increasing volumes of research data. To produce high quality research data, researchers have to follow good data management and data stewardship practices. Beyond proper data collection, annotation and archival, good data management and stewardship include long-term care of valuable digital assets, either alone or in combination with newly generated data. To maximise the value of science, research data should be FAIR: Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable. The FAIR principles, introduced in 2014, are a minimal set of community-agreed guiding principles that allow both machines and humans to find, access, interoperate and re-use research data. It is recognised that FAIR data play an essential role in the objectives of Open Science to improve and accelerate scientific research, to increase the engagement of society, and to contribute significantly to economic growth. Accordingly, the EU's Open Science policy⁴⁶ contains the ambition to make FAIR data sharing the default for scientific research and this can be accelerated by focusing on specific scientific disciplines. Although the FAIR principles were initially applied to research data, their coverage extends to all digital objects that are essential to research practice (e.g. algorithms, models, tools, workflows), and to other public sector data. However, initiatives for good data management and stewardship practices and FAIR practice remain fragmented across borders and disciplines. In addition, interoperability remains the least developed to date. Interoperability standards, at discipline-level first, and then across disciplines, are an essential catalyst to foster interdisciplinary science to tackle the global societal challenges of our age. Finally, FAIR digital objects related to the research process are increasingly indispensable to ensure the reproducibility, integrity and re-use of data.

Proposals should support international cooperation on the FAIRness of both data & digital objects in a discipline-specific manner. Applicants should map current initiatives and best practices, globally, within a given scientific discipline, and should facilitate the exchange of best practices across disciplines. They should support case studies and pilots to implement both domain-specific and domain-independent recommendations in FAIR practice (from the Research Data Alliance –RDA-, the Committee on Data of the International Science Council - CODATA-, etc.). They should develop, pilot and possibly deploy interoperability standards and guidelines for increasing FAIRness in specific scientific disciplines, and across different disciplines. They should also develop assessment and evaluation methodologies to appraise FAIRness within disciplines and to develop domain-specific benchmarks.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes, proposals are expected to cooperate and align with activities of the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC) Partnership and to coordinate with relevant initiatives and projects contributing to the development of EOSC. In particular, in areas such as data interoperability, metadata and vocabularies or the use of persistent identifiers, proposals should coordinate the work and establish a feedback mechanism with the awarded proposal(s) from the topic HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-05 in order to ensure alignment with EOSC policies and to identify common useful tools and resources as well as relevant data repositories that comply with EOSC guidelines.

⁴⁶ <https://ec.europa.eu/digital-single-market/en/open-science>

Proposals are also expected to engage and/or align where appropriate with projects funded under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-03 and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-04. Finally, if appropriate, proposals should further seek alignment with disciplinary use cases for FAIR as will be developed under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-06, HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-07, and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-03.

Any prospective alignments should be clearly acknowledged in the proposals, which should foresee dedicated activities and earmark appropriate resources for such activities.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved understanding of the current landscape of institutional scientific publishing activities across Europe.
- Coordination amongst institutional publishing services and initiatives across Europe at the non-technological level and improve their overall service efficiency, in particular in a multilingual environment.
- Actionable recommendations for strategies regarding institutional publishing in research performing organisations across the European Research Area.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices in the European Research Area.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Recent years have witnessed a sharp increase in open access publishing activities. Commercial scientific publishers and other service providers have turned their attention to open access publishing, responding to increased demand for open access by funders and research performing organisations. Research institutions have also developed their own open access publishing activities and services. These are either new and based on open access

publishing, or are existing publishing activities transitioning into the new digital and open access environment. Libraries are often involved, while new types of mission-driven open access university presses are also emerging in Europe and beyond. Such initiatives do not require article fees for publishing, and are often supported by their institutions. They enable open access publishing of journals and other types of outcomes in various languages and are important in supporting multilingualism in Europe. At the same time, they often have not gained the prestige bestowed on established publishing venues, usually produced in collaboration with well-known commercial scientific publishers. Moreover, institutional publishing in the social sciences and the humanities is often in languages other than English, which is both an asset and a limitation.

This action aims to support institutional publishing initiatives across Europe to improve the quality of their non-technological services to researchers, and to overcome fragmentation, specifically:

1. Activities that provide a comprehensive map of the current landscape of institutional publishing activities across Europe, through the collection of robust empirical evidence on service provision mechanisms, funding processes, gaps, among other things to be specified;
2. Activities that improve the coordination, quality and services of existing and substantial institutional open access publishing in EU member states and associated countries. This can be achieved, in particular, by establishing minimum shared standards and good practices for the non-technological aspects of their services, such as developing high quality journal policies and procedures to make services more efficient and more attractive for researchers (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), developing appropriate business/funding models that support the long-term provision of services, etc.;
3. Explicit and actionable recommendations for strategies and policies to be adopted by research institutions to support the further flourishing of their mission-driven, open access publishing activities in a coordinated fashion across Europe.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting*: This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining*: This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNÝCH CINNOSTÍ AV ČR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-30: Implementation of a new macro-economic modelling concept

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Project results are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better integration of research and innovation activities in macro-economic models, leading to better measurement of their impact and a better understanding of the channels through which research and innovation lead to impact (direct and indirect) in Europe.
- Improved macro-economic modelling for the evaluation of R&I policy, at the different levels of policy intervention (EU, national, regional), and reinforced alignment between the development of models and policy use, for example in the context of assessing policy options.
- Reinforcement of the scientific community focused on the role of research and innovation in the EU economy based on macro-economic models and increased interactions between this community and policy makers in charge of R&I policy in Europe.

Scope: This action will operationalise the recommendations of the “Expert Group to advise on further development of the macro-economic modelling agenda” run during the period 2019-2020, which can be found in the report of the Group⁴². Based on these, it will implement a renovated macro-economic modelling concept to improve the treatment of R&I and R&I policies in macroeconomic models, by developing a modelling framework consistent with the most recent empirical evidence and the theoretical state of the art.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-32: Standardisation Booster for fostering exploitation of FP-funded research results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR

⁴²

The report is available here: <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/47086c5e-f249-11ea-991b-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-153127582>.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Increased participation of research performers in standardisation activities
- Increased development of new standards or revision of existing standards to reply to new industrial and market conditions through contribution of EU research performers
- Increased uptake of new technologies resulting from boosting standardisation activities

Scope: The Standardisation Booster will help beneficiaries, whose H2020 and Horizon Europe research results appear likely to lead to the revision or creation of a standard, to test the relevance of their results for standardisation activities. This booster will be open for on-going and closed H2020 and Horizon Europe projects. This service will help these beneficiaries to engage with standardisation bodies and contribute to the preparation and elaboration of standardisation activities, such as participating in a focus group, setting up a new technical committee, drafting a technical specification or a technical report, participating in awareness events.

The Standardisation Booster will serve as a standardisation proof of concept scheme. The consortium will manage the scheme and should be able to engage with high-level independent experts in standardization in order to assess the standardization potential of research results. The consortium will select H2020 or Horizon Europe projects with a high likelihood of leading to the preparation and elaboration of standardisation activities, while ensuring geographical and gender balance.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-33: R&I intensive IP management: Scenarios for the future

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A mapping of the forthcoming technology process trends and the IP framework relevant for R&I that will go with these
- An assessment of the current intellectual property methods and how fit for purpose they are taking into account the transformation of research results into markets / socio-economic benefits
- Development of scenarios with potential new protection mechanisms that will benefit both the research community and society.
- Set of guidelines to R&I actors, notably the research generators, for the protection and use of intellectual property assets.
- Set of recommendations for policy makers regarding the future needs for framework conditions relevant for R&I.
- Establishment of a communication channel with the aim of promoting an open dialogue on R&I driven intellectual property needs, bringing together various stakeholders and practitioners and providing a feedback loop between practitioners and policy makers regarding emerging needs.

Scope: Technology sovereignty requires, together with investment, an in-depth understanding of the research and innovation landscape. The current Open Innovation strategies, the ever growing Open Science practices and the artificial intelligence revolution create an ecosystem where the innovations happen faster than ever (machine learning, big data etc.). This topic will look at ways to overcome the existing gaps researchers have to face when following unconventional discovery methods (e.g. artificial intelligence, computer inventions etc.).

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-40: Modelling and quantifying the impacts of open science practice

Specific conditions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the strategies, methodologies, models, and raw and analysed data deriving from their activities. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Structured evidence of scientific, societal and economic impacts of open science practice, complemented by the new methods, tools and data required to measure them.
- Better knowledge on how impacts develop and how a diversity of benefits can be achieved at scientific, societal and economic levels.
- Better understanding on how the practice of open science can contribute to the increased reproducibility of research results.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Prioritisation of policy actions for open science, and improved policy making on open science.
- Maximised impact of open science.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Open science consists of sharing knowledge and data as early as possible in the research process, in open collaboration with all relevant actors, including citizens. The mainstreaming of open science practice⁴³ is driven by expected impacts: (i) on the research

⁴³ Open science practice includes: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

system, e.g. increased efficiency, better reliability, and better responsiveness towards societal challenges; (ii) on the innovation system, e.g. faster innovation when results are shared earlier, and innovations more directed towards societal challenges; (iii) on the interface between science and society, e.g. more productive interactions among academia and other knowledge actors, and higher trust of society in the science system when researchers and citizens are engaged. While past projects have started building an evidence base, this remains fragmented and incomplete. A broad and comprehensive evidence base would help define new policies for open science, drive further uptake and help communicate on open science.

Proposals are expected to:

- systematise and evaluate the validity and robustness of existing literature, data and evidence of impacts of open science practice, including potential legal and licensing issues;
- leverage and valorise the body of knowledge resulting from the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes;
- complement existing evidence and develop scientific methodologies and models to capture impacts, notably those relating to socio-economic, including gender equality related, environmental and public health aspects. It is in particular expected to develop and implement methods for measuring the contribution of open science practice to the reproducibility of research results, and the implications of involving citizens, civil society and end-users in R&I;
- perform cost/benefit analyses of open science practice and conduct research to identify by which causality/mechanisms the impacts develop.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-41: Global cooperation on FAIR data policy and practice

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may

	exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic, and with the EOSC Partnership⁴⁴. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries will be subject to the additional exploitation obligations: Beneficiaries must make all relevant results generated in the action available for re-use, through a well-defined mechanism, to the EOSC Partnership. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened international cooperation to increase and mainstream FAIRness⁴⁵ of data and digital objects.
- Connection of disconnected initiatives on data management, data stewardship and FAIR data practices, across borders and disciplines, as enablers of open science.
- Increased FAIR data sharing within and across scientific disciplines and innovation sectors.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Proliferation of interdisciplinary research that helps address societal challenges.
- More efficient research practices as a result of an increased reproducibility of research and reduced duplication of efforts.
- Better informed citizens and society about the results and value of research.
- Improved quality of R&I within the EU.
- Contributions to sustainable growth and faster innovation in Europe, and beyond, in the context of the global economy.

⁴⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/info/files/european-open-science-cloud-eosc_en

⁴⁵ 'FAIRness' is the compliance with the requirements of FAIR data.

Scope: Technological advancements have made science more data intensive and interconnected, with researchers producing and sharing increasing volumes of research data. To produce high quality research data, researchers have to follow good data management and data stewardship practices. Beyond proper data collection, annotation and archival, good data management and stewardship include long-term care of valuable digital assets, either alone or in combination with newly generated data. To maximise the value of science, research data should be FAIR: Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable. The FAIR principles, introduced in 2014, are a minimal set of community-agreed guiding principles that allow both machines and humans to find, access, interoperate and re-use research data. It is recognised that FAIR data play an essential role in the objectives of Open Science to improve and accelerate scientific research, to increase the engagement of society, and to contribute significantly to economic growth. Accordingly, the EU's Open Science policy⁴⁶ contains the ambition to make FAIR data sharing the default for scientific research and this can be accelerated by focusing on specific scientific disciplines. Although the FAIR principles were initially applied to research data, their coverage extends to all digital objects that are essential to research practice (e.g. algorithms, models, tools, workflows), and to other public sector data. However, initiatives for good data management and stewardship practices and FAIR practice remain fragmented across borders and disciplines. In addition, interoperability remains the least developed to date. Interoperability standards, at discipline-level first, and then across disciplines, are an essential catalyst to foster interdisciplinary science to tackle the global societal challenges of our age. Finally, FAIR digital objects related to the research process are increasingly indispensable to ensure the reproducibility, integrity and re-use of data.

Proposals should support international cooperation on the FAIRness of both data & digital objects in a discipline-specific manner. Applicants should map current initiatives and best practices, globally, within a given scientific discipline, and should facilitate the exchange of best practices across disciplines. They should support case studies and pilots to implement both domain-specific and domain-independent recommendations in FAIR practice (from the Research Data Alliance –RDA-, the Committee on Data of the International Science Council - CODATA-, etc.). They should develop, pilot and possibly deploy interoperability standards and guidelines for increasing FAIRness in specific scientific disciplines, and across different disciplines. They should also develop assessment and evaluation methodologies to appraise FAIRness within disciplines and to develop domain-specific benchmarks.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes, proposals are expected to cooperate and align with activities of the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC) Partnership and to coordinate with relevant initiatives and projects contributing to the development of EOSC. In particular, in areas such as data interoperability, metadata and vocabularies or the use of persistent identifiers, proposals should coordinate the work and establish a feedback mechanism with the awarded proposal(s) from the topic HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-05 in order to ensure alignment with EOSC policies and to identify common useful tools and resources as well as relevant data repositories that comply with EOSC guidelines.

⁴⁶ <https://ec.europa.eu/digital-single-market/en/open-science>

Proposals are also expected to engage and/or align where appropriate with projects funded under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-03 and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-04. Finally, if appropriate, proposals should further seek alignment with disciplinary use cases for FAIR as will be developed under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-06, HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-07, and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-03.

Any prospective alignments should be clearly acknowledged in the proposals, which should foresee dedicated activities and earmark appropriate resources for such activities.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved understanding of the current landscape of institutional scientific publishing activities across Europe.
- Coordination amongst institutional publishing services and initiatives across Europe at the non-technological level and improve their overall service efficiency, in particular in a multilingual environment.
- Actionable recommendations for strategies regarding institutional publishing in research performing organisations across the European Research Area.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices in the European Research Area.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Recent years have witnessed a sharp increase in open access publishing activities. Commercial scientific publishers and other service providers have turned their attention to open access publishing, responding to increased demand for open access by funders and research performing organisations. Research institutions have also developed their own open access publishing activities and services. These are either new and based on open access

publishing, or are existing publishing activities transitioning into the new digital and open access environment. Libraries are often involved, while new types of mission-driven open access university presses are also emerging in Europe and beyond. Such initiatives do not require article fees for publishing, and are often supported by their institutions. They enable open access publishing of journals and other types of outcomes in various languages and are important in supporting multilingualism in Europe. At the same time, they often have not gained the prestige bestowed on established publishing venues, usually produced in collaboration with well-known commercial scientific publishers. Moreover, institutional publishing in the social sciences and the humanities is often in languages other than English, which is both an asset and a limitation.

This action aims to support institutional publishing initiatives across Europe to improve the quality of their non-technological services to researchers, and to overcome fragmentation, specifically:

1. Activities that provide a comprehensive map of the current landscape of institutional publishing activities across Europe, through the collection of robust empirical evidence on service provision mechanisms, funding processes, gaps, among other things to be specified;
2. Activities that improve the coordination, quality and services of existing and substantial institutional open access publishing in EU member states and associated countries. This can be achieved, in particular, by establishing minimum shared standards and good practices for the non-technological aspects of their services, such as developing high quality journal policies and procedures to make services more efficient and more attractive for researchers (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), developing appropriate business/funding models that support the long-term provision of services, etc.;
3. Explicit and actionable recommendations for strategies and policies to be adopted by research institutions to support the further flourishing of their mission-driven, open access publishing activities in a coordinated fashion across Europe.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting:* This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining:* This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ege-statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIÈGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Août 7, Liège 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷

Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting:* This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining:* This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ege-statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects ⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from ongoing and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV ČR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects ⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNYCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-20: Towards a Europe-wide training and networking scheme for research managers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved knowledge for policy making about the training and networking patterns of research support staff and research management
- Measures to increase awareness amongst research management staff about existing training, networking and mobility opportunities at EU, national, and regional levels
- Ultimately, increased capacity and compatibility of cooperation and funding systems throughout the ERA for research management, and support to scientists.

- Improved awareness of the EU policy drivers and the EU research peculiarity in the Higher Education Institutions and Research organisations
- Preparation of the establishment of (a) central hub(s) to provide the EU research system with the most appropriate “fit for purpose” skills in EU research management, with active involvement of entities located in widening countries
- Provide recommendations aiming at facilitating a clear career path for research managers at national and EU levels, enhancing their role towards the achievement of the new ERA objectives, including those addressed in the related Council Conclusions on the New European Research Area (13567/20).

Scope: Research management can take many shapes: research policy advisers, research managers, financial support staff, data stewards, research infrastructure operators, knowledge transfer officers, business developers, knowledge brokers, innovation managers, etc. Entities and regions who are proven strong and excellent hubs in knowledge creation and innovation usually rely on a strong population of research managers.

This topic aims at improving training and skills development of research management staff, to develop better research and innovation management capacity and guidance for researchers across the entire ERA, as well as pave the way towards institutional acknowledgement of the research management profession.

Proposals are expected to map and analyse the EU landscape of research management and the financial framework to support it. They should address a wide scope of activities, such as trainings, study visits, staff exchange, internships, exchange of good practices, development of guidelines for new research managers and policy recommendations on how to deliver on research management under the new ERA.

It could include piloting a European network for research managers, including research infrastructures managers, through the integration of existing capabilities of Research Organisations, Higher Education Institutions and institutes, networks or umbrella organisations in research management. Projects are expected to generate a wide outreach to the European community of research managers, active across the ERA.

Proposals should explore the possibility to create new training paths dedicated to research support/management staff, or to optimise integration of existing recognised institutional training and certification programmes for research managers. Both these solutions should aim also at developing recommendations to strengthen existing schemes at EU level.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-30: Implementation of a new macro-economic modelling concept

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Project results are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better integration of research and innovation activities in macro-economic models, leading to better measurement of their impact and a better understanding of the channels through which research and innovation lead to impact (direct and indirect) in Europe.
- Improved macro-economic modelling for the evaluation of R&I policy, at the different levels of policy intervention (EU, national, regional), and reinforced alignment between the development of models and policy use, for example in the context of assessing policy options.
- Reinforcement of the scientific community focused on the role of research and innovation in the EU economy based on macro-economic models and increased interactions between this community and policy makers in charge of R&I policy in Europe.

Scope: This action will operationalise the recommendations of the “Expert Group to advise on further development of the macro-economic modelling agenda” run during the period 2019-2020, which can be found in the report of the Group⁴². Based on these, it will implement a renovated macro-economic modelling concept to improve the treatment of R&I and R&I policies in macroeconomic models, by developing a modelling framework consistent with the most recent empirical evidence and the theoretical state of the art.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-32: Standardisation Booster for fostering exploitation of FP-funded research results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR

⁴² The report is available here: <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/47086c5e-f249-11ea-991b-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-153127582>.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Increased participation of research performers in standardisation activities
- Increased development of new standards or revision of existing standards to reply to new industrial and market conditions through contribution of EU research performers
- Increased uptake of new technologies resulting from boosting standardisation activities

Scope: The Standardisation Booster will help beneficiaries, whose H2020 and Horizon Europe research results appear likely to lead to the revision or creation of a standard, to test the relevance of their results for standardisation activities. This booster will be open for on-going and closed H2020 and Horizon Europe projects. This service will help these beneficiaries to engage with standardisation bodies and contribute to the preparation and elaboration of standardisation activities, such as participating in a focus group, setting up a new technical committee, drafting a technical specification or a technical report, participating in awareness events.

The Standardisation Booster will serve as a standardisation proof of concept scheme. The consortium will manage the scheme and should be able to engage with high-level independent experts in standardization in order to assess the standardization potential of research results. The consortium will select H2020 or Horizon Europe projects with a high likelihood of leading to the preparation and elaboration of standardisation activities, while ensuring geographical and gender balance.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-33: R&I intensive IP management: Scenarios for the future

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A mapping of the forthcoming technology process trends and the IP framework relevant for R&I that will go with these
- An assessment of the current intellectual property methods and how fit for purpose they are taking into account the transformation of research results into markets / socio-economic benefits
- Development of scenarios with potential new protection mechanisms that will benefit both the research community and society.
- Set of guidelines to R&I actors, notably the research generators, for the protection and use of intellectual property assets.
- Set of recommendations for policy makers regarding the future needs for framework conditions relevant for R&I.
- Establishment of a communication channel with the aim of promoting an open dialogue on R&I driven intellectual property needs, bringing together various stakeholders and practitioners and providing a feedback loop between practitioners and policy makers regarding emerging needs.

Scope: Technology sovereignty requires, together with investment, an in-depth understanding of the research and innovation landscape. The current Open Innovation strategies, the ever growing Open Science practices and the artificial intelligence revolution create an ecosystem where the innovations happen faster than ever (machine learning, big data etc.). This topic will look at ways to overcome the existing gaps researchers have to face when following unconventional discovery methods (e.g. artificial intelligence, computer inventions etc.).

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-40: Modelling and quantifying the impacts of open science practice

Specific conditions

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the strategies, methodologies, models, and raw and analysed data deriving from their activities. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Structured evidence of scientific, societal and economic impacts of open science practice, complemented by the new methods, tools and data required to measure them.
- Better knowledge on how impacts develop and how a diversity of benefits can be achieved at scientific, societal and economic levels.
- Better understanding on how the practice of open science can contribute to the increased reproducibility of research results.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Prioritisation of policy actions for open science, and improved policy making on open science.
- Maximised impact of open science.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Open science consists of sharing knowledge and data as early as possible in the research process, in open collaboration with all relevant actors, including citizens. The mainstreaming of open science practice⁴³ is driven by expected impacts: (i) on the research

⁴³ Open science practice includes: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

system, e.g. increased efficiency, better reliability, and better responsiveness towards societal challenges; (ii) on the innovation system, e.g. faster innovation when results are shared earlier, and innovations more directed towards societal challenges; (iii) on the interface between science and society, e.g. more productive interactions among academia and other knowledge actors, and higher trust of society in the science system when researchers and citizens are engaged. While past projects have started building an evidence base, this remains fragmented and incomplete. A broad and comprehensive evidence base would help define new policies for open science, drive further uptake and help communicate on open science.

Proposals are expected to:

- systematise and evaluate the validity and robustness of existing literature, data and evidence of impacts of open science practice, including potential legal and licensing issues;
- leverage and valorise the body of knowledge resulting from the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes;
- complement existing evidence and develop scientific methodologies and models to capture impacts, notably those relating to socio-economic, including gender equality related, environmental and public health aspects. It is in particular expected to develop and implement methods for measuring the contribution of open science practice to the reproducibility of research results, and the implications of involving citizens, civil society and end-users in R&I;
- perform cost/benefit analyses of open science practice and conduct research to identify by which causality/mechanisms the impacts develop.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-41: Global cooperation on FAIR data policy and practice

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may

	exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic, and with the EOSC Partnership⁴⁴. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries will be subject to the additional exploitation obligations: Beneficiaries must make all relevant results generated in the action available for re-use, through a well-defined mechanism, to the EOSC Partnership. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened international cooperation to increase and mainstream FAIRness⁴⁵ of data and digital objects.
- Connection of disconnected initiatives on data management, data stewardship and FAIR data practices, across borders and disciplines, as enablers of open science.
- Increased FAIR data sharing within and across scientific disciplines and innovation sectors.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Proliferation of interdisciplinary research that helps address societal challenges.
- More efficient research practices as a result of an increased reproducibility of research and reduced duplication of efforts.
- Better informed citizens and society about the results and value of research.
- Improved quality of R&I within the EU.
- Contributions to sustainable growth and faster innovation in Europe, and beyond, in the context of the global economy.

⁴⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/info/files/european-open-science-cloud-eosc_en

⁴⁵ 'FAIRness' is the compliance with the requirements of FAIR data.

Scope: Technological advancements have made science more data intensive and interconnected, with researchers producing and sharing increasing volumes of research data. To produce high quality research data, researchers have to follow good data management and data stewardship practices. Beyond proper data collection, annotation and archival, good data management and stewardship include long-term care of valuable digital assets, either alone or in combination with newly generated data. To maximise the value of science, research data should be FAIR: Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable. The FAIR principles, introduced in 2014, are a minimal set of community-agreed guiding principles that allow both machines and humans to find, access, interoperate and re-use research data. It is recognised that FAIR data play an essential role in the objectives of Open Science to improve and accelerate scientific research, to increase the engagement of society, and to contribute significantly to economic growth. Accordingly, the EU's Open Science policy⁴⁶ contains the ambition to make FAIR data sharing the default for scientific research and this can be accelerated by focusing on specific scientific disciplines. Although the FAIR principles were initially applied to research data, their coverage extends to all digital objects that are essential to research practice (e.g. algorithms, models, tools, workflows), and to other public sector data. However, initiatives for good data management and stewardship practices and FAIR practice remain fragmented across borders and disciplines. In addition, interoperability remains the least developed to date. Interoperability standards, at discipline-level first, and then across disciplines, are an essential catalyst to foster interdisciplinary science to tackle the global societal challenges of our age. Finally, FAIR digital objects related to the research process are increasingly indispensable to ensure the reproducibility, integrity and re-use of data.

Proposals should support international cooperation on the FAIRness of both data & digital objects in a discipline-specific manner. Applicants should map current initiatives and best practices, globally, within a given scientific discipline, and should facilitate the exchange of best practices across disciplines. They should support case studies and pilots to implement both domain-specific and domain-independent recommendations in FAIR practice (from the Research Data Alliance –RDA-, the Committee on Data of the International Science Council - CODATA-, etc.). They should develop, pilot and possibly deploy interoperability standards and guidelines for increasing FAIRness in specific scientific disciplines, and across different disciplines. They should also develop assessment and evaluation methodologies to appraise FAIRness within disciplines and to develop domain-specific benchmarks.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes, proposals are expected to cooperate and align with activities of the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC) Partnership and to coordinate with relevant initiatives and projects contributing to the development of EOSC. In particular, in areas such as data interoperability, metadata and vocabularies or the use of persistent identifiers, proposals should coordinate the work and establish a feedback mechanism with the awarded proposal(s) from the topic HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-05 in order to ensure alignment with EOSC policies and to identify common useful tools and resources as well as relevant data repositories that comply with EOSC guidelines.

⁴⁶ <https://ec.europa.eu/digital-single-market/en/open-science>

Proposals are also expected to engage and/or align where appropriate with projects funded under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-03 and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-04. Finally, if appropriate, proposals should further seek alignment with disciplinary use cases for FAIR as will be developed under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-06, HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-07, and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-03.

Any prospective alignments should be clearly acknowledged in the proposals, which should foresee dedicated activities and earmark appropriate resources for such activities.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved understanding of the current landscape of institutional scientific publishing activities across Europe.
- Coordination amongst institutional publishing services and initiatives across Europe at the non-technological level and improve their overall service efficiency, in particular in a multilingual environment.
- Actionable recommendations for strategies regarding institutional publishing in research performing organisations across the European Research Area.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices in the European Research Area.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Recent years have witnessed a sharp increase in open access publishing activities. Commercial scientific publishers and other service providers have turned their attention to open access publishing, responding to increased demand for open access by funders and research performing organisations. Research institutions have also developed their own open access publishing activities and services. These are either new and based on open access

publishing, or are existing publishing activities transitioning into the new digital and open access environment. Libraries are often involved, while new types of mission-driven open access university presses are also emerging in Europe and beyond. Such initiatives do not require article fees for publishing, and are often supported by their institutions. They enable open access publishing of journals and other types of outcomes in various languages and are important in supporting multilingualism in Europe. At the same time, they often have not gained the prestige bestowed on established publishing venues, usually produced in collaboration with well-known commercial scientific publishers. Moreover, institutional publishing in the social sciences and the humanities is often in languages other than English, which is both an asset and a limitation.

This action aims to support institutional publishing initiatives across Europe to improve the quality of their non-technological services to researchers, and to overcome fragmentation, specifically:

1. Activities that provide a comprehensive map of the current landscape of institutional publishing activities across Europe, through the collection of robust empirical evidence on service provision mechanisms, funding processes, gaps, among other things to be specified;
2. Activities that improve the coordination, quality and services of existing and substantial institutional open access publishing in EU member states and associated countries. This can be achieved, in particular, by establishing minimum shared standards and good practices for the non-technological aspects of their services, such as developing high quality journal policies and procedures to make services more efficient and more attractive for researchers (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), developing appropriate business/funding models that support the long-term provision of services, etc.;
3. Explicit and actionable recommendations for strategies and policies to be adopted by research institutions to support the further flourishing of their mission-driven, open access publishing activities in a coordinated fashion across Europe.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting:* This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining:* This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_ece_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNYCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-41: Global cooperation on FAIR data policy and practice

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may

	exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic, and with the EOSC Partnership⁴⁴. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries will be subject to the additional exploitation obligations: Beneficiaries must make all relevant results generated in the action available for re-use, through a well-defined mechanism, to the EOSC Partnership. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened international cooperation to increase and mainstream FAIRness⁴⁵ of data and digital objects.
- Connection of disconnected initiatives on data management, data stewardship and FAIR data practices, across borders and disciplines, as enablers of open science.
- Increased FAIR data sharing within and across scientific disciplines and innovation sectors.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Proliferation of interdisciplinary research that helps address societal challenges.
- More efficient research practices as a result of an increased reproducibility of research and reduced duplication of efforts.
- Better informed citizens and society about the results and value of research.
- Improved quality of R&I within the EU.
- Contributions to sustainable growth and faster innovation in Europe, and beyond, in the context of the global economy.

⁴⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/info/files/european-open-science-cloud-eosc_en

⁴⁵ 'FAIRness' is the compliance with the requirements of FAIR data.

Scope: Technological advancements have made science more data intensive and interconnected, with researchers producing and sharing increasing volumes of research data. To produce high quality research data, researchers have to follow good data management and data stewardship practices. Beyond proper data collection, annotation and archival, good data management and stewardship include long-term care of valuable digital assets, either alone or in combination with newly generated data. To maximise the value of science, research data should be FAIR: Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable. The FAIR principles, introduced in 2014, are a minimal set of community-agreed guiding principles that allow both machines and humans to find, access, interoperate and re-use research data. It is recognised that FAIR data play an essential role in the objectives of Open Science to improve and accelerate scientific research, to increase the engagement of society, and to contribute significantly to economic growth. Accordingly, the EU's Open Science policy⁴⁶ contains the ambition to make FAIR data sharing the default for scientific research and this can be accelerated by focusing on specific scientific disciplines. Although the FAIR principles were initially applied to research data, their coverage extends to all digital objects that are essential to research practice (e.g. algorithms, models, tools, workflows), and to other public sector data. However, initiatives for good data management and stewardship practices and FAIR practice remain fragmented across borders and disciplines. In addition, interoperability remains the least developed to date. Interoperability standards, at discipline-level first, and then across disciplines, are an essential catalyst to foster interdisciplinary science to tackle the global societal challenges of our age. Finally, FAIR digital objects related to the research process are increasingly indispensable to ensure the reproducibility, integrity and re-use of data.

Proposals should support international cooperation on the FAIRness of both data & digital objects in a discipline-specific manner. Applicants should map current initiatives and best practices, globally, within a given scientific discipline, and should facilitate the exchange of best practices across disciplines. They should support case studies and pilots to implement both domain-specific and domain-independent recommendations in FAIR practice (from the Research Data Alliance –RDA-, the Committee on Data of the International Science Council - CODATA-, etc.). They should develop, pilot and possibly deploy interoperability standards and guidelines for increasing FAIRness in specific scientific disciplines, and across different disciplines. They should also develop assessment and evaluation methodologies to appraise FAIRness within disciplines and to develop domain-specific benchmarks.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes, proposals are expected to cooperate and align with activities of the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC) Partnership and to coordinate with relevant initiatives and projects contributing to the development of EOSC. In particular, in areas such as data interoperability, metadata and vocabularies or the use of persistent identifiers, proposals should coordinate the work and establish a feedback mechanism with the awarded proposal(s) from the topic HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-05 in order to ensure alignment with EOSC policies and to identify common useful tools and resources as well as relevant data repositories that comply with EOSC guidelines.

⁴⁶ <https://ec.europa.eu/digital-single-market/en/open-science>

Proposals are also expected to engage and/or align where appropriate with projects funded under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-03 and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-04. Finally, if appropriate, proposals should further seek alignment with disciplinary use cases for FAIR as will be developed under topics HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-06, HORIZON-INFRA-2021-EOSC-01-07, and HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-03.

Any prospective alignments should be clearly acknowledged in the proposals, which should foresee dedicated activities and earmark appropriate resources for such activities.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improved understanding of the current landscape of institutional scientific publishing activities across Europe.
- Coordination amongst institutional publishing services and initiatives across Europe at the non-technological level and improve their overall service efficiency, in particular in a multilingual environment.
- Actionable recommendations for strategies regarding institutional publishing in research performing organisations across the European Research Area.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices in the European Research Area.
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Recent years have witnessed a sharp increase in open access publishing activities. Commercial scientific publishers and other service providers have turned their attention to open access publishing, responding to increased demand for open access by funders and research performing organisations. Research institutions have also developed their own open access publishing activities and services. These are either new and based on open access

publishing, or are existing publishing activities transitioning into the new digital and open access environment. Libraries are often involved, while new types of mission-driven open access university presses are also emerging in Europe and beyond. Such initiatives do not require article fees for publishing, and are often supported by their institutions. They enable open access publishing of journals and other types of outcomes in various languages and are important in supporting multilingualism in Europe. At the same time, they often have not gained the prestige bestowed on established publishing venues, usually produced in collaboration with well-known commercial scientific publishers. Moreover, institutional publishing in the social sciences and the humanities is often in languages other than English, which is both an asset and a limitation.

This action aims to support institutional publishing initiatives across Europe to improve the quality of their non-technological services to researchers, and to overcome fragmentation, specifically:

1. Activities that provide a comprehensive map of the current landscape of institutional publishing activities across Europe, through the collection of robust empirical evidence on service provision mechanisms, funding processes, gaps, among other things to be specified;
2. Activities that improve the coordination, quality and services of existing and substantial institutional open access publishing in EU member states and associated countries. This can be achieved, in particular, by establishing minimum shared standards and good practices for the non-technological aspects of their services, such as developing high quality journal policies and procedures to make services more efficient and more attractive for researchers (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), developing appropriate business/funding models that support the long-term provision of services, etc.;
3. Explicit and actionable recommendations for strategies and policies to be adopted by research institutions to support the further flourishing of their mission-driven, open access publishing activities in a coordinated fashion across Europe.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting:* This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining:* This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/eg_e_statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022 Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-44: Societal trust in science, research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Recommendations for policy makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors for tackling societal mistrust in science, research and innovation;
- Recommendations for strengthening the co-creation of R&I contents by society, and for the spreading of good practices and evidence of their effects.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values.

Scope: Societal trust in the research system and confidence in its outcomes is vital to ensure the EU's contribution to attain the Sustainable Development Goals and to achieve the European Green Deal targets; for the uptake of innovation in society; and for continued public support for investment in R&I.

Trust depends on scientists and engineers' capacity to demonstrate high standards of research integrity, an ethical mind-set, critical thinking and rigorous exploration of ideas in an open, transparent manner; and their desire to maximise the societal relevance, robustness and overall quality of outcomes. This, in turn, is fostered by conducive institutional governance arrangements and policy environments. In addition, citizen and civil society's involvement in co-creating R&I agendas and contents makes research more relevant and responsive to society and strengthens co-ownership and trust in scientific evidence and innovation.

However, not all research is conducted in line with these high standards. Rules and guidelines are sometimes missing or ignored, research protocols and raw data are not always published, methodological limitations may be inadequately addressed, inappropriate statistical analyses may lead to exaggeration of conclusions, papers are generally only published when significant results are obtained, and self-interest may interfere in peer-review processes. A significant part of research cannot be reproduced and therefore cannot be relied upon to build a solid base for policy or innovation, and this leads in turn to a decrease in societal trust in research and innovation. Compounding this, research often addresses issues of limited direct relevance to end-users, or comes to conclusions that are wildly out of step with societal needs and values, including gender equality related ones, because societal input to setting the research agenda and taking part in research is often treated as an afterthought – long after innovations and research trajectories have been decided.

To better understand the nature and scale of the sources and consequences of mistrust of society in science and the challenges of science-society co-creation, a series of expert workshops, small-scale studies and participatory research actions should take into account existing knowledge (including from projects funded under previous Framework Programmes) and should lead to new and robust evidence and analysis, as a basis for further policy action.

Evidence from relevant Eurobarometers, and national science barometers, should form particularly important inputs to this action.

The action should involve a broad range of potential users and stakeholders and the general public in co-creation (e.g. civil society, businesses, research/academia, public authorities and policy makers), develop policy guidance and recommendations, and implement innovative means of communicating and disseminating the findings and messages. As such, Responsible Research and Innovation could be a relevant research approach. Close co-operation should be sought with relevant projects to encourage uptake and early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45: Support to changes in the assessment of research and researchers to reward the practice of open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated information on initiatives for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, taking better account of open science practice⁴⁷.
- Connection of existing initiatives at European level, facilitating mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders.
- Pilots on new metrics, methods and institutional changes for reforming the assessment of research and researchers, which lead to better rewarding the practice of open science, as well as related issues such as gender equality, science education, and academia-industry collaboration.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Researchers incentivised to practice open science.
- Increased impact of open science.

⁴⁷ Open science practices include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: The current evaluation and funding system of research and researchers is limiting open science practice, as it is still largely based on inappropriate indicators, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers rather than quality of (collaborative) open research practice and socio-economic impact of research. For the focus to shift to quality over quantity, and to more efficient and impactful research, changes are required in the institutions performing and funding research and innovation. One way of doing this is for research funding and performing organisations to develop and implement strategies and policies that reward the practice of open science in the evaluation of research and researchers.

A few institutions in Europe, including some universities, are currently taking steps to reward the practice of open science, by reforming the assessment system of their research and researchers. The proposals should build on these various institutional initiatives, on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programmes such as the “*Science with and for Society*” part of Horizon 2020, as well as on policy work conducted by the Open Science Policy Platform and by several umbrella organisations of research performing and research funding organisations. The proposals are expected to support the sharing of information at European level across institutions and umbrella organisations, to identify good practices, and to develop guidance and recommendations on institutional changes with respect to rewarding researchers for open science practices. The proposals should also pilot the development, implementation and monitoring of new methods, associated metrics, strategies and policies, by clusters of funders and/or research performing organisations, for research and research career assessment that integrates open science practices, in several EU member states and associated countries.

To ensure complementarity of outcomes and synergies, applicants are expected to cooperate with projects to be funded under topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-50: Protection of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations against conventional and non-conventional threats

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Increase the awareness of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to conventional and non-conventional threats
- Boost the capacities of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations to deter and respond to non-conventional threats
- Improve the resilience of Higher Education Institutions and research organisations

Scope: The EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations continue to face serious threats, such as to academic freedom, freedom of research and institutional autonomy, as well as increasing distrust in science and scientific experts, next to various forms of foreign interference. In addition, acute threats increasingly take non-conventional forms, such as cyber-attacks, infiltration or disinformation campaigns. These actions seek to access research findings, destabilise and endanger our higher education and research institutions and undermine our fundamental European values. To respond to these threats, the EU Higher Education Institutions and research organisations need to boost significantly their capacities in detecting and tackling these threats and they need to be well informed and geared with simple and effective tools ensuring security while respecting the openness of research and innovation. Given the very nature of the topic, continued exchange with member states and relevant stakeholders is necessary in order to expand the knowledge of conventional and non-conventional threats to Higher Education Institutions and research organisation, and develop appropriate actions.

Proposals are expected to: (i) analyse possible threats and identify mitigation measures; (ii) increase awareness of threats within higher education institutions and research organisations; (iii) promote networking and optimising of infrastructure and resources to ensure adequate preparedness and prevention at European level.

In the framework of the new ERA, this action should also complement and reinforce EU action for academic freedom as well as the European *Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60: A capacity-building and brokering network to make citizen science an integral part of the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthened links and collaboration between citizen science initiatives and other research and innovation actors;
- Increased capacity to conduct excellent research and innovation through citizen science, while maximising other potential benefits of citizen science;
- Data infrastructures better aligned to the needs of citizen science, and improved data practices employed by citizen science initiatives;
- Europe positioned as a leader in citizen science throughout the entire research and innovation system with flourishing and mutually beneficial global collaborations.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens in research and innovation;
- Increased public trust in research and innovation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- Increased openness of the EU R&I system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, it is embedded institutionally only to a limited extent, at an early stage of developing data infrastructures, and lacks the capacities and sustainable resourcing required to live up to its potentials.

This action will become a central point of exchange between citizen science in Horizon 2020, Horizon Europe, and other EU-level and sub-national programmes and initiatives. It should amplify significant outcomes of citizen science in areas such as Horizon Europe's Missions, should they be confirmed, Clusters and Partnerships, the Sustainable Development Goals, and the Green Deal, across all parts of the research and innovation system. It should maintain up-to-date repositories of initiatives, good practices and tools, and become a stage for discussion and collaboration.

It should offer extensive *in situ* brokering, skills, training, and capacity building services to citizen science practitioners, civil society, public authorities, businesses/SMEs, formal and informal education establishments, and research funding and performing organisations, with a view to raising their awareness, knowledge and skills to collaborate with, support, and implement citizen science.

Co-ordination of and support for citizen science to work towards FAIR (and in many cases open) data should cut across activities. The action should become a key interlocutor between citizen science initiatives and existing thematic databases and infrastructures. It should support - and 'connect the dots' between - existing efforts to make citizen science data FAIR and open, make new efforts to liaise between citizen science and infrastructures where they are needed, identify unmet needs, and develop policy recommendations. Overall the action should move citizen science towards open science as its *modus operandi*.

Underlying these activities should be efforts to reduce disparities in awareness and actual practice of citizen science across disciplines in the ERA (e.g. at local, regional, national and EU levels). Moreover, significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in citizens' involvement in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation and mutual learning that promise tangible scientific, societal or policy impacts is advised.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The action should be no shorter than 3 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61: Supporting and giving recognition to citizen science in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement. Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prize. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Significant number of experimental citizen science initiatives kick-started;
- Significant number of citizen science initiatives supported to become sustainable;
- Significant number of newcomers to the Framework Programme and a significant number of citizens involved in co-producing scientific knowledge;
- Increased recognition of excellent citizen science initiatives throughout the European Research Area;
- Improved evidence base for making policy on citizen science.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased engagement of citizens with science and researchers with citizens;
- Increased public trust in science;
- Increased alignment of strategic research with society needs, expectations and values;
- Better understanding among citizens of the process of building scientific knowledge through experimentation;
- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science;
- A more open and inclusive research and innovation system.

Scope: Citizen Science is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that shows huge promise in terms of collecting new qualities and quantities of data, harnessing collective intelligence, improving science-society literacy, and improving the relationship between science and society. However, financial support is not well adapted to the needs of small-scale and experimental activities and many citizen science initiatives that have proven their worth fail to sustain over the longer term. In addition, citizen science is under-recognised for its role in bridging between science and society, under-utilised where it is needed such as in relation to the Green Deal and the Sustainable Development Goals, and practitioners of citizen science are insufficiently recognised within the EU research and innovation system as conducting high-quality activities that can have numerous side-benefits.

In order to help remedy these weaknesses in the European research and innovation system, this action will launch two calls for proposals through financial support to third parties:

- *Kick-starting*: This will kick-start and provide support services to *at least* 100 citizen science activities that are at the conceptual or pilot stage and which show promise in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, or generating other important benefits.
- *Sustaining*: This will support *at least* 25 on-going or recent citizen science activities to find ways to sustain their activities; these will have shown their worth in terms of innovative theme or approach, collecting and analysing data, generating other important benefits, or have particular potential to scale up across member states or the ERA.

The two calls may be launched over one or more waves but it should not be necessary to be supported by the ‘kick-starting’ call to apply for ‘sustainable’ call. Efforts should be made to evaluate the response to the open calls, capture the benefits arising from the citizen science activities it kick-starts (social, economic, democratic, scientific, etc.), and develop intelligence about factors that support or hinder the sustainability of successful citizen science initiatives.

In addition, this action should launch a European Union Prize for Citizen Science (funded by the action through financial support to third parties) open to all citizen science initiatives

involving research and innovation actors, including civil society organisations, in the European Union. The action should prepare, publicise and launch the competition, organise a high-profile award ceremony and showcase the breadth and scope of excellent citizen science activities taking place across the European Union. In close liaison with the Commission throughout the process, the action should decide on the award categories, setup the panel of experts that will evaluate the contestants, and develop the conditions for participation and the award criteria that enable identification of excellent/best-in-class examples of citizen science in terms of their contribution to the scientific evidence base and/or other benefits (e.g. societal, economic, democratic). The action should also set up a comprehensive communication strategy around the prize. Prizes should be awarded to several winners (e.g. for different categories) and be funded through financial support to third parties. Each prize should be in the range of EUR 10 000 – 60 000.

Across all three of parts (kick-starting, sustaining, and the citizen science prize), the action should consider citizen science across all areas of research and innovation and take into account all of the different forms of participation that citizen science can entail without prejudice to any. Significant efforts should be made to be inclusive in terms of geography, gender, ethnicity, disability, age, socio-economic background etc. The large majority of the funding should be allocated to the activities to kick-start and sustain citizen science initiatives. The action should develop policy recommendations, policy briefs, and other research and innovation results/outputs and disseminate its experiences and learnings widely.

The action should build on and valorise the results of earlier projects in the Science and Society (FP6), Science in Society (FP7) and Science with and for Society (Horizon 2020) programmes, in particular projects focused on public engagement, responsible research and innovation, and citizen science, as well as of national and regional initiatives, and should aim to provide a seamless transition between previous supporting actions and this new action.

The project should last a minimum of 4 years.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70: Developing a STE(A)M roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 1.75 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Better knowledge on policy deficiencies and better understanding of needs;
- Identify synergies between second and third level education, and between education and business;
- Contributions to future Policy actions;
- Promoting an integrated learning continuum between second and third level education and between education and business;
- Convince students and citizens about the opportunities within policy areas such as the Green Deal, Digitisation and Health.

Scope: Europe needs more scientists and Europe needs a science literate society. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of Europe's scientists and medics in keeping our society safe and healthy. The comprehensive recovery package to help the EU rebuild highlights the importance and necessity of major EU policies on the European Green Deal, the Digital transition and Health, all of which call for more highly educated European scientists.

In order to increase the uptake in science careers, to feed the talent pipeline, a plan of action is needed to encourage more interest in STE(A)M for young and old alike, with a focus on also increasing female participation and deconstructing gender stereotypes. The use of artistic approaches to STEM involving creative thinking and applied arts (the "A" in STEAM) could prove particularly useful in this regard. Convince students and citizens of the importance of policies such as the Green Deal and Digitisation and the opportunities that exist within these areas. Science is not just about hard science; it encompasses a world of technology not always obvious to the student and undergraduate. It is important to take into account the needs of industry in education and to develop work ready students and graduates. Introduce the concept of open schooling. Support formal, informal and non-formal science education initiatives, in synergy with the European Education Area.

This action should develop and deliver a STEAM roadmap for Science Education in Horizon Europe, in synergy with Erasmus. The action should develop strategies to increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, demonstrate the breadth of content available for consideration, align the needs of society and industry with education to prepare students to become active citizens and ready for the world of work, develop synergies between second and third level education and promote science education mainstreaming in funded projects.

The action should consider current policy initiatives and identify gaps and overlaps or duplication of effort. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁴⁸, as well as with projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap), and consider links with other policy domains.

⁴⁸

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80: Centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in Research & Innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge, policy and practice on inclusive gender equality in research and innovation institutions across Europe, with an intersectional, geographically inclusive, and multi-sectorial approach.
- Reduced disparities across Member States and strengthening of the European Research Area and its gender equality and inclusiveness objective.

Scope: As having a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place is becoming an eligibility criterion for legal entities applying to Horizon Europe, and, as the new European Research Area Communication of 30 September 2020 is foreseeing stronger measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans, there is a strong need for expert policy and knowledge support for inclusive GEP implementation, in research and innovation (R&I) organisations (including research funding and performing organisations, incl. companies and SMEs) across EU Member States. In order to adapt to different national and local situations, and help foster effective transformation in countries and institutions less advanced in the field of gender equality in R&I, a first European centre of excellence on inclusive gender equality in R&I will be created.

Building on projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including projects ACT, GE Academy, GENDERACTION, and the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans funded under the SwafS work programme 2020, as well as on initiatives developed by existing national or regional centres of excellence and knowledge centres on gender equality in R&I in Europe, and by European R&I stakeholder umbrella organisations, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Establish a sustainable European Centre of Excellence and think tank to advance and disseminate knowledge on inclusive gender equality policies in R&I, addressing three levels of inclusiveness, i.e.: the intersectional level, considering intersecting social categories such as ethnicity (including migration and refugees), disability, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ issues) or else social origin; the sectorial level, to better address innovation and the private sector; and geographical inclusiveness. This Centre could work as a single entity or as core centre and network of hubs in different Member States, and should involve experts from different Member States, including widening countries.
- Provide expertise and support to Member States, R&I organisations, and the European Commission, in the design, implementation and assessment of institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans, including through the design and delivery of tailored training activities on inclusive gender equality in R&I, and the development of an enhanced Community of Practice on gender equality and diversity in R&I organisations, including R&I performing and funding organisations.
- Provide expert support for the collection of pan-European data on gender equality in R&I and the development of new indicators, including on intersectionality. Collected data should cover also information on the uptake and implementation of gender equality plans in EU Member States and Associated countries, and contribute to the She Figures⁴⁹ publication.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81: Policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome:

Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Development of a consistent and sustainable coordination network of national representatives on gender equality and inclusiveness in support of the implementation of

⁴⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

the ERA Communication policy objectives, leading to better coordination of Member States' efforts.

Scope: The new European Research Area (Communication of 30 September 2020 on “A new ERA for Research and Innovation”) is foreseeing strong measures to promote inclusive gender equality plans in Research and Innovation (R&I) organisations, in line with the European Strategy for Gender Equality for the period 2020-2025, to which R&I, and Horizon Europe, must contribute actively. As the new ERA Communication and the Council Conclusions of 1 December 2020 on the new ERA underline, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within the Member States. Ensuring the active promotion of equal opportunities for all includes opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else socio-economic status; geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

Building on related projects and actions supported through Horizon 2020, including project GENDERACTION, the action focuses on the establishment of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g. ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop various innovative and engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy makers, as well as contribute to policy making at national and European administration level.
- Provide support and advancing the knowledge of representatives of widening countries is of particular importance. The action should also develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise for gender equality and mainstreaming in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender representatives to acquire expertise.
- Establish a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of a gender-inclusive culture change in R&I institutions across Europe, linked through a Memorandum of Understanding. Specific attention should be paid to promoting the development of incentives or setting requirements at research funding level to foster institutional change in organisations, as well as establishing a zero-tolerance policy on gender-based violence including sexual harassment in R&I organisations.
- A specific focus should also be placed on promoting the integration of the gender dimension into R&I content, with an opening to intersectionality. For this, the action

should foresee mobilising national expertise on the integration of the sex and gender analysis in R&I content to support the different Horizon Europe National Contact Points in all EU Member States.

- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project must engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-90: The challenges of research ethics and integrity in response to crisis: the coronavirus pandemic and beyond

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform

	Embassy of Good Science⁵⁰, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁵¹ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵². The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Crises, and in particular health related ones, have become a dramatic reality for the EU and globally since the beginning of the coronavirus pandemic. Scientific knowledge focuses the attention, as it is a key element to address the urgency of the situation in an effective way and improve preparedness for the future. The extremely heavy human, social, cultural and economic consequences associated with the time pressure sets exceptional conditions calling for an adaptation of the way and procedures to work, and decide and prioritise which inevitably raises associated ethical questions. Some research topics have an intrinsically complex ethics dimension, for example research on the imposing of protection measures, health care prioritization, consequences for family life, and gender impacts on health.

In this context, the activity proposed is expected to propose an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Scope: The first priority is to analyse what characterises, from an ethics perspective, a crisis of a global, sudden and unexpected nature of the type of the Covid-19 pandemic, and isolate what are the related ethics and integrity challenges as regards the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data⁵³ in designing and implementing responses as well as in anticipating future global urgencies.

Derogations of human rights and freedoms, albeit in the interests of the public good, must be temporary, proportionate, used only as last resort, and critically there must be clear transparent criteria for their suspension e.g. in the form of sunset clauses to emergency legislation. The greatest danger – during and after the end of any formal ‘state of emergency’ – is a ‘new normal’ of eroded rights and liberties.⁵⁴ For example, the pressing need to collect large amounts of personal data raises important questions regarding the preservation of

⁵⁰ www.embassy.science

⁵¹ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁵² <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁵³ The need for the sharing of data was emphasised in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures, COM(2020) 687 final, <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/communication-additional-covid-19-response-measures.pdf>

⁵⁴ Statement on European Solidarity and the Protection of Fundamental Rights in the COVID-19 Pandemic, European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/research_and_innovation/egge/ec_rd_egge-statement-covid-19.pdf

privacy⁵⁵, and should be assessed carefully against the need to ensure information of data subjects and the possibility to pursue alternative means.

An important element that characterises major crises is that they go beyond the impact on the wellbeing of persons and touches the society more globally notably in terms of solidarity and social justice, as well as gender equality. Mid and long-term social, cultural and economic consequences are also more prominent in these unusual research contexts. The issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent, undue inducement, the right to know, and to opt out should be among the elements to tackle.

Based on this analysis, the action should draw the lessons and examine how to adapt processes followed under normal conditions (e.g. for informed consent, regulatory approvals etc.).

The scope should also cover the ethics of the scientific work on public health measures (such as behavioural studies, communication strategies, gender impacts on health⁵⁶), including those aiming at an increased preparedness. The objective is to cover emerging ethics issues related to new concepts like “immunisation certification” that are at the centre of vivid debates involving fundamental values.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of coping with the urgency and the magnitude of the impact of a crisis (including the moral distress of the front line personnel, a large majority of which are women). Another important example is the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhance the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole⁵⁷. Emergency needs adaptation should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

The work should be based on existing know how and identification of preparedness need. The joint advice on “Improving Pandemic Preparedness and Management”⁵⁸ by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors (GCSA), the European Group on Ethics in Science and New Technologies (EGE) and Peter Piot, special advisor to the President of the European Commission, should be considered. In a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g. researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers and citizens) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings) the activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture, and promote openness, communication and dialogue. This must be done in cooperation with ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁵⁹ and ENERI

⁵⁵ The full respect of the data protection law with regard to contact tracing technologies was reaffirmed in the Commission Communication on the on additional COVID-19 response measures.

⁵⁶ See European Institute for Gender Equality (2020) Covid-19 and gender equality, <https://eige.europa.eu/topics/health/covid-19-and-gender-equality>.

⁵⁷ Ibid. The Commission Communication calls for a “robust authorisation process” to ensure safety.

⁵⁸ <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a1016d77-2562-11eb-9d7e-01aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-171481573>

⁵⁹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

(European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁰. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged.

The action should result in (A) the identification of policy options at EU level (including those to address possible legislation gaps) and practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders notably the ethics committees and integrity bodies. The European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁶¹ should be a main reference.

The work undertaken should also result in (B) operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams.

The need to complement the European Code⁶² with specific guidelines should be assessed and a proposal (C) for short documents complementing the Code should be made, focusing for example on fast track processes (ethics review, publication etc.).

In addition, this action should produce (D) traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. Case studies (for example on mobile tracing apps) should be included in order to facilitate practical learning. The material, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶³. Where relevant the EU Digital education plan⁶⁴ should be taken into account.

Although the main focus should be on the recent Covid-19 pandemic, it is also important to have in mind the wider objective of addressing the ethics of global crisis of the same kind (manmade or not). The action should in this regard present a generalised version of the produced recommendations and guidelines and training material.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects⁶⁵ (e.g. SHERPA, SIENNA, Panelfit, SOP4RI) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science and the European Networks ENERI and ENRIO, with clear attribution of research ethics and research integrity responsibilities, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-91: Ensuring reliability and trust in quality of Research Ethics expertise in the context of new/emerging technologies

Specific conditions	
Expected EU	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 4.50

⁶⁰ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶¹ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁶² Ibid.

⁶³ www.embassy.science

⁶⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁶⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>contribution per project</i>	million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at least two participants from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁶⁶, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁷ and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)⁶⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Ensuring the adherence to the highest standards of research ethics is a key element of national and EU research policy. Because of its universal impact on our society and its primary role in innovation, the need for ethics rigour, the pillar of public trust in the scientific endeavour, is essential. Overall, research ethics is the foundation of high quality research and a prerequisite for achieving excellence in research and innovation in Europe and beyond.

In order to ensure that the research activities meet these expectations, they need to comply with the relevant legislations (e.g. on personal data protection, clinical trials, animal research

⁶⁶ www.embassy.science

⁶⁷ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁶⁸ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

etc.) and ethics principles. Assessing the compatibility with ethics principles requires the involvement of ethics experts that usually provide, as an ethics committee/panel an opinion or an approval. These experts, including early career researchers, come from all disciplines in science, from the public and private sector, as well as from citizens associations and NGOs.

Reliability and trust in the quality and expertise of the ethics experts is therefore key. This requires beyond the questions related to the independence and the possible conflicts of interest, that the experts have the necessary knowledge and understanding of the issues at stake to be able to assess the activity under review.

The recent rapid development of new technologies with high potential socio-economic impact⁶⁹ constitutes in this regard an important challenge: ensuring that technological transformations go hand in hand with the protection and promotion of fundamental rights thus ensuring that people can prosper, enjoy their rights and freedoms and live without discrimination.⁷⁰ In this context, because of the continuous globalisation of the research activities involving those new technologies, the risk of ethics dumping, the exportation of unacceptable practices outside the EU is a growing concern.

The action proposed should address these issues in mobilising the research ethics community and develop the necessary education, awareness and training actions as well as propose possible adaptation of the ethics review process.

Scope: The first objective should be to identify the main ethics challenges resulting from the most impactful new and emerging technologies, including the specific challenges arising from research activities involving those new technologies in collaboration with non-EU partners and outside the EU.

From this analysis, the action should develop education, awareness actions and trainings for research ethics experts. This should be done by involving the key stakeholders. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷¹ and the European networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁷² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices) is necessary. The cooperation with other relevant networks can be envisaged. In addition, where feasible these activities should be based on the analysis of case studies, including from non-EU countries where relevant research activities take place, to facilitate the development of practice-oriented trainings as well as the identification of good practices. The material produced, as well as all other outputs of the action, must be made available in the platform Embassy of Good Science, a one stop shop for all Commission produced ethics and research integrity reference materials

⁶⁹ Applicants may consult : https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/what-are-technologies-will-reshape-our-world-independent-experts-identify-100-them-2019-jun-13_en

⁷⁰ Presidency conclusions - The Charter of Fundamental Rights in the context of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Change, Brussels, 21 October 2020 (OR. en) 11481/20 FREMP 87 JAI 776

⁷¹ www.embassy.science

⁷² <http://eneri.eu/>

and trainings, which can be readily used by all Members States and beyond. Where relevant, the EU Digital Education Action Plan⁷³ should be taken into account.

The action should be based on the results coming from projects funded by the EU⁷⁴ on the ethics dimension of new technologies and other relevant domains (notably SIENNA, PANELFIT, SHERPA, I-CONSENT, ENERI, and TRUST) as well as benefit from the work of the project SOP4RI, working on standard operating procedures and VIRT2UE working on a train-the-trainer programme. For the ongoing projects, cooperation and synergies should be established, via a dedicated horizontal coordination work package. This work package should also pay particular attention to the cooperation with the projects resulting from call H2020-SwafS-2020-1 TechEthos, HYBRIDA and ROSiE.⁷⁵ The involvement of the stakeholders such as ENERI and ENRIO should also be used to launch a debate on the impact of the new ethics challenges on the ethics review process to determine how its role and working practices could evolve to maintain effectiveness.

In addition, this cooperation with the main actors should aim at disseminating widely the material produced. The action should in this context foresee the training of the 250-300 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings. More largely, the institutions organising ethics reviews (universities, research centres, etc.) should be invited to ensure that the experts they rely on are also trained, as part of their quality process and standard operating procedures.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising the work produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts and in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks (such as EUA, YERUN, LERU, CESAER, EARMA etc.) in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with actors from China, Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Call - European Research Area

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)⁷⁶

⁷³ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

⁷⁴ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

⁷⁵ Ibid.

⁷⁶ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ⁷⁷	Number of projects expected to be funded
		2022		
Opening: 19 Jan 2022				
Deadline(s): 20 Apr 2022				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10	CSA	7.50	2.00 to 3.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30	CSA	3.00	Around 1.50	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31	CSA		Around 0.00	0
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40	CSA	5.00	Around 5.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41	RIA	4.00	Around 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50	CSA	3.00	1.50 to 2.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51	CSA	10.50	2.50 to 3.50	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70	CSA	5.50	1.50 to 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80	RIA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		59.00		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General
---------------------------------	---

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

⁷⁷ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITIZING INVESTMENT AND REFORM

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i, 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNYCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i, 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸² <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNYCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERth), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERth, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV ČR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i, 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNÝCH CINNOSTÍ AV ČR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilksi Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Août 7, Liège 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERth), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERth, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from ongoing and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FUR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Federal de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLECNÝCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i., 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-10: Support for policy makers – Programme level collaboration between national R&I programmes

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.00 and 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 7.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting the market, regulatory or societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contribution to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) and starting with FP6, Programme level collaboration among Member States and their research and innovation programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than € 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

The new policy approach to European Partnerships limits co-funding to Member State collaboration to Union and Horizon Europe priorities. Therefore, the ERA part of the Horizon Europe provides the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice.

The successful proposal should align national and regional research funding programmes (managed by national or regional programme owners / managers) on agreed common priorities and implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls. Proposers have to demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnership Initiatives.

Applicants should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposal should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level research and innovation. The proposal should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

Participation of legal entities from third countries, and/or regions including those not automatically eligible for funding is encouraged.

The actions should envisage a duration which is appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-30: Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Test the new ERA Hubs⁷⁸ concept across different geographies and structures in Europe, based on common compliance criteria; the process should act as an incentive for advanced ecosystems to seek recognition, and for less advanced ecosystems to reach the criteria facilitating support from European, national and regional level.
- Better coordinate relationships between the European Research Area and relevant national or regional stakeholders in order to ensure the smart directionality introduced in the new ERA.
- Develop a common platform for collaboration and best practice sharing across borders, sectors and disciplines on knowledge production, circulation and use, and facilitate cross-fertilisation and smart directionality among ecosystem actors to achieve transformative changes and advance Europe together.
- Increase both the interoperability of the European ecosystems and the intra-operability within each territorial ecosystem, aiming to improve coordination, and foster excellence.
- Facilitate a better circulation and absorption of talents in countries/regions, as well as improve knowledge circulation and uptake of research results;
- Provide a toolbox of best practices for researchers, innovators, industry and institutions across Europe to cooperate.

⁷⁸

See COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Scope: A vibrant ecosystem is an essential condition for growth. In order to take full advantage of possible synergies and complementarities between the EU and national and regional ecosystems for knowledge production, circulation and use, there is a need to make compatible and interoperable the policy frameworks that govern existing structures for knowledge transfer and sharing, and address common criteria for assessing work, processes and outputs. Reinforcing the networking interconnecting geographically or thematically, the ecosystem actors on the basis of smart specialisation and other strategic considerations, such as value chains, will consequently stimulate excellence and complete the coverage across Europe.

This action should build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme on Knowledge Ecosystems, which provides among others a mapping of existing ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use across Europe, as well as designing the ERA Hubs concept as a toolbox of pre-defined common standards of work, processes and outputs, and key performance indicators on operational, programme and strategic impacts. The concept should be tested on collaborations, platforms, or other structures bringing together ecosystem actors, and increase networking between those structures in a coordinated approach, around a common agenda and compliance criteria. The rollout of the concept across Europe is expected to support and coordinate the efforts at local and regional level for the implementation of a pan-European ERA Hubs initiative.

The scope of this action is to pilot the ERA Hub concept with a limited number of ecosystems through implementation in countries and regions where knowledge ecosystem structures aligned to the ERA Hubs concept already exist, combined with countries or regions where an integrated place-based approach is missing. The main goal of the action is to fine-tune through experimentation the designed concept of ERA Hubs and its technical specifications and compliance criteria, share practices, as well as provide a toolkit of best practices and activities that ensure a strong basis for a potential scale-up in different geographies across the EU territory in the next phase.

Projects will be assigned to entities or networks of structures involved in knowledge production, circulation and use activities at European, national, regional or city level, which should take the coordination role in orchestrating the actors of an ecosystem working together to implement the ERA Hubs concept, in pursuit of intra-operability with the territorial ecosystem and a common agenda supporting the economic transitions and smart specialisation strategies, as well as job creation and skills development to better absorb talent in a country or region. These structures could be entities that have the competences and/or the willingness to become pioneers, benchmarks and ambassadors of the new concept and should include higher education institutions or their tech transfer offices, research institutes, business schools, private companies, not for profit organisations, or entities already part of pan-European networks or coming from different funding communities, in order to better connect those communities.

Support from institutional, regional, or national sources is highly encouraged (proven through e.g. letters of commitment), in order to make considerable progress in the deployment of the ERA Hubs initiative in the respective country or region.

The action should include the development of an independent monitoring mechanism to assess the progress of the ecosystem actors engaged in a common agenda and implementation of the ERA Hubs concept in a dedicated country or region. On the basis of the assessment, projects should also provide recommendations on how to deploy the ERA Hubs in different geographies and regions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31: Innnowwide Bridging Facility

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Contributing to implementing the political priorities of the new European Commission, in particular in relation to the objective of ‘A stronger Europe in the world’, and in relation to the EU communication on the comprehensive Strategy with Africa, aiming to support building knowledge economies
- Economic growth and job creation in the EU and in Africa, contributing to the AU Agenda 2030 and relevant EU policies, and enhancing the visibility of EU R&I at the international scene
- Transfer and internationalisation of demonstrated technologies and know-how, both to and from the EU and Africa

Scope: Competition has become global and so is innovation. To compete effectively in new and emerging markets, European and African SMEs need to develop partnerships with their strategic counterparts to generate joint business opportunities in new product-market combinations. Developing a new product-market combination with a strategic partner can be very challenging for SMEs on both continents in terms of technological & financial risks, and market barriers. Before starting, it is essential to assess first the technical feasibility as well as developing a deep understanding of the business environment, including the financial, legal, market and cultural aspects in the targeted markets. This instrument will allow European and African SMEs to develop a partnership beyond conventional market studies, sales channels and export aids. This Horizon Europe funded ‘INNOWIDE Bridging Facility’ precisely covers these risks, by supporting innovative European and African SMEs in conducting Viability Assessment Projects (VAPs) in Europe and Africa, creating the favourable conditions needed to increase the uptake of European and African innovative solutions in each other’s markets. An SME friendly bottom-up approach applies, with no specific technical areas to be addressed.

The VAPs will be selected following a series of open calls organised by the action. The proposal for undertaking the action should define the organisational process for selecting the VAPs for which financial support will be granted, including the process of selecting, allocating and reporting on the use of independent experts and ensuring no conflicts of interest.

At least 75% of the EU funding shall be allocated to financial support for the third parties carrying out the selected VAPs.

The calls should specify that each VAP should include a wide variety of activities to explore the practical, technological and commercial viability of an innovative solution in particular in terms of how it needs to meet local conditions and demands.

Proposals must detail the different types of activities for which a third party may receive financial support such as market studies, partner search and networking, approaches for client/user involvement including societal, behavioural and cultural aspects, and other activities aimed at overcoming barriers for market introduction and uptake.

Proposals must clearly detail the criteria for awarding financial support and simple and comprehensive criteria for calculating the exact amount of such support, which may not exceed EUR 60 000 for each VAP. The award criteria must be objective and non-discriminatory.

Each VAP shall be led by an entity established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country and shall involve at least one entity established in an African country.

The open calls must be published widely, and Horizon Europe standards with respect to transparency, equal treatment, no conflict of interest and respect of confidentiality must be adhered to. The results of the calls must be published without delay, including, for each VAP,

a description of the project, the legal name and country of the third party, the start date and duration of the project, and the amount of the award.

Proposals should specify how they will promote the calls, how they will monitor and report on call results and how they will assess the quality of the outcomes and experiences from the VAPs, as well as how they will provide regular in-depth analyses and which indicators will be used for measuring the impacts achieved. Analyses should draw up R&I policy conclusions on questions such as which additional joint R&I activities in third countries should be supported, what framework conditions for R&I cooperation need improving, and what further R&I support services should be implemented.

The Commission does not intend to implement the action and will not fund the topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-31.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-32: An experimentation space for the uptake and use of R&I results for EU resilience and future preparedness

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- A methodology and toolbox to design and implement testing of policy relevant findings stemming from European R&I that can contribute to EU resilience and future preparedness.
- A knowledge base of EU research findings, with high capacity to inform policy and engage citizens and research communities, that are tested, including the methodologies for testing (small scale experiments, randomised control trials etc).
- Lessons learnt to enhance the use of R&I results to enable fast response in the face of future crises and strengthen economic and social resilience, for example through

supporting policy reforms, new regulation, social innovation, behavioural change, new technology adoption and the integration of the gender dimension.

Scope: R&I results and new scientific knowledge can inform policy making and help address societal challenges through new technological and societal solutions, as well as through providing policy recommendations and policy options with a proper (scientific) understanding of the underlying conditions. Testing policy recommendations and findings of scientific research through experiments and novel methodologies increases understanding of the implications, risks and opportunities of possible new solutions, enabling societies to respond faster and more effectively to crises and build resilience and social cohesion.

This action aims at increasing the visibility and fostering the use of R&I results with high policy relevance to contribute to the recovery and resilience of Europe, while engaging research communities and citizens in an “experimentation space” for new, science based, socially inclusive and gender responsive policy initiatives and solutions.

The action will match policy relevant findings for EU resilience stemming from research (such as from EU H2020, HE and previous programmes as well as other EU programmes, and national level publicly funded research) with national, regional and local needs, and carry out the experimentation phase in co-creation with the research communities and citizens. At the core of the action is the design of appropriate trial mechanisms that will test research findings which can be translated to policy and new societal solutions, and thereby provide policy makers and citizens with a high degree of confidence and trust in responding to new challenges.

The project consortium may consider links with related knowledge management activities by the European Commission, including the European Commission’s Knowledge Centres and the Knowledge for Policy Platform hosted by the Joint Research Centre.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

OPEN SCIENCE

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-40: Stepping-up institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from this work programme part subject to the same additional dissemination obligations. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on sustainable institutional and territorial changes towards open and responsible research and innovation;
- A central point of expertise providing services and support for research and innovation institutions, and territories, to open up to society;
- A significant number of institutions and territories in the European Research Area (ERA) become more porous to society, align with the needs, values and expectations of society, improve the excellence of their research and innovation, promote gender equality, and reduce instances of ethical misconduct;
- Reduction in disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to open and responsible research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Open and responsible research and innovation practices mainstreamed throughout territorial and institutional settings;

- Increased impact of EU R&I outputs and the conversion of knowledge and ideas into products and services.

Scope: Research and innovation institutions play a key role in creating an enabling environment for opening research and innovation towards society, sharing research outputs, improving research integrity and gender equality, and promoting science education, societal engagement (such as citizen science and other forms of co-design and co-creation) and two-way science communication. At territorial level, interactions between different institutions from across the quadruple helix ⁷⁹, and including societal actors such as civil society organisations and non-governmental organisations, are essential to ensuring that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation are aligned with the needs, values and expectations of society.

However, European research and innovation actors lack a consolidated evidence base and guidance based on EU investments in this area to date to support them, there are significant differences in attention to different aspects of responsibility and openness between institutions and territories, rewards and incentives at the workforce and institutional level are often misaligned or even disfavour openness to society, and there is no central point of reference or provider of services and expertise to turn to.

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first involves consolidating the evidence base and develop innovative guidance and other materials, which can support institutions and territories to implement sustainable institutional changes and open up to society⁸⁰. It should take into account and build on the learning and knowledge developed by Horizon 2020's Science with and for Society programme ⁸¹ and potentially other sources of knowledge.

The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching 'cascading grant' call(s) to support institutions and territories from across the ERA to implement sustainable institutional changes towards open and responsible research and innovation. This may require consultancy or other kinds of support services to be developed and rolled out to successful institutions. A significant number of institutional changes (e.g. 70-100 individual institutional changes) should be expected in beneficiary organisations and territories. As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to the 'cascading grant' mechanism. One or more call(s) for proposals should be launched, which could focus on specific disciplines,

⁷⁹ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁰ Institutional changes are characterised as: 1) a change to how the institution governs/structures itself, 2) expected to have meaningful impact within the institution concerned, 3) intended to last beyond the lifetime of funding (i.e. not one-off activities). See <https://op.europa.eu/s/olV2>.

⁸¹ Particularly relevant projects to build upon were supported by: ISSI-5-2014, GARRI-1-2014, ISSI-5-2015, SwafS-04-2016, SwafS-05-2017, SwafS-05-2018-2019, SwafS-14-2018-2019-2020, SwafS-23-2020. Moreover, this action should build on the evidence base for benefits developed by the MoRRI and Super_MoRRI projects. Projects focused on implementing Gender Equality Plans under SwafS (including those supported by topics GERI-4-2014, SwafS-03-2016-2017, SwafS-09-2018-2019-2020) may also be of relevance. The RRI-Tools project, from FP7's Science in Society programme, may also be relevant: <https://rri-tools.eu/>.

MoRRI country clusters⁸², or other pertinent criteria, but with the underlying goal of reducing disparities between institutions and territories in terms of their attention to different dimensions of openness and responsibility.

The third part involves acting as a central point of expertise and support services on open and responsible research and innovation for institutions and projects under Horizon Europe and within the European Research Area. This point of expertise should have appropriate high-level visibility, and the ability to interact and support all parts of the research and innovation system (all parts of quadruple helix, disciplines, sectors). In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international networking is advised to support co-operation on the issue at global level and provide expertise in support of institutions and projects.

The action should evaluate its impacts and develop recommendations useful to policy makers and those responsible for the governance of research and innovation institutions. The action should raise awareness of the benefits of open and responsible research and innovation to organisations across the ERA. It should develop close co-operation with other relevant projects, with a view to fostering collaboration and the early sharing of knowledge and evidence.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 4.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to freely share, in a timely manner and as appropriate, all relevant results with the other grants awarded from the same call topic. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁸²

<https://op.europa.eu/s/olV4>

- Structured understanding of the underlying drivers, of concrete and effective interventions - funding, community-based, technical and policy - to increase reproducibility of the results of R&I; and of their benefits;
- Effective solutions, policy-, technical- and practice-based, to increase the reproducibility of R&I results in funding programmes, in communities and in the dissemination of scientific results;
- Greater collaboration, alignment of practices and joint action by stakeholders to increase reproducibility, including but not limited to training, specialised careers and guidelines for best practice.

These outcomes should contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results from publicly funded R&I;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Reproducibility refers to the possibility for the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators of a specific finding. As such, reproducibility is core to scientific progress, and there is debate on whether there is a ‘crisis of reproducibility’ in contemporary science. At a time when funding levels for R&I are under scrutiny globally, and societal trust in the outcomes of research and innovation become increasingly essential, there is a need to address inefficiencies in the research process, to avoid useless and costly repetition, to maximise return on investment in R&D&I, to prevent the propagation of mistakes, and to facilitate the translation of results into innovations.

Therefore, this topic aims to fund activities to

- a) determine how increased reproducibility generates gains and savings in the R&I process and improve overall performance - alongside the demonstrated positive effects on their quality, integrity and trust-worthiness, and
- b) find, experiment and mainstream concrete solutions and best-practices to increase the reproducibility of research funded with European taxpayers’ money, including through the more systematic integration of sex and gender as variables whenever relevant.

Consequently, actions should help understand and promote reproducibility by:

- 1) creating an open knowledge base of results, methodologies and interventions on the drivers and consequences of reproducibility for the R&I system; and to fill the main gaps in such knowledge;
- 2) develop, validate, pilot and deploy practices and practical tools for funders, publishers and scientists;

3) promote uptake, greater collaboration, and increased alignment of the activities of stakeholders - scientific and technical communities, publishers and funders among others - to increase reproducibility.

Finally, projects should assist further policy development on reproducibility, based on scoping work by the Commission⁸³. While solutions should be applicable to Europe, attention should be paid to reproducibility in global science.

It is expected that the funded action(s) will adhere to best practices in open science and reproducibility (e.g. re-use existing results, fully document the research process), and provide a final reflection based on their own experience at the forefront of reproducibility.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-42: Supporting the development of aligned policies for open access books and monographs

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Improve the understanding of the current landscape of scientific book and monograph publishing in different fields of science in which it plays an important role, and in particular the bottlenecks in strategies and policies for their open access.
- Support aligned funder and institutional policies for open access monographs and books within the open science culture in the European Research Area and facilitate their coordination.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Address and increase equity, diversity and inclusivity in open science practices⁸⁴ inside the European Research Area.

⁸³ i.e. <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

- Increased capacity in the EU R&I system to conduct open science and to set it as a *modus operandi* of modern science.

Scope: Monographs, books and other types of long-text formats are very important outputs in some disciplines, such as in the Social Sciences and the Humanities. Whilst many disciplines rely nearly exclusively on the production of articles, professional advancement requirements, as well as the nature of the research and the writing process in some disciplines, result in the unwavering significance of long-text formats and monographs, both in the digital and in the print formats.

Open access for monographs and other long-text formats has been a slow process in multiple aspects. This is likely because of the higher costs and business models of book publishing, as well as a hesitancy on the side of researcher to trust important parts of their work in terms of volume to the new open access publishing environment. Additionally, funder policies and strategies focus a lot less on monographs than on journal articles, and they are often recommendations and not requirements.

This action aims to support the development of aligned institutional and funder policies and strategies regarding open access to books and monographs in Europe. In this context, the action should support: 1. activities that foster greater understanding of bottlenecks in the development of policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs by institutions and funders; 2. the coordination of policies amongst funders and research institutions, and the sharing of good practices in policies and strategies for open access to books and monographs; 3. actionable and evidence-based recommendations and resources for comprehensive institutional and funder policies for open access to books and monographs. The action may also envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and associated countries.

The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-44: Developing and piloting training on the practice of open and responsible research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

⁸⁴ Open science practices may include: providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, crowd-sourcing of solutions to a specific problem); participation in open peer-review; measures to ensure reproducibility of results; and involving citizens, civil society and end-users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and content, including citizen science.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Beneficiaries must make proactive efforts to disseminate policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance. Beneficiaries must acknowledge and incorporate this obligation in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them, and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidated evidence base on open and responsible research and innovation⁸⁵ training for researchers at all stages of their careers across the European Research Area.
- Development and piloting of high-quality training to a significant number of researchers on diverse aspects of open and responsible research and innovation.
- Establishment of a platform for further development of training, mutual learning, and dissemination of recommendations to authorities and institutions responsible for researcher training.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Improved skills leading to greater employability and career prospects for researchers.
- Improvements in the excellence of the science conducted, improved capacity within the European Research Area to tackle societal challenges, greater interaction between science and society, improved overall effectiveness of EU research and innovation funding.
- Improved engagement and cooperation of researchers, with communicators, journalists, industry, policy maker and civil society.

Scope: In order to ensure the excellence of EU research and innovation, the research workforce needs to strengthen skills related to integrity, avoidance of various forms of bias, including gender bias, non-discrimination and inclusion, FAIR data management, data robustness and reproducibility, dissemination and exploitation of results, and interdisciplinary research. It requires skills to communicate science and research results, in the media (including social media) and to policy makers, and skills to participate in public debates. It also requires skills to engage the public to develop research and innovation agenda, the ability

⁸⁵ Responsible research and innovation involves multi-actor and public engagement in research and innovation, easier access to scientific results, the take up of gender and ethics in the research and innovation content and process, and formal and informal science education.

to work in multi-actor collaborations covering all parts of the quadruple helix⁸⁶ where interests and motivation for engaging in research may be diverse, and actively involve citizens in research activities such as citizen science to expand the scope and the potentials of science itself. These skills are needed at all stages of researchers' careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training).

This action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating existing evidence⁸⁷ on researcher training on open and responsible research and innovation, at all stages of their careers, from undergraduate onwards (including as part of doctoral training), and identifying gaps in existing practices in the European Research Area. This will include mutual learning activities within and outside the European Research Area to ensure established and emergent good practices are considered. Existing initiatives, such as the European Charter and Code⁸⁸ and the EU Principles for Innovative Doctoral Training⁸⁹, should be taken into account.

The second part consists of developing training modules, courses or other kinds of interventions on open and responsible research and innovation that will be piloted to a significant number of students and researchers in different kinds of research organisations and higher education organisations across Europe, and at all stages of their studies and careers. The learning outcomes will be evaluated, with a view to refining the training ready for more widespread deployment (e.g. at national, institutional levels, or in MSCA actions). Attention should be paid to the gender dimension of the training/learning outcomes, and to ensure that the training is adapted and piloted to researchers of all backgrounds (age, ethnicity, geography, gender, etc.).

The third part consists of establishing a platform, sustainable beyond the lifetime of project funding, to continue knowledge exchange, develop guidance, and further develop training on open and responsible research and innovation. Part of the work must include the wide dissemination of policy recommendations aimed at relevant research institutions and levels of governance.

Working closely with relevant on-going actions, quadruple helix stakeholders, and science outreach stakeholders, is advised. The action is also expected to build on and valorise results from projects already funded under the "Science with and for Society" part of Horizon 2020.

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS AND RESEARCHERS

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

⁸⁶ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁸⁷ In addition to relevant national-level initiatives, or even initiatives outside the EU, this includes Horizon 2020 projects supported through topics SEAC-2-2014 and topic SwafS-08-2019-2020 under Science with and for Society; the Horizon 2020 Innovative Training Networks supported through the MSCA-ITN topics as well as the COFUND projects for doctoral programmes under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions, and the Erasmus+ European University Alliances and Horizon 2020 top-up pilot.

⁸⁸ <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/charter>

⁸⁹ <https://www.euraxess.be/belgium/jobs-funding/doctoral-training-principles>

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-50: Developing an effective ERA talent pipeline

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Several projects may work in parallel and contribute to several of the following expected outcomes:

- Creation of a common academic researchers' career structure, taking into account new developments and diversification of careers in academia, based on practices in Member States, linking it to the updated European Skills Competences and Occupations (ESCO) framework⁹⁰
- Enabling widespread recognition of the ESCO qualifications profile, more precisely the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs in various stages of their careers have obtained, both within and outside academia regardless of sector, discipline or location
- Mainstreaming of tenure track like systems, as an attempt to improve career development and solve part of the precarity of research careers in academia
- Mainstreaming practices for higher education institutions to involve non-academic sector from the onset in training & career development of PhD students
- Mainstreaming value creation and intersectoral mobility schemes within higher education institutions to promote jobs and growth.

Scope: The European Research and Innovation system needs to optimise its support for the constant flow-through of highly skilled talents to match the demand of society and the economy. Establishing an enhanced framework for researchers' careers within the EU towards a pipeline of highly skilled, creative, and resilient talents will accelerate the achievement of a knowledge-based society and economy.

The talent pipeline's main initiator remains the curiosity-driven approach to science, delivering creative and resilient individuals that can cope with change, for the benefit of society as a whole. The autonomy of organisations that are at the basis of the talent pipeline is an additional essential success factor for the ERA to provide visible value through excellence in research and innovation.

⁹⁰

<https://ec.europa.eu/esco/portal/home>

The framework aims at addressing: (i) the recognition of the research profession and PhD qualifications within and outside academia, the structuring of the researcher scientific career (i.e. to improve interoperability between academia and other employers), (ii) the diversification of the careers of talents trained as researcher, (iii) solutions to the precariousness of researchers' careers in academia including a model tenure-track system accompanied by possible standard principles, and (iv) strengthened interaction with business to facilitate access to the labour market.

The common framework for research careers is expected to be based on dynamic competence profiles of researchers in various stages of their diverse careers in order to enable widespread recognition of the competences that PhD trainees and postdocs have obtained, both within and outside academia independent of sector or discipline and geographical location. It should be translated in the new European competence framework⁹¹, which will need to be mainstreamed across Europe.

We expect projects to take measures to improve flow-through of talent within academia and to and from the non-academic sector or to other highly needed positions in academia, to (i) improve transferable skills training, involving non-academic actors in education and training of researchers from the onset, (ii) improve talent transfer to actors in the surrounding ecosystem, (iii) improve value creation practices among higher education institutions, (iv) communicate about the competences and qualifications of researchers and their talents to economic actors and society as a whole, (v) initiatives enabling the sustainable and dynamic interaction within and between the ecosystem actors for knowledge production, circulation and use, and stimulating career fluidity through inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mobility (bi-directionally), (vi) embed additional elements in the assessment schemes for both organisations and individuals at all career stages, (vii) propose methodologies on how to introduce skills requirements from the business, social and public sector to academia.

Activities should include the establishment of pilot (for instance) local talent management centres and training hubs that strengthen involvement of the non-academic sector in defining the priorities of researchers' training and lifelong learning upskilling. Attention should be paid to addressing gender equality related issues throughout the different strands of the proposed framework.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 2 years.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51: Acceleration Services in support of the institutional transformation of Higher Education Institutions

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 2.50 and 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and

⁹¹ COM(2020)628, Commission Communication, A new ERA for Research and Innovation

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 10.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes in relation to acceleration services in support of the institutional transformation of higher education institutions (HEI):

- A methodology towards acceleration services that can help HEI or alliances/networks of HEIs in pursuing institutional transformations, including a monitoring mechanism to assess quality of the delivered services.
- A coaching service with best practice examples and guidance for individual HEIs as well as networks of HEIs, aligned with the common transformation agenda, facilitating access to finance from various sources.
- Tested acceleration services with user groups (HEI umbrella organisations, individual HEIs, or networks of HEIs, including partners from surrounding ecosystems), supporting HEI or networks of HEIs in developing a strategy to pursue institutional transformations in the field of R&I.
- An investment strategy mechanism, implemented with the user group, facilitating access to funding from national, regional, or EU resources to deliver on the Higher Education Transformation Agenda.
- Progress of the user groups of the acceleration services regarding the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda, measured through a monitoring mechanism.
- Policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, and widespread dissemination of the pilot results to other target groups

Scope: The overall aim of the Higher Education Institutions acceleration services is to help institutions to successfully implement a strategy and roadmap for transformation, by creating a shared knowledge base, coaching service and virtual meeting place for them to connect with peers and other ecosystem actors, as well as with investors and public funders. The acceleration services should consist of (i) a coaching and support mechanism for HEIs to pursue institutional transformation in various areas, (ii) a methodology for an investment strategy to facilitate access of higher education institutions and surrounding ecosystem to support to deliver on the chosen transformations, (iii) a monitoring mechanism to assess progress in the transformation efforts. Projects should address all three aspects and test them with user groups.

HEIs, including universities, are crucial drivers of knowledge ecosystems, and increasingly also of innovation ecosystems. The new ERA is expected to strengthen the R&I dimension of

HEIs through a comprehensive institutional Higher Education Transformation Agenda in synergy with the European Education Area, reinforcing their role as drivers of change, fostering their recovery, enabling shared objectives between the EU and Member States' initiatives to support higher education institutions in their efforts to transform on their education, research, innovation and service to society missions. To deliver on the transformation agenda for HEIs a large-scale concerted action in support of the institutional transformation efforts of HEIs will be required, including a standard methodology to develop roadmaps of EU, national and regional actions and investment measures for institutions or alliances.

Projects should build on the results of previous analyses that set out a framework for empowering HEIs across Europe in their research and innovation mission, facilitating ongoing transformation processes based on universities' needs (*"Towards a 2030 Vision on the Future of Universities in the field of research and innovation in Europe"*, October 2020⁹²), and the analyses performed under the previous Work Programme (in particular the study *"Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures"*, 2021). The projects should link and build on the results of the initiative of the European Institute of Innovation and Technology (EIT) on Innovation Capacity Building for Higher Education launched in 2021 that has the objective to unlock the full innovation potential of higher education institutions (HEIs).

The Higher Education Transformation Agenda developed under the previous Work Programme is expected to include the most important priorities and challenges for HEIs regarding institutional transformations towards the future, including (trans)national cooperation with other HEIs, and the growing importance of engagement with a broad range of sectors and societal actors inherent to the multiple dimensions of HEI (education, research, innovation, service to society). Acceleration services should address all possible R&I areas of the Higher Education Transformation Agenda such as: (a) empower HEIs towards developing shared R&I strategies that deliver on Europe's challenges with critical mass; (b) facilitate the sharing of capacity, infrastructure and resources through collaborative settings, such as the European Universities initiative; (c) improve the attractiveness of researchers' careers, including through reform of the career assessment and incentives regimes; (d) facilitate co-operation with surrounding R&I ecosystem actors; (e) support the transition to knowledge- and digitally-driven HEIs that mainstream Open Science practices and include research and innovation outputs in teaching; (f) engage citizens in solving societal challenges; (g) support institutional change through inclusive gender equality plans.

Projects are expected to a methodology how to deploy such acceleration services including (i) access to coaches, mentors, expertise and training from academia or outside academia, with different profiles that match with the areas from the transformation agenda, which the project puts at the disposal of individual HEIs or networks of universities in need of institutional transformation in the field of R&I; these experts, coaches, mentors, etc should provide

⁹² <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/a3cde934-12a0-11eb-9a54-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

support for (ii) strategy development, (iii) roadmap development, and (iv) mapping of required support resources, as well as provide (v) detailed advice on access to funding from EU, national, and regional sources to allow the HEIs to deliver on the transformations; this should in particular include support and access to financial instruments for excellent research and innovation capacity, and support for disruptive innovation from academic sector, incl. spin-offs from universities and public research organisations, and cooperation agreements between academic and business sector. This should lead to a standard methodology to develop specific investment agendas for individual institutions or networks of HEI that consists of different funding and financial instrument branches, aligned with the priorities and areas of the common transformation agenda, and realising concerted support to the institutional transformation efforts universities want to engage in.

The acceleration services should be piloted together with large user groups (either individual HEI, networks or alliances of universities and surrounding ecosystem actors, or umbrella organisations of HEI), and progress of the users in the implementation of the chosen areas of the transformation agenda should be measured. Actions should therefore include an evaluation mechanism that enables to assess the strategies from individual HEIs or alliances of universities, pursuing institutional transformation towards universities of the future, for instance under supervision of an ‘acceleration board’ of independent experts. The evaluation mechanism should also monitor progress of the HEIs in the implementation of the chosen areas from the transformation agenda.

Projects should disseminate widely the methodology and the results of the pilot with user groups, as well as provide policy recommendations to the Commission and Member States on the acceleration services, in view of future targeted and synergetic actions in support of Higher Education sector.

The duration of the action should not exceed 5 years.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-60: A European competence centre for science communication

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Consolidation of knowledge and development of guidelines, tools, innovative strategies, and recommendations to improve science communication for all research and innovation actors;
- Establishment of a European competence centre for science communication, sustained beyond the lifetime of funding;
- Increased networking and mutual learning, higher quality, more trustworthy, and more rapidly mobilised science communication by national authorities, businesses, civil society organisations, other stakeholders and projects.

Scope: Science communication is a scientific discipline, an activity conducted by career scientists and science outreach organisations, and a specific career pathway followed by journalists. It has the potential to improve science-society relations by increasing the transparency of science, building trust in the processes and outcomes of science, and raising scientific literacy. It can also improve the uptake of science by society and support evidence-based policy making.

Science and science communication have been undergoing radical changes over recent years, creating opportunities that may, in turn, pose new challenges. For instance, traditional media are increasingly being superseded by social media with more user-edited content; rapid diffusion of open access or pre-peer review papers gives the general public access to research that was previously locked behind paywalls; and open data enable a wider set of actors to interact with, analyse and interpret research results than in the past.

The covid-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of communicating scientific knowledge and recommendations to respond to a fast-moving and critical threat. It is important to learn from this and other experiences when science communication has been essential to conveying scientific knowledge and recommendations on critical issues, to explaining how hypotheses, experiments and uncertainties are also part of the scientific method, to build capacities and strengthen networks, and to ensure greater ability in the future to react rapidly and effectively to critical situations.

This action has two parts, both of which must be addressed:

The first part consists of consolidating the evidence base on science communication from on-going and past projects and initiatives⁹³, covering a wide range of existing and potential critical areas for research and innovation for society. Particular attention should be paid to contextual issues (geography, gender, age, socio-economic status, etc.) that affect the uptake or effectiveness of science communication. Policy reports and recommendations, guidelines, and innovative strategies should be developed for all research and innovation actor types; potential targets should include government agencies and public authorities, research funding and performing organisations, and civil society organisations. An important outcome should

⁹³ In particular, but not limited to, projects supported by Horizon 2020's SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020 topic, but other relevant projects and initiatives within and outside the Framework Programmes should also be considered.

be the publication of one or more user-friendly handbook(s) for effective science communication, backed by an interactive and pedagogical online toolkit, for use by Horizon Europe projects. This part should involve all parts of the quadruple helix⁹⁴ in co-creation activities, to ensure that the outcomes are usable in different contexts, for different purposes, and by different research and innovation actors; considerable efforts to disseminate the findings across the European Research Area should be undertaken.

The second part will consist of establishing a centre of knowledge, expertise, advice, resources, and tools on science communication in the European Research Area. It should link to - and support - existing communities of knowledge and practice, with the goal of improving co-ordination and mutual learning between them. It should support potential user groups including R&I projects, public authorities, government agencies, the private sector, and civil society organisations, to improve and initiate trusted and impactful science communication. An important element will be preparing the European Research Area to react quickly to situations requiring science communication, and the ability to provide rapid advice and support, as required. The centre should work towards the sustainability of its activities beyond the lifetime of funding, including through the provision of a basket of services and other activities that have market value; a business plan should therefore be elaborated from the very earliest stages of the project.

The action should build on the knowledge, networks and capacities developed by Horizon 2020⁹⁵ and by national and regional initiatives and work closely with relevant projects. A minimum project duration of 4 years should be envisaged.

SCIENCE EDUCATION

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>

will build on projects and actions supported under Horizon 2020, including the EU Prize for Women Innovators and its network of awardees, project GENDERACTION, recommendations from the Horizon 2020 Expert Group to update and expand “Gendered Innovations/Innovation through Gender”⁹⁹ and outputs of projects funded under the SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap) topic. It will also complement initiatives led by the European Innovation Council, as well as EIT-led activities aimed at supporting women-led innovation.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Establish a sustainable learning and collaboration hub between various innovation ecosystem actors, including, e.g., women innovators, social innovators, education institutions, science and technology museums, foundations, start-ups and larger companies, as well as social science researchers and gender scholars from a variety of scientific disciplines.
- Develop real-life action research with above-mentioned stakeholders, based on the co-development and testing of user-centred and open and social innovation processes promoting gender equal participation, as well as integrating the gender dimension into their contents, with an opening to intersectional approaches considering social categories intersecting with gender such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or else social origin. A special focus should be placed on information technology and AI-related fields and Commission priorities such as the European Green Deal and the preparedness and response to future pandemics.
- Propose concrete new methods and solutions for the development of gender-responsive innovation in Europe.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply:

⁹⁹

https://ec.europa.eu/info/news/gendered-innovations-2-2020-nov-24_en

	The scheme must involve at least one leading university or research organisation in gender equality, and at least three less advanced institutions from Widening Member States or Associated Countries including countries from the Western Balkans
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and research excellence of less advanced institutions as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans.
- Transform institutions to advance inclusive gender equality within the European Research Area (ERA).

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans has had very positive impacts in many research organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as the latest ERA progress report has shown. However, there is a heterogeneity in the implementation of Gender Equality Plans across the EU, and persisting structural barriers in R&I institutions which must be addressed, through a renewed approach.

The inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum requirements for a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criteria, and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs in line with the new ERA Communication and gender equality objectives¹⁰⁰.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies, including new areas such as intersectionality and diversity, outreach beyond the organisation, gender budgeting, or gender and innovation among others, building on knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g. GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice). Advanced organisations will mentor on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities.
- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, including in the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

¹⁰⁰

https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/strategy/era_fr

The partners involved in the twinning exercise are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background for a better contextualization.

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-91: The empirical and behavioural approach to research ethics and integrity

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰¹, and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰² and ENRIO (European Network of Research Integrity Offices)¹⁰³. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science. .

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

¹⁰¹ www.embassy.science

¹⁰² <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰³ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

Trust in science is key for an inclusive, open and democratic society.¹⁰⁴ To sustain that trust, it is pivotal all research is conducted in line with the highest standards on research ethics and integrity. Research misconduct, in any stage of the research process, can undermine public trust in research and may amount to severe socio-economic consequences.

Several factors may lead researchers to breach research ethics and integrity standards and engage in questionable research practices. While some of these factors are systemic and institutional, individual factors may contribute to researchers' behaviour within the institutional environments in which they operate. While researchers mostly act with integrity, they sometimes (and often unintentionally) end up engaging in questionable practices that could lead to transgressions, engulfing research teams, departments, institutions and on rare occasions, even national research systems. In order to develop a comprehensive preventive policy and support research organizations and research funders to uphold the highest standards of research ethics and integrity, there is a need to explore in depth the behavioural and organizational factors that may facilitate researchers engaging in questionable practices and misconduct and develop methodologies to address those factors.

This action aims to improve the understanding of researchers' behaviours and incorporate this knowledge in measures aiming at enhancing promotion of ethics and integrity principles through shared responsibility (individual and institutional), improved education and training processes and qualified mentoring and support. Guaranteeing a generalised and consistently high level of research ethics and integrity, could drastically improve the relevance, robustness, accessibility and dissemination of research results and enhance societal trust in the scientific process.

Scope: In order to elucidate behavioural factors that may lead researchers to breach standards of research ethics and integrity, this action should perform a literature review, map the existing knowledge on behavioural ethics and moral psychology and identify research outcomes and research needs.

Based on the results of the literature review the action should develop a casuistry-based methodology to address research misconduct. This methodology should also take into account personal and institutional responsibilities for the promotion of research integrity and relevant research and efforts on the rehabilitation and reintegration of researchers. Particular attention should be paid to issues related to the mental health and wellbeing of researchers, especially for those employed in uncertain work conditions (short-term contracts, early career researchers, students, etc.), including with respect to bullying and sexual harassment as well as other forms of gender-based violence.

Based on the results of the literature review, the action should conduct a public consultation process with all involved stakeholders and ensuring adequate representation of young students and early career researchers. The literature review and the consultation process should also incorporate real life experiences from researchers, members of ethics and misconduct

¹⁰⁴ Bonn Declaration on Freedom of Scientific Research, adopted at the Ministerial Conference on the European Research Area on 20 October 2020 in Bonn, https://www.bmbf.de/files/10_2_2_Bonn_Declaration_en_final.pdf.

committees, Integrity and Ethics officers (and the local and national level). Participation of the private sector is strongly encouraged, especially as behavioural studies on ethical conduct in industry have been widely published and discussed.

Publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects¹⁰⁵ (e.g. SOP4RI, Integrity, PRO-Ethics, TRUST, PRO-RES, Path2Integrity) should be taken into account. Structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁶ and the European Network ENRIO, is necessary.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly advised, in particular with countries which have concluded an international agreement on science and technology with the European Union. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners.

The action should develop:

- i. An identification of current needs in improving institutional research culture, taking into account the potential unequal impacts on people of different genders;
- ii. Specific course material to enhance and supplement current efforts on research ethics and integrity that stem from (but not limited to) EU-funded projects (see <https://www.embassy.science/>);
- iii. Guidelines to facilitate adoption of the gained knowledge in host institutions - as a supplement to existing Standard Operating procedures (see SOP4RI, <https://www.sops4ri.eu/>). These guidelines should also cover responsible mentoring, supervision and role modelling;
- iv. Methodologies for measuring the short-, medium- and long-term impact of ethics and integrity trainings in the attitudes and behaviours of students and researchers and their ethical conduct in research and innovation; and
- v. A best practice manual, based on case studies of implemented measures that analyse what works and what does not work in various contexts, to enable practice-oriented learning.

All outputs of the action must be available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science web site (<https://www.embassy.science/>)

¹⁰⁵ Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS web site (<https://cordis.europa.eu/>)

¹⁰⁶ www.embassy.science

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS

GRANT TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. Support the Slovenian Presidency for the organization of an ERA Conference

As part of the implementation of the renewed ERA, the Slovenian Presidency will organise a major ERA conference in the second half of 2021. This high-level conference will engage in major political debates related to ERA as well as its future governance. This grant will support the government of Slovenia, and more concretely the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, in organizing this conference.

Legal entities:

Government of Slovenia, Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, Masarykova 16, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

2. Support to RESAVER Pension Fund

RESAVER Pension Fund is the first multi-country, multi-employers pension fund that enables mobile employees of the research institutions to remain affiliated to the same supplementary pension fund (2nd pillar and 3rd pillar) when moving between different countries and changing jobs.

The pension fund is based on the IORP II directive ((2016/2341/EC) Institutions for Occupational Retirement Provision) which provides a framework for institutions providing occupational pensions in all EU countries. The pension fund complies with national social and labour law and does not interfere with Member States prerogative in the area of 1st pillar pension.

The purpose of the grant is to provide financial support towards the functioning of the RESAVER pension fund in its core activities - over a period of three years - in order to carry out a set of activities detailed in a work programme.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFF' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.85 million from the 2021 budget

3. ERA Talent Platform

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility patterns by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions, and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of the action is to further intensify the services provided by the EURAXESS network, by reforming its structure and expanding its mandate towards taking care of the career development of researchers in Europe, with particular focus on talented researchers and opening new career trajectories for them in academia, industry and business. This is expected to happen through the set-up of dedicated physical and/or virtual centres/hubs affiliated to the existing network, acting as one-stop-shops based on multidisciplinary teams and cross-country and cross-border coordinated structures on a common agenda and standards of work, processes and tools for talent management services.

The support for the career development of talented researchers needs to take into account different layers of specialization, such as a basic career orientation service or more advanced services, consisting in personalized assistance, such as organization of trainings and providing access to career advisor, mentoring and coaching sessions. The advanced services need to be

empowered with competences drawn from or accessed through EURAXESS centres' partnerships with multiplier and enabler organizations.

The centres to be specialised in talent management services should also assist institutions and have within their portfolio the organization of networking activities to connect researchers with employers and the local/regional R&I community. Additional services for institutions should include, among others, the creation of communities of practice on the sub-processes of talent management (recruitment, selection, integration in the culture of the host country, rewards and skills, recognition and motivation of high-potential researchers, etc.). Such centres should facilitate best practice sharing and are expected to keep their R&I communities informed and engaged on new ERA policy measures in the respective areas.

The support for talented researchers should be complemented by enhanced services for the social-cultural and labour integration of researchers and their families in the host country.

The reform and expansion of the services need to be reflected on the EURAXESS portal and national portals, which should develop into a Talent Platform addressing both researchers and institutions, including newly designed sections, tools and training materials making EURAXESS a recruitment, career development and social networking website, designed for research professionals. A specific focus should be placed on fostering gender equality in talent recognition, including through targeted support for women researchers, and also addressing mobility-related dual career and work-life balance issues.

The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Legal entities:

OEAD GMBH - AGENTUR FÜR BILDUNG UND INTERNATIONALISIERUNG -
FN320219K, Ebendorferstraße 7, 1010 Wien, Austria

Government of Flanders (VL O), Department of Economy, Science and Innovation (EWI),
Koning Albert II-laan 35, Box 10, 1030 Brussels, Belgium

Service Public Fédéral de Programmation Politique Scientifique, 30 Boulevard Simon
Bolivar, Brussels 1000, Belgium

UNIVERSITE DE LIEGE, 325777171, Place du 20 Aout 7, Liege 4000, Belgium,
BE0325777171

SOFIISKI UNIVERSITET SVETI KLIMENT OHRIDSKI (СУ Св.Климент Охридски),
2263021177, Bul Tzar Osvoboditel 15, Sofia 1504, Bulgaria

AGENCIJA ZA MOBILNOST I PROGRAME EUROPSKE UNIJE (AGENCY FOR
MOBILITY AND EU PROGRAMMES), 080631323, Frankopanska 26, Zagreb 10000,
Croatia, HR25385906011

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

IDRYMA EREVNAS KAI KAINOTOMIAS (RESEARCH AND INNOVATION FOUNDATION), ANDREA MICHALAKOPOULOU 29 A, 1075 NICOSIA, CYPRUS

STREDISKO SPOLEČNYCH CINNOSTI AV CR v.v.i, 60457856, Narodni 1009/3, Prague 1 11000, Czech Republic, CZ60457856.

KOBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET, 29979812, Norregrade 10, Kobenhavn 1165, Denmark, DK29979812

SIHTASUTUS EESTI TEADUSAGENTUUR, EE4, 90000759/1125175, Soola 8, Tartu 51013, Estonia

The University of Turku (UTU) FI, 20014 Turun yliopisto, Finland

CONFERENCE DES PRESIDENTS D UNIVERSITE, FR3, 504248626, Boulevard Saint Michel 103, Paris 75005, France

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT - UND RAUMFAHRT EV (DLR), Linder Hoehe, 51147 Koeln, Germany

ETHNIKO KENTRO EREVNAS KAI TECHNOLOGIKIS ANAPTYXIS (CERTH), represented by Director of Central Directorate and Chairman of the Board of Directors of CERTH, Athanasios KONSTANDOPOULOS (Party no. 1), CHARILAOU THERMI ROAD 6 KM, THERMI THESSALONIKI 57001, Greece, EL099785242

BAY ZOLTAN ALKALMAZOTT KUTATASI KOZHASZNU NONPROFIT KFT., KONDORFA UTCA 1, BUDAPEST 1116, Hungary, HU23497980

THE ICELANDIC CENTRE FOR RESEARCH, Borgartún 30. 105 Reykjavik. Iceland

IRISH UNIVERSITIES ASSOCIATION LTD, 264534, Merrion Square 48, Dublin D2, Ireland, IE8264534J

APRE AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, VIA CAVOUR 71 , 00184 ROMA (IT)

VALSTS IZGLITIBAS ATTISTIBAS AGENTURA, VALNU IELA 1, RIGA 1050, Latvia

Lietuvos mokslo taryba - The Research Council of Lithuania (RCL), Lithuania, Gedimio pr.3, LT-01103, Lithuania

University of Luxembourg (UL), Maison du Savoir 2, Avenue de l'Université, L-4365 Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxemburg

MINISTRY FOR EQUALITY, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION (MFER – MCST) , Villa Bighi, Kalkara KKR 1320 – Malta

STICHTING EP-NUFFIC, NL6, 41150085, Kortenaerkade 11, Den Haag 2518 AX, Netherlands, NL002877612B01

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

NORGES FORSKNINGSRAD (RCN), DRAMMENSVEIEN 288, OSLO 0283, Norway,
VAT number: NO970141669MVA

NARODOWA AGENCJA WYMIANY AKDEMICKIEJ, Polna 40, Warsaw 00-635, Poland,
PL 904106543

FUNDACAO PARA A CIENCIA E A TECNOLOGIA, 503904040, Avenida Carlos I 126,
Lisboa 1249-074, Portugal, PT503904040

UNITATEA EXECUTIVA PENTRU FINANTAREA INVATAMANTULUI SUPERIOR, A
CERCETARII, DEZVOLTARII SI INOVARII, 12354176, Mendeleev Street 21-25,
Bucharest 010362, Romania

SAIA, n. o., 31821596, Sasinkova 10, Bratislava 1 812 20, Slovakia, SAIA, n. o.

CENTER REPUBLIKE SLOVENIJE ZA MOBILNOST IN EVROPSKE PROGRAME
IZOBRAZEVANJA IN USPOSABLJANJA, 1833006000, Ob Zeleznici 30A, Ljubljana
1000, Slovenia, SI33171629

FUNDACION ESPANOLA PARA LA CIENCIA Y LA TECNOLOGIA, ES3, 577, Calle
Pedro Teixeira 8, Planta 2, MADRID 28020, Spain, ESG82999871

GOETEBORGS UNIVERSITET (UGOT), VASAPARKEN, GOETEBORG 405 30, Sweden,
SE202100315301

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT, RRUGA
PAPA "GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001, Albania, ALL621274510

SCIENTIFIC AND INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP ASSISTANCE CENTER, 1, Sevak
Street, 0014, Yerevan, Armenia

UNIVERZITET U BANJOJ LUCI, 1511001I4/161100, Bulevar Vojvode Petra Bojovica BB,
Banja Luka 78000 , Bosnia and Herzegovina, BA0401017720006

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12,
Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands, FO527920

Shota Rustaveli National Science Foundation, Aleksidze Str 1, 0193 Tbilisi, Georgia

IP&D INNOVATION PROJECTS AND DEVELOPMENT, A. NUTMAN STREET 35,
REHOVOT 76656, Israel, IL513423244

DRUSHTVO ZA EDUACIJA CENTAR ZA INOVACII TRANSFER NA ZNAEENJE
DOOEL SKOPJE AD, 6953476, Rilski Congress 49 14, Skopje 1000, Former Yugoslav
Republic of Macedonia, MK4058014518960

ACADEMIA DE STIINTE A MOLDOVEI, STEFAN CEL MARE 1, CHISINAU 2001

University of Montenegro (UoM) , Cetinjska 2, Podgorica, 81000, Montenegro

MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU (MASINSKI FAKULTET - UNIVERZITETA U NISU), 07174713, Aleksandra Medvedeva 14, Nis 18000, Serbia, RS100662813

EIDGENOESSISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE ZUERICH, GESETZSR414110, Raemistrasse 101, Zuerich 8092, Switzerland, CHE115203630MWST

UGPE (European Project Management Unit) within the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, 7ième Etage. Bur. 710, DG R&I Horizon2020 - 50 Av. Mohamed V, 1002, Tunis -TUNISIE

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU, 278, Ataturk Bulvari 221, Ankara 06100, Turkey, TR1750003600

THE BRITISH COUNCIL, GB22, RC000060/CH209131, 1 Redman Place, Stratford, London, E20 1JQ, United Kingdom

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 4.00 million from the 2022 budget

4. The EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) and European City of Science 2022 actions

Expected Outcomes:

- Bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside Europe;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society.

Scope:

In addition to the ESOF conference, Leiden, the host city of ESOF 2022, includes two new initiatives:

- A festival: “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference.
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF2022 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2022

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14 to 20 year olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The proposal could also consider a pilot scheme for other constituents such as early career researchers. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission. https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants or prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Legal entities:

Foundation Leiden European City of Science 2022 , Zijldijk 8, 2362 AE Warmond, Netherlands.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2021 budget

6. Science Advice for Policy by European Academies

Expected impact:

- Enhanced capacity for sound evidence-informed policy-making by providing reliable, state-of-the art, policy-relevant and publicly accessible scientific evidence available to the Group in a timely, efficient and transparent manner;
- A demonstrably more open and inclusive dialogue about major societal challenges via a transparently managed, interdisciplinary approach and a wide engagement of the scientific community;
- Increased societal awareness of the role of science advice-to-policy- and to decision-making, by developing capabilities to accurately communicate science advice, including the degree of uncertainty of specific scientific knowledge;
- Improved transparency of the EU policy-making process, including through the possibility of active engagement with the wider public and involvement of the entire scientific community

Scope: Better Regulation is a priority for the European Commission ('the EC') and so is the use of scientific evidence to inform policy-making. Scientific advice is necessary and it must be excellent, independent, timely, relevant to European Union (EU) policy-making and as interdisciplinary as required to address all dimensions of the policy issue at stake.

In this regard, the Science Advice for Policy by European Academies ('the SAPEA') Consortium has a proven record of working in partnership mode to provide scientific evidence to the European Commission's Group of Chief Scientific Advisors ('the Group'), within the framework of the Commission's Scientific Advice Mechanism ('SAM'). SAM consists of the Group, the external scientific evidence provider SAPEA and a dedicated secretariat established in DG RTD. As evidence-informed policy is among the priorities of the 2019-2024 European Commission One of the priorities for this College: https://ec.europa.eu/commission/sites/beta-political/files/political-guidelines-next-commission_en.pdf

Building on its experience, the SAPEA consortium will:

- Provide at the request of the Commission targeted scientific evidence in a timely and transparent manner to inform the production of science advice by the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors. The evidence should be of the highest scientific quality, developed by complete and independent evidence analysis and synthesis respecting timelines and policy needs;
- Strengthen the links between European science academies and ensure active participation of all academies that are associated in the networks that make up the Consortium, and include experts from other organisations. In carrying out this process, the Consortium will ensure optimal geographical and gender diversity, coverage of all relevant science fields, and interdisciplinary. An open and inclusive approach will be used involving experts who are not Academy Fellows, both early career and senior of various, relevant backgrounds. These approaches aim at increasing the range of the

available scientific evidence to be considered and the excellence of the expertise provided;

- To consider for the Evidence Review Report scientific evidence published in peer reviewed scientific journals, edited volumes, and monographs submitted by independent experts in the area under consideration. Scientific evidence submitted by other interested entities should only be considered, if relevant and meeting high quality and if these entities provide proof that they are registered in the EU Transparency Register..
- Develop novel and improve existing forms of scientific input to address short-term needs of the Group in a timely, reliable, policy-relevant and efficient manner, e.g. fast evidence-gathering tools and literature reviews, short term evidence reports, and expert consultation on high-priority, short-term policy initiatives.
- Develop further SAPEA's internal database to access an up-to-date pool of top-quality experts in various fields, in combination with other networking approaches that can be called upon at short notice.
- In coordination with the secretariat supporting the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors, engage with citizens, stakeholders, scientific communities and policy-makers to disseminate and promote the work of the Group, and to monitor, assess and report on the impact and uptake thereof;
- Increase awareness of the significance of science-to-policy advice and ensure outreach to larger audiences, including in the Member States, through targeted communication actions, novel information products, media outreach, and policy monitoring processes, whilst ensuring consistent internal and external communication;
- Include an 'early alert' mechanism to signal topics and challenges that may become relevant for the Group of Chief Scientific Advisors and the Commission, identified through techniques such as horizon scanning and consultation including through through the academy networks.
- Formulate in the Evidence Review Report (ERR) clear options and conclusions (not policy recommendations) in response to the given policy question.

The project duration is up to 3 years.

Legal entities:

Acatech (Deutsche Akademie der Technikwissenschaften), Unter den Linden 14, 10117 Berlin, Germany

FEAM - Federation of European Academies of Medicine, Palais des Académies, Rue Ducale 1, 1000 Brussels, Belgium

Euro-CASE, Grand Palais des Champs-Élysées | Porte C, Avenue Franklin D. Roosevelt, 75008 Paris, France

Academia Europaea Bergen, Jekteviksbakken 31 in 5006 Bergen, Norway

Young Academy of Europe e.V., Saupfercheckweg 1, 69117 Heidelberg, Germany

Academia Europaea, Room 251, Senate House, University of London, Malet Street, London, WC1E 7HU

EASAC (European Academies, Science Advisory Council), c/o the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters, Drammensveien 78, Oslo, Norway

ALLEA, c/o Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Jägerstrasse 22/23, 10117 Berlin, Germany

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.20 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2022 budget

7. Presidency event - Conference on international cooperation in research and innovation

Expected Outcome: the project is expected to organise an international conference which will contribute to all of the following outcomes, based on the elements listed below, as a key step in the implementation of the Global Approach to Research and Innovation, as set out in the Commission Communication of 18 May 2021 and the Council Conclusions of 28 September 2021:

- Create a shared European dynamic to strengthen international R&I partnerships, while promoting reciprocity and shared values and principles;
- Strengthen concertation between Member States and with the Commission on their approaches and actions to support international cooperation, guiding the international elements of both Horizon Europe and of Member States' own programmes, in particular by focusing joint efforts on global challenges and strengthening the role of multilateral alliances in these areas;
- Launch a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the implementation of the EU's Global Approach to research and innovation to identify a pathway to achieve a

level playing field in terms of values, principles, reciprocity and framework conditions, notably through establishing a more permanent dialogue around these issues;

- Increase the visibility of research innovation and higher education actions in the framework of external action.

Expected Impact: the proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the following impact of the Horizon Europe Strategic Plan:

- Achieve a critical mass of global research efforts focused on common challenges facilitated by common approaches to research and innovation.

Scope: To meet these objectives, the conference programme is proposed as follows:

First block: Exchanges between Member States and with the Commission in the form of a meeting of European Ministers for Research and Innovation on “What are the stakes for international cooperation in R&I in a changing world” (What coordination mechanisms? What strategies are needed with the rest of the world?):

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers for Research and Innovation, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth.

Second block: Launch of a multilateral dialogue with international partners on the theme of “a new research and innovation partnership based on shared values and principles. The discussion will also bring in the perspective of higher education:

- Target audience: EU Member State Ministers, European Commissioner for Innovation, Research, Culture, Education and Youth; Ministers/Ambassadors of countries having concluded Science and Technology Agreements with the EU, Associated Countries; international organisations such as the OECD and UNESCO.

Legal entities:

Institut de recherche pour le développement (IRD), 44 boulevard de Dunkerque, CS 90009, 13572 Marseille Cedex 02, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 /2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget

8. NCP Network including proposal pre-check

Research and innovation performance is correlated with the efficiency of the national research and innovation system and the capacity and the effectiveness of the National Contact Points (NCPs). Special attention should be given to less experienced entities in low R&I performing countries to bridge the knowledge gap and enable better access to funding opportunities in the EU Framework Programmes and beyond.

A dedicated support mechanism under this Work programme part with specific objective to strengthen the activities of NCPs to support international networking and to improve the quality of proposals from legal entities from low R&I performing countries is envisaged.

Proposals should aim to facilitate trans-national co-operation between NCPs with a view to identifying and sharing good practices and raising the general standard of support to programme applicants, taking into account the diversity of actors that make up the constituencies of both the Widening and ERA parts. They also should show that the activities put forward will deliver tangible benefits to potential applicants.

Activities should capitalise on relevant work of the previous NCP network project in this sector. To help close the innovation divide, a substantial component of the proposed activities must be devoted to activities aimed at helping NCPs in those countries that have been participating at low levels in the FP programmes up to now. These activities should help these NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how on NCP operations accumulated in other countries including, for example, training, mentoring, and twinning. They may also include awareness raising actions aimed at increasing visibility of well-qualified potential applicant organisations in the Widening countries.

Support will be given to a consortium of identified NCPs in the area of the ‘Widening Participation and strengthening the European Research Area’ part coordinated by an organisation with a proven track record in managing an network of NCPs in the Widening domain. The members of the core consortium are identified in this call. Additional NCP organisations especially from Associated Countries may participate as linked third parties.

The implementation will include following actions: info days, training and workshops; tailored consultations and advice; support to matchmaking platform; proposal pre-screening (checks on eligibility and viability of concept) and actions dedicated to networking and matchmaking activities capitalising on the experience of the former NCP WIDENET project. For matchmaking activities the consortium will closely collaborate with NCP networks working on other parts of Horizon Europe notably pillar 2. A mutual learning process among NCPs will help building capacity by helping less experienced NCPs to enhance their competence (training, workshops). For these activities beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants.

The implementation will be carried out in work packages distinguished for the two programme part components (Widening and ERA). The Widening part will especially take into account the requirements of the Advancing Europe package.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

For the proposal pre-check part it ranges from seminar style training for proposal writing for larger groups to written advice on individual proposals (e.g. on clarity of objectives, consistency with work programme, balanced budget etc.) but not on scientific content and coaching of individuals. The action may include advice for applications outside the widening programme to a limited extent and based on strategic choices such as areas under Pillar 2, where application success rate from Widening countries were below average in comparable fields of Horizon 2020. As far as the matchmaking is concerned, possible synergies with existing platforms, e.g. Funding & Tenders Portal and EURAXESS should be explored, as well as dedicated events for brokerage and partner search in a physical or virtual mode.

Special attention should be given to enhancing the competence of NCPs, including helping less experienced NCPs rapidly acquire the know-how built up in other countries. The consortium should have a good representation of experienced and less experienced NCPs.

Legal entities:

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION AND SCIENCE, 2A, Aleksandar Dondukov blvd., 1000, Sofia, Bulgaria

Agencija za Mobilnost i Programe Europske Unije, Frankopanska 26, 10 000 Zagreb, Croatia

Research and Innovation Foundation, 123 Strovolos Avenue, 2042 Nicosia, Cyprus

TECHNOLOGICKE CENTRUM AKADEMIE VED CESKE REPUBLIKY, Ve Struhach 1076/27, 160 00 Praha, Czechia

Estonian Research Council, Soola 8, Tartu 51004, Estonia

Academy of Finland, Hakaniemenranta 6, PO Box 131, FI-00531 Helsinki, Finland

DEUTSCHES ZENTRUM FUER LUFT- UND RAUMFAHRT EV, Linder Hohe, 51147, Koln, Germany

Foundation for Research & Technology - Hellas, Nikolaou Plastira 100, Vassilika Vouton GR - 700 13 Heraklion, Crete, Greece

Nemzeti Kutatási, Fejlesztési és Innovációs Hivatal, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1., Hungary

Rannsóknamidstöð Islands (The Icelandic Centre for Research), Borgartún 30; 105 Reykjavík; Iceland

AGENZIA PER LA PROMOZIONE DELLA RICERCA EUROPEA, Via Cavour, 71, 00184 Roma, Italy

Latvia Council of Science, SMILSU IELA 8, PO box: 000, 1050, RIGA Latvia

Research Council of Lithuania, Gedimino pr. 3, LT-01103, Vilnius, Lithuania

THE MALTA COUNCIL OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, Villa Bighi, Triq il-Marina, Kalkara KKR 1320, Malta

National Centre for Research and Development, Nowogrodzka 47A, 00-695 Warszawa, Poland

FCT – Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia, Av. D. Carlos I, 126, 1249-074, Lisbon, Portugal

CENTRUM VEDECKO-TECHNICKÝCH INFORMÁCIÍ SR, Lamačská cesta 8-A; 811 04 Bratislava; Slovak Republic

Ministry of education, science and sport, Masarykova 16, SI - 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia

Agencia Estatal Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Serrano 117, 28006, Madrid, Spain

AGJENCIA KOMBETARE E KERKIMIT SHKENCOR DHE INOVACIONIT – NASRI, RRUGA PAPA"GJON PALI" II NR.3, TIRANA 1001 Albania

Scientific and Innovation Partnership Assistance Center, Sevak str. 1, Yerevan 0014, Armenia

THE FAROESE RESEARCH COUNCIL (GRANSKINGARRADID), Bryggjubakki 12, Torshavn FO-110, Faroe Islands

NATIONAL TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION AUTHORITY, 2ND DERECH AGUDAT SPORT HAPOEL BUILDING, JERUSALEM 6812511, Israel

AGENTIA NATIONALA PENTRU CERCETARE SI DEZVOLTARE, 1001 OFF 180 STEFAN CEL MARE BVLD, CHISINAU 2004, Moldova

Ss. CYRIL AND METHODIUS UNIVERSITY IN SKOPJE, BLVD GOCE DELCEV 9, SKOPJE 1000, North Macedonia

MINISTARSTVO PROSVETE, NAUKE I TEHNOLOSKOG RAZVOJA - MPNTR, Nemanjina 22-26, BELGRADE 11000, Serbia

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH, AVENUE MOHAMED V 50, TUNIS 1002 Tunisia

TURKIYE BILIMSEL VE TEKNOLOJIK ARASTIRMA KURUMU – TUBITAK, Ataturk Bulvari 221, ANKARA 06100, Turkey

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and

operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative budget: EUR 8.00 million from the 2021 budget

9. Framework Partnership Agreement with COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology)

COST (European Co-operation in Science and Technology) is an EU funded pan European programme that enables researchers to set up their interdisciplinary research networks in Europe and beyond. The programme was established in 1971 in an intergovernmental mode. It will be implemented by a member state owned organisation i.e. the COST Association under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA). This FPA will outline an action plan for the full duration of Horizon Europe until 2027 describing the strategic objectives and key milestones for the implementation of COST. This FPA is based on Article 195 of the Financial Regulation that allows the use of a named beneficiary for activities with specific characteristics that require a particular type of body on account of its technical competence, its high degree of specialisation or its administrative powers, on condition that the activities concerned do not fall within the scope of a call for proposals.

While the networks are open to international partners from outside Europe, COST provides a unique low entry mechanism for researchers from countries catching up in the R&I in the EU and from its Eastern and Southern neighbours while remaining open for researchers from all European countries and international partners. For many researchers (especially at the beginning of their career) from widening countries, the participation in COST networking actions is the sole opportunity for getting in touch with European and international research initiatives and to benefitting from exposure to leading scientists in their field. The approach of COST is not funding research itself but pooling resources and research results by networking and hence upscaling.

The specific objectives of this support mechanism are to:

- Increase participation of widening countries (inclusiveness target countries (ITC) according to COST internal terminology) in European research activities and higher success rates;
- Contribute towards improving the R&I culture of the widening country (indicators such as research intensity, innovation performance, values towards R&I);
- Improve scientific capabilities of widening countries to increase their chances in participating and successfully obtaining competitive funding from the EU and other international sources;
- Trigger scientific breakthroughs and new research strands by pooling interdisciplinary resources across Europe;

- Boost the career of young and female researchers by networking and brain circulation in line with ERA principles and the development of leadership skills;
- Strengthen the research management capacities and administrative skills of participating researchers;
- Develop operational synergies with other widening actions and create links to thematic parts of Horizon Europe, notably Pillar 2.

Legal entities:

COST Association , Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

10. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The EC funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPAs) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from countries eligible from the Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate. The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 20 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a maximum of 2 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in widening countries.

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: CSA for 3 years

Indicative budget: EUR 153.00 million from the 2021 budget

11. Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised under the EU French Presidency (Presidency Conference) in 2022. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

Université Paris-Saclay, 3 rue Joliot Curie, Bâtiment Breguet, 91190 Gif-sur-Yvette, France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: 1st Quarter 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2022 budget

PRIZE

1. EU Award for (Academic) Gender Equality Champions

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality.
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

Award and certification schemes implemented in different countries, in the EU and beyond, have been shown to be useful tools for advancing gender equality in academic, research and innovation organisations, with some awarding schemes effectively being used as drivers for competition in attracting students and researchers and/or as prerequisite for having access to funding. Building on the feasibility study for a European award/certification system for gender equality in research organisations, including universities, carried out by Horizon 2020 project CASPER, an annual Award scheme is established. The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education and research organisations applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place, and as an enabler for the new priority on inclusive gender equality plans and the transformation agenda for universities set in the new European Research Area, in synergy with the European Education Area and in line with the new European Strategy for Universities.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTI+) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total, from the 2022 budget.

The contestants will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria:

Eligible applications will be evaluated by a Jury consisting of a group of independent experts, with expertise on gender equality plan implementation and intersectional approaches in research and higher education institutions, appointed by the Commission.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address a set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories.

Eligibility criteria:

The contestant must be a university, higher education institution, or research performing organisation (public or private) located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁰⁷.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into become gender equality champions themselves.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Second quarter of 2022
Deadline for submission of application	Third quarter of 2022
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Fourth quarter of 2022

Form of Funding: Prizes

¹⁰⁷ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme)

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4/2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

2. Horizon impact award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact.
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected by the evaluation jury for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget, and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted the society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialized. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact.

Eligibility criteria: The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e. natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7 or Horizon 2020¹⁰⁸. The projects must have ended by close of the contest¹⁰⁹. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2021¹¹⁰ and in 2022 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts.

Indicative timetable of contest(s):

Stages	Date and time or indicative period
Opening of the contest	Q1-Q2 (2021/2022)
Deadline for submission of application	Q2-Q3 (2021/2022)
Evaluation and solutions demonstration (if applicable)	N/A
Award of the prize	Q3-Q4 (2021/2022)

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2022 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. External expertise for monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments)

¹⁰⁸ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity is limited

¹⁰⁹ Refers to the end date of the project as in the Grant Agreement.

¹¹⁰ The Horizon Impact Award has not been implemented in 2021

funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate include ethics checks.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.60 million from the 2022 budget

2. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

3. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the EU Research and Innovation System and the pursued of the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to the development of the ERA Scoreboard, to enable monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts to map out the academic freedom landscape in Europe and to devise an appropriate system for monitoring its development;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network, as well as experts in employment conditions and contracts, social security and remuneration; the experts will contribute to the development of a wide range of actions related to the strengthening of research careers, including researchers' mobility, improvement of the attractiveness of researchers' work conditions, careers, remuneration, assessment;
- Experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, and cooperation within knowledge ecosystems, to support the development of a legal toolbox that facilitates such cooperation;
- Experts in various areas of higher education institutional transformation, in order to monitor transformation and strengthen synergies between education, research and innovation.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

Academic freedom is a prerequisite for scientific excellence and for fostering strong collaborative links between researchers, international partners, scientific organisations and businesses. Academic freedom and the values that it encompasses lead to the creation of resilient R&I ecosystems that cherish, among others, openness, freedom of discussion, autonomy by engaging into open science, peer reviews, research verifiability and replicability, autonomous research agenda setting. The independent experts will contribute to reinforce the future *European Pact for Research and Innovation*, which aims at deepening the implementation of the new ERA's objectives, setting out commonly agreed values and principles and indicating the areas where Member States will jointly develop priority actions. In the frame of the implementation of the "European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers" (C&C), the European Commission relies on independent experts to perform the peer review assessments on which the continuous monitoring mechanism for the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) award and renewal is based. The creation of a larger pool of experts is envisaged, including in legal, HR, skills, social security, remuneration and employment conditions matters, as well as in science education, skills, financial instruments, innovation, value creation, cooperation and ecosystems, foreign interference, science diplomacy and international competitiveness. This should allow greater flexibility and crossed interactions between various intervention fields, including legal, technical, and operational ones.

Experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

4. Commission expert group on the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on gender equality in EU R&I

The Expert Group will deliver a study on the consequences of the COVID-19 crisis and the pandemic containment measures put in place at institutional, national and EU level, on the

work and productivity of women researchers and on gender equality in the EU R&I system in general.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest. This amount is considered to be proportionate to the specific tasks to be assigned to the experts, including the number of meetings to be attended and possible preparatory work.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

5. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks requires specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g. Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2022 budget

6. Use of individual expert(s) on ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the European Valorisation policy

This action will support the use of independent experts to advice on or assist with the implementation of the European Valorisation policy. Individual experts will work in the following areas:

- European knowledge valorisation strategy and specific dimensions and results of its development and implementation, in particular for the delivery of the European Research Area
- IP strategy for European R&I

- Industry-academia knowledge exchange and collaboration
- Citizen engagement and knowledge valorisation through collaboration with cities and communities
- Science and research informing policies
- Other specific aspects with a key role in the European Knowledge Valorisation policy

The tasks require specialised knowledge in R&I Valorisation, intellectual property management, exploitation and dissemination of research results, open innovation, university-business collaboration, citizen engagement for innovation etc.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2021 budget

7. Support for policy makers – Horizontal support to the Strategic Coordinating Process for partnerships

This action will offer horizontal support to the strategic coordinating process for partnerships, focusing on issues related to the implementation of the process, mutual learning across the community involved and strengthening the evidence base for strategic discussions.

It will support the continued monitoring of the new approach to European Partnerships, the identification of gaps, emerging opportunities and potential novel approaches in the partnerships landscape and support the preparedness of Member States' and Associated Countries' Horizon Europe participation in the Strategic Coordinating Process. It will contribute to the implementation of the revised policy approach for European Partnerships in Horizon Europe.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 and Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2022 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. EU data for R&I policy

Overall, the set up of an initiative to allow MS and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with

other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in Europe, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

2. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard

This action will support the continuation and enhancement of the European Innovation Scoreboard, which provides a comparative analysis of innovation performance in EU countries, other European countries, and regional neighbours.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.75 million from the 2021 budget

3. Overview of regulatory sandboxes and innovation-enabling approaches to regulation

The study will analyse innovation-enabling approaches to regulation with a focus on regulatory sandboxes. It will establish a state-of-play regarding the use of regulatory sandboxes and experimentation clauses in the European Union, with a benchmarking internationally and vs. other experimentation-enabling instruments. The study will identify key features, benefits and risks related to regulatory sandboxes, present best practices regarding the implementation and evaluation of regulatory sandboxes and analyse how learning from regulatory sandboxes at national level can contribute to evidence-based policy-making at EU level. It will also briefly present an overview of sandboxes and similar instruments in European Programmes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2021 budget

4. Implementation of Workshop series with industry and other stakeholders as well as discussions with Member States to prepare ERA common industrial technology roadmaps

This action is a key element to implement priority action 5 under ERA with which the Commission will work with stakeholders from relevant industries to develop by end of 2022 common industrial technology roadmaps which ensure a better transfer of R&I into the real economy and make EU industry more competitive. Industrial technology roadmaps will address R&I for the development of key industrial technology roadmaps across Horizon Europe clusters, ranging from circular industries over health equipment to clean transport and social innovation. They will gauge the prospects of future technological development, collect relevant evidence and co-design R&I investment agendas from basic research to deployment.

The Commission will co-create Industrial technology roadmaps with Member States, industrial companies, RTOs, universities and other stakeholders. The preparation of roadmaps within the deadline stipulated by ERA will require 4-5 meetings per roadmap with industry and other stakeholders and 4-5 meetings with representatives from Member States (ERA Forum for Transition). In order to inform, steer and organize these discussions, the Commission requires support services for the preparation, implementation and summary of discussions, organisation of the meeting venue and administrative support.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

5. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found at <https://rio.jrc.ec.europa.eu/en/policy-support-facility>. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as enabler for concrete policy changes.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q2 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2022 budget

6. ERA Talent Platform – the international dimension

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an ERA Talent Platform, an online one-stop-shop, with improved structure and governance, exploiting links to Europass, the EU platform for people to manage their learning and careers and the EURES network of European public employment services. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS as the ERA pilot action to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA into an ERA Talent Platform fit to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The scope of this action is to complement the ERA Talent Platform with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of Europe. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools that will serve as a diplomacy asset internationally and promoting instrument of European R&I landscape, attracting international talent and European researchers back home.

This action should be in strong connection with the European dimension of the Talent Platform. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators and centers across Europe. It is expected to bridge researchers working outside of Europe to their peers in the home countries, also to activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of the ERA Talent Platform should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or trainings, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, *inter alia* to:

- (i) promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research,
- (ii) facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return,
- (iii) strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as

(iv) improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of Europe, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 /2021 - Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 2.50 million from the 2022 budget

7. Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and Research Careers

This action is expected to build on the preparatory work of the previous Work Programme, in particular the study “*Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: a comprehensive analysis of the state of play, the design of monitoring mechanisms, and creation of a toolbox of support measures*” (2021), both at the level of knowledge ecosystems, and research careers and mobility. In particular, it should build (1) on the knowledge ecosystems mapping exercise and liaise and coordinate activities with the beneficiaries of the “Testing of the ERA Hub concept – pilot phase” action mentioned elsewhere in this work programme. It will contribute to the understanding of successful knowledge ecosystems across Europe through a recurrent monitoring process and development of an interactive online platform as an Observatory on Knowledge Ecosystems and ERA Hubs testing, endorsing and implementing structures. Next to this, (2) it will need to enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility. The observatory should integrate, analyse and map data related to the emergence of ecosystem actors engaged in knowledge production, circulation and use and will reflect how they interact, network and coordinate each other on common agendas, smart specialization strategies, value chains, etc.

Four main targets are foreseen:

- Single actors in knowledge ecosystems (higher education institutions, research organisations, business, other actors)
- Ecosystems (platforms, collaborations, and other structures between above mentioned actors)
- ERA Hubs (structures and practices enabling interactions between knowledge ecosystems), and how the concept helps the ecosystems to work and interact better
- Tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions

This action is expected to ensure a recurrent stock taking exercise of existing knowledge ecosystems, including, but not limited to, ERA Hubs, endorsing and implementing collaboration capacities (platforms and other structures of cooperation between ecosystem

actors) at European, national and regional level. The exercise needs to be based on surveys, data collection processes and tools, as well as analyses that need to provide quantitative and qualitative high-level insights, such as on the available types of structures, functions, expertise, the geographical coverage and gaps in the territory, the broader context in which they are functioning, including framework conditions, investment and key operational characteristics.

The Observatory should function as an online platform and real-time assessment of the state of play, reflecting the inventory of knowledge ecosystem actors according to predefined criteria as set in above mentioned Knowledge Ecosystems study. It should also propose a forward-looking perspective to complement and reinforce the ecosystem landscape and maximize its impact. It should identify challenges and needs in order to fill in the gaps in the territory, any white space where no such capacities are currently active, and the gaps in expertise and best practices with a view to mainstream them. Benchmarking in the broader geopolitical context (e.g. Silicon Valley) should be also provided.

Expected impact: Actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Provide evidence-based policy support through recurrent monitoring, data collection and analysis on knowledge ecosystem actors across Europe through dedicated processes and tools.
- Gain insight into the dynamics and evolution of the knowledge ecosystems across Europe and measure progress in terms of geographical coverage, patterns of cooperation, interaction, networking and functioning at European, national and regional level;
- Measure progress of testing and implementing the ERA Hubs concept, as well as identify gaps in the territory where such actions could be further needed and stimulated;
- Gain insight in the mobility of researchers, both in terms of the regional/national capacity of attracting and retaining R&I talents, and flow-through of talents between sectors;
- Measure progress of countries, regions, and institutions, in terms of acquisition of new skills and competences by early-career researchers, matching skills needs of employers, in terms of working conditions (remuneration, contract duration, social security provisions), and in terms of research careers and career assessment.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2022 budget

8. Development of the ERA Talent Platform: website, proof of concept, online services, design, maintenance, communication

EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making Europe more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella will be expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform - ERA Talent Platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the preparatory work under the previous Work Programme, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 (*“Taking stock, evaluating the achievements and identifying the way forward for the ERA Priority 3 policy measures with a focus on European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (C&C), the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) and EURAXESS”*, 2020). The newly designed portal is expected to support institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it should be aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It should also be interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, as well as adopt new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, ERC panel descriptors, etc.

The primary purpose of the ERA Talent Platform is to create a virtual hub for researchers and institutions, R&I employers and funders. The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also develop activities to provide a new facelift to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The ERA Talent Platform is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage into intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The secondary purpose of the newly designed website is to create tools that facilitate automatized data gathering on researchers, research careers, and institutions (R&I employers and funders), in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/ National Coordinators, national portal administrators and

EURAXESS Worldwide. It should encompass different activities, such as the development of a proof of concept with the re-conceptualisation of the EURAXESS portal and associated national portals and tools under its umbrella, graphical and functional enhancements, as well as technical development and maintenance. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021 and Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 2.75 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

9. Technical support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during accumulation phase and at retirement.

RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy and Cyprus. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER has the ambition to engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers that do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, a personal pension product is expected to be developed that should utilise the existing structure to the extent possible. In addition, investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in

order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations.

In this context following technical support is needed: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, providing advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development of a third pillar product, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2021 budget

10. Monitoring and evaluating the Horizon 2020 complementary support for the European Universities initiative

The European Universities initiative piloted under Erasmus+ and supported under Horizon 2020 offers a testbed for the Higher Education Transformation Agenda to support modernisation of higher education institutions, and explore new integrated ways of cooperation between universities and with other actors in their surrounding ecosystem. In view of the potential full deployment of the European Universities initiative as of 2023, the Commission will monitor progress and identify and address remaining barriers to the transformation agenda.

This action is expected to focus on the R&I dimension of the pilot projects and needs to be implemented in synergy with a similar exercise for the education dimension.

The analysis should include progress made by the project portfolio on areas in the transformation agenda, and in implementing measures for borderless cooperation and circulation of knowledge and talents. Project(s) are expected to provide recommendations to developing future effective synergies with the Erasmus programme and with national or regional funding mechanisms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 / 2021

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

11. Studies and communication

Activities should support the implementation of the ERA Communication objectives and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU space R&I environment, for example

- higher education in the EU versus needs of the space R&I community;
- dissemination of scientific results;
- analysis of the portfolio of EU-funded projects in the field of research careers, universities, research assessment, researcher mobility;
- collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on ***the implementation of the ERA policy agenda*** across target groups.

Activities are expected to include surveys as appropriate implemented through public procurement, and/or appointing (groups of) independent experts. These limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.95 million from the 2022 budget

12. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)'

The European Commission, in cooperation with the Member States, will continue collecting sex-disaggregated data and monitoring with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies, objectives, guiding targets and actions at institutional, national and EU level. The study will update data and indicators on human resources in Science and Technology, Research & Development personnel, seniority grades, education, work-life balance, the

inclusion of the gender dimension in research and innovation content, boards' composition, funds, institutional change, gender and innovation, collected insofar.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 / 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2021 budget

13. Service Facility in Support of the Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation

The Strategic Development of International Cooperation in Research and Innovation aims to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in research and innovation.

A new framework contract for services will be launched and it would reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world” and facilitate strategic international cooperation in research and innovation. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles, and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU.

- **Activity description:** international cooperation in R&I is a cross-cutting activity relevant for the whole HE programme. The framework contract should reflect on the new political priorities “making Europe stronger in the world”. The objective is to provide services that support the policy development, priority setting, and follow-up and implementation of the strategy for international cooperation in R&I.
- **Information related to the activity:** it is a contribution to the implementation of international dimension of HE and it would facilitate strengthening the coordination and alignment of the Member States international R&I strategies with the EU. It would also support the monitoring of Associated Countries’ alignment with the ERA principles.
- **Impact:** The activities under the framework contract should result in in-depth and well-informed policy dialogues, improved framework conditions for cooperation in R&I, strategic priority setting for R&I, coordination between internal and external policies and better coordination and alignment with member states’ R&I international strategies

The service facility will be implemented through a new framework contract for services to be launched and signed for a duration of 4 years, with an estimated budget ceiling for its entire duration of 25 million euro, as well as through other existing framework contracts (i.e. for communication related activities). Several specific contracts will be signed under this framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4/2021

Indicative budget: EUR 7.00 million from the 2021 budget and EUR 7.00 million from the 2022 budget

14. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g. annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3/Q4 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.20 million from the 2022 budget

15. EU Gender Equality Competence Facility

This EU Gender Equality Competence Facility will follow up on the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans, and the GE Academy project, funded under the 2020 work programme of Horizon 2020, under the Science-with-and-for-society programme.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

In support to the requirement for public bodies, research organisations and higher education establishments applying to Horizon Europe to have a Gender Equality Plan (GEP) in place as an eligibility criterion, and the new ERA policy agenda, this facility will act as a competence centre and deploy support to public bodies, research organisations and universities on how to design, implement, evaluate, and sustain a gender equality plan.

This practical support will include the development of an enhanced digital, interactive platform to offer i) access to gender knowledge and expertise on gender equality plans, including to national-level contact points appointed through the pilot European knowledge and support facility for fostering institutional change through gender equality plans; ii) as well as trainers on gender equality in research and innovation certified through the GE Academy project.

This support will include providing guidance, information and assistance at institutional level, as well as disseminating the good practices and best tools in the field, adapted to specific country contexts and organisations' needs

The platform will include digital training modules and an extensive range of useful, applicable and appealing end-user material for the implementation of GEPs. It will take into account and build on the GEAR tool developed by the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE) and DG Research and Innovation. Activities should be implemented in close cooperation and complementarity with the EIGE.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2/Q3 2022

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2022 budget

Budget¹¹¹

	Budget line(s)	2021 Budget (EUR million)	2022 Budget (EUR million)
Calls			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-01-two-stage			180.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>180.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-02		21.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>21.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-03		149.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>149.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-04			50.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>50.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-05		30.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>30.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ACCESS-06		5.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ACCESS-07			40.00
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		<i>40.00</i>
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-01			80.00
	<i>from</i>		<i>80.00</i>

¹¹¹

The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2021 and 2022.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-02			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-03			24.00
	from 01.020401		24.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-TALENTS-04			8.00
	from 01.020401		8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01		61.50	
	from 01.020402	61.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01			59.00
	from 01.020402		59.00
Other actions			
Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)		168.55	6.70
	from 01.020401	161.00	0.50
	from 01.020402	7.55	6.20
Prize		0.15	0.55
	from 01.020402	0.15	0.55
Expert contract action		1.80	2.70
	from 01.020401	0.40	1.00
	from 01.020402	1.40	1.70
Public procurement		19.20	19.40

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2021-2022
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	<i>from 01.020402</i>	<i>19.20</i>	<i>19.40</i>
Estimated total budget		456.20	478.35

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its *modus operandi* towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-06: Building a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The action funded under this topic will have the objective of networking excellent knowledge nodes supporting the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China from across the European Union to build a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that will become sustainable beyond the end of the project. The goal of the platform would be to collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent knowledge on Contemporary China produced in the European Union (e.g., by universities, think tanks, research centres, NGOs, private companies, public organisations etc.) so as to foster the development of a network of independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level, raise awareness, and mainstream information on China also within the wider remit of civil society. The virtual European Info Platform will aim to become a key go-to source for independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level across all major relevant research areas (foreign policy, domestic politics, contemporary society and culture, science, technology, and innovation policy, economics, law, etc.). This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 9 on promoting international cooperation.

Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Bring together knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe to build and manage a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that would become a European key go-to source of independent knowledge on contemporary China;
- Coordinate with other initiatives and stakeholders where relevant for the action. Synergies with the two projects that were selected for funding under the previous call ‘HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07: Upgrading Independent Knowledge on Contemporary China in Europe’ are strongly encouraged. The work they bring forth should contribute to the development of the European Info Platform on Contemporary China;
- Regularly upload and disseminate knowledge on contemporary China, (including analyses, reports, articles, policy briefs, scoping studies, interviews, podcasts, etc.), not only produced by the successful consortium, but also filtered/selected from the work of external prominent and emerging knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe, so as to give visibility to all relevant European centres of excellence (including the smaller ones);
- Successful proposals would be expected to build into the website a section dedicated to the translation into English of key Chinese policy-documents and to create related policy briefs that would be openly accessible;

- Organise the material to be uploaded on the platform into thematic sections taking into account the priorities identified through the interactions with the relevant experts. A section of the platform should be specifically dedicated to understanding China's STI (science, technology, and innovation) system/policy and its implications for the European Union;
- Organise virtual and physical events (conferences, workshops, networking activities, trainings, staff exchanges, etc.), and manage their related communication activities, to foster pan-European connections among the different EU knowledge nodes on contemporary China. The organisation of China-focused thematic courses, ad-hoc seminars, and trainings, is encouraged in order to raise awareness on key China-related subjects, also involving the wider civil society/public/private institutions beyond China experts;
- Provide the Commission with regular policy recommendations and updates on the activities of the project;
- Reach out and encourage the participation of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China to enhance the visibility and impact of their work and foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge;
- Prepare and put in place a sustainability plan for the platform to ensure the continuation of the work after the end of the action.

Scope: This topic contributes to the priority areas of action number 9 on *promoting a positive environment and level playing field for international cooperation based on reciprocity* listed in the Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area⁵⁶ (ERA). More specifically it aims to satisfy the objective of *launching a pilot initiative on the Team Europe approach for a specific world region and/or topic*.

This action seeks to bolster a stronger European understanding of contemporary China and to strengthen European's capacity to sustain the production of such knowledge that is key to develop excellent EU-China policy-making based on facts, independent and unbiased analyses, and foresight. In accordance with the EU-China – A Strategic Outlook Communication of 2019⁵⁷ and the Global Approach to Research and Innovation Communication of May 2021⁵⁸, the action aims to empower the European Union to act coherently and proactively on the international stage preserving an open research and innovation ecosystem while safeguarding European interests and values.

Today China is a key global actor and a leading scientific and technological power. China's increasing relevance in the geopolitical system has exposed the weakness the European Union

⁵⁶ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14126-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁵⁷ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/communication-eu-china-a-strategic-outlook.pdf>

⁵⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/research_and_innovation/strategy_on_research_and_innovation/documents/ec_rtd_com2021-252.pdf

faces in its capacity to better understand contemporary China in its various specificities, complexities, and goals and respond to its rapid evolution and new policy directions. The European Union needs to get to know and understand it on its own terms: not through the lens of other external sources but from its own European perspective. The underlined priority for the EU to develop its own knowledge capacity to navigate China's continuous transformations is embedded in the concept of independent European knowledge, which should guide the work of successful applicants.

Following interactions with Member States, China experts, and stakeholders in the framework of the EU R&I Knowledge Network on China (EUKNOC) and following the publication of the SFIC recommendations on China in November 2021⁵⁹ it has emerged that at the European level expertise on contemporary China is often fragmented and difficult to access. Networking existing prominent and emerging knowledge nodes, gathering, categorising, and mainstreaming their work on an easily accessible public information platform would be therefore pivotal to break siloes and provide policy-makers, researchers, businesses, and civil society with the tools needed to develop a deeper understanding of the different dimensions that characterise contemporary China. Doing so would also increase the circulation of information and foster the creation of new knowledge, in line with the Commission's efforts to upgrade independent knowledge on contemporary China in Europe started in the 2021-2022 Horizon Europe work programme⁶⁰. Building synergies with granted projects from topic HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07, would be therefore strongly encouraged.

This action should bring forth the creation of a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China through networking relevant knowledge nodes from across the European Union that pursue the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China. The platform would collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent research material and provide translations from Chinese into English of relevant Chinese policy documents (and produce subsequent policy briefs on such documents). The successful consortium will be in charge of setting up the platform, organising/curating the material on the new virtual tool, setting up relevant events, thematic courses and trainings, communication activities, and developing a sustainability plan to ensure the successful continuation and growth of the platform after the end of the action.

The involvement of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China is strongly encouraged to foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge on contemporary China across the European Union and enhance the visibility of their work.

⁵⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1204-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

NB - Such recommendations call, among others, for the EU to build a permanent EU Info Centre for policy, academic, media and business based on existing networks and expertise available on China and to establish links between stakeholders from academia, public and private sector to create a network of China related actors and work on China in a concerted way.

⁶⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/horizon-cl2-2021-transformations-01-07> -

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-07: Support to reforms of research assessment in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support and contribute to the implementation of institutional changes for reforming research assessment (i.e., the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units,

and research institutions), in line with Action 3 of the ERA Policy Agenda actions and in support of Action 1;

- Connection of existing organisations and initiatives for reforms of research assessment, facilitating the exchange of information and mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders;
- Recommendations for policy-makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement institutional changes to research assessment;
- Global outreach of European efforts to reform research assessment and reinforced international cooperation on evolutions in research assessment.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research proposals and researchers evaluated in an unbiased manner on their intrinsic merits and performance rather than on the number of publications and where these are published;
- Researchers evaluated based on a broader range of research outputs and tasks (including open science practices);
- Researchers benefit from attractive careers, regardless of gender or other social characteristics;
- Modernised higher education sector, benefitting from improvements to the research assessment systems (including for performance-based funding).

Scope: The way research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions are assessed is fundamental for a well-functioning research and innovation system. The research and innovation system is undergoing major transformations with diversification of desired research outputs not restricted anymore to publications, and of research tasks and required skills; with a culture of sharing of knowledge and tools and of open collaboration (including societal engagement) becoming mainstream; and with a growing need of multi-disciplinary approaches and collaboration to tackle ever more complex scientific questions and societal challenges. However, the current system often uses limited methods to assess the quality, performance and impact of research, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers and the impact factor of the venue where they are published.

Several institutions including research funders and universities, in Europe and beyond, are currently reforming the assessment systems of their research and researchers. At a global level, the San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment⁶¹ (DORA) aims at improving how the output of scientific research is evaluated. The Recommendation on Open Science⁶² adopted by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

⁶¹ <https://sfdora.org/>

⁶² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949.locale=en>

in November 2021 calls for a review of research assessment systems to align them with the principles of open science. The Global Research Council (GRC) held a conference⁶³ in 2020 on “Responsible Research Assessment” and established a dedicated working group in 2021. The European Research Area ERA Policy Agenda for 2022-2024⁶⁴, adopted by the Council of the European Union on 26 November 2021, includes a priority action for reforming the assessment systems for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact. Accordingly, the European Commission is taking steps to facilitate an agreement between research funders, research performing organisations, national/regional evaluation agencies or authorities, and other stakeholders like learned societies, to reform research assessment criteria and processes in willing organisations, along commonly agreed principles and actions. In 2021, consultation of stakeholders⁶⁵ identified convergence on 10 principles expected to guide the reform of research assessment⁶⁶.

The establishment of a coalition of committed organisations is expected to accelerate changes towards research assessment systems that promote qualitative judgement with unbiased peer-review, supported by a more responsible use of quantitative indicators. The reformed research assessment systems should consider a more diverse set of research cultures and outputs, by valuing not only publications but also other research outputs such as data sets, software, models, workflows, methods, etc., and proper conduct including integrity and gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness. The reformed systems are expected to reward open collaboration as well as early knowledge and data sharing, as these practices enable good science⁶⁷. It should also reward the diversity of tasks of researchers, and consider the different contributions to the work of teams.

This action aims at supporting the reform of the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions. The action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

- The first part aims at supporting the operation of the coalition. This includes support to the sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across individual organisations, umbrella organisations, and initiatives, involved in the coalition and beyond, including with national and regional authorities. The action is expected to

⁶³ <https://www.globalresearchcouncil.org/news/responsible-research-assessment/>

⁶⁴ Annex to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the European Research Area of 26 November 2021 <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14308-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁶⁵ Scoping report “Towards a reform of the research assessment system”:
<https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/707440>

⁶⁶ The 10 principles identified during the stakeholders consultation and listed in the scoping report are: Ethics and integrity; Freedom of scientific research; Autonomy of research organisations; Independence and transparency of the data, infrastructure and criteria; Quality; Contribution to advancing knowledge and the (potential) impact of research results; Diversity of research activities, practices, outputs; Variety of scientific disciplines, research approaches, research career stages; Diversity in research roles and careers, and team science; and Gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness

⁶⁷ Open science practices include: early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, or crowd-sourcing); research output management; measures to ensure reproducibility of research outputs; providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); participation in open peer-review; and involving all relevant knowledge actors including citizens, civil society and end users in the co creation of R&I agendas and contents (such as citizen science).

support workshops, working groups and other tools to: raise awareness, exchange experience and disseminate information on institutional changes, contribute to the development and piloting of metrics needed for research assessment; identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, and develop and share guidance and recommendations for research organisations and policy-makers;

- The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching ‘cascading grant’ call(s) to support institutions from across the ERA, notably those engaged in the coalition approach, to implement sustainable institutional changes to reform and improve research assessment criteria and processes. This may require support services to be developed and provided to the beneficiary third party organisations. The ‘cascading grant’ mechanism is expected to contribute to institutional changes in a significant number of organisations (e.g., 40-50 individual organisations involved, of different types and across different geographical areas). As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to this mechanism, and one or more call(s) for proposals should be launched;
- The third part aims at international cooperation on research assessment. The action will envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and Associated Countries. The action will promote internationally the European efforts, will support exchange of information and explore opportunities for aligning policies, and will seek to attract non-European organisations to join the coalition.

The proposals should develop close cooperation, share knowledge and evidence, and build on various institutional, national and international initiatives, including DORA, GRC, UNESCO and the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC). Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51, call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes. Further collaborations are expected to emerge at a later stage, e.g. resulting from the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03 of Horizon Europe

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

One of the eight ambitions under the Open Science policy of the European Union is citizen science. ‘The general public should be able to make significant contributions and be recognised as valid European science knowledge producers.’ The aim under Horizon Europe is to ‘engage and involve citizens, civil society organisations and end-users in co-design and co-creation processes and promote responsible research and innovation.’

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-08: Laying the groundwork towards Europe-wide citizen science campaigns

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of citizen science initiatives with high potential impact if upscaled to ERA level;
- Establishment of broad societal coalitions/networks of quadruple helix actors organised around promising citizen science initiatives;
- Protocols and working modalities for use of open transnational data repositories and infrastructures;
- Proposals and commitments for mobilising diverse sources of funding to ensure sustainability of citizen science initiatives.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased collaboration with all stakeholders, including citizens in all phases of research and innovation, leading to more responsible R&I;
- Increased alignment of ERA countries' citizen science efforts;
- Transnational citizen science community building;
- Contributions to the objectives of Horizon Europe's EU Missions;
- Increased public trust in, and understanding of, science.

Scope: Citizen science, involving citizens directly in the development of new knowledge or innovations, is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that can lead to increased quality and effectiveness, e.g., through collecting, processing or analysing new qualities and quantities of data.

Many citizen science initiatives could achieve much higher impact if they were implemented on a transnational basis, collecting, analysing and exploiting vast amounts of cross-country data and, thereby, building a multinational community of citizen scientists. However, small-scale national citizen science projects often face practical, technical, or conceptual challenges and lack the support, the transnational coordination skills, and the resources, to upscale their efforts to a transnational level.

This action should conduct preparatory work for the launch of Europe-wide citizen science campaigns under the New ERA, which will also have synergies with Horizon Europe EU Missions. The action should identify the most promising citizen science initiatives for transnational upscaling, foster the development of broad societal coalitions around the identified and promising initiatives, and propose how to unlock the necessary funding commitments (e.g., from EU and national programmes and funders, philanthropic, and/or commercial sources) required.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should require the involvement of quadruple helix stakeholders. Citizen science 'champions' in public authorities should be envisaged, to raise awareness, 'connect the dots' between different services and institutions, and obtain broad and high-level commitments. The involvement of SMEs and industry could lead to new means to organise, collect and analyse data, and disseminate and exploit results. The involvement of research stakeholders will be essential to ensuring rigorous and credible research approaches and maximising scientific and technological impacts. Obtaining the inputs of civil society, involving and making youth aware of CS, building understanding of the activities (including their scientific bases), and fostering broad societal ownership of the promising initiatives could prove crucial to the scale and intensity of the eventual citizen science campaigns.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should aim to cover a majority, – and potentially all – ERA countries; involve citizens at different stages of the research cycle (e.g., development of

methods, data collection, data analysis, evidence-based advocacy processes, testing and evaluation); be inclusive and make particular efforts to involve those from lower socio-economic groups; and aim to deliver a range of additional benefits such as increased scientific literacy, improved trust in science, improved social inclusion and employability, and improved capacity within the scientific workforce to engage with society.

The action should conduct a thorough screening of potential initiatives to be upscaled, analysing the most promising in terms of synergies with one or more Horizon Europe EU Missions, the potential to advance scientific knowledge, and generation of a range of additional benefits. The action should develop scientific protocols, establish working modalities with open data repositories and infrastructures, prepare training (e.g., for volunteers and volunteer co-ordinators), develop societal engagement and science communication strategies, and propose how to mobilise diverse commitments for funding.

The action will build on the existing knowledge base and experience, including previous projects focused on citizen science, citizen engagement activities in the context of Horizon Europe EU Missions, citizen observatories, and the upscaling of the Plastic Pirates – Go Europe! (plastic-pirates.eu) campaign. It will work in collaboration with existing networks and actions, and develop synergies with the actions supported by HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61. The action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 to bring science closer to the citizens.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its *modus operandi* towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-03: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens) in line with ERA Policy Agenda action 7;
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives.

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging citizens and communities through creative interactions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

- a. Innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities in the field of academia–society collaboration. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society that promote the uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens’ needs and collaboration with industry. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities in the academia-society interaction;
- b. Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation, in the area of ‘academia-industry/SME linkages’ or ‘quadruple helix-based innovation’, i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach. Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The action should facilitate the sharing of experiences and lessons learned from the experimentation or transfer of best practices, develop policy recommendations and links to other relevant actions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-04: Development of new approaches to the macroeconomic modelling of research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The successful proposal will improve the integration of R&I within macro-economic modelling, while at the same time bringing fresh light on the role of R&I to tackle current societal challenges, with a particular focus on the European context. Project results are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support research at the knowledge frontier of macroeconomic models;

- Contribute to the development of innovative and interdisciplinary approaches to modelling of Research and Innovation (R&I) and R&I policy in Europe;
- Better integrate R&I activities in macro-economic models, leading to better measurement of their impact and a better understanding of the channels through which research and innovation lead to impact (direct and indirect) in Europe;
- Investigate new approaches to R&I macroeconomic models that link R&I-related drivers to economic, scientific and societal outcomes;
- Improve macro-economic modelling for the evaluation of R&I policy on different outcome variables, at different levels of policy intervention (EU, national, regional);
- Produce a novel macro-economic model able to simulate the economy, including the R&I dimension, linking R&I to sustainable and fair growth;
- Provide the full description of the models, codes and datasets, to allow easy access to forefront modelling ideas to the European scientific community and broader audience.

Scope: Existing macroeconomic models still fall short in providing sound ex-ante estimates of the various impacts of R&I. Therefore, the European Commission has engaged in a medium- to long-term agenda to improve the treatment of research and innovation (R&I) in macroeconomic models by supporting and financing cutting edge research on macroeconomic modelling able to attract the best researchers to work and develop new models capable of supporting the rising demand for policy evaluation tools in the EU. This agenda started in 2014 following the Commission Communication "Research and innovation as sources of renewed growth". The Council of the European Union called on the Commission to promote further research to build the evidence base for R&I policy making and for budgetary decision making, including by further improving the way R&I is accounted for in macro-economic models.

On the one hand, R&I are acknowledged as key engines for long-term growth and societal prosperity by an extensive body of economic literature. On the other hand, there is still need to develop further evidence about the quality, relevance and impact of R&I investments and the role that related policies have in scientific, technological, economic and social development. There is a crucial need for more developed and nuanced tools that would be able to account for the heterogeneity of different economic actors and that would be able to simulate the effects of a wide range of policies along different dimensions relevant for societal wellbeing. In addition, it is important that models are able to distinguish between the innovation process and the adoption / diffusion process.

Against these backdrops, the proposals, building upon the current state of the art existing in the literature, should develop and provide new macro-economic models with R&I, capable to integrate socio-economic challenges.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-05: Exploitation and valorisation of results relevant for the ERA Policy Agenda

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.20 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.20 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Boosting the dissemination, valorisation and broad uptake of results stemming from the different ERA Policy Agenda actions;
- Supporting mutual learning between Member States and stakeholders on their implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action;
- Building of an ERA community and branding at national and European level;
- Recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholders on how to best implement institutional changes related to ERA policies.

Scope: The ERA Policy Agenda, the 20 actions and their implementation will be supported with a range of actions under the different parts of the Horizon Europe Work Programme, and in particular, under the WIDERA work programme. Many of these actions will produce results that require a broad uptake by Member States, Associated Countries and their stakeholders. At the same time, important actions under Horizon Europe support the transformation and institutional change of universities, research organisations and enterprises. The action will implement a facility to disseminate results widely, facilitate their use, tailor them to the needs of the different communities and build a community of practitioners that

support mutual learning and exchange of good practices in institutional change in the spirit of the New ERA. It will furthermore design measures for mutual learning among Member States and stakeholders, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this. It will provide expertise to countries participating in the implementation of an ERA Policy Agenda action to address bottlenecks and increase stakeholder engagement. It will contribute to the building of an ERA community, including, with regular events at European level, and support a coherent approach to communication activities and their branding at national level. This will also allow the consortium to provide recommendations on how the necessary institutional and structural changes can best be achieved, including identifying gaps in methodologies and tools that would help to address these.

The action consists of four parts, all of which should be addressed:

- Design and implement a dissemination and valorisation facility covering the relevant actions of the ERA Policy Agenda;
- Support the coordination, sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across Member States and stakeholders, with the help of meetings, workshops, working groups and other tools to exchange experience, identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this;
- Community building, with regular events at European level, and support to coherent communication on ERA Policies, outcomes and results at national and European level;
- Design a process to develop and share guidance and recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholder organisations, across the European Union.

In order to support the achievement of the ERA objectives across the EU, the consortium should demonstrate that it covers the Member States in a geographically comprehensive way, as well as the capacity to provide or access expertise related to all relevant ERA Policy Agenda actions. Proposals should describe how they intend to collaborate closely with the Commission services, and build on the ERA Policy Platform in order to avoid additional IT developments.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-06: Building a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The action funded under this topic will have the objective of networking excellent knowledge nodes supporting the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China from across the European Union to build a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that will become sustainable beyond the end of the project. The goal of the platform would be to collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent knowledge on Contemporary China produced in the European Union (e.g., by universities, think tanks, research centres, NGOs, private companies, public organisations etc.) so as to foster the development of a network of independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level, raise awareness, and mainstream information on China also within the wider remit of civil society. The virtual European Info Platform will aim to become a key go-to source for independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level across all major relevant research areas (foreign policy, domestic politics, contemporary society and culture, science, technology, and innovation policy, economics, law, etc.). This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 9 on promoting international cooperation.

Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Bring together knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe to build and manage a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that would become a European key go-to source of independent knowledge on contemporary China;
- Coordinate with other initiatives and stakeholders where relevant for the action. Synergies with the two projects that were selected for funding under the previous call ‘HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07: Upgrading Independent Knowledge on Contemporary China in Europe’ are strongly encouraged. The work they bring forth should contribute to the development of the European Info Platform on Contemporary China;
- Regularly upload and disseminate knowledge on contemporary China, (including analyses, reports, articles, policy briefs, scoping studies, interviews, podcasts, etc.), not only produced by the successful consortium, but also filtered/selected from the work of external prominent and emerging knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe, so as to give visibility to all relevant European centres of excellence (including the smaller ones);
- Successful proposals would be expected to build into the website a section dedicated to the translation into English of key Chinese policy-documents and to create related policy briefs that would be openly accessible;

- Organise the material to be uploaded on the platform into thematic sections taking into account the priorities identified through the interactions with the relevant experts. A section of the platform should be specifically dedicated to understanding China's STI (science, technology, and innovation) system/policy and its implications for the European Union;
- Organise virtual and physical events (conferences, workshops, networking activities, trainings, staff exchanges, etc.), and manage their related communication activities, to foster pan-European connections among the different EU knowledge nodes on contemporary China. The organisation of China-focused thematic courses, ad-hoc seminars, and trainings, is encouraged in order to raise awareness on key China-related subjects, also involving the wider civil society/public/private institutions beyond China experts;
- Provide the Commission with regular policy recommendations and updates on the activities of the project;
- Reach out and encourage the participation of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China to enhance the visibility and impact of their work and foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge;
- Prepare and put in place a sustainability plan for the platform to ensure the continuation of the work after the end of the action.

Scope: This topic contributes to the priority areas of action number 9 on *promoting a positive environment and level playing field for international cooperation based on reciprocity* listed in the Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area⁵⁶ (ERA). More specifically it aims to satisfy the objective of *launching a pilot initiative on the Team Europe approach for a specific world region and/or topic*.

This action seeks to bolster a stronger European understanding of contemporary China and to strengthen European's capacity to sustain the production of such knowledge that is key to develop excellent EU-China policy-making based on facts, independent and unbiased analyses, and foresight. In accordance with the EU-China – A Strategic Outlook Communication of 2019⁵⁷ and the Global Approach to Research and Innovation Communication of May 2021⁵⁸, the action aims to empower the European Union to act coherently and proactively on the international stage preserving an open research and innovation ecosystem while safeguarding European interests and values.

Today China is a key global actor and a leading scientific and technological power. China's increasing relevance in the geopolitical system has exposed the weakness the European Union

⁵⁶ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14126-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁵⁷ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/communication-eu-china-a-strategic-outlook.pdf>

⁵⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/research_and_innovation/strategy_on_research_and_innovation/documents/ec_rtd_com2021-252.pdf

faces in its capacity to better understand contemporary China in its various specificities, complexities, and goals and respond to its rapid evolution and new policy directions. The European Union needs to get to know and understand it on its own terms: not through the lens of other external sources but from its own European perspective. The underlined priority for the EU to develop its own knowledge capacity to navigate China's continuous transformations is embedded in the concept of independent European knowledge, which should guide the work of successful applicants.

Following interactions with Member States, China experts, and stakeholders in the framework of the EU R&I Knowledge Network on China (EUKNOC) and following the publication of the SFIC recommendations on China in November 2021⁵⁹ it has emerged that at the European level expertise on contemporary China is often fragmented and difficult to access. Networking existing prominent and emerging knowledge nodes, gathering, categorising, and mainstreaming their work on an easily accessible public information platform would be therefore pivotal to break siloes and provide policy-makers, researchers, businesses, and civil society with the tools needed to develop a deeper understanding of the different dimensions that characterise contemporary China. Doing so would also increase the circulation of information and foster the creation of new knowledge, in line with the Commission's efforts to upgrade independent knowledge on contemporary China in Europe started in the 2021-2022 Horizon Europe work programme⁶⁰. Building synergies with granted projects from topic HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07, would be therefore strongly encouraged.

This action should bring forth the creation of a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China through networking relevant knowledge nodes from across the European Union that pursue the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China. The platform would collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent research material and provide translations from Chinese into English of relevant Chinese policy documents (and produce subsequent policy briefs on such documents). The successful consortium will be in charge of setting up the platform, organising/curating the material on the new virtual tool, setting up relevant events, thematic courses and trainings, communication activities, and developing a sustainability plan to ensure the successful continuation and growth of the platform after the end of the action.

The involvement of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China is strongly encouraged to foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge on contemporary China across the European Union and enhance the visibility of their work.

⁵⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1204-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

NB - Such recommendations call, among others, for the EU to build a permanent EU Info Centre for policy, academic, media and business based on existing networks and expertise available on China and to establish links between stakeholders from academia, public and private sector to create a network of China related actors and work on China in a concerted way.

⁶⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/horizon-cl2-2021-transformations-01-07> -

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-07: Support to reforms of research assessment in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support and contribute to the implementation of institutional changes for reforming research assessment (i.e., the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units,

and research institutions), in line with Action 3 of the ERA Policy Agenda actions and in support of Action 1;

- Connection of existing organisations and initiatives for reforms of research assessment, facilitating the exchange of information and mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders;
- Recommendations for policy-makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement institutional changes to research assessment;
- Global outreach of European efforts to reform research assessment and reinforced international cooperation on evolutions in research assessment.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research proposals and researchers evaluated in an unbiased manner on their intrinsic merits and performance rather than on the number of publications and where these are published;
- Researchers evaluated based on a broader range of research outputs and tasks (including open science practices);
- Researchers benefit from attractive careers, regardless of gender or other social characteristics;
- Modernised higher education sector, benefitting from improvements to the research assessment systems (including for performance-based funding).

Scope: The way research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions are assessed is fundamental for a well-functioning research and innovation system. The research and innovation system is undergoing major transformations with diversification of desired research outputs not restricted anymore to publications, and of research tasks and required skills; with a culture of sharing of knowledge and tools and of open collaboration (including societal engagement) becoming mainstream; and with a growing need of multi-disciplinary approaches and collaboration to tackle ever more complex scientific questions and societal challenges. However, the current system often uses limited methods to assess the quality, performance and impact of research, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers and the impact factor of the venue where they are published.

Several institutions including research funders and universities, in Europe and beyond, are currently reforming the assessment systems of their research and researchers. At a global level, the San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment⁶¹ (DORA) aims at improving how the output of scientific research is evaluated. The Recommendation on Open Science⁶² adopted by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

⁶¹ <https://sfdora.org/>

⁶² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949.locale=en>

in November 2021 calls for a review of research assessment systems to align them with the principles of open science. The Global Research Council (GRC) held a conference⁶³ in 2020 on “Responsible Research Assessment” and established a dedicated working group in 2021. The European Research Area ERA Policy Agenda for 2022-2024⁶⁴, adopted by the Council of the European Union on 26 November 2021, includes a priority action for reforming the assessment systems for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact. Accordingly, the European Commission is taking steps to facilitate an agreement between research funders, research performing organisations, national/regional evaluation agencies or authorities, and other stakeholders like learned societies, to reform research assessment criteria and processes in willing organisations, along commonly agreed principles and actions. In 2021, consultation of stakeholders⁶⁵ identified convergence on 10 principles expected to guide the reform of research assessment⁶⁶.

The establishment of a coalition of committed organisations is expected to accelerate changes towards research assessment systems that promote qualitative judgement with unbiased peer-review, supported by a more responsible use of quantitative indicators. The reformed research assessment systems should consider a more diverse set of research cultures and outputs, by valuing not only publications but also other research outputs such as data sets, software, models, workflows, methods, etc., and proper conduct including integrity and gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness. The reformed systems are expected to reward open collaboration as well as early knowledge and data sharing, as these practices enable good science⁶⁷. It should also reward the diversity of tasks of researchers, and consider the different contributions to the work of teams.

This action aims at supporting the reform of the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions. The action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

- The first part aims at supporting the operation of the coalition. This includes support to the sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across individual organisations, umbrella organisations, and initiatives, involved in the coalition and beyond, including with national and regional authorities. The action is expected to

⁶³ <https://www.globalresearchcouncil.org/news/responsible-research-assessment/>

⁶⁴ Annex to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the European Research Area of 26 November 2021 <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14308-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁶⁵ Scoping report “Towards a reform of the research assessment system”:
<https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/707440>

⁶⁶ The 10 principles identified during the stakeholders consultation and listed in the scoping report are: Ethics and integrity; Freedom of scientific research; Autonomy of research organisations; Independence and transparency of the data, infrastructure and criteria; Quality; Contribution to advancing knowledge and the (potential) impact of research results; Diversity of research activities, practices, outputs; Variety of scientific disciplines, research approaches, research career stages; Diversity in research roles and careers, and team science; and Gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness

⁶⁷ Open science practices include: early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, or crowd-sourcing); research output management; measures to ensure reproducibility of research outputs; providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); participation in open peer-review; and involving all relevant knowledge actors including citizens, civil society and end users in the co creation of R&I agendas and contents (such as citizen science).

support workshops, working groups and other tools to: raise awareness, exchange experience and disseminate information on institutional changes, contribute to the development and piloting of metrics needed for research assessment; identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, and develop and share guidance and recommendations for research organisations and policy-makers;

- The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching ‘cascading grant’ call(s) to support institutions from across the ERA, notably those engaged in the coalition approach, to implement sustainable institutional changes to reform and improve research assessment criteria and processes. This may require support services to be developed and provided to the beneficiary third party organisations. The ‘cascading grant’ mechanism is expected to contribute to institutional changes in a significant number of organisations (e.g., 40-50 individual organisations involved, of different types and across different geographical areas). As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to this mechanism, and one or more call(s) for proposals should be launched;
- The third part aims at international cooperation on research assessment. The action will envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and Associated Countries. The action will promote internationally the European efforts, will support exchange of information and explore opportunities for aligning policies, and will seek to attract non-European organisations to join the coalition.

The proposals should develop close cooperation, share knowledge and evidence, and build on various institutional, national and international initiatives, including DORA, GRC, UNESCO and the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC). Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51, call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes. Further collaborations are expected to emerge at a later stage, e.g. resulting from the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03 of Horizon Europe

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

One of the eight ambitions under the Open Science policy of the European Union is citizen science. ‘The general public should be able to make significant contributions and be recognised as valid European science knowledge producers.’ The aim under Horizon Europe is to ‘engage and involve citizens, civil society organisations and end-users in co-design and co-creation processes and promote responsible research and innovation.’

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-08: Laying the groundwork towards Europe-wide citizen science campaigns

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of citizen science initiatives with high potential impact if upscaled to ERA level;
- Establishment of broad societal coalitions/networks of quadruple helix actors organised around promising citizen science initiatives;
- Protocols and working modalities for use of open transnational data repositories and infrastructures;
- Proposals and commitments for mobilising diverse sources of funding to ensure sustainability of citizen science initiatives.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased collaboration with all stakeholders, including citizens in all phases of research and innovation, leading to more responsible R&I;
- Increased alignment of ERA countries' citizen science efforts;
- Transnational citizen science community building;
- Contributions to the objectives of Horizon Europe's EU Missions;
- Increased public trust in, and understanding of, science.

Scope: Citizen science, involving citizens directly in the development of new knowledge or innovations, is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that can lead to increased quality and effectiveness, e.g., through collecting, processing or analysing new qualities and quantities of data.

Many citizen science initiatives could achieve much higher impact if they were implemented on a transnational basis, collecting, analysing and exploiting vast amounts of cross-country data and, thereby, building a multinational community of citizen scientists. However, small-scale national citizen science projects often face practical, technical, or conceptual challenges and lack the support, the transnational coordination skills, and the resources, to upscale their efforts to a transnational level.

This action should conduct preparatory work for the launch of Europe-wide citizen science campaigns under the New ERA, which will also have synergies with Horizon Europe EU Missions. The action should identify the most promising citizen science initiatives for transnational upscaling, foster the development of broad societal coalitions around the identified and promising initiatives, and propose how to unlock the necessary funding commitments (e.g., from EU and national programmes and funders, philanthropic, and/or commercial sources) required.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should require the involvement of quadruple helix stakeholders. Citizen science 'champions' in public authorities should be envisaged, to raise awareness, 'connect the dots' between different services and institutions, and obtain broad and high-level commitments. The involvement of SMEs and industry could lead to new means to organise, collect and analyse data, and disseminate and exploit results. The involvement of research stakeholders will be essential to ensuring rigorous and credible research approaches and maximising scientific and technological impacts. Obtaining the inputs of civil society, involving and making youth aware of CS, building understanding of the activities (including their scientific bases), and fostering broad societal ownership of the promising initiatives could prove crucial to the scale and intensity of the eventual citizen science campaigns.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should aim to cover a majority, – and potentially all – ERA countries; involve citizens at different stages of the research cycle (e.g., development of

methods, data collection, data analysis, evidence-based advocacy processes, testing and evaluation); be inclusive and make particular efforts to involve those from lower socio-economic groups; and aim to deliver a range of additional benefits such as increased scientific literacy, improved trust in science, improved social inclusion and employability, and improved capacity within the scientific workforce to engage with society.

The action should conduct a thorough screening of potential initiatives to be upscaled, analysing the most promising in terms of synergies with one or more Horizon Europe EU Missions, the potential to advance scientific knowledge, and generation of a range of additional benefits. The action should develop scientific protocols, establish working modalities with open data repositories and infrastructures, prepare training (e.g., for volunteers and volunteer co-ordinators), develop societal engagement and science communication strategies, and propose how to mobilise diverse commitments for funding.

The action will build on the existing knowledge base and experience, including previous projects focused on citizen science, citizen engagement activities in the context of Horizon Europe EU Missions, citizen observatories, and the upscaling of the Plastic Pirates – Go Europe! (plastic-pirates.eu) campaign. It will work in collaboration with existing networks and actions, and develop synergies with the actions supported by HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61. The action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 to bring science closer to the citizens.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.

<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentivise programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-02: A strong European R&I Foresight Community to better inform R&I policy decisions in the European Research Area about potential futures

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply:

	The Joint Research Centre (JRC) may participate as member of the consortium selected for funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: The project is expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthening the European R&I foresight community, its networks, resources and functions, and its engagement with citizens. Improve the use of foresight in R&I policy and planning across the European Research Area to support prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms, which will support the implementation. Common visions and pathways to the future(s), and “accounting” of Member States R&I foresight activities contribute to the monitoring of the ERA;
- Building and mobilising joint resources to inform R&I policies at EU and national levels, including through the European Framework Programme for Research and Innovation (Strategic Plan and Work Programmes), such as collection of manuals and guidebooks, a library of futures, expert pools, digital tool-boxes or shared software solutions to support horizon scanning, citizen engagement projects, scenario building, and science and technology road mapping;
- Joining forces on pilot activities and projects on topics of common interest, supporting and “training” the networking within the R&I foresight community including governmental R&I foresight organisations, which already organised regular workshops meetings under several Council Presidencies.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Common visions and shared appreciations of future challenges and opportunities amongst R&I policy-makers in the European Research Area;
- Improved capacity of Member States within the European Research Area to anticipate the future and tackle new challenges, and to take advantage of new opportunity spaces, identifying trajectories for R&I interventions at EU and national level, combining knowledge, data, expert advice and citizen engagement;
- Improved engagement of researchers, communicators, journalists, industry, policy-makers and civil society, with foresight in general and foresight for R&I in particular, improving the contributions of science and research to policy across the board for improved preparedness for future disruptive events;
- Stronger engagement of society in R&I policy as a consequence of citizen discourses on future implications of S&T&I, improved coherence and overall effectiveness of research and innovation interventions across Europe through better anticipation of futures, and thus improved impact on the economy and on policy priorities at EU and national levels;

- More and better contributions of R&I to societal ideals and political and economic objectives across Europe, namely the twin green and digital transition, and increasing public engagement and participation in the ERA as well as resilience of the EU.

Scope: Foresight has become an important element of policymaking across the European Union and much of the world. It is increasingly recognised for its potential to help anticipation and preparedness to deal with challenges and capture opportunities of the future.

Foresight is an important and proven means to engage with citizens on issues of science, technology and innovation and their possible contribution to tackle societal challenges. It supports the needed just, sustainable and digital transitions, and the move towards the future we want.

R&I policy has been amongst the first to support and use foresight in Europe, at both national and European levels. The longstanding experience provides a strong foundation for a European R&I foresight community. However, the extent of use of foresight in R&I policy across Europe is still uneven, as well as its degree of institutionalisation.

Foresight today is a common tool in strategy development and programming in science and technology and in policy making in a broader sense. It complements and incorporates much of the classical R&I policy toolbox of technology assessment, trend analysis, forecasting, road mapping, evaluation, strategic or SWOT analyses etc. The unevenness of the use of foresight affects the potential of foresight to support national and European R&I policies in the European Research Area.

The objective of this action is to accelerate the development of a European R&I foresight community supporting the development of national R&I foresight communities that are well integrated in national policy systems; and can contribute not only to the design of national reforms and policies but also to the evidence underpinning and the governance of a vibrant European Research Area, which delivers on common priorities and objectives.

The diversity of experiences with foresight can be a resource for a European foresight community, underscoring the need and being a foundation for highly beneficial networking actions, to exchange experiences, share ideas and work on topics of common interest. Such topics should have a clear link to ERA agenda points. Previous discussions with Member States suggest for instance the workforce skill and capacity needs for the twin transition. The consortium to carry out the CSA tasks should reflect the diversity of R&I foresight settings across Europe and involve government R&I foresight agencies and institutions from across the EU including countries associated with Horizon Europe.

This action should include:

- A stocktaking of the organisation of foresight activities informing R&I policy in the European Research Area, covering institutional, methodological, and analytical practices as well as an assessment of the main strengths and weaknesses nationally and in relation to policy needs at European level;

- Networking activities for institutions and people engaged in the R&I foresight community as well as potential users and stakeholders of foresight. This could be workshops, seminars, programmes, guidelines, methodology toolboxes, training modules, annual conferences, common social media platforms, network services and infrastructures (e.g., a database of science and technology experts who are interested in futures' intelligence, which could be used for Delphi surveys, scenario building, horizon scanning etc.);
- Development and practical application of the network in pilot foresight projects on topics of common interest, which are linked to ERA Policy Agenda Actions, possibly in coordination with the ERA Forum;
- Participatory approaches and engaging with citizens for foresight across Europe, as well as activities promoting futures literacy should play a core role in order to exploit foresight to the full;
- A network of national agencies on foresight and R&I (including foresight units in ministries and government institutions) should lie at the core of the action and at the core of Europe's R&I foresight community, covering as many member states and countries associated with Horizon Europe as possible.

The European R&I foresight community should build on, and valorise and disseminate results from, foresight projects funded as part of Horizon 2020 and in Horizon Europe including the foresight work done by the JRC: The community will be supported by a principally publicly accessible online platform, providing common resources, further development of training, mutual exchange, and joint foresight work on topics of common interest amongst Europe's R&I policy-makers. Developing a model for the governance and financial sustainability of the network and platform is part of the task, as is a sound European programme on foresight methodologies, resources and activities that will inform the policies shaping the future of science, technology and innovation across the European Union and interested Horizon Europe participating countries.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-03: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens) in line with ERA Policy Agenda action 7;
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives.

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging citizens and communities through creative interactions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

- a. Innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities in the field of academia–society collaboration. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society that promote the uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens’ needs and collaboration with industry. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities in the academia-society interaction;
- b. Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation, in the area of ‘academia-industry/SME linkages’ or ‘quadruple helix-based innovation’, i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach. Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The action should facilitate the sharing of experiences and lessons learned from the experimentation or transfer of best practices, develop policy recommendations and links to other relevant actions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-04: Development of new approaches to the macroeconomic modelling of research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The successful proposal will improve the integration of R&I within macro-economic modelling, while at the same time bringing fresh light on the role of R&I to tackle current societal challenges, with a particular focus on the European context. Project results are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support research at the knowledge frontier of macroeconomic models;

- Contribute to the development of innovative and interdisciplinary approaches to modelling of Research and Innovation (R&I) and R&I policy in Europe;
- Better integrate R&I activities in macro-economic models, leading to better measurement of their impact and a better understanding of the channels through which research and innovation lead to impact (direct and indirect) in Europe;
- Investigate new approaches to R&I macroeconomic models that link R&I-related drivers to economic, scientific and societal outcomes;
- Improve macro-economic modelling for the evaluation of R&I policy on different outcome variables, at different levels of policy intervention (EU, national, regional);
- Produce a novel macro-economic model able to simulate the economy, including the R&I dimension, linking R&I to sustainable and fair growth;
- Provide the full description of the models, codes and datasets, to allow easy access to forefront modelling ideas to the European scientific community and broader audience.

Scope: Existing macroeconomic models still fall short in providing sound ex-ante estimates of the various impacts of R&I. Therefore, the European Commission has engaged in a medium- to long-term agenda to improve the treatment of research and innovation (R&I) in macroeconomic models by supporting and financing cutting edge research on macroeconomic modelling able to attract the best researchers to work and develop new models capable of supporting the rising demand for policy evaluation tools in the EU. This agenda started in 2014 following the Commission Communication "Research and innovation as sources of renewed growth". The Council of the European Union called on the Commission to promote further research to build the evidence base for R&I policy making and for budgetary decision making, including by further improving the way R&I is accounted for in macro-economic models.

On the one hand, R&I are acknowledged as key engines for long-term growth and societal prosperity by an extensive body of economic literature. On the other hand, there is still need to develop further evidence about the quality, relevance and impact of R&I investments and the role that related policies have in scientific, technological, economic and social development. There is a crucial need for more developed and nuanced tools that would be able to account for the heterogeneity of different economic actors and that would be able to simulate the effects of a wide range of policies along different dimensions relevant for societal wellbeing. In addition, it is important that models are able to distinguish between the innovation process and the adoption / diffusion process.

Against these backdrops, the proposals, building upon the current state of the art existing in the literature, should develop and provide new macro-economic models with R&I, capable to integrate socio-economic challenges.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-05: Exploitation and valorisation of results relevant for the ERA Policy Agenda

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.20 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.20 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Boosting the dissemination, valorisation and broad uptake of results stemming from the different ERA Policy Agenda actions;
- Supporting mutual learning between Member States and stakeholders on their implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action;
- Building of an ERA community and branding at national and European level;
- Recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholders on how to best implement institutional changes related to ERA policies.

Scope: The ERA Policy Agenda, the 20 actions and their implementation will be supported with a range of actions under the different parts of the Horizon Europe Work Programme, and in particular, under the WIDERA work programme. Many of these actions will produce results that require a broad uptake by Member States, Associated Countries and their stakeholders. At the same time, important actions under Horizon Europe support the transformation and institutional change of universities, research organisations and enterprises. The action will implement a facility to disseminate results widely, facilitate their use, tailor them to the needs of the different communities and build a community of practitioners that

support mutual learning and exchange of good practices in institutional change in the spirit of the New ERA. It will furthermore design measures for mutual learning among Member States and stakeholders, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this. It will provide expertise to countries participating in the implementation of an ERA Policy Agenda action to address bottlenecks and increase stakeholder engagement. It will contribute to the building of an ERA community, including, with regular events at European level, and support a coherent approach to communication activities and their branding at national level. This will also allow the consortium to provide recommendations on how the necessary institutional and structural changes can best be achieved, including identifying gaps in methodologies and tools that would help to address these.

The action consists of four parts, all of which should be addressed:

- Design and implement a dissemination and valorisation facility covering the relevant actions of the ERA Policy Agenda;
- Support the coordination, sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across Member States and stakeholders, with the help of meetings, workshops, working groups and other tools to exchange experience, identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this;
- Community building, with regular events at European level, and support to coherent communication on ERA Policies, outcomes and results at national and European level;
- Design a process to develop and share guidance and recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholder organisations, across the European Union.

In order to support the achievement of the ERA objectives across the EU, the consortium should demonstrate that it covers the Member States in a geographically comprehensive way, as well as the capacity to provide or access expertise related to all relevant ERA Policy Agenda actions. Proposals should describe how they intend to collaborate closely with the Commission services, and build on the ERA Policy Platform in order to avoid additional IT developments.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-06: Building a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The action funded under this topic will have the objective of networking excellent knowledge nodes supporting the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China from across the European Union to build a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that will become sustainable beyond the end of the project. The goal of the platform would be to collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent knowledge on Contemporary China produced in the European Union (e.g., by universities, think tanks, research centres, NGOs, private companies, public organisations etc.) so as to foster the development of a network of independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level, raise awareness, and mainstream information on China also within the wider remit of civil society. The virtual European Info Platform will aim to become a key go-to source for independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level across all major relevant research areas (foreign policy, domestic politics, contemporary society and culture, science, technology, and innovation policy, economics, law, etc.). This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 9 on promoting international cooperation.

Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Bring together knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe to build and manage a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that would become a European key go-to source of independent knowledge on contemporary China;
- Coordinate with other initiatives and stakeholders where relevant for the action. Synergies with the two projects that were selected for funding under the previous call ‘HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07: Upgrading Independent Knowledge on Contemporary China in Europe’ are strongly encouraged. The work they bring forth should contribute to the development of the European Info Platform on Contemporary China;
- Regularly upload and disseminate knowledge on contemporary China, (including analyses, reports, articles, policy briefs, scoping studies, interviews, podcasts, etc.), not only produced by the successful consortium, but also filtered/selected from the work of external prominent and emerging knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe, so as to give visibility to all relevant European centres of excellence (including the smaller ones);
- Successful proposals would be expected to build into the website a section dedicated to the translation into English of key Chinese policy-documents and to create related policy briefs that would be openly accessible;

- Organise the material to be uploaded on the platform into thematic sections taking into account the priorities identified through the interactions with the relevant experts. A section of the platform should be specifically dedicated to understanding China's STI (science, technology, and innovation) system/policy and its implications for the European Union;
- Organise virtual and physical events (conferences, workshops, networking activities, trainings, staff exchanges, etc.), and manage their related communication activities, to foster pan-European connections among the different EU knowledge nodes on contemporary China. The organisation of China-focused thematic courses, ad-hoc seminars, and trainings, is encouraged in order to raise awareness on key China-related subjects, also involving the wider civil society/public/private institutions beyond China experts;
- Provide the Commission with regular policy recommendations and updates on the activities of the project;
- Reach out and encourage the participation of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China to enhance the visibility and impact of their work and foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge;
- Prepare and put in place a sustainability plan for the platform to ensure the continuation of the work after the end of the action.

Scope: This topic contributes to the priority areas of action number 9 on *promoting a positive environment and level playing field for international cooperation based on reciprocity* listed in the Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area⁵⁶ (ERA). More specifically it aims to satisfy the objective of *launching a pilot initiative on the Team Europe approach for a specific world region and/or topic*.

This action seeks to bolster a stronger European understanding of contemporary China and to strengthen European's capacity to sustain the production of such knowledge that is key to develop excellent EU-China policy-making based on facts, independent and unbiased analyses, and foresight. In accordance with the EU-China – A Strategic Outlook Communication of 2019⁵⁷ and the Global Approach to Research and Innovation Communication of May 2021⁵⁸, the action aims to empower the European Union to act coherently and proactively on the international stage preserving an open research and innovation ecosystem while safeguarding European interests and values.

Today China is a key global actor and a leading scientific and technological power. China's increasing relevance in the geopolitical system has exposed the weakness the European Union

⁵⁶ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14126-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁵⁷ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/communication-eu-china-a-strategic-outlook.pdf>

⁵⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/research_and_innovation/strategy_on_research_and_innovation/documents/ec_rtd_com2021-252.pdf

faces in its capacity to better understand contemporary China in its various specificities, complexities, and goals and respond to its rapid evolution and new policy directions. The European Union needs to get to know and understand it on its own terms: not through the lens of other external sources but from its own European perspective. The underlined priority for the EU to develop its own knowledge capacity to navigate China's continuous transformations is embedded in the concept of independent European knowledge, which should guide the work of successful applicants.

Following interactions with Member States, China experts, and stakeholders in the framework of the EU R&I Knowledge Network on China (EUKNOC) and following the publication of the SFIC recommendations on China in November 2021⁵⁹ it has emerged that at the European level expertise on contemporary China is often fragmented and difficult to access. Networking existing prominent and emerging knowledge nodes, gathering, categorising, and mainstreaming their work on an easily accessible public information platform would be therefore pivotal to break siloes and provide policy-makers, researchers, businesses, and civil society with the tools needed to develop a deeper understanding of the different dimensions that characterise contemporary China. Doing so would also increase the circulation of information and foster the creation of new knowledge, in line with the Commission's efforts to upgrade independent knowledge on contemporary China in Europe started in the 2021-2022 Horizon Europe work programme⁶⁰. Building synergies with granted projects from topic HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07, would be therefore strongly encouraged.

This action should bring forth the creation of a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China through networking relevant knowledge nodes from across the European Union that pursue the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China. The platform would collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent research material and provide translations from Chinese into English of relevant Chinese policy documents (and produce subsequent policy briefs on such documents). The successful consortium will be in charge of setting up the platform, organising/curating the material on the new virtual tool, setting up relevant events, thematic courses and trainings, communication activities, and developing a sustainability plan to ensure the successful continuation and growth of the platform after the end of the action.

The involvement of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China is strongly encouraged to foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge on contemporary China across the European Union and enhance the visibility of their work.

⁵⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1204-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

NB - Such recommendations call, among others, for the EU to build a permanent EU Info Centre for policy, academic, media and business based on existing networks and expertise available on China and to establish links between stakeholders from academia, public and private sector to create a network of China related actors and work on China in a concerted way.

⁶⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/horizon-cl2-2021-transformations-01-07> -

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-07: Support to reforms of research assessment in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support and contribute to the implementation of institutional changes for reforming research assessment (i.e., the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units,

and research institutions), in line with Action 3 of the ERA Policy Agenda actions and in support of Action 1;

- Connection of existing organisations and initiatives for reforms of research assessment, facilitating the exchange of information and mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders;
- Recommendations for policy-makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement institutional changes to research assessment;
- Global outreach of European efforts to reform research assessment and reinforced international cooperation on evolutions in research assessment.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research proposals and researchers evaluated in an unbiased manner on their intrinsic merits and performance rather than on the number of publications and where these are published;
- Researchers evaluated based on a broader range of research outputs and tasks (including open science practices);
- Researchers benefit from attractive careers, regardless of gender or other social characteristics;
- Modernised higher education sector, benefitting from improvements to the research assessment systems (including for performance-based funding).

Scope: The way research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions are assessed is fundamental for a well-functioning research and innovation system. The research and innovation system is undergoing major transformations with diversification of desired research outputs not restricted anymore to publications, and of research tasks and required skills; with a culture of sharing of knowledge and tools and of open collaboration (including societal engagement) becoming mainstream; and with a growing need of multi-disciplinary approaches and collaboration to tackle ever more complex scientific questions and societal challenges. However, the current system often uses limited methods to assess the quality, performance and impact of research, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers and the impact factor of the venue where they are published.

Several institutions including research funders and universities, in Europe and beyond, are currently reforming the assessment systems of their research and researchers. At a global level, the San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment⁶¹ (DORA) aims at improving how the output of scientific research is evaluated. The Recommendation on Open Science⁶² adopted by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

⁶¹ <https://sfdora.org/>

⁶² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949.locale=en>

in November 2021 calls for a review of research assessment systems to align them with the principles of open science. The Global Research Council (GRC) held a conference⁶³ in 2020 on “Responsible Research Assessment” and established a dedicated working group in 2021. The European Research Area ERA Policy Agenda for 2022-2024⁶⁴, adopted by the Council of the European Union on 26 November 2021, includes a priority action for reforming the assessment systems for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact. Accordingly, the European Commission is taking steps to facilitate an agreement between research funders, research performing organisations, national/regional evaluation agencies or authorities, and other stakeholders like learned societies, to reform research assessment criteria and processes in willing organisations, along commonly agreed principles and actions. In 2021, consultation of stakeholders⁶⁵ identified convergence on 10 principles expected to guide the reform of research assessment⁶⁶.

The establishment of a coalition of committed organisations is expected to accelerate changes towards research assessment systems that promote qualitative judgement with unbiased peer-review, supported by a more responsible use of quantitative indicators. The reformed research assessment systems should consider a more diverse set of research cultures and outputs, by valuing not only publications but also other research outputs such as data sets, software, models, workflows, methods, etc., and proper conduct including integrity and gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness. The reformed systems are expected to reward open collaboration as well as early knowledge and data sharing, as these practices enable good science⁶⁷. It should also reward the diversity of tasks of researchers, and consider the different contributions to the work of teams.

This action aims at supporting the reform of the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions. The action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

- The first part aims at supporting the operation of the coalition. This includes support to the sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across individual organisations, umbrella organisations, and initiatives, involved in the coalition and beyond, including with national and regional authorities. The action is expected to

⁶³ <https://www.globalresearchcouncil.org/news/responsible-research-assessment/>

⁶⁴ Annex to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the European Research Area of 26 November 2021 <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14308-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁶⁵ Scoping report “Towards a reform of the research assessment system”:
<https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/707440>

⁶⁶ The 10 principles identified during the stakeholders consultation and listed in the scoping report are: Ethics and integrity; Freedom of scientific research; Autonomy of research organisations; Independence and transparency of the data, infrastructure and criteria; Quality; Contribution to advancing knowledge and the (potential) impact of research results; Diversity of research activities, practices, outputs; Variety of scientific disciplines, research approaches, research career stages; Diversity in research roles and careers, and team science; and Gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness

⁶⁷ Open science practices include: early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, or crowd-sourcing); research output management; measures to ensure reproducibility of research outputs; providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); participation in open peer-review; and involving all relevant knowledge actors including citizens, civil society and end users in the co creation of R&I agendas and contents (such as citizen science).

support workshops, working groups and other tools to: raise awareness, exchange experience and disseminate information on institutional changes, contribute to the development and piloting of metrics needed for research assessment; identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, and develop and share guidance and recommendations for research organisations and policy-makers;

- The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching ‘cascading grant’ call(s) to support institutions from across the ERA, notably those engaged in the coalition approach, to implement sustainable institutional changes to reform and improve research assessment criteria and processes. This may require support services to be developed and provided to the beneficiary third party organisations. The ‘cascading grant’ mechanism is expected to contribute to institutional changes in a significant number of organisations (e.g., 40-50 individual organisations involved, of different types and across different geographical areas). As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to this mechanism, and one or more call(s) for proposals should be launched;
- The third part aims at international cooperation on research assessment. The action will envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and Associated Countries. The action will promote internationally the European efforts, will support exchange of information and explore opportunities for aligning policies, and will seek to attract non-European organisations to join the coalition.

The proposals should develop close cooperation, share knowledge and evidence, and build on various institutional, national and international initiatives, including DORA, GRC, UNESCO and the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC). Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51, call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes. Further collaborations are expected to emerge at a later stage, e.g. resulting from the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03 of Horizon Europe

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

One of the eight ambitions under the Open Science policy of the European Union is citizen science. ‘The general public should be able to make significant contributions and be recognised as valid European science knowledge producers.’ The aim under Horizon Europe is to ‘engage and involve citizens, civil society organisations and end-users in co-design and co-creation processes and promote responsible research and innovation.’

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-08: Laying the groundwork towards Europe-wide citizen science campaigns

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of citizen science initiatives with high potential impact if upscaled to ERA level;
- Establishment of broad societal coalitions/networks of quadruple helix actors organised around promising citizen science initiatives;
- Protocols and working modalities for use of open transnational data repositories and infrastructures;
- Proposals and commitments for mobilising diverse sources of funding to ensure sustainability of citizen science initiatives.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased collaboration with all stakeholders, including citizens in all phases of research and innovation, leading to more responsible R&I;
- Increased alignment of ERA countries' citizen science efforts;
- Transnational citizen science community building;
- Contributions to the objectives of Horizon Europe's EU Missions;
- Increased public trust in, and understanding of, science.

Scope: Citizen science, involving citizens directly in the development of new knowledge or innovations, is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that can lead to increased quality and effectiveness, e.g., through collecting, processing or analysing new qualities and quantities of data.

Many citizen science initiatives could achieve much higher impact if they were implemented on a transnational basis, collecting, analysing and exploiting vast amounts of cross-country data and, thereby, building a multinational community of citizen scientists. However, small-scale national citizen science projects often face practical, technical, or conceptual challenges and lack the support, the transnational coordination skills, and the resources, to upscale their efforts to a transnational level.

This action should conduct preparatory work for the launch of Europe-wide citizen science campaigns under the New ERA, which will also have synergies with Horizon Europe EU Missions. The action should identify the most promising citizen science initiatives for transnational upscaling, foster the development of broad societal coalitions around the identified and promising initiatives, and propose how to unlock the necessary funding commitments (e.g., from EU and national programmes and funders, philanthropic, and/or commercial sources) required.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should require the involvement of quadruple helix stakeholders. Citizen science 'champions' in public authorities should be envisaged, to raise awareness, 'connect the dots' between different services and institutions, and obtain broad and high-level commitments. The involvement of SMEs and industry could lead to new means to organise, collect and analyse data, and disseminate and exploit results. The involvement of research stakeholders will be essential to ensuring rigorous and credible research approaches and maximising scientific and technological impacts. Obtaining the inputs of civil society, involving and making youth aware of CS, building understanding of the activities (including their scientific bases), and fostering broad societal ownership of the promising initiatives could prove crucial to the scale and intensity of the eventual citizen science campaigns.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should aim to cover a majority, – and potentially all – ERA countries; involve citizens at different stages of the research cycle (e.g., development of

methods, data collection, data analysis, evidence-based advocacy processes, testing and evaluation); be inclusive and make particular efforts to involve those from lower socio-economic groups; and aim to deliver a range of additional benefits such as increased scientific literacy, improved trust in science, improved social inclusion and employability, and improved capacity within the scientific workforce to engage with society.

The action should conduct a thorough screening of potential initiatives to be upscaled, analysing the most promising in terms of synergies with one or more Horizon Europe EU Missions, the potential to advance scientific knowledge, and generation of a range of additional benefits. The action should develop scientific protocols, establish working modalities with open data repositories and infrastructures, prepare training (e.g., for volunteers and volunteer co-ordinators), develop societal engagement and science communication strategies, and propose how to mobilise diverse commitments for funding.

The action will build on the existing knowledge base and experience, including previous projects focused on citizen science, citizen engagement activities in the context of Horizon Europe EU Missions, citizen observatories, and the upscaling of the Plastic Pirates – Go Europe! (plastic-pirates.eu) campaign. It will work in collaboration with existing networks and actions, and develop synergies with the actions supported by HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61. The action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 to bring science closer to the citizens.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its *modus operandi* towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of citizen science initiatives with high potential impact if upscaled to ERA level;
- Establishment of broad societal coalitions/networks of quadruple helix actors organised around promising citizen science initiatives;
- Protocols and working modalities for use of open transnational data repositories and infrastructures;
- Proposals and commitments for mobilising diverse sources of funding to ensure sustainability of citizen science initiatives.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased collaboration with all stakeholders, including citizens in all phases of research and innovation, leading to more responsible R&I;
- Increased alignment of ERA countries' citizen science efforts;
- Transnational citizen science community building;
- Contributions to the objectives of Horizon Europe's EU Missions;
- Increased public trust in, and understanding of, science.

Scope: Citizen science, involving citizens directly in the development of new knowledge or innovations, is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that can lead to increased quality and effectiveness, e.g., through collecting, processing or analysing new qualities and quantities of data.

Many citizen science initiatives could achieve much higher impact if they were implemented on a transnational basis, collecting, analysing and exploiting vast amounts of cross-country data and, thereby, building a multinational community of citizen scientists. However, small-scale national citizen science projects often face practical, technical, or conceptual challenges and lack the support, the transnational coordination skills, and the resources, to upscale their efforts to a transnational level.

This action should conduct preparatory work for the launch of Europe-wide citizen science campaigns under the New ERA, which will also have synergies with Horizon Europe EU Missions. The action should identify the most promising citizen science initiatives for transnational upscaling, foster the development of broad societal coalitions around the identified and promising initiatives, and propose how to unlock the necessary funding commitments (e.g., from EU and national programmes and funders, philanthropic, and/or commercial sources) required.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should require the involvement of quadruple helix stakeholders. Citizen science 'champions' in public authorities should be envisaged, to raise awareness, 'connect the dots' between different services and institutions, and obtain broad and high-level commitments. The involvement of SMEs and industry could lead to new means to organise, collect and analyse data, and disseminate and exploit results. The involvement of research stakeholders will be essential to ensuring rigorous and credible research approaches and maximising scientific and technological impacts. Obtaining the inputs of civil society, involving and making youth aware of CS, building understanding of the activities (including their scientific bases), and fostering broad societal ownership of the promising initiatives could prove crucial to the scale and intensity of the eventual citizen science campaigns.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should aim to cover a majority, – and potentially all – ERA countries; involve citizens at different stages of the research cycle (e.g., development of

methods, data collection, data analysis, evidence-based advocacy processes, testing and evaluation); be inclusive and make particular efforts to involve those from lower socio-economic groups; and aim to deliver a range of additional benefits such as increased scientific literacy, improved trust in science, improved social inclusion and employability, and improved capacity within the scientific workforce to engage with society.

The action should conduct a thorough screening of potential initiatives to be upscaled, analysing the most promising in terms of synergies with one or more Horizon Europe EU Missions, the potential to advance scientific knowledge, and generation of a range of additional benefits. The action should develop scientific protocols, establish working modalities with open data repositories and infrastructures, prepare training (e.g., for volunteers and volunteer co-ordinators), develop societal engagement and science communication strategies, and propose how to mobilise diverse commitments for funding.

The action will build on the existing knowledge base and experience, including previous projects focused on citizen science, citizen engagement activities in the context of Horizon Europe EU Missions, citizen observatories, and the upscaling of the Plastic Pirates – Go Europe! (plastic-pirates.eu) campaign. It will work in collaboration with existing networks and actions, and develop synergies with the actions supported by HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61. The action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 to bring science closer to the citizens.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its *modus operandi* towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRFs include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRFs and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-02: A strong European R&I Foresight Community to better inform R&I policy decisions in the European Research Area about potential futures

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply:

	The Joint Research Centre (JRC) may participate as member of the consortium selected for funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: The project is expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- Strengthening the European R&I foresight community, its networks, resources and functions, and its engagement with citizens. Improve the use of foresight in R&I policy and planning across the European Research Area to support prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms, which will support the implementation. Common visions and pathways to the future(s), and “accounting” of Member States R&I foresight activities contribute to the monitoring of the ERA;
- Building and mobilising joint resources to inform R&I policies at EU and national levels, including through the European Framework Programme for Research and Innovation (Strategic Plan and Work Programmes), such as collection of manuals and guidebooks, a library of futures, expert pools, digital tool-boxes or shared software solutions to support horizon scanning, citizen engagement projects, scenario building, and science and technology road mapping;
- Joining forces on pilot activities and projects on topics of common interest, supporting and “training” the networking within the R&I foresight community including governmental R&I foresight organisations, which already organised regular workshops meetings under several Council Presidencies.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Common visions and shared appreciations of future challenges and opportunities amongst R&I policy-makers in the European Research Area;
- Improved capacity of Member States within the European Research Area to anticipate the future and tackle new challenges, and to take advantage of new opportunity spaces, identifying trajectories for R&I interventions at EU and national level, combining knowledge, data, expert advice and citizen engagement;
- Improved engagement of researchers, communicators, journalists, industry, policy-makers and civil society, with foresight in general and foresight for R&I in particular, improving the contributions of science and research to policy across the board for improved preparedness for future disruptive events;
- Stronger engagement of society in R&I policy as a consequence of citizen discourses on future implications of S&T&I, improved coherence and overall effectiveness of research and innovation interventions across Europe through better anticipation of futures, and thus improved impact on the economy and on policy priorities at EU and national levels;

- More and better contributions of R&I to societal ideals and political and economic objectives across Europe, namely the twin green and digital transition, and increasing public engagement and participation in the ERA as well as resilience of the EU.

Scope: Foresight has become an important element of policymaking across the European Union and much of the world. It is increasingly recognised for its potential to help anticipation and preparedness to deal with challenges and capture opportunities of the future.

Foresight is an important and proven means to engage with citizens on issues of science, technology and innovation and their possible contribution to tackle societal challenges. It supports the needed just, sustainable and digital transitions, and the move towards the future we want.

R&I policy has been amongst the first to support and use foresight in Europe, at both national and European levels. The longstanding experience provides a strong foundation for a European R&I foresight community. However, the extent of use of foresight in R&I policy across Europe is still uneven, as well as its degree of institutionalisation.

Foresight today is a common tool in strategy development and programming in science and technology and in policy making in a broader sense. It complements and incorporates much of the classical R&I policy toolbox of technology assessment, trend analysis, forecasting, road mapping, evaluation, strategic or SWOT analyses etc. The unevenness of the use of foresight affects the potential of foresight to support national and European R&I policies in the European Research Area.

The objective of this action is to accelerate the development of a European R&I foresight community supporting the development of national R&I foresight communities that are well integrated in national policy systems; and can contribute not only to the design of national reforms and policies but also to the evidence underpinning and the governance of a vibrant European Research Area, which delivers on common priorities and objectives.

The diversity of experiences with foresight can be a resource for a European foresight community, underscoring the need and being a foundation for highly beneficial networking actions, to exchange experiences, share ideas and work on topics of common interest. Such topics should have a clear link to ERA agenda points. Previous discussions with Member States suggest for instance the workforce skill and capacity needs for the twin transition. The consortium to carry out the CSA tasks should reflect the diversity of R&I foresight settings across Europe and involve government R&I foresight agencies and institutions from across the EU including countries associated with Horizon Europe.

This action should include:

- A stocktaking of the organisation of foresight activities informing R&I policy in the European Research Area, covering institutional, methodological, and analytical practices as well as an assessment of the main strengths and weaknesses nationally and in relation to policy needs at European level;

- Networking activities for institutions and people engaged in the R&I foresight community as well as potential users and stakeholders of foresight. This could be workshops, seminars, programmes, guidelines, methodology toolboxes, training modules, annual conferences, common social media platforms, network services and infrastructures (e.g., a database of science and technology experts who are interested in futures' intelligence, which could be used for Delphi surveys, scenario building, horizon scanning etc.);
- Development and practical application of the network in pilot foresight projects on topics of common interest, which are linked to ERA Policy Agenda Actions, possibly in coordination with the ERA Forum;
- Participatory approaches and engaging with citizens for foresight across Europe, as well as activities promoting futures literacy should play a core role in order to exploit foresight to the full;
- A network of national agencies on foresight and R&I (including foresight units in ministries and government institutions) should lie at the core of the action and at the core of Europe's R&I foresight community, covering as many member states and countries associated with Horizon Europe as possible.

The European R&I foresight community should build on, and valorise and disseminate results from, foresight projects funded as part of Horizon 2020 and in Horizon Europe including the foresight work done by the JRC: The community will be supported by a principally publicly accessible online platform, providing common resources, further development of training, mutual exchange, and joint foresight work on topics of common interest amongst Europe's R&I policy-makers. Developing a model for the governance and financial sustainability of the network and platform is part of the task, as is a sound European programme on foresight methodologies, resources and activities that will inform the policies shaping the future of science, technology and innovation across the European Union and interested Horizon Europe participating countries.

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-03: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions

<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens) in line with ERA Policy Agenda action 7;
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives.

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging citizens and communities through creative interactions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

- a. Innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities in the field of academia–society collaboration. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society that promote the uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens’ needs and collaboration with industry. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities in the academia-society interaction;
- b. Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation, in the area of ‘academia-industry/SME linkages’ or ‘quadruple helix-based innovation’, i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach. Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The action should facilitate the sharing of experiences and lessons learned from the experimentation or transfer of best practices, develop policy recommendations and links to other relevant actions.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-04: Development of new approaches to the macroeconomic modelling of research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The successful proposal will improve the integration of R&I within macro-economic modelling, while at the same time bringing fresh light on the role of R&I to tackle current societal challenges, with a particular focus on the European context. Project results are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support research at the knowledge frontier of macroeconomic models;

- Contribute to the development of innovative and interdisciplinary approaches to modelling of Research and Innovation (R&I) and R&I policy in Europe;
- Better integrate R&I activities in macro-economic models, leading to better measurement of their impact and a better understanding of the channels through which research and innovation lead to impact (direct and indirect) in Europe;
- Investigate new approaches to R&I macroeconomic models that link R&I-related drivers to economic, scientific and societal outcomes;
- Improve macro-economic modelling for the evaluation of R&I policy on different outcome variables, at different levels of policy intervention (EU, national, regional);
- Produce a novel macro-economic model able to simulate the economy, including the R&I dimension, linking R&I to sustainable and fair growth;
- Provide the full description of the models, codes and datasets, to allow easy access to forefront modelling ideas to the European scientific community and broader audience.

Scope: Existing macroeconomic models still fall short in providing sound ex-ante estimates of the various impacts of R&I. Therefore, the European Commission has engaged in a medium- to long-term agenda to improve the treatment of research and innovation (R&I) in macroeconomic models by supporting and financing cutting edge research on macroeconomic modelling able to attract the best researchers to work and develop new models capable of supporting the rising demand for policy evaluation tools in the EU. This agenda started in 2014 following the Commission Communication "Research and innovation as sources of renewed growth". The Council of the European Union called on the Commission to promote further research to build the evidence base for R&I policy making and for budgetary decision making, including by further improving the way R&I is accounted for in macro-economic models.

On the one hand, R&I are acknowledged as key engines for long-term growth and societal prosperity by an extensive body of economic literature. On the other hand, there is still need to develop further evidence about the quality, relevance and impact of R&I investments and the role that related policies have in scientific, technological, economic and social development. There is a crucial need for more developed and nuanced tools that would be able to account for the heterogeneity of different economic actors and that would be able to simulate the effects of a wide range of policies along different dimensions relevant for societal wellbeing. In addition, it is important that models are able to distinguish between the innovation process and the adoption / diffusion process.

Against these backdrops, the proposals, building upon the current state of the art existing in the literature, should develop and provide new macro-economic models with R&I, capable to integrate socio-economic challenges.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-05: Exploitation and valorisation of results relevant for the ERA Policy Agenda

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.20 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.20 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Boosting the dissemination, valorisation and broad uptake of results stemming from the different ERA Policy Agenda actions;
- Supporting mutual learning between Member States and stakeholders on their implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action;
- Building of an ERA community and branding at national and European level;
- Recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholders on how to best implement institutional changes related to ERA policies.

Scope: The ERA Policy Agenda, the 20 actions and their implementation will be supported with a range of actions under the different parts of the Horizon Europe Work Programme, and in particular, under the WIDERA work programme. Many of these actions will produce results that require a broad uptake by Member States, Associated Countries and their stakeholders. At the same time, important actions under Horizon Europe support the transformation and institutional change of universities, research organisations and enterprises. The action will implement a facility to disseminate results widely, facilitate their use, tailor them to the needs of the different communities and build a community of practitioners that

support mutual learning and exchange of good practices in institutional change in the spirit of the New ERA. It will furthermore design measures for mutual learning among Member States and stakeholders, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this. It will provide expertise to countries participating in the implementation of an ERA Policy Agenda action to address bottlenecks and increase stakeholder engagement. It will contribute to the building of an ERA community, including, with regular events at European level, and support a coherent approach to communication activities and their branding at national level. This will also allow the consortium to provide recommendations on how the necessary institutional and structural changes can best be achieved, including identifying gaps in methodologies and tools that would help to address these.

The action consists of four parts, all of which should be addressed:

- Design and implement a dissemination and valorisation facility covering the relevant actions of the ERA Policy Agenda;
- Support the coordination, sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across Member States and stakeholders, with the help of meetings, workshops, working groups and other tools to exchange experience, identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this;
- Community building, with regular events at European level, and support to coherent communication on ERA Policies, outcomes and results at national and European level;
- Design a process to develop and share guidance and recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholder organisations, across the European Union.

In order to support the achievement of the ERA objectives across the EU, the consortium should demonstrate that it covers the Member States in a geographically comprehensive way, as well as the capacity to provide or access expertise related to all relevant ERA Policy Agenda actions. Proposals should describe how they intend to collaborate closely with the Commission services, and build on the ERA Policy Platform in order to avoid additional IT developments.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-06: Building a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The action funded under this topic will have the objective of networking excellent knowledge nodes supporting the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China from across the European Union to build a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that will become sustainable beyond the end of the project. The goal of the platform would be to collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent knowledge on Contemporary China produced in the European Union (e.g., by universities, think tanks, research centres, NGOs, private companies, public organisations etc.) so as to foster the development of a network of independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level, raise awareness, and mainstream information on China also within the wider remit of civil society. The virtual European Info Platform will aim to become a key go-to source for independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level across all major relevant research areas (foreign policy, domestic politics, contemporary society and culture, science, technology, and innovation policy, economics, law, etc.). This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 9 on promoting international cooperation.

Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Bring together knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe to build and manage a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that would become a European key go-to source of independent knowledge on contemporary China;
- Coordinate with other initiatives and stakeholders where relevant for the action. Synergies with the two projects that were selected for funding under the previous call ‘HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07: Upgrading Independent Knowledge on Contemporary China in Europe’ are strongly encouraged. The work they bring forth should contribute to the development of the European Info Platform on Contemporary China;
- Regularly upload and disseminate knowledge on contemporary China, (including analyses, reports, articles, policy briefs, scoping studies, interviews, podcasts, etc.), not only produced by the successful consortium, but also filtered/selected from the work of external prominent and emerging knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe, so as to give visibility to all relevant European centres of excellence (including the smaller ones);
- Successful proposals would be expected to build into the website a section dedicated to the translation into English of key Chinese policy-documents and to create related policy briefs that would be openly accessible;

- Organise the material to be uploaded on the platform into thematic sections taking into account the priorities identified through the interactions with the relevant experts. A section of the platform should be specifically dedicated to understanding China's STI (science, technology, and innovation) system/policy and its implications for the European Union;
- Organise virtual and physical events (conferences, workshops, networking activities, trainings, staff exchanges, etc.), and manage their related communication activities, to foster pan-European connections among the different EU knowledge nodes on contemporary China. The organisation of China-focused thematic courses, ad-hoc seminars, and trainings, is encouraged in order to raise awareness on key China-related subjects, also involving the wider civil society/public/private institutions beyond China experts;
- Provide the Commission with regular policy recommendations and updates on the activities of the project;
- Reach out and encourage the participation of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China to enhance the visibility and impact of their work and foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge;
- Prepare and put in place a sustainability plan for the platform to ensure the continuation of the work after the end of the action.

Scope: This topic contributes to the priority areas of action number 9 on *promoting a positive environment and level playing field for international cooperation based on reciprocity* listed in the Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area⁵⁶ (ERA). More specifically it aims to satisfy the objective of *launching a pilot initiative on the Team Europe approach for a specific world region and/or topic*.

This action seeks to bolster a stronger European understanding of contemporary China and to strengthen European's capacity to sustain the production of such knowledge that is key to develop excellent EU-China policy-making based on facts, independent and unbiased analyses, and foresight. In accordance with the EU-China – A Strategic Outlook Communication of 2019⁵⁷ and the Global Approach to Research and Innovation Communication of May 2021⁵⁸, the action aims to empower the European Union to act coherently and proactively on the international stage preserving an open research and innovation ecosystem while safeguarding European interests and values.

Today China is a key global actor and a leading scientific and technological power. China's increasing relevance in the geopolitical system has exposed the weakness the European Union

⁵⁶ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14126-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁵⁷ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/communication-eu-china-a-strategic-outlook.pdf>

⁵⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/research_and_innovation/strategy_on_research_and_innovation/documents/ec_rtd_com2021-252.pdf

faces in its capacity to better understand contemporary China in its various specificities, complexities, and goals and respond to its rapid evolution and new policy directions. The European Union needs to get to know and understand it on its own terms: not through the lens of other external sources but from its own European perspective. The underlined priority for the EU to develop its own knowledge capacity to navigate China's continuous transformations is embedded in the concept of independent European knowledge, which should guide the work of successful applicants.

Following interactions with Member States, China experts, and stakeholders in the framework of the EU R&I Knowledge Network on China (EUKNOC) and following the publication of the SFIC recommendations on China in November 2021⁵⁹ it has emerged that at the European level expertise on contemporary China is often fragmented and difficult to access. Networking existing prominent and emerging knowledge nodes, gathering, categorising, and mainstreaming their work on an easily accessible public information platform would be therefore pivotal to break siloes and provide policy-makers, researchers, businesses, and civil society with the tools needed to develop a deeper understanding of the different dimensions that characterise contemporary China. Doing so would also increase the circulation of information and foster the creation of new knowledge, in line with the Commission's efforts to upgrade independent knowledge on contemporary China in Europe started in the 2021-2022 Horizon Europe work programme⁶⁰. Building synergies with granted projects from topic HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07, would be therefore strongly encouraged.

This action should bring forth the creation of a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China through networking relevant knowledge nodes from across the European Union that pursue the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China. The platform would collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent research material and provide translations from Chinese into English of relevant Chinese policy documents (and produce subsequent policy briefs on such documents). The successful consortium will be in charge of setting up the platform, organising/curating the material on the new virtual tool, setting up relevant events, thematic courses and trainings, communication activities, and developing a sustainability plan to ensure the successful continuation and growth of the platform after the end of the action.

The involvement of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China is strongly encouraged to foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge on contemporary China across the European Union and enhance the visibility of their work.

⁵⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1204-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

NB - Such recommendations call, among others, for the EU to build a permanent EU Info Centre for policy, academic, media and business based on existing networks and expertise available on China and to establish links between stakeholders from academia, public and private sector to create a network of China related actors and work on China in a concerted way.

⁶⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/horizon-cl2-2021-transformations-01-07> -

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-07: Support to reforms of research assessment in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support and contribute to the implementation of institutional changes for reforming research assessment (i.e., the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units,

and research institutions), in line with Action 3 of the ERA Policy Agenda actions and in support of Action 1;

- Connection of existing organisations and initiatives for reforms of research assessment, facilitating the exchange of information and mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders;
- Recommendations for policy-makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement institutional changes to research assessment;
- Global outreach of European efforts to reform research assessment and reinforced international cooperation on evolutions in research assessment.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research proposals and researchers evaluated in an unbiased manner on their intrinsic merits and performance rather than on the number of publications and where these are published;
- Researchers evaluated based on a broader range of research outputs and tasks (including open science practices);
- Researchers benefit from attractive careers, regardless of gender or other social characteristics;
- Modernised higher education sector, benefitting from improvements to the research assessment systems (including for performance-based funding).

Scope: The way research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions are assessed is fundamental for a well-functioning research and innovation system. The research and innovation system is undergoing major transformations with diversification of desired research outputs not restricted anymore to publications, and of research tasks and required skills; with a culture of sharing of knowledge and tools and of open collaboration (including societal engagement) becoming mainstream; and with a growing need of multi-disciplinary approaches and collaboration to tackle ever more complex scientific questions and societal challenges. However, the current system often uses limited methods to assess the quality, performance and impact of research, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers and the impact factor of the venue where they are published.

Several institutions including research funders and universities, in Europe and beyond, are currently reforming the assessment systems of their research and researchers. At a global level, the San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment⁶¹ (DORA) aims at improving how the output of scientific research is evaluated. The Recommendation on Open Science⁶² adopted by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

⁶¹ <https://sfdora.org/>

⁶² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949.locale=en>

in November 2021 calls for a review of research assessment systems to align them with the principles of open science. The Global Research Council (GRC) held a conference⁶³ in 2020 on “Responsible Research Assessment” and established a dedicated working group in 2021. The European Research Area ERA Policy Agenda for 2022-2024⁶⁴, adopted by the Council of the European Union on 26 November 2021, includes a priority action for reforming the assessment systems for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact. Accordingly, the European Commission is taking steps to facilitate an agreement between research funders, research performing organisations, national/regional evaluation agencies or authorities, and other stakeholders like learned societies, to reform research assessment criteria and processes in willing organisations, along commonly agreed principles and actions. In 2021, consultation of stakeholders⁶⁵ identified convergence on 10 principles expected to guide the reform of research assessment⁶⁶.

The establishment of a coalition of committed organisations is expected to accelerate changes towards research assessment systems that promote qualitative judgement with unbiased peer-review, supported by a more responsible use of quantitative indicators. The reformed research assessment systems should consider a more diverse set of research cultures and outputs, by valuing not only publications but also other research outputs such as data sets, software, models, workflows, methods, etc., and proper conduct including integrity and gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness. The reformed systems are expected to reward open collaboration as well as early knowledge and data sharing, as these practices enable good science⁶⁷. It should also reward the diversity of tasks of researchers, and consider the different contributions to the work of teams.

This action aims at supporting the reform of the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions. The action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

- The first part aims at supporting the operation of the coalition. This includes support to the sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across individual organisations, umbrella organisations, and initiatives, involved in the coalition and beyond, including with national and regional authorities. The action is expected to

⁶³ <https://www.globalresearchcouncil.org/news/responsible-research-assessment/>

⁶⁴ Annex to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the European Research Area of 26 November 2021 <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14308-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁶⁵ Scoping report “Towards a reform of the research assessment system”:
<https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/707440>

⁶⁶ The 10 principles identified during the stakeholders consultation and listed in the scoping report are: Ethics and integrity; Freedom of scientific research; Autonomy of research organisations; Independence and transparency of the data, infrastructure and criteria; Quality; Contribution to advancing knowledge and the (potential) impact of research results; Diversity of research activities, practices, outputs; Variety of scientific disciplines, research approaches, research career stages; Diversity in research roles and careers, and team science; and Gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness

⁶⁷ Open science practices include: early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, or crowd-sourcing); research output management; measures to ensure reproducibility of research outputs; providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); participation in open peer-review; and involving all relevant knowledge actors including citizens, civil society and end users in the co creation of R&I agendas and contents (such as citizen science).

support workshops, working groups and other tools to: raise awareness, exchange experience and disseminate information on institutional changes, contribute to the development and piloting of metrics needed for research assessment; identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, and develop and share guidance and recommendations for research organisations and policy-makers;

- The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching ‘cascading grant’ call(s) to support institutions from across the ERA, notably those engaged in the coalition approach, to implement sustainable institutional changes to reform and improve research assessment criteria and processes. This may require support services to be developed and provided to the beneficiary third party organisations. The ‘cascading grant’ mechanism is expected to contribute to institutional changes in a significant number of organisations (e.g., 40-50 individual organisations involved, of different types and across different geographical areas). As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to this mechanism, and one or more call(s) for proposals should be launched;
- The third part aims at international cooperation on research assessment. The action will envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and Associated Countries. The action will promote internationally the European efforts, will support exchange of information and explore opportunities for aligning policies, and will seek to attract non-European organisations to join the coalition.

The proposals should develop close cooperation, share knowledge and evidence, and build on various institutional, national and international initiatives, including DORA, GRC, UNESCO and the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC). Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51, call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes. Further collaborations are expected to emerge at a later stage, e.g. resulting from the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03 of Horizon Europe

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

One of the eight ambitions under the Open Science policy of the European Union is citizen science. ‘The general public should be able to make significant contributions and be recognised as valid European science knowledge producers.’ The aim under Horizon Europe is to ‘engage and involve citizens, civil society organisations and end-users in co-design and co-creation processes and promote responsible research and innovation.’

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-08: Laying the groundwork towards Europe-wide citizen science campaigns

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of citizen science initiatives with high potential impact if upscaled to ERA level;
- Establishment of broad societal coalitions/networks of quadruple helix actors organised around promising citizen science initiatives;
- Protocols and working modalities for use of open transnational data repositories and infrastructures;
- Proposals and commitments for mobilising diverse sources of funding to ensure sustainability of citizen science initiatives.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased collaboration with all stakeholders, including citizens in all phases of research and innovation, leading to more responsible R&I;
- Increased alignment of ERA countries' citizen science efforts;
- Transnational citizen science community building;
- Contributions to the objectives of Horizon Europe's EU Missions;
- Increased public trust in, and understanding of, science.

Scope: Citizen science, involving citizens directly in the development of new knowledge or innovations, is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that can lead to increased quality and effectiveness, e.g., through collecting, processing or analysing new qualities and quantities of data.

Many citizen science initiatives could achieve much higher impact if they were implemented on a transnational basis, collecting, analysing and exploiting vast amounts of cross-country data and, thereby, building a multinational community of citizen scientists. However, small-scale national citizen science projects often face practical, technical, or conceptual challenges and lack the support, the transnational coordination skills, and the resources, to upscale their efforts to a transnational level.

This action should conduct preparatory work for the launch of Europe-wide citizen science campaigns under the New ERA, which will also have synergies with Horizon Europe EU Missions. The action should identify the most promising citizen science initiatives for transnational upscaling, foster the development of broad societal coalitions around the identified and promising initiatives, and propose how to unlock the necessary funding commitments (e.g., from EU and national programmes and funders, philanthropic, and/or commercial sources) required.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should require the involvement of quadruple helix stakeholders. Citizen science 'champions' in public authorities should be envisaged, to raise awareness, 'connect the dots' between different services and institutions, and obtain broad and high-level commitments. The involvement of SMEs and industry could lead to new means to organise, collect and analyse data, and disseminate and exploit results. The involvement of research stakeholders will be essential to ensuring rigorous and credible research approaches and maximising scientific and technological impacts. Obtaining the inputs of civil society, involving and making youth aware of CS, building understanding of the activities (including their scientific bases), and fostering broad societal ownership of the promising initiatives could prove crucial to the scale and intensity of the eventual citizen science campaigns.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should aim to cover a majority, – and potentially all – ERA countries; involve citizens at different stages of the research cycle (e.g., development of

methods, data collection, data analysis, evidence-based advocacy processes, testing and evaluation); be inclusive and make particular efforts to involve those from lower socio-economic groups; and aim to deliver a range of additional benefits such as increased scientific literacy, improved trust in science, improved social inclusion and employability, and improved capacity within the scientific workforce to engage with society.

The action should conduct a thorough screening of potential initiatives to be upscaled, analysing the most promising in terms of synergies with one or more Horizon Europe EU Missions, the potential to advance scientific knowledge, and generation of a range of additional benefits. The action should develop scientific protocols, establish working modalities with open data repositories and infrastructures, prepare training (e.g., for volunteers and volunteer co-ordinators), develop societal engagement and science communication strategies, and propose how to mobilise diverse commitments for funding.

The action will build on the existing knowledge base and experience, including previous projects focused on citizen science, citizen engagement activities in the context of Horizon Europe EU Missions, citizen observatories, and the upscaling of the Plastic Pirates – Go Europe! (plastic-pirates.eu) campaign. It will work in collaboration with existing networks and actions, and develop synergies with the actions supported by HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61. The action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 to bring science closer to the citizens.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-07: Support to reforms of research assessment in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support and contribute to the implementation of institutional changes for reforming research assessment (i.e., the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units,

and research institutions), in line with Action 3 of the ERA Policy Agenda actions and in support of Action 1;

- Connection of existing organisations and initiatives for reforms of research assessment, facilitating the exchange of information and mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders;
- Recommendations for policy-makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement institutional changes to research assessment;
- Global outreach of European efforts to reform research assessment and reinforced international cooperation on evolutions in research assessment.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research proposals and researchers evaluated in an unbiased manner on their intrinsic merits and performance rather than on the number of publications and where these are published;
- Researchers evaluated based on a broader range of research outputs and tasks (including open science practices);
- Researchers benefit from attractive careers, regardless of gender or other social characteristics;
- Modernised higher education sector, benefitting from improvements to the research assessment systems (including for performance-based funding).

Scope: The way research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions are assessed is fundamental for a well-functioning research and innovation system. The research and innovation system is undergoing major transformations with diversification of desired research outputs not restricted anymore to publications, and of research tasks and required skills; with a culture of sharing of knowledge and tools and of open collaboration (including societal engagement) becoming mainstream; and with a growing need of multi-disciplinary approaches and collaboration to tackle ever more complex scientific questions and societal challenges. However, the current system often uses limited methods to assess the quality, performance and impact of research, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers and the impact factor of the venue where they are published.

Several institutions including research funders and universities, in Europe and beyond, are currently reforming the assessment systems of their research and researchers. At a global level, the San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment⁶¹ (DORA) aims at improving how the output of scientific research is evaluated. The Recommendation on Open Science⁶² adopted by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

⁶¹ <https://sfdora.org/>

⁶² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949.locale=en>

in November 2021 calls for a review of research assessment systems to align them with the principles of open science. The Global Research Council (GRC) held a conference⁶³ in 2020 on “Responsible Research Assessment” and established a dedicated working group in 2021. The European Research Area ERA Policy Agenda for 2022-2024⁶⁴, adopted by the Council of the European Union on 26 November 2021, includes a priority action for reforming the assessment systems for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact. Accordingly, the European Commission is taking steps to facilitate an agreement between research funders, research performing organisations, national/regional evaluation agencies or authorities, and other stakeholders like learned societies, to reform research assessment criteria and processes in willing organisations, along commonly agreed principles and actions. In 2021, consultation of stakeholders⁶⁵ identified convergence on 10 principles expected to guide the reform of research assessment⁶⁶.

The establishment of a coalition of committed organisations is expected to accelerate changes towards research assessment systems that promote qualitative judgement with unbiased peer-review, supported by a more responsible use of quantitative indicators. The reformed research assessment systems should consider a more diverse set of research cultures and outputs, by valuing not only publications but also other research outputs such as data sets, software, models, workflows, methods, etc., and proper conduct including integrity and gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness. The reformed systems are expected to reward open collaboration as well as early knowledge and data sharing, as these practices enable good science⁶⁷. It should also reward the diversity of tasks of researchers, and consider the different contributions to the work of teams.

This action aims at supporting the reform of the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions. The action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

- The first part aims at supporting the operation of the coalition. This includes support to the sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across individual organisations, umbrella organisations, and initiatives, involved in the coalition and beyond, including with national and regional authorities. The action is expected to

⁶³ <https://www.globalresearchcouncil.org/news/responsible-research-assessment/>

⁶⁴ Annex to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the European Research Area of 26 November 2021 <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14308-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁶⁵ Scoping report “Towards a reform of the research assessment system”:
<https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/707440>

⁶⁶ The 10 principles identified during the stakeholders consultation and listed in the scoping report are: Ethics and integrity; Freedom of scientific research; Autonomy of research organisations; Independence and transparency of the data, infrastructure and criteria; Quality; Contribution to advancing knowledge and the (potential) impact of research results; Diversity of research activities, practices, outputs; Variety of scientific disciplines, research approaches, research career stages; Diversity in research roles and careers, and team science; and Gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness

⁶⁷ Open science practices include: early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, or crowd-sourcing); research output management; measures to ensure reproducibility of research outputs; providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); participation in open peer-review; and involving all relevant knowledge actors including citizens, civil society and end users in the co creation of R&I agendas and contents (such as citizen science).

support workshops, working groups and other tools to: raise awareness, exchange experience and disseminate information on institutional changes, contribute to the development and piloting of metrics needed for research assessment; identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, and develop and share guidance and recommendations for research organisations and policy-makers;

- The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching ‘cascading grant’ call(s) to support institutions from across the ERA, notably those engaged in the coalition approach, to implement sustainable institutional changes to reform and improve research assessment criteria and processes. This may require support services to be developed and provided to the beneficiary third party organisations. The ‘cascading grant’ mechanism is expected to contribute to institutional changes in a significant number of organisations (e.g., 40-50 individual organisations involved, of different types and across different geographical areas). As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to this mechanism, and one or more call(s) for proposals should be launched;
- The third part aims at international cooperation on research assessment. The action will envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and Associated Countries. The action will promote internationally the European efforts, will support exchange of information and explore opportunities for aligning policies, and will seek to attract non-European organisations to join the coalition.

The proposals should develop close cooperation, share knowledge and evidence, and build on various institutional, national and international initiatives, including DORA, GRC, UNESCO and the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC). Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51, call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes. Further collaborations are expected to emerge at a later stage, e.g. resulting from the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03 of Horizon Europe

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

One of the eight ambitions under the Open Science policy of the European Union is citizen science. ‘The general public should be able to make significant contributions and be recognised as valid European science knowledge producers.’ The aim under Horizon Europe is to ‘engage and involve citizens, civil society organisations and end-users in co-design and co-creation processes and promote responsible research and innovation.’

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-08: Laying the groundwork towards Europe-wide citizen science campaigns

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of citizen science initiatives with high potential impact if upscaled to ERA level;
- Establishment of broad societal coalitions/networks of quadruple helix actors organised around promising citizen science initiatives;
- Protocols and working modalities for use of open transnational data repositories and infrastructures;
- Proposals and commitments for mobilising diverse sources of funding to ensure sustainability of citizen science initiatives.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased collaboration with all stakeholders, including citizens in all phases of research and innovation, leading to more responsible R&I;
- Increased alignment of ERA countries' citizen science efforts;
- Transnational citizen science community building;
- Contributions to the objectives of Horizon Europe's EU Missions;
- Increased public trust in, and understanding of, science.

Scope: Citizen science, involving citizens directly in the development of new knowledge or innovations, is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that can lead to increased quality and effectiveness, e.g., through collecting, processing or analysing new qualities and quantities of data.

Many citizen science initiatives could achieve much higher impact if they were implemented on a transnational basis, collecting, analysing and exploiting vast amounts of cross-country data and, thereby, building a multinational community of citizen scientists. However, small-scale national citizen science projects often face practical, technical, or conceptual challenges and lack the support, the transnational coordination skills, and the resources, to upscale their efforts to a transnational level.

This action should conduct preparatory work for the launch of Europe-wide citizen science campaigns under the New ERA, which will also have synergies with Horizon Europe EU Missions. The action should identify the most promising citizen science initiatives for transnational upscaling, foster the development of broad societal coalitions around the identified and promising initiatives, and propose how to unlock the necessary funding commitments (e.g., from EU and national programmes and funders, philanthropic, and/or commercial sources) required.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should require the involvement of quadruple helix stakeholders. Citizen science 'champions' in public authorities should be envisaged, to raise awareness, 'connect the dots' between different services and institutions, and obtain broad and high-level commitments. The involvement of SMEs and industry could lead to new means to organise, collect and analyse data, and disseminate and exploit results. The involvement of research stakeholders will be essential to ensuring rigorous and credible research approaches and maximising scientific and technological impacts. Obtaining the inputs of civil society, involving and making youth aware of CS, building understanding of the activities (including their scientific bases), and fostering broad societal ownership of the promising initiatives could prove crucial to the scale and intensity of the eventual citizen science campaigns.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should aim to cover a majority, – and potentially all – ERA countries; involve citizens at different stages of the research cycle (e.g., development of

methods, data collection, data analysis, evidence-based advocacy processes, testing and evaluation); be inclusive and make particular efforts to involve those from lower socio-economic groups; and aim to deliver a range of additional benefits such as increased scientific literacy, improved trust in science, improved social inclusion and employability, and improved capacity within the scientific workforce to engage with society.

The action should conduct a thorough screening of potential initiatives to be upscaled, analysing the most promising in terms of synergies with one or more Horizon Europe EU Missions, the potential to advance scientific knowledge, and generation of a range of additional benefits. The action should develop scientific protocols, establish working modalities with open data repositories and infrastructures, prepare training (e.g., for volunteers and volunteer co-ordinators), develop societal engagement and science communication strategies, and propose how to mobilise diverse commitments for funding.

The action will build on the existing knowledge base and experience, including previous projects focused on citizen science, citizen engagement activities in the context of Horizon Europe EU Missions, citizen observatories, and the upscaling of the Plastic Pirates – Go Europe! (plastic-pirates.eu) campaign. It will work in collaboration with existing networks and actions, and develop synergies with the actions supported by HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61. The action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 to bring science closer to the citizens.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-04: Development of new approaches to the macroeconomic modelling of research and innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The successful proposal will improve the integration of R&I within macro-economic modelling, while at the same time bringing fresh light on the role of R&I to tackle current societal challenges, with a particular focus on the European context. Project results are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support research at the knowledge frontier of macroeconomic models;

- Contribute to the development of innovative and interdisciplinary approaches to modelling of Research and Innovation (R&I) and R&I policy in Europe;
- Better integrate R&I activities in macro-economic models, leading to better measurement of their impact and a better understanding of the channels through which research and innovation lead to impact (direct and indirect) in Europe;
- Investigate new approaches to R&I macroeconomic models that link R&I-related drivers to economic, scientific and societal outcomes;
- Improve macro-economic modelling for the evaluation of R&I policy on different outcome variables, at different levels of policy intervention (EU, national, regional);
- Produce a novel macro-economic model able to simulate the economy, including the R&I dimension, linking R&I to sustainable and fair growth;
- Provide the full description of the models, codes and datasets, to allow easy access to forefront modelling ideas to the European scientific community and broader audience.

Scope: Existing macroeconomic models still fall short in providing sound ex-ante estimates of the various impacts of R&I. Therefore, the European Commission has engaged in a medium- to long-term agenda to improve the treatment of research and innovation (R&I) in macroeconomic models by supporting and financing cutting edge research on macroeconomic modelling able to attract the best researchers to work and develop new models capable of supporting the rising demand for policy evaluation tools in the EU. This agenda started in 2014 following the Commission Communication "Research and innovation as sources of renewed growth". The Council of the European Union called on the Commission to promote further research to build the evidence base for R&I policy making and for budgetary decision making, including by further improving the way R&I is accounted for in macro-economic models.

On the one hand, R&I are acknowledged as key engines for long-term growth and societal prosperity by an extensive body of economic literature. On the other hand, there is still need to develop further evidence about the quality, relevance and impact of R&I investments and the role that related policies have in scientific, technological, economic and social development. There is a crucial need for more developed and nuanced tools that would be able to account for the heterogeneity of different economic actors and that would be able to simulate the effects of a wide range of policies along different dimensions relevant for societal wellbeing. In addition, it is important that models are able to distinguish between the innovation process and the adoption / diffusion process.

Against these backdrops, the proposals, building upon the current state of the art existing in the literature, should develop and provide new macro-economic models with R&I, capable to integrate socio-economic challenges.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-05: Exploitation and valorisation of results relevant for the ERA Policy Agenda

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.20 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.20 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Boosting the dissemination, valorisation and broad uptake of results stemming from the different ERA Policy Agenda actions;
- Supporting mutual learning between Member States and stakeholders on their implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action;
- Building of an ERA community and branding at national and European level;
- Recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholders on how to best implement institutional changes related to ERA policies.

Scope: The ERA Policy Agenda, the 20 actions and their implementation will be supported with a range of actions under the different parts of the Horizon Europe Work Programme, and in particular, under the WIDERA work programme. Many of these actions will produce results that require a broad uptake by Member States, Associated Countries and their stakeholders. At the same time, important actions under Horizon Europe support the transformation and institutional change of universities, research organisations and enterprises. The action will implement a facility to disseminate results widely, facilitate their use, tailor them to the needs of the different communities and build a community of practitioners that

support mutual learning and exchange of good practices in institutional change in the spirit of the New ERA. It will furthermore design measures for mutual learning among Member States and stakeholders, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this. It will provide expertise to countries participating in the implementation of an ERA Policy Agenda action to address bottlenecks and increase stakeholder engagement. It will contribute to the building of an ERA community, including, with regular events at European level, and support a coherent approach to communication activities and their branding at national level. This will also allow the consortium to provide recommendations on how the necessary institutional and structural changes can best be achieved, including identifying gaps in methodologies and tools that would help to address these.

The action consists of four parts, all of which should be addressed:

- Design and implement a dissemination and valorisation facility covering the relevant actions of the ERA Policy Agenda;
- Support the coordination, sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across Member States and stakeholders, with the help of meetings, workshops, working groups and other tools to exchange experience, identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this;
- Community building, with regular events at European level, and support to coherent communication on ERA Policies, outcomes and results at national and European level;
- Design a process to develop and share guidance and recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholder organisations, across the European Union.

In order to support the achievement of the ERA objectives across the EU, the consortium should demonstrate that it covers the Member States in a geographically comprehensive way, as well as the capacity to provide or access expertise related to all relevant ERA Policy Agenda actions. Proposals should describe how they intend to collaborate closely with the Commission services, and build on the ERA Policy Platform in order to avoid additional IT developments.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-06: Building a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The action funded under this topic will have the objective of networking excellent knowledge nodes supporting the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China from across the European Union to build a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that will become sustainable beyond the end of the project. The goal of the platform would be to collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent knowledge on Contemporary China produced in the European Union (e.g., by universities, think tanks, research centres, NGOs, private companies, public organisations etc.) so as to foster the development of a network of independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level, raise awareness, and mainstream information on China also within the wider remit of civil society. The virtual European Info Platform will aim to become a key go-to source for independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level across all major relevant research areas (foreign policy, domestic politics, contemporary society and culture, science, technology, and innovation policy, economics, law, etc.). This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 9 on promoting international cooperation.

Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Bring together knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe to build and manage a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that would become a European key go-to source of independent knowledge on contemporary China;
- Coordinate with other initiatives and stakeholders where relevant for the action. Synergies with the two projects that were selected for funding under the previous call ‘HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07: Upgrading Independent Knowledge on Contemporary China in Europe’ are strongly encouraged. The work they bring forth should contribute to the development of the European Info Platform on Contemporary China;
- Regularly upload and disseminate knowledge on contemporary China, (including analyses, reports, articles, policy briefs, scoping studies, interviews, podcasts, etc.), not only produced by the successful consortium, but also filtered/selected from the work of external prominent and emerging knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe, so as to give visibility to all relevant European centres of excellence (including the smaller ones);
- Successful proposals would be expected to build into the website a section dedicated to the translation into English of key Chinese policy-documents and to create related policy briefs that would be openly accessible;

- Organise the material to be uploaded on the platform into thematic sections taking into account the priorities identified through the interactions with the relevant experts. A section of the platform should be specifically dedicated to understanding China's STI (science, technology, and innovation) system/policy and its implications for the European Union;
- Organise virtual and physical events (conferences, workshops, networking activities, trainings, staff exchanges, etc.), and manage their related communication activities, to foster pan-European connections among the different EU knowledge nodes on contemporary China. The organisation of China-focused thematic courses, ad-hoc seminars, and trainings, is encouraged in order to raise awareness on key China-related subjects, also involving the wider civil society/public/private institutions beyond China experts;
- Provide the Commission with regular policy recommendations and updates on the activities of the project;
- Reach out and encourage the participation of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China to enhance the visibility and impact of their work and foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge;
- Prepare and put in place a sustainability plan for the platform to ensure the continuation of the work after the end of the action.

Scope: This topic contributes to the priority areas of action number 9 on *promoting a positive environment and level playing field for international cooperation based on reciprocity* listed in the Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area⁵⁶ (ERA). More specifically it aims to satisfy the objective of *launching a pilot initiative on the Team Europe approach for a specific world region and/or topic*.

This action seeks to bolster a stronger European understanding of contemporary China and to strengthen European's capacity to sustain the production of such knowledge that is key to develop excellent EU-China policy-making based on facts, independent and unbiased analyses, and foresight. In accordance with the EU-China – A Strategic Outlook Communication of 2019⁵⁷ and the Global Approach to Research and Innovation Communication of May 2021⁵⁸, the action aims to empower the European Union to act coherently and proactively on the international stage preserving an open research and innovation ecosystem while safeguarding European interests and values.

Today China is a key global actor and a leading scientific and technological power. China's increasing relevance in the geopolitical system has exposed the weakness the European Union

⁵⁶ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14126-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁵⁷ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/communication-eu-china-a-strategic-outlook.pdf>

⁵⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/research_and_innovation/strategy_on_research_and_innovation/documents/ec_rtd_com2021-252.pdf

faces in its capacity to better understand contemporary China in its various specificities, complexities, and goals and respond to its rapid evolution and new policy directions. The European Union needs to get to know and understand it on its own terms: not through the lens of other external sources but from its own European perspective. The underlined priority for the EU to develop its own knowledge capacity to navigate China's continuous transformations is embedded in the concept of independent European knowledge, which should guide the work of successful applicants.

Following interactions with Member States, China experts, and stakeholders in the framework of the EU R&I Knowledge Network on China (EUKNOC) and following the publication of the SFIC recommendations on China in November 2021⁵⁹ it has emerged that at the European level expertise on contemporary China is often fragmented and difficult to access. Networking existing prominent and emerging knowledge nodes, gathering, categorising, and mainstreaming their work on an easily accessible public information platform would be therefore pivotal to break siloes and provide policy-makers, researchers, businesses, and civil society with the tools needed to develop a deeper understanding of the different dimensions that characterise contemporary China. Doing so would also increase the circulation of information and foster the creation of new knowledge, in line with the Commission's efforts to upgrade independent knowledge on contemporary China in Europe started in the 2021-2022 Horizon Europe work programme⁶⁰. Building synergies with granted projects from topic HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07, would be therefore strongly encouraged.

This action should bring forth the creation of a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China through networking relevant knowledge nodes from across the European Union that pursue the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China. The platform would collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent research material and provide translations from Chinese into English of relevant Chinese policy documents (and produce subsequent policy briefs on such documents). The successful consortium will be in charge of setting up the platform, organising/curating the material on the new virtual tool, setting up relevant events, thematic courses and trainings, communication activities, and developing a sustainability plan to ensure the successful continuation and growth of the platform after the end of the action.

The involvement of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China is strongly encouraged to foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge on contemporary China across the European Union and enhance the visibility of their work.

⁵⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1204-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

NB - Such recommendations call, among others, for the EU to build a permanent EU Info Centre for policy, academic, media and business based on existing networks and expertise available on China and to establish links between stakeholders from academia, public and private sector to create a network of China related actors and work on China in a concerted way.

⁶⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/horizon-cl2-2021-transformations-01-07> -

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-07: Support to reforms of research assessment in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support and contribute to the implementation of institutional changes for reforming research assessment (i.e., the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units,

and research institutions), in line with Action 3 of the ERA Policy Agenda actions and in support of Action 1;

- Connection of existing organisations and initiatives for reforms of research assessment, facilitating the exchange of information and mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders;
- Recommendations for policy-makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement institutional changes to research assessment;
- Global outreach of European efforts to reform research assessment and reinforced international cooperation on evolutions in research assessment.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research proposals and researchers evaluated in an unbiased manner on their intrinsic merits and performance rather than on the number of publications and where these are published;
- Researchers evaluated based on a broader range of research outputs and tasks (including open science practices);
- Researchers benefit from attractive careers, regardless of gender or other social characteristics;
- Modernised higher education sector, benefitting from improvements to the research assessment systems (including for performance-based funding).

Scope: The way research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions are assessed is fundamental for a well-functioning research and innovation system. The research and innovation system is undergoing major transformations with diversification of desired research outputs not restricted anymore to publications, and of research tasks and required skills; with a culture of sharing of knowledge and tools and of open collaboration (including societal engagement) becoming mainstream; and with a growing need of multi-disciplinary approaches and collaboration to tackle ever more complex scientific questions and societal challenges. However, the current system often uses limited methods to assess the quality, performance and impact of research, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers and the impact factor of the venue where they are published.

Several institutions including research funders and universities, in Europe and beyond, are currently reforming the assessment systems of their research and researchers. At a global level, the San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment⁶¹ (DORA) aims at improving how the output of scientific research is evaluated. The Recommendation on Open Science⁶² adopted by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

⁶¹ <https://sfdora.org/>

⁶² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949.locale=en>

in November 2021 calls for a review of research assessment systems to align them with the principles of open science. The Global Research Council (GRC) held a conference⁶³ in 2020 on “Responsible Research Assessment” and established a dedicated working group in 2021. The European Research Area ERA Policy Agenda for 2022-2024⁶⁴, adopted by the Council of the European Union on 26 November 2021, includes a priority action for reforming the assessment systems for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact. Accordingly, the European Commission is taking steps to facilitate an agreement between research funders, research performing organisations, national/regional evaluation agencies or authorities, and other stakeholders like learned societies, to reform research assessment criteria and processes in willing organisations, along commonly agreed principles and actions. In 2021, consultation of stakeholders⁶⁵ identified convergence on 10 principles expected to guide the reform of research assessment⁶⁶.

The establishment of a coalition of committed organisations is expected to accelerate changes towards research assessment systems that promote qualitative judgement with unbiased peer-review, supported by a more responsible use of quantitative indicators. The reformed research assessment systems should consider a more diverse set of research cultures and outputs, by valuing not only publications but also other research outputs such as data sets, software, models, workflows, methods, etc., and proper conduct including integrity and gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness. The reformed systems are expected to reward open collaboration as well as early knowledge and data sharing, as these practices enable good science⁶⁷. It should also reward the diversity of tasks of researchers, and consider the different contributions to the work of teams.

This action aims at supporting the reform of the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions. The action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

- The first part aims at supporting the operation of the coalition. This includes support to the sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across individual organisations, umbrella organisations, and initiatives, involved in the coalition and beyond, including with national and regional authorities. The action is expected to

⁶³ <https://www.globalresearchcouncil.org/news/responsible-research-assessment/>

⁶⁴ Annex to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the European Research Area of 26 November 2021 <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14308-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁶⁵ Scoping report “Towards a reform of the research assessment system”:
<https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/707440>

⁶⁶ The 10 principles identified during the stakeholders consultation and listed in the scoping report are: Ethics and integrity; Freedom of scientific research; Autonomy of research organisations; Independence and transparency of the data, infrastructure and criteria; Quality; Contribution to advancing knowledge and the (potential) impact of research results; Diversity of research activities, practices, outputs; Variety of scientific disciplines, research approaches, research career stages; Diversity in research roles and careers, and team science; and Gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness

⁶⁷ Open science practices include: early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, or crowd-sourcing); research output management; measures to ensure reproducibility of research outputs; providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); participation in open peer-review; and involving all relevant knowledge actors including citizens, civil society and end users in the co creation of R&I agendas and contents (such as citizen science).

support workshops, working groups and other tools to: raise awareness, exchange experience and disseminate information on institutional changes, contribute to the development and piloting of metrics needed for research assessment; identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, and develop and share guidance and recommendations for research organisations and policy-makers;

- The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching ‘cascading grant’ call(s) to support institutions from across the ERA, notably those engaged in the coalition approach, to implement sustainable institutional changes to reform and improve research assessment criteria and processes. This may require support services to be developed and provided to the beneficiary third party organisations. The ‘cascading grant’ mechanism is expected to contribute to institutional changes in a significant number of organisations (e.g., 40-50 individual organisations involved, of different types and across different geographical areas). As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to this mechanism, and one or more call(s) for proposals should be launched;
- The third part aims at international cooperation on research assessment. The action will envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and Associated Countries. The action will promote internationally the European efforts, will support exchange of information and explore opportunities for aligning policies, and will seek to attract non-European organisations to join the coalition.

The proposals should develop close cooperation, share knowledge and evidence, and build on various institutional, national and international initiatives, including DORA, GRC, UNESCO and the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC). Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51, call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes. Further collaborations are expected to emerge at a later stage, e.g. resulting from the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03 of Horizon Europe

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

One of the eight ambitions under the Open Science policy of the European Union is citizen science. ‘The general public should be able to make significant contributions and be recognised as valid European science knowledge producers.’ The aim under Horizon Europe is to ‘engage and involve citizens, civil society organisations and end-users in co-design and co-creation processes and promote responsible research and innovation.’

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-08: Laying the groundwork towards Europe-wide citizen science campaigns

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of citizen science initiatives with high potential impact if upscaled to ERA level;
- Establishment of broad societal coalitions/networks of quadruple helix actors organised around promising citizen science initiatives;
- Protocols and working modalities for use of open transnational data repositories and infrastructures;
- Proposals and commitments for mobilising diverse sources of funding to ensure sustainability of citizen science initiatives.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased collaboration with all stakeholders, including citizens in all phases of research and innovation, leading to more responsible R&I;
- Increased alignment of ERA countries' citizen science efforts;
- Transnational citizen science community building;
- Contributions to the objectives of Horizon Europe's EU Missions;
- Increased public trust in, and understanding of, science.

Scope: Citizen science, involving citizens directly in the development of new knowledge or innovations, is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that can lead to increased quality and effectiveness, e.g., through collecting, processing or analysing new qualities and quantities of data.

Many citizen science initiatives could achieve much higher impact if they were implemented on a transnational basis, collecting, analysing and exploiting vast amounts of cross-country data and, thereby, building a multinational community of citizen scientists. However, small-scale national citizen science projects often face practical, technical, or conceptual challenges and lack the support, the transnational coordination skills, and the resources, to upscale their efforts to a transnational level.

This action should conduct preparatory work for the launch of Europe-wide citizen science campaigns under the New ERA, which will also have synergies with Horizon Europe EU Missions. The action should identify the most promising citizen science initiatives for transnational upscaling, foster the development of broad societal coalitions around the identified and promising initiatives, and propose how to unlock the necessary funding commitments (e.g., from EU and national programmes and funders, philanthropic, and/or commercial sources) required.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should require the involvement of quadruple helix stakeholders. Citizen science 'champions' in public authorities should be envisaged, to raise awareness, 'connect the dots' between different services and institutions, and obtain broad and high-level commitments. The involvement of SMEs and industry could lead to new means to organise, collect and analyse data, and disseminate and exploit results. The involvement of research stakeholders will be essential to ensuring rigorous and credible research approaches and maximising scientific and technological impacts. Obtaining the inputs of civil society, involving and making youth aware of CS, building understanding of the activities (including their scientific bases), and fostering broad societal ownership of the promising initiatives could prove crucial to the scale and intensity of the eventual citizen science campaigns.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should aim to cover a majority, – and potentially all – ERA countries; involve citizens at different stages of the research cycle (e.g., development of

methods, data collection, data analysis, evidence-based advocacy processes, testing and evaluation); be inclusive and make particular efforts to involve those from lower socio-economic groups; and aim to deliver a range of additional benefits such as increased scientific literacy, improved trust in science, improved social inclusion and employability, and improved capacity within the scientific workforce to engage with society.

The action should conduct a thorough screening of potential initiatives to be upscaled, analysing the most promising in terms of synergies with one or more Horizon Europe EU Missions, the potential to advance scientific knowledge, and generation of a range of additional benefits. The action should develop scientific protocols, establish working modalities with open data repositories and infrastructures, prepare training (e.g., for volunteers and volunteer co-ordinators), develop societal engagement and science communication strategies, and propose how to mobilise diverse commitments for funding.

The action will build on the existing knowledge base and experience, including previous projects focused on citizen science, citizen engagement activities in the context of Horizon Europe EU Missions, citizen observatories, and the upscaling of the Plastic Pirates – Go Europe! (plastic-pirates.eu) campaign. It will work in collaboration with existing networks and actions, and develop synergies with the actions supported by HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61. The action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 to bring science closer to the citizens.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its *modus operandi* towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

76

[Shemakes.EU](#) and [EQUALS-EU](#)

77

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566>;
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825>;

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.
The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its *modus operandi* towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-05: Exploitation and valorisation of results relevant for the ERA Policy Agenda

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.20 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.20 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Boosting the dissemination, valorisation and broad uptake of results stemming from the different ERA Policy Agenda actions;
- Supporting mutual learning between Member States and stakeholders on their implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action;
- Building of an ERA community and branding at national and European level;
- Recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholders on how to best implement institutional changes related to ERA policies.

Scope: The ERA Policy Agenda, the 20 actions and their implementation will be supported with a range of actions under the different parts of the Horizon Europe Work Programme, and in particular, under the WIDERA work programme. Many of these actions will produce results that require a broad uptake by Member States, Associated Countries and their stakeholders. At the same time, important actions under Horizon Europe support the transformation and institutional change of universities, research organisations and enterprises. The action will implement a facility to disseminate results widely, facilitate their use, tailor them to the needs of the different communities and build a community of practitioners that

support mutual learning and exchange of good practices in institutional change in the spirit of the New ERA. It will furthermore design measures for mutual learning among Member States and stakeholders, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this. It will provide expertise to countries participating in the implementation of an ERA Policy Agenda action to address bottlenecks and increase stakeholder engagement. It will contribute to the building of an ERA community, including, with regular events at European level, and support a coherent approach to communication activities and their branding at national level. This will also allow the consortium to provide recommendations on how the necessary institutional and structural changes can best be achieved, including identifying gaps in methodologies and tools that would help to address these.

The action consists of four parts, all of which should be addressed:

- Design and implement a dissemination and valorisation facility covering the relevant actions of the ERA Policy Agenda;
- Support the coordination, sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across Member States and stakeholders, with the help of meetings, workshops, working groups and other tools to exchange experience, identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, with a focus on those ERA Policy Agenda actions where no other configuration support this;
- Community building, with regular events at European level, and support to coherent communication on ERA Policies, outcomes and results at national and European level;
- Design a process to develop and share guidance and recommendations for policy-makers and stakeholder organisations, across the European Union.

In order to support the achievement of the ERA objectives across the EU, the consortium should demonstrate that it covers the Member States in a geographically comprehensive way, as well as the capacity to provide or access expertise related to all relevant ERA Policy Agenda actions. Proposals should describe how they intend to collaborate closely with the Commission services, and build on the ERA Policy Platform in order to avoid additional IT developments.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-06: Building a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: The action funded under this topic will have the objective of networking excellent knowledge nodes supporting the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China from across the European Union to build a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that will become sustainable beyond the end of the project. The goal of the platform would be to collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent knowledge on Contemporary China produced in the European Union (e.g., by universities, think tanks, research centres, NGOs, private companies, public organisations etc.) so as to foster the development of a network of independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level, raise awareness, and mainstream information on China also within the wider remit of civil society. The virtual European Info Platform will aim to become a key go-to source for independent knowledge on contemporary China at European level across all major relevant research areas (foreign policy, domestic politics, contemporary society and culture, science, technology, and innovation policy, economics, law, etc.). This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 9 on promoting international cooperation.

Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Bring together knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe to build and manage a virtual European Info Platform on contemporary China that would become a European key go-to source of independent knowledge on contemporary China;
- Coordinate with other initiatives and stakeholders where relevant for the action. Synergies with the two projects that were selected for funding under the previous call ‘HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07: Upgrading Independent Knowledge on Contemporary China in Europe’ are strongly encouraged. The work they bring forth should contribute to the development of the European Info Platform on Contemporary China;
- Regularly upload and disseminate knowledge on contemporary China, (including analyses, reports, articles, policy briefs, scoping studies, interviews, podcasts, etc.), not only produced by the successful consortium, but also filtered/selected from the work of external prominent and emerging knowledge nodes on contemporary China from across Europe, so as to give visibility to all relevant European centres of excellence (including the smaller ones);
- Successful proposals would be expected to build into the website a section dedicated to the translation into English of key Chinese policy-documents and to create related policy briefs that would be openly accessible;

- Organise the material to be uploaded on the platform into thematic sections taking into account the priorities identified through the interactions with the relevant experts. A section of the platform should be specifically dedicated to understanding China's STI (science, technology, and innovation) system/policy and its implications for the European Union;
- Organise virtual and physical events (conferences, workshops, networking activities, trainings, staff exchanges, etc.), and manage their related communication activities, to foster pan-European connections among the different EU knowledge nodes on contemporary China. The organisation of China-focused thematic courses, ad-hoc seminars, and trainings, is encouraged in order to raise awareness on key China-related subjects, also involving the wider civil society/public/private institutions beyond China experts;
- Provide the Commission with regular policy recommendations and updates on the activities of the project;
- Reach out and encourage the participation of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China to enhance the visibility and impact of their work and foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge;
- Prepare and put in place a sustainability plan for the platform to ensure the continuation of the work after the end of the action.

Scope: This topic contributes to the priority areas of action number 9 on *promoting a positive environment and level playing field for international cooperation based on reciprocity* listed in the Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area⁵⁶ (ERA). More specifically it aims to satisfy the objective of *launching a pilot initiative on the Team Europe approach for a specific world region and/or topic*.

This action seeks to bolster a stronger European understanding of contemporary China and to strengthen European's capacity to sustain the production of such knowledge that is key to develop excellent EU-China policy-making based on facts, independent and unbiased analyses, and foresight. In accordance with the EU-China – A Strategic Outlook Communication of 2019⁵⁷ and the Global Approach to Research and Innovation Communication of May 2021⁵⁸, the action aims to empower the European Union to act coherently and proactively on the international stage preserving an open research and innovation ecosystem while safeguarding European interests and values.

Today China is a key global actor and a leading scientific and technological power. China's increasing relevance in the geopolitical system has exposed the weakness the European Union

⁵⁶ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14126-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁵⁷ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/communication-eu-china-a-strategic-outlook.pdf>

⁵⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/default/files/research_and_innovation/strategy_on_research_and_innovation/documents/ec_rtd_com2021-252.pdf

faces in its capacity to better understand contemporary China in its various specificities, complexities, and goals and respond to its rapid evolution and new policy directions. The European Union needs to get to know and understand it on its own terms: not through the lens of other external sources but from its own European perspective. The underlined priority for the EU to develop its own knowledge capacity to navigate China's continuous transformations is embedded in the concept of independent European knowledge, which should guide the work of successful applicants.

Following interactions with Member States, China experts, and stakeholders in the framework of the EU R&I Knowledge Network on China (EUKNOC) and following the publication of the SFIC recommendations on China in November 2021⁵⁹ it has emerged that at the European level expertise on contemporary China is often fragmented and difficult to access. Networking existing prominent and emerging knowledge nodes, gathering, categorising, and mainstreaming their work on an easily accessible public information platform would be therefore pivotal to break siloes and provide policy-makers, researchers, businesses, and civil society with the tools needed to develop a deeper understanding of the different dimensions that characterise contemporary China. Doing so would also increase the circulation of information and foster the creation of new knowledge, in line with the Commission's efforts to upgrade independent knowledge on contemporary China in Europe started in the 2021-2022 Horizon Europe work programme⁶⁰. Building synergies with granted projects from topic HORIZON-CL2-2021-TRANSFORMATIONS-01-07, would be therefore strongly encouraged.

This action should bring forth the creation of a virtual European Info Platform on Contemporary China through networking relevant knowledge nodes from across the European Union that pursue the advancement of independent knowledge on contemporary China. The platform would collect, connect, produce, select, disseminate, and give visibility to excellent research material and provide translations from Chinese into English of relevant Chinese policy documents (and produce subsequent policy briefs on such documents). The successful consortium will be in charge of setting up the platform, organising/curating the material on the new virtual tool, setting up relevant events, thematic courses and trainings, communication activities, and developing a sustainability plan to ensure the successful continuation and growth of the platform after the end of the action.

The involvement of excellent knowledge centres from Eastern European Member States producing independent knowledge on contemporary China is strongly encouraged to foster the cross-fertilisation of knowledge on contemporary China across the European Union and enhance the visibility of their work.

⁵⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1204-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

NB - Such recommendations call, among others, for the EU to build a permanent EU Info Centre for policy, academic, media and business based on existing networks and expertise available on China and to establish links between stakeholders from academia, public and private sector to create a network of China related actors and work on China in a concerted way.

⁶⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/topic-details/horizon-cl2-2021-transformations-01-07> -

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-07: Support to reforms of research assessment in the European Research Area

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 5.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support and contribute to the implementation of institutional changes for reforming research assessment (i.e., the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units,

and research institutions), in line with Action 3 of the ERA Policy Agenda actions and in support of Action 1;

- Connection of existing organisations and initiatives for reforms of research assessment, facilitating the exchange of information and mutual learning, and stimulating consensus building among the stakeholders;
- Recommendations for policy-makers, research funding and performing organisations, higher education institutions and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement institutional changes to research assessment;
- Global outreach of European efforts to reform research assessment and reinforced international cooperation on evolutions in research assessment.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research proposals and researchers evaluated in an unbiased manner on their intrinsic merits and performance rather than on the number of publications and where these are published;
- Researchers evaluated based on a broader range of research outputs and tasks (including open science practices);
- Researchers benefit from attractive careers, regardless of gender or other social characteristics;
- Modernised higher education sector, benefitting from improvements to the research assessment systems (including for performance-based funding).

Scope: The way research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions are assessed is fundamental for a well-functioning research and innovation system. The research and innovation system is undergoing major transformations with diversification of desired research outputs not restricted anymore to publications, and of research tasks and required skills; with a culture of sharing of knowledge and tools and of open collaboration (including societal engagement) becoming mainstream; and with a growing need of multi-disciplinary approaches and collaboration to tackle ever more complex scientific questions and societal challenges. However, the current system often uses limited methods to assess the quality, performance and impact of research, favouring quantity of results of individual researchers and the impact factor of the venue where they are published.

Several institutions including research funders and universities, in Europe and beyond, are currently reforming the assessment systems of their research and researchers. At a global level, the San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment⁶¹ (DORA) aims at improving how the output of scientific research is evaluated. The Recommendation on Open Science⁶² adopted by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

⁶¹ <https://sfdora.org/>

⁶² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949.locale=en>

in November 2021 calls for a review of research assessment systems to align them with the principles of open science. The Global Research Council (GRC) held a conference⁶³ in 2020 on “Responsible Research Assessment” and established a dedicated working group in 2021. The European Research Area ERA Policy Agenda for 2022-2024⁶⁴, adopted by the Council of the European Union on 26 November 2021, includes a priority action for reforming the assessment systems for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact. Accordingly, the European Commission is taking steps to facilitate an agreement between research funders, research performing organisations, national/regional evaluation agencies or authorities, and other stakeholders like learned societies, to reform research assessment criteria and processes in willing organisations, along commonly agreed principles and actions. In 2021, consultation of stakeholders⁶⁵ identified convergence on 10 principles expected to guide the reform of research assessment⁶⁶.

The establishment of a coalition of committed organisations is expected to accelerate changes towards research assessment systems that promote qualitative judgement with unbiased peer-review, supported by a more responsible use of quantitative indicators. The reformed research assessment systems should consider a more diverse set of research cultures and outputs, by valuing not only publications but also other research outputs such as data sets, software, models, workflows, methods, etc., and proper conduct including integrity and gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness. The reformed systems are expected to reward open collaboration as well as early knowledge and data sharing, as these practices enable good science⁶⁷. It should also reward the diversity of tasks of researchers, and consider the different contributions to the work of teams.

This action aims at supporting the reform of the assessment of research projects, researchers, research units, and research institutions. The action consists of three parts, all of which must be addressed:

- The first part aims at supporting the operation of the coalition. This includes support to the sharing of information, mutual learning and awareness raising, across individual organisations, umbrella organisations, and initiatives, involved in the coalition and beyond, including with national and regional authorities. The action is expected to

⁶³ <https://www.globalresearchcouncil.org/news/responsible-research-assessment/>

⁶⁴ Annex to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the European Research Area of 26 November 2021 <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-14308-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

⁶⁵ Scoping report “Towards a reform of the research assessment system”:
<https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/707440>

⁶⁶ The 10 principles identified during the stakeholders consultation and listed in the scoping report are: Ethics and integrity; Freedom of scientific research; Autonomy of research organisations; Independence and transparency of the data, infrastructure and criteria; Quality; Contribution to advancing knowledge and the (potential) impact of research results; Diversity of research activities, practices, outputs; Variety of scientific disciplines, research approaches, research career stages; Diversity in research roles and careers, and team science; and Gender equality, equal opportunities and inclusiveness

⁶⁷ Open science practices include: early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, or crowd-sourcing); research output management; measures to ensure reproducibility of research outputs; providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software, models, algorithms, and workflows); participation in open peer-review; and involving all relevant knowledge actors including citizens, civil society and end users in the co creation of R&I agendas and contents (such as citizen science).

support workshops, working groups and other tools to: raise awareness, exchange experience and disseminate information on institutional changes, contribute to the development and piloting of metrics needed for research assessment; identify, monitor and showcase case studies, including good practices and lessons learnt, and develop and share guidance and recommendations for research organisations and policy-makers;

- The second part involves financial support to third parties, by launching ‘cascading grant’ call(s) to support institutions from across the ERA, notably those engaged in the coalition approach, to implement sustainable institutional changes to reform and improve research assessment criteria and processes. This may require support services to be developed and provided to the beneficiary third party organisations. The ‘cascading grant’ mechanism is expected to contribute to institutional changes in a significant number of organisations (e.g., 40-50 individual organisations involved, of different types and across different geographical areas). As such, a significant proportion of the funding should be allocated to this mechanism, and one or more call(s) for proposals should be launched;
- The third part aims at international cooperation on research assessment. The action will envisage international cooperation with entities outside the EU Member States and Associated Countries. The action will promote internationally the European efforts, will support exchange of information and explore opportunities for aligning policies, and will seek to attract non-European organisations to join the coalition.

The proposals should develop close cooperation, share knowledge and evidence, and build on various institutional, national and international initiatives, including DORA, GRC, UNESCO and the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC). Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-45, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-51, call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-01, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes. Further collaborations are expected to emerge at a later stage, e.g. resulting from the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03 of Horizon Europe

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic, but not exceed 36 months.

CITIZEN SCIENCE

One of the eight ambitions under the Open Science policy of the European Union is citizen science. ‘The general public should be able to make significant contributions and be recognised as valid European science knowledge producers.’ The aim under Horizon Europe is to ‘engage and involve citizens, civil society organisations and end-users in co-design and co-creation processes and promote responsible research and innovation.’

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-08: Laying the groundwork towards Europe-wide citizen science campaigns

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000. The respective options of the Model Grant Agreement will be applied. Beneficiaries should refer to General Annex B of the Work Programme for further information and guidance.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Identification of citizen science initiatives with high potential impact if upscaled to ERA level;
- Establishment of broad societal coalitions/networks of quadruple helix actors organised around promising citizen science initiatives;
- Protocols and working modalities for use of open transnational data repositories and infrastructures;
- Proposals and commitments for mobilising diverse sources of funding to ensure sustainability of citizen science initiatives.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased collaboration with all stakeholders, including citizens in all phases of research and innovation, leading to more responsible R&I;
- Increased alignment of ERA countries' citizen science efforts;
- Transnational citizen science community building;
- Contributions to the objectives of Horizon Europe's EU Missions;
- Increased public trust in, and understanding of, science.

Scope: Citizen science, involving citizens directly in the development of new knowledge or innovations, is a rapidly emerging mode of research and innovation that can lead to increased quality and effectiveness, e.g., through collecting, processing or analysing new qualities and quantities of data.

Many citizen science initiatives could achieve much higher impact if they were implemented on a transnational basis, collecting, analysing and exploiting vast amounts of cross-country data and, thereby, building a multinational community of citizen scientists. However, small-scale national citizen science projects often face practical, technical, or conceptual challenges and lack the support, the transnational coordination skills, and the resources, to upscale their efforts to a transnational level.

This action should conduct preparatory work for the launch of Europe-wide citizen science campaigns under the New ERA, which will also have synergies with Horizon Europe EU Missions. The action should identify the most promising citizen science initiatives for transnational upscaling, foster the development of broad societal coalitions around the identified and promising initiatives, and propose how to unlock the necessary funding commitments (e.g., from EU and national programmes and funders, philanthropic, and/or commercial sources) required.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should require the involvement of quadruple helix stakeholders. Citizen science 'champions' in public authorities should be envisaged, to raise awareness, 'connect the dots' between different services and institutions, and obtain broad and high-level commitments. The involvement of SMEs and industry could lead to new means to organise, collect and analyse data, and disseminate and exploit results. The involvement of research stakeholders will be essential to ensuring rigorous and credible research approaches and maximising scientific and technological impacts. Obtaining the inputs of civil society, involving and making youth aware of CS, building understanding of the activities (including their scientific bases), and fostering broad societal ownership of the promising initiatives could prove crucial to the scale and intensity of the eventual citizen science campaigns.

Europe-wide citizen science campaigns should aim to cover a majority, – and potentially all – ERA countries; involve citizens at different stages of the research cycle (e.g., development of

methods, data collection, data analysis, evidence-based advocacy processes, testing and evaluation); be inclusive and make particular efforts to involve those from lower socio-economic groups; and aim to deliver a range of additional benefits such as increased scientific literacy, improved trust in science, improved social inclusion and employability, and improved capacity within the scientific workforce to engage with society.

The action should conduct a thorough screening of potential initiatives to be upscaled, analysing the most promising in terms of synergies with one or more Horizon Europe EU Missions, the potential to advance scientific knowledge, and generation of a range of additional benefits. The action should develop scientific protocols, establish working modalities with open data repositories and infrastructures, prepare training (e.g., for volunteers and volunteer co-ordinators), develop societal engagement and science communication strategies, and propose how to mobilise diverse commitments for funding.

The action will build on the existing knowledge base and experience, including previous projects focused on citizen science, citizen engagement activities in the context of Horizon Europe EU Missions, citizen observatories, and the upscaling of the Plastic Pirates – Go Europe! (plastic-pirates.eu) campaign. It will work in collaboration with existing networks and actions, and develop synergies with the actions supported by HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-60 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-61. The action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 to bring science closer to the citizens.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-09: Policy support to facilitate the implementation of a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Support to various national R&I entities, including national administrations, with adopting a zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment at higher education institutions and research organisations, in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 5;
- Cooperation between national R&I actors from Member States and Associated Countries, including with less advanced organisations, to facilitate the exchange of information, mutual learning, and best practice sharing on the implementation of measures to tackle GBV;
- Training and awareness-raising activities for research funding and performing organisations, and other research and innovation actors on how to best implement a zero-tolerance approach towards GBV at their organisation;
- Data collection and monitoring on the implementation of GBV measures at higher education institutions and other research organisations, in line with the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Research entities in Member States and Associated Countries having measures in place to effectively address cases of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and to provide victim support and hold perpetrators accountable;
- Research talents, particularly women and LGBTIQ+ persons, remain in academic careers due to safer, gender-inclusive, and mental health supportive working environments;
- A safe and gender-inclusive higher education and academic sector, benefitting from a strong network and knowledge base on the prevention of and protection from GBV.

Scope: Gender-based violence (GBV), including sexual harassment, sexual assault and psychological violence, occurs at all career levels of higher education and research and in all disciplines. It has destructive consequences for individuals, disrupts careers, damages institutions, and affects the quality of research and education itself. Nevertheless, very few countries have comprehensive policies in place to address the issue, as relatively little public policy attention has been given to GBV in universities and research institutions in the EU.⁶⁸ With the institutional change approach through gender equality plans, measures to address GBV (e.g., through a code of conduct or a protocol for complaints), are expected to advance among R&I organisations, as they are recommended components of these plans, defined in the Horizon Europe eligibility criteria. However, a more comprehensive and strategic policy coordination is needed to ensure that R&I entities in Member States and Associated Countries are supported in implementing the necessary institutional changes to foster safe and inclusive working environments in academia. Interplays between gender-based violence and more

⁶⁸ [ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1](#): Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries

subtle forms of psychological violence, such as stress and pressure, often inherent in reward-based and hierarchical systems such as academia, should also be taken into account.

This action should support Member States, Associated Countries, as well as national research funding organisations (RFOs) and research performing organisations (RPOs), with the implementation of a strategic zero-tolerance approach towards gender-based violence in higher education and research. This action should directly contribute to the outcome under the ERA policy agenda, action 5⁶⁹, and support the implementation of EU Presidencies priorities.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Support the sharing of information, mutual learning, best practice sharing, training, and awareness raising on tackling GBV in academia across Member States, Associated Countries, RPOs and RFOs. Providing support and advancing the knowledge of R&I actors in Widening countries is thereby of particular importance. The action should build on the zero-tolerance policy established by the Communities of Practice, under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81;
- Facilitate the implementation of an EU baseline code of conduct on zero-tolerance towards GBV, including sexual harassment, adapted to a wide range of RPOs, including higher education institutions, RFOs and other research organisations in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Foster dialogue, awareness-raising and training to counter more subtle forms of psychological violence, including cases that result from PhD supervisor/PhD candidate, mentor/mentee dependencies, and other forms of hierarchical relationships;
- Particular attention should be given to protection mechanisms for internationally mobile students and researchers, as well as early-career stage researchers in precarious positions;
- Monitor and evaluate the implementation process of the code of conduct on zero-tolerance of GBV at a wide range of higher education institutions, RPOs, RFOs, and other research organisations.

The action should develop close cooperation with relevant R&I stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, share knowledge and evidence, and build on the outputs and recommendations of related actions, e.g., Horizon 2020-SwafS funded UniSAFE⁷⁰ project, the GEAR tool⁷¹, as well as on other key initiatives at national level⁷² and institutional level from

⁶⁹ [ERA Policy Agenda Action 5 outcome](#): “Strategy to counteract gender-based violence including sexual harassment in the European R&I system and to assure gender equality in working environments through institutional change in any research funding or performing organisation”

⁷⁰ <https://unisafe-gbv.eu/>

⁷¹ EIGE’s Gender Equality in Academia and Research tool: <https://eige.europa.eu/gender-mainstreaming/toolkits/gear/action-toolbox>

⁷² See e.g., ERAC 1205/1/20 REV 1, by former ERAC Standing Working Group on Gender in Research and Innovation (SWG GRI): [Sexual Harassment in the Research and Higher Education Sector: National Policies and Measures in EU Member States and Associated Countries](#)

gender equality plan (GEP) implementing projects. Proposals should also build on the results of projects funded under earlier Framework Programme actions. Notably, applicants are expected to cooperate with relevant projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81 and call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81 of Horizon Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls' participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women's underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the "A" in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-10: Support to the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STE(A)M education and research and innovation career paths to tackle gender inequalities in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Common principles and joint commitment on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation among a wide range of R&I actors in Member States and Associated Countries;
- Network of STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, informal science education establishments, and civil society organisations, supporting knowledge sharing, mutual learning and structural change towards gender equality and diversity at their organisations;
- Increased cooperation between relevant R&I actors from academia, the private sector, and national administrations to foster women and girls’ participation in STEM studies and careers through a STEAM approach.

Scope: Persisting gender gaps, particularly in STEM fields, are hindering the potential of the European Research Area (ERA) to meet pressing challenges like the green and digital transitions. According to She Figures 2021, women outnumber men at Bachelor and Master levels overall, but are still underrepresented as doctoral graduates in STEM fields, including physical sciences (38%), ICT (20.8%), engineering (27%), and mathematics (32.5%).⁷³ In order to increase the uptake in scientific careers, feed the talent pipeline, and counteract women’s underrepresentation, a STEAM approach, featuring creative thinking, applied arts (the “A” in STEAM), and the teaching of science in political, environmental, socio-economic

⁷³ European Commission, Directorate-General for Research and Innovation, She Figures 2021: gender in research and innovation: statistics and indicators, Publications Office, 2021, <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/06090>

and cultural contexts, can prove particularly useful. By highlighting the social impact and market relevance of research and innovation, the STEAM approach would also strengthen the appeal of scientific careers.

In line with the European Strategy for Universities and the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027⁷⁴, this action aims to support the cooperation between STEM-oriented businesses, secondary and higher education institutions, research organisations, as well as informal science education establishments, NGOs, and civil society organisations, committed to fostering gender-inclusive career paths in the STEM fields through a STEAM⁷⁵ approach.

More specifically, the action should ensure the implementation of a European Manifesto for STEAM education and career paths to tackle gender inequalities among relevant R&I actors, through the adoption of common principles and actions on gender-inclusive STEAM education, research and innovation. Particular attention should also be paid to addressing bottleneck moments and structural barriers in young researchers' careers. The implementation of this manifesto should build on the STE(A)M roadmap(s) for science education, developed by projects under the call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-70, and seek synergies with the ERA Talent Platform initiative and the Digital Education Hubs.

To support relevant R&I actors, including umbrella organisations, with the implementation of an EU Manifesto for STEAM education to tackle gender inequalities, proposals are expected to cover the following:

- Development of a network of national R&I and education actors from Member States and Associated Countries, involved in STEAM education, research and innovation, to support best practice sharing, mutual learning, and transformative actions to tackle gender inequalities at education institutions and R&I organisations;
- Setting-up of principles and a joint commitment on gender equality and diversity in STEM education, research and innovation at organisational level, in line with the ERA, EEA and the European Innovation Agenda;
- Communication and awareness-raising on the deconstruction of gender stereotypes and unconscious biases in science and the benefit of STEAM education, research and innovation;
- Support STEM skills-development and learning opportunities for all genders through the use of arts, social sciences and humanities, including e.g., mentoring sessions, non-cost summer schools, workshops, and traineeship opportunities, and involving inter alia start-

⁷⁴ Commission Communication on a European Strategy for Universities, 4.2 Foster diversity, inclusiveness and gender equality, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-communication-on-a-european-strategy-for-universities>; Digital Education Action Plan 2021 -2027, Action 13: Women participation in STEM, <https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital/education-action-plan>.

⁷⁵ Science, technology, engineering, (the arts) and mathematics (STEAM) is a multidisciplinary set of approaches to education removing traditional barriers between subjects and disciplines to connect STEM and ICT education with the arts, humanities, and social sciences.

ups, incubators, innovative industries, universities, schools, science and technology museums etc;

- Support teachers' and practitioners' skills development on gender-responsive STEAM education to increase knowledge and expertise on STEAM approaches and enable them to act as ambassadors for the implementation of the Manifesto and the innovative approaches produced under this action.

Particular attention should be given to targeting and involving a diverse range of young women and girls, including those from disadvantaged backgrounds (e.g., ethnic minorities, people with migration background, or with disability, children from poor families or of low qualified parents). Geographically balanced participation is also important.

Proposals are expected to seek collaboration with the living labs for gender-responsive innovation, funded under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80, and build on the outcomes of projects funded under call topic Horizon SwafS-26-2020 'Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap'⁷⁶, as well as gender equality plan implementing projects. Proposals should also take into account project results, funded under earlier Framework Programmes (e.g., HYPATIA, SPARKS and Scientix 4)⁷⁷.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserving the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-11: Research ethics for environmental and climate technologies

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following

⁷⁶ [Shemakes.EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566) and [EQUALS-EU](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063)

⁷⁷ [https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665566)
<https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101000063>

[https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825;](https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/665825)

<i>conditions</i>	exceptions apply: Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding. Moreover, due to the scope of this topic, applications must be submitted by consortium and the minimum eligibility criteria for consortium composition set out in part B of the General Annexes applies. In addition, proposals must include at least two additional participants (joining as an associated partner or beneficiary if eligible for funding), each of whom must be a legal entity established in one of the following countries: Japan, China, Republic of Korea, or African countries not-associated to Horizon Europe.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁷⁸. The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible implementation of the EU Green deal, the projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Design an operational ethics and integrity framework, which preserves and promotes the key ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective green transition in the European Union;
- Promote awareness, ethics education and training about climate and environmental aspects of research activities, as well as insight in ethical aspects of the development of related knowledge and applications (for example: new agricultural and breeding techniques, environmental protection, geoengineering, tools facilitating energy efficiency and behavioural change).

Scope: Becoming the world's first climate-neutral continent by 2050 is the greatest challenge and opportunity of our times. For this reason, the European Commission adopted the European Green Deal, the most ambitious package of measures that should enable European citizens and businesses to benefit from a sustainable green transition. In order to support the green transition, it is a priority for the European Research Area to build an encompassing framework for research and innovation activities⁷⁹.

⁷⁸ www.embassy.science

⁷⁹ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

The high magnitude and multi-fold nature of the consequences that we would face, if we do not tackle the global environmental risks, necessitate adapting the way we work, protect the world's scarce resources, and decide on policy priorities. This inevitably raises important ethical questions and dilemmas including some related to the production of scientific knowledge and the development of novel technologies.

There is a growing awareness that biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation at local, regional and global scale pose direct and existential threats to human life and wellbeing⁸⁰. At the same time, actively pursuing the preservation of the environment can, in some cases, lead to some tensions between the pure environmental objective and the protection of human rights. This is the case in particular when the implementation of anthropomorphic models gives to natural elements the same status as human beings.

An important aspect that characterises global challenges is that they, by nature, go beyond the well-being of persons and touch the whole society notably in terms of solidarity and social justice. Mid and long-term socio-economic consequences are also more prominent in these complex research contexts, not only those affecting vulnerable populations exposed to environmental degradation, but also those caused by a green transition depending on social and geographic circumstances⁸¹.

Some research topics intrinsically also have a complex environmental and ecological ethics dimension including for example research and innovation in the area of electro-magnetic fields and the high frequency communication systems that are necessary to achieve a European gigabit society, or the digital innovation and biotechnology in food production practices that should not only remain safe for human health and the environment, but also allow a fair and sustainable system⁸².

In this context, the action should conduct an analytical work covering the following aspects:

1. What characterises the different dimensions and concepts associated with climate and environmental ethics in the context of research and development;
2. Identify the ethics and integrity challenges related to the production and use of scientific knowledge in designing and implementing novel technologies and approaches to the global environmental challenge facing the European Union and the Planet;
3. Develop strategies to uphold the integrity of scientific research in addressing climate change issues⁸³.

Elements to tackle by this action should encompass the issues related to the role of ethics and integrity experts (as advisors, for example), informed consent of communities and

⁸⁰ Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸¹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸² Council Conclusions on the Farm to Fork Strategy, 12099/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-12099-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸³ UNESCO Declaration of Ethical Principles in Relation to Climate Change (2017), <https://en.unesco.org/themes/ethics-science-and-technology/ethical-principles>.

individuals⁸⁴, undue inducement and opt out approach, as well as equitable sharing of benefits arising from research⁸⁵.

The action should clearly highlight what cannot be accepted or neglected in the name of addressing environmental issues. This notably includes the need to always conduct, prior to the start of a research, an independent ethical review, which remains a necessary safeguard for the individuals involved and enhances the trust from the impacted communities and the society as a whole, in the name of the ‘do no harm’ principle⁸⁶. Environmental concerns justify immediate actions and should not lower ethics and integrity standards.

In addition, issues related to refining environmental risk assessment in various fields of research and innovation should be addressed. The action should explore also how the quality of data estimating environmental impact is assessed and fed back in policy design. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda actions 11 and 12.

The action should result in:

- Producing an operational (“how-to”) guidelines to support the work of research teams’ ethics committee members and integrity experts, taking into account the concept of climate justice, including intergenerational justice as well as gender justice. The guidelines should include, among others, clear guidance for addressing ethical challenges related to the development of novel technologies and approaches to address climate change (e.g., in relation to technologies encouraging behavioural change, geo-engineering) and the application of the precautionary approach in different fields of research and innovation;
- Assessing the need to complement the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity⁸⁷ with specific guidelines and if relevant propose short documents complementing the Code, focusing on the need to ensure an “inclusive and just transition that leaves no one behind”⁸⁸;
- An effective incorporation of the objectives of the “Do No Significant Harm” Principle⁸⁹;
- Developing traditional and online training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. The material must be made available

⁸⁴ As also highlighted in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁵ Ibid.

⁸⁶ Also reaffirmed in the Council Conclusions on Biodiversity – the need for urgent action, 11829/20, <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-11829-2020-INIT/en/pdf>

⁸⁷ http://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/h2020-ethics_code-of-conduct_en.pdf

⁸⁸ https://ec.europa.eu/info/sites/info/files/european-green-deal-communication_en.pdf

⁸⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/programme-guide_horizon_en.pdf

on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁰. The priorities of the European Digital Education Plan must be taken into account;

- The action should in this context foresee the training of 400-450 Horizon Europe ethics appraisal scheme experts, paying close attention to gender balance, as well as to gender equality and diversity related ethical aspects, and make use of their feedback to improve the trainings.

Overall, the work should be based on existing know how and have a bottom-up approach, involving all relevant stakeholders (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations) through the organisation of participatory events (workshops, consultations, ‘town hall’ meetings). Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - or higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and ethics experts.

- The activities should propose ways and means to encourage changes in the research culture and promote openness, communication, dialogue and stronger links among stakeholders. This work should involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENRIO⁹¹ or European networks of (early) career researchers and educators in the field of research ethics and integrity.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SOP4RI, Integrity, TRUST, Path2Integrity, TechEthos)⁹² are taken into account. Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with Embassy of Good Science⁹³ should be included.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe is required.

Consortia with EU partners or partners from Associated Countries that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

⁹⁰ www.embassy.science

⁹¹ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

⁹² Detailed information of the mentioned EU funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

⁹³ www.embassy.science

HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01-12: The future of research ethics review in the changing research environments

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional dissemination obligations: Proposals must include structured cooperation with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science⁹⁴ (including the necessary technical aspects), and the European Networks ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)⁹⁵. The output material of the action must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science.

Expected Outcome: In order to support an effective adaptation of the ethics reviews to the evolution of scientific research, notably due to the emergence of new areas of research and new forms of research collaborations, projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Evaluate the effectiveness of current approaches to the ethics reviews in ensuring the embeddedness of human rights in the development of digital technologies and promoting adherence to ‘digital rights’ and ‘digital principles’ in the context of research and related international cooperation and partnership⁹⁶;
- Develop new approaches to ethics reviews and assessments. This should focus on developing systems and procedures that promote an ethics by design culture fostering innovation, while supporting the research community to operationalise and embed new

⁹⁴ www.embassy.science

⁹⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

⁹⁶ Communication From the Commission to the European Parliament, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions: 2030 Digital Compass: the European way for the Digital Decade, COM(2021) 118 final, Brussels, 9.3.2021, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/resource.html?uri=cellar:12e835e2-81af-11eb-9ac9-01aa75ed71a1.0001.02/DOC_1&format=PDF

and upcoming EU human rights driven legal frameworks in research proposals, in line with the ethics by design approach;

- Enable the ethics processes to better inform policy choices about the uses of new and emerging technologies and support the researchers in incorporating ethical considerations into their research, thereby contributing to the protection of human rights and the promotion of EU values. For example, the GDPR, since its adoption has inspired the adoption and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’⁹⁷.

The emergence of new areas of research and development, including in the areas of gene editing and artificial intelligence, and the shift of research activities and collaborations to the online digital space, challenge the future of research ethics reviews.

At the same time, ethics should focus on the adherence to values and principles and not be a legal compliance mechanism. It is also necessary to prevent ethics reviews and assessments from becoming a red-tape mechanism, especially as the ex-ante-model of traditional ethics oversight might not be apt to deal with new challenges for example stemming from various forms of data re-use and the often unpredictable and tentative nature of big data research and unforeseeable risks.⁹⁸

Scope: Among the key concerns are research activities that do not involve traditional ‘research participants’ or where there are no established practices or legal obligations to undergo ethics review. A pertinent example is research assembling and analysing large volumes of existing (anonymised) research data, data produced as a by-product of people’s use of technological devices and services, and other categories of non-personal data. The absence of the traditional individual research participant or data subjects, however, does not mean the research activities do not pose ethical challenges or risks.

In addition, a broader variety of players, often in an international setting, is frequently involved in such research activities. These may include universities, corporations, public and private foundations, civil society organisations, online service providers, open exchange and collaboration initiatives and platforms, and other formal and informal associations.

Another important element to be taken into account when investigating how the ethics committee should evolve is the development of a new legal framework related to the protection of human rights. In particular, to prepare for ‘Europe’s Digital Decade’, there are several important initiatives in the pipeline that aim to facilitate the access to and use of digital data, such as the Data Governance Act⁹⁹ and the proposals for a Data Act¹⁰⁰ and the

⁹⁷ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

⁹⁸ Ferretti, A., Ienca, M., Sheehan, M. *et al.* Ethics review of big data research: What should stay and what should be reformed?. *BMC Med Ethics* 22,51 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12910-021-00616-4>.

⁹⁹ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/PE-85-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹⁰⁰ <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/data-act-proposal-regulation-harmonised-rules-fair-access-and-use-data>

European Health Data Space¹⁰¹. Meanwhile, the EU has been a frontrunner in the formulation of normative frameworks that aim at safeguarding human rights and freedoms in the context of digital innovation, and has committed to incorporate those values into international research collaboration¹⁰². What is more, the GDPR, since its adoption, has inspired the implementation and reform of privacy and data protection frameworks globally, resulting in a so-called ‘Brussels effect’,¹⁰³ and the Commission has indicated a clear willingness to move further ahead with the proposal for an Artificial Intelligence Act¹⁰⁴ and the Declaration on Digital Rights and Principles for the Digital Decade.

In this context, the proposed actions should:

1. Analyse the strengths and weaknesses of the current approaches to ethics review in their capacity to address the challenges above (new technologies, new players, new forms of collaboration and partnerships, new human rights related framework, etc.), and, on this basis, propose concrete ways of adapting ethics committees (working methodologies, composition, etc.) in view of matching the new challenges. The overall objective is to identify gaps in practice and formulate proposals to enhance the capabilities of the existing ‘ethics infrastructure’ in Europe. As regards the role of the bodies, it is important not to limit the scope to the ex-ante ethics review, prior to the start of the research concerned, but to also cover the monitoring during the implementation of the research and innovation activities. Practical ways to support the work of relevant stakeholders, notably research funders should also be identified, including the development of quality criteria or benchmarking tools to assist in the evaluation of existing research ethics oversight mechanisms¹⁰⁵. The applicability of the proposed approaches should also be tested via the use of specific case-studies (involving non-EU partners where appropriate);
2. Organise stakeholder consultations and interdisciplinary mutual learning initiatives to enable the identification of best practices for the ethics oversight of new modes of research. As cutting-edge research is of cross-border character, this action should involve institutions that engage in research ethics review and relevant related activities, including at the international level;
3. Develop guidelines and corresponding training and education materials to enable ethics experts involved in ethics reviews to assess compliance with the new ethics standards resulting from the new challenges addressed under point 1 and above;

¹⁰¹ https://ec.europa.eu/health/ehealth-digital-health-and-care/european-health-data-space_en

¹⁰² As confirmed by the [Marseille Declaration on International Cooperation in Research and Innovation](#) of 8 March 2022, and reflected as priority of the [European Research Area Policy Agenda for 2022-2024](#).

¹⁰³ Floridi, L. The European Legislation on AI: a Brief Analysis of its Philosophical Approach. *Philos. Technol.* 34, 215–222 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-021-00460-9>.

¹⁰⁴ [EUR-Lex - 52021PC0206 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#)

¹⁰⁵ For health research, a notable example of a Benchmarking Tool for ethics oversight has been developed by the WHO. See https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/ethics/who-benchmarking-tool_research-ethics-oversight_draft-for-consultation-26-nov-2021.pdf?sfvrsn=ed34a0ec_5

4. Train Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

In addition, this action should produce traditional and innovative training material (reflecting the developed approaches and guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers, as well as for research administrators and managers (to support the professionalisation of research management in the area of research ethics). The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹⁰⁶ should be taken into account.

Proposals should ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU-funded research projects (e.g., SOPs4RI, SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos, RoSie)¹⁰⁷ are incorporated, in particular the guidelines that they have produced.

Proposals should foresee budget for cooperation with Embassy of Good Science (including the necessary technical aspects) and ENERI¹⁰⁸, as well as cooperation with other existing European Networks with clear attribution of research ethics responsibilities, including (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. The material must be made available on the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹⁰⁹.

In order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes, etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

To achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is strongly recommended.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

For all published articles and deliverables produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement must be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01

¹⁰⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

¹⁰⁸ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹⁰⁹ <https://embassy.science/>

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹¹⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹¹¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be funded
		2024		
Opening: 06 Dec 2023 Deadline(s): 12 Mar 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01	CSA	6.00	Around 2.00	3
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03	CSA	1.00	Around 1.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04	CSA	0.50	Around 0.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05	CSA		Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08	CSA	2.50	Around 2.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09	CSA	2.00	Around 2.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10	CSA	3.50	Around 3.50	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11	CSA	3.00	0.50 to 1.00	4
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12	CSA	3.00	Around 3.00	1
Overall indicative budget		23.50		

General conditions relating to this call

<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
---------------------------------	--

¹¹⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹¹¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰

<https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹

[Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.

Successful proposals should align national and regional research funding programmes on agreed priorities that are common to the countries participating in the action and, where appropriate, implement joint calls for transnational R&I projects as well as other joint calls or other joint activities. Applicants should demonstrate clear commitments from participating programmes to pool resources and ensure complementarity between activities and policies with those of the Framework Programme and relevant European Partnerships and EU missions.

Proposals should pool the necessary resources from the participating national (or regional) research programmes as well as, where appropriate, leverage resources from pertinent foundations, charities and transnational initiatives, with a view to implementing calls for proposals, either within the context of this action or in possible follow-up actions, resulting in grants to third parties without EU co-funding in this area.

The proposals should also demonstrate potential impact at national, regional and transnational level. The proposals should demonstrate that activities exclude overlaps with on-going actions co-funded by the EU under Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe.

The actions should envisage a duration appropriate to the ambition and complexity of the proposed topic.

IMPROVING ACCESS TO EXCELLENCE

This part of the Work Programme addresses the need to improve access to excellence and to increase the performance of R&I systems, building on dedicated Horizon Europe measures as well as complementarities with smart specialisation strategies under the Cohesion Policy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-03: Support for the professionalisation of research management

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 1.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: This action aims to contribute to improve the European R&I system across the entire ERA by particularly strengthening the capacity for research management in the European Union's public research performing and funding organisations. Actions are expected to:

- Involve a large number of public research performing and research funding organisations and their research management staff in the training and networking programmes, including by improving accessibility for staff from regions of lower R&I intensity;
- Improve training, skills and career development of research management staff in the participating organisations;
- Contribute to professionalisation, including through certification of training programmes;
- Increase recognition of the research management profession in Member States and the important role of research managers across the ERA.

Strengthen research management capacity and support for a Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) approach across the entire ERA, including in regions of lower R&I intensity.

Scope: Research management takes various shapes across the ERA (and beyond), and therefore its definition/scope is multi-dimensional, including but not limited to the following roles: research policy advice, evidence-based policy making, foresight and strategy development; research coordination, research development, research project and funding management, financial support; evaluation and assessment support; research and complementary training programme management; data-based research support, such as data stewards and data analysts, exploitation of research data, data protection; specialised research infrastructure operation; scientific integrity and ethics expertise, gender perspective support, legal support; science communication support; knowledge transfer and innovation support, knowledge brokering, incubator coordination and business development. In particular, the aim of this action is to further develop and implement a methodology to identify, train and 'professionalise' individuals who are essential support for the 'research enterprise'.

There is a strong need for creating sustained pan-European research management training – both in virtual and in non-virtual curricula. This would help to create solid networks of early career and experienced managers that will last throughout their careers, in the various dimensions of research management for which such opportunities do not yet exist. Secondly, research performing and funding entities, local ecosystems, and regions that are strong in knowledge creation and circulation usually rely on a strong community of research managers. An important challenge for the European R&I system in this respect is the uneven distribution of research management communities and expertise across the ERA. Lower R&I intense countries, regions, institutions often lack such communities, or do not have sufficient access to expertise. Thirdly, the need for new skills is constantly evolving, and upskilling of staff requires ready access to training and practice exchange platforms and across the ERA. Fourthly, there seems to be a lack of recognition of research management as a profession, compared to other policy sectors. Similarly, accreditation of training and career development programmes for research managers in the diverse specialisations is lacking.

This call intends to support initiatives towards flexible careers for research managers and career diversification of R&I talents towards research management. Actions should create joint virtual and non-virtual training programmes and curricula for research managers and prepare the road to certification and accreditation. Actions should take measures to realise equal opportunities for access to training programmes for staff from across the entire ERA, including from regions with lower R&I intensity.

The call addresses also support for virtual and non-virtual networks of research managers from public research performing and funding organisations at European level, as well as cross-border European operational networks (existing or new), complementing and coordinating existing national initiatives. Focus could be put on equal access for staff to such networks and exchanges, building capacity in regions and institutions of lower R&I intensity.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-04: Strengthening researchers' skills for better careers – leveraging the European Competence Framework for Researchers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 0.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Researchers at all career stages equipped with a comprehensive set of transversal skills based on the European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp), to foster more open and inter-sectoral research careers, and a better recognition of the researcher profession;
- Coordination and exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions, research institutions, and other training providers for the improvement of research and transversal skills training;
- Meeting of labour market demands by strategic partnerships of training providers with labour market actors in the development of training programmes;
- Contribution to certification of microcredentials;
- Improved communication of science to the public, to make research careers more appealing to younger generations.

Scope: Skills are of utmost importance for researchers, they allow them to perform high quality research, and to make the overall European R&I system competitive and challenges-

proof. However, it is crucial that researchers are equipped not only with research-specific skills, but also with transversal skills that allow them to be interoperable between academia and the other sectors, including industry and business, and to be capable to establish entrepreneurial activities to turn innovative ideas into business and lead to social, environmental and economic profitability.

Being equipped with a wide spectrum of skills is of high benefit for researchers, who can have access to an enlarged number of opportunities for career development compared to the limited ones available in academia, but also for the labour market, which is in constant need for highly skilled talents such as researchers.

To support inter-sectoral mobility and a broad recognition of the research profession in academia and beyond, and in line with the Skills Agenda, the Commission has developed a set of skills and occupations relevant for researchers which contributed to the update of the European Skills, Competences and Occupations (ESCO) classification. It has also finalised a European Competence Framework for Researchers (ResearchComp)¹¹², which contains the competences that researchers should have for a successful and interoperable career in academia and beyond, including via entrepreneurship creation and through effective communication of science to the public, to engage an increasing number of young people in research careers. ResearchComp is divided into 7 competence areas, and for each competence it provides four progression levels, each of them with a number of foreseen learning outcomes.

Projects are expected to support research performing organisations in adapting and reinforcing formal and targeted training for researchers based on:

- The use of ResearchComp, so that training is provided not only on research-specific skills, but also on transversal skills that can foster better research careers in academia and beyond;
- Strategic interaction with ecosystem actors, in order to have a better understanding of labour market needs, close the gap between demand and supply, and jointly develop training programmes;
- The promotion and support for networking and the exchange of best practices between Higher Education Institutions and other training providers with regard to the development of formal and targeted training opportunities for researchers that can foster inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility;

¹¹² ResearchComp has been developed in line with the new ERA Communication and the Skills Agenda to strengthen researchers skills for successful careers in academia and beyond. The conceptual model of the framework includes 38 skills, divided in 7 competence areas (Cognitive abilities, Doing research, Managing research, Managing research tools, Making an impact, Working with others, Self-management). Each stakeholder will be able to use the framework according to its own needs. The final version of ResearchComp, to be rolled out by the end of 2022, will also include learning outcomes for each of the relevant skills. More information can be found in the policy brief “Knowledge ecosystems in the new ERA: Using a competence-based approach for career development in academia and beyond” <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/8d536780-3025-11ed-975d-01aa75ed71a1/language-en>

- Without prejudice to the other transversal skills needed by researchers for inter-sectoral and inter-disciplinary mobility, put a specific emphasis on science communication to make researchers capable to correctly and effectively communicate to the public, and to make research careers more attractive for young talents.

Projects are also expected to contribute to the certification and recognition of targeted training opportunities to up-skill and re-skill, provided under the form of micro-credentials.

Activities may include roadmap development, networking, sector-specific training development, seed funding for training providers in academia and beyond (non-exhaustive list of activities that projects may consider).

TRANSLATING R&I RESULTS INTO THE ECONOMY

The Council has asked the Commission to develop a strategy to accelerate the potential uptake of research and innovation results and data. The recent ERA Communication calls for the valorisation of research results with citizens at the forefront; people expect science to be a driving force that will support the transition towards a greener and fairer society and economy.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 0.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Scope: The Commission has cancelled the topic “HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-05: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation”. The topic has been re-introduced as "HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation" with an updated description under the call HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher

education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

OPEN SCIENCE

Open science is a policy priority for the European Commission and the standard method of working under its research and innovation funding programmes as it improves the quality, efficiency and responsiveness of research. The effective linking of open science practices to innovation and business models requires careful consideration of issues such as Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), licensing agreements, interoperability and reuse of data.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-07: Capacity building on Intellectual Property (IP) management to support open science

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations regarding open science practices: Beneficiaries must ensure early and open sharing of the outputs deriving from their activities under a Creative Commons Attribution –CC BY- or equivalent license, including training and educational materials. Applicants must acknowledge and incorporate these obligations in the proposal, outlining the efforts they will make towards meeting them and in Annex I to the Grant Agreement.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Analysis of how adequate IP management enables and boosts open science and how both open science and IP management are complementary in achieving a better dissemination and valorisation of knowledge;
- Specific training materials, modules or courses on Intellectual Property assets and open science, including how to manage IP assets to enable open access to scientific

publications and to ensure scientific results are Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (“FAIR principles”); the open licenses applied to the outputs deriving from this call will allow for their reusability by the wider R&I community; resulting training materials, modules or courses are expected to reuse or build on existing materials, updating them when necessary;

- High-quality training on the diverse aspects of IP management and how an adequate IP management enables open science delivered to research performing organisations’ professional and managerial staff and/or academic staff (“train the trainers”);
- Support the trainers in acting as multipliers of the acquired knowledge, in particular, by embedding the training materials, modules and courses resulting from the projects into the curricula/learning or research support material of research performing organisations;
- Gather experiences and share good practices for the further development of programmes and specialised courses on the topic; the project is expected to deposit the resulting good practices in the Knowledge Valorisation Platform¹¹³ repository of best practices under IP management;
- Awareness-raising campaign on how an adequate management of IP enables and fosters open science; such a campaign is expected to be built on the previous awareness raising campaigns on IP management organised by the European Commission (Directorate General for Research and Innovation), with the European Patent Office (EPO), the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA).

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Support to research performing organisations and researchers in practising open science by providing them with relevant training materials, sharing best practices and raising awareness on the importance of adequate IP management;
- Increased understanding among the research community of IP assets and the role their adequate management plays in enabling open science;
- Better management of IP in line with the Code of practice for the smart use of IP to be developed in 2022, including better IP management to facilitate open science;
- Improved overall capacities within the EU R&I system to conduct open science and implement it as a *modus operandi* of modern science for researchers and research organisations (e.g., by integrating the expected outcomes into their open science and IP policies).

Scope: Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the scientific process. Adequate

¹¹³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/research-area/industrial-research-and-innovation/eu-valorisation-policy/knowledge-valorisation-platform_en

management of IPR over research results is necessary for such cooperative work and systematic sharing to happen. However, a lack of awareness and understanding of IPR -in particular given the complexity of the relevant legal and regulatory landscape- sometimes leads to mismanagement of IP and the consequent difficulty of researchers and institutions to determine how their research is disseminated.

Copyright is an area of particular importance for open science within the field of IP, since the bundle of rights that authors have on their original works (e.g., scientific publications or databases) allow them to set the conditions for their dissemination and re-use.

Greater awareness of their rights and how they can be exercised would help authors to make more informed choices and get them in control about the further usage of their research results. They will also align themselves better with open science practices and comply with funder open access mandates.

Adequate IP management is therefore an important enabler of open science. Against this context, there is the need to improve knowledge among researchers and their institutions of concepts such as copyright, licences and patents, leading to an understanding of the options at their disposal for, amongst other, archiving, posting, distributing and eventually publishing their scholarship in ways that enable open science in their own terms. There is also a need to improve the understanding of the relationship between open science and IP, in particular how the adequate management of IP lies at the very core of open science. This calls for supporting education and training in IP management that enables open science and for building capacity in research organisations and their staff, with the objective to support and equip researchers at all stages of their career with the knowledge they need in this area.

In contributing to the above-mentioned outputs, projects are expected to take into account the existing IP service delivery landscape and the existing training and capacity building efforts and materials offered by European Commission service contracts (i.e., IP Helpdesk¹¹⁴, IP Scan¹¹⁵, IP Booster¹¹⁶) and the work of EUIPO on copyright and trademarks and EPO's work on patents. The projects are also expected to build on the European Commission code of practice for the smart use of IP (expected to be delivered in 2022) and further strengthen the relationship with open science.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 24 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

¹¹⁴ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en

¹¹⁵ https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en

¹¹⁶ <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴²

In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-08: Global cooperation in not-for-profit open access publishing

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately.

114 https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/regional-helpdesks/european-ip-helpdesk_en
115 https://intellectual-property-helpdesk.ec.europa.eu/horizon-ip-scan_en
116 <https://ipbooster.meta-group.com/>

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>project</i>	Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Enhanced understanding of the different non-for-profit open access publishing solutions, their business models and sustainability;
- Coordination amongst institutional not-for-profit open access publishing services between Europe and other areas in the world at the non-technological level leading to high-quality publishing services and publishing venues at the global scale that are trusted by researchers;
- Enhance the uptake of elements of open science by open access publishing services in Europe and other areas of the world (e.g., open peer review, early sharing of research, post-publication peer review models etc.);
- Fit for purpose training materials and trainings for service providers and scientific journal editors in different disciplines enabling the improvement of the quality of publishing services and of the scientific quality of publishing venues along internationally accepted standards.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased equity, diversity and inclusivity of open science practices, and in particular open access publishing on a not-for-profit basis, in the European Union and in the world;
- Structured mechanisms for knowledge transfer between relevant not-for-profit open access publishing services in the European Union and other areas of the world.

Scope: A significant increase in open access publishing activities based on not-for-profit business models can be observed in Europe and across the world, which in principle do not charge authors for publishing. They are the result of technological advancements leading to shifting roles of actors involved in scholarly communication. Their offering is presented as an alternative to commercially oriented publishing, or is a continuation of long-term traditions of institutional and mission-oriented publishing in a new digitally enabled context. Such services

enable inclusivity for all authors, regardless of affiliation and funding, and support a healthy diversification in the scholarly publishing ecosystem. Research institutions and their libraries are often involved in their operation. In some countries, they operate at the national level and are frequently supported by national funding agencies. In many cases, such initiatives have evolved into robust and reliable services which enjoy the trust of researchers.

The aim of this topic is to support the cooperation between such not-for-profit publishing services and their editors to enable the flow of knowledge between the European Union and one or more other areas of the world, and in more than one discipline. It is expected that most of the activities of the actions will take place online, and that platforms and other online tools will be used to perform as many of the activities as possible.

The call will fund activities that will:

1. Gather, share and improve good practices with regard to the non-technological aspects of service provision (editorial scopes, peer-review policies, organisation of editorial and publishing business processes, translation, among others), and with regard to business models;
2. Implement practices that will strengthen high-quality publishing services at the global scale so that they are trusted by researchers across countries and disciplines;
3. Develop training materials and organise virtual trainings for not-for-profit publishing service providers and their editors to increase knowledge transfer and dissemination of good practices. The materials should become available in open access.

Applicants are expected to cooperate with projects funded under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-43: Capacity-building for institutional open access publishing across Europe, and call topic HORIZON-INFRA-2022-EOSC-01-02: Improving and coordinating technical infrastructure for institutional open access publishing across Europe, to ensure synergies and complementarity of outcomes.

Duration: The action should be no longer than 36 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-09: Support to the development and implementation of policies and practices for reproducibility of scientific results

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
-------------------------------	--

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Facilitated development, implementation and monitoring of interventions in research organisations that increase the reproducibility of scientific results;
- More collaboration, joint actions by stakeholders, and mutual learning, notably between national reproducibility networks, to increase reproducibility of scientific results;
- Greater alignment of policies and reduction in disparities between research organisations and between countries in terms of their attention to reproducibility of scientific results;
- Facilitated development and implementation of training programmes and awareness raising.

These targeted outcomes in turn contribute to medium and long-term impacts:

- Increased proportion of reproducible results;
- Increased re-use of scientific results by research and innovation;
- Greater quality of the scientific production.

Scope: Increasing the reproducibility of scientific results, i.e., the possibility for scientists and the scientific community to obtain the same results as the originators, contributes to higher quality and more efficient research processes, more trustworthy results, increasing reuse by other researchers, more effective translation into innovations, and higher return on investments in research (see the scoping report “*Reproducibility of scientific results in the EU*”¹¹⁷).

The aim of this topic is to facilitate the development and implementation of policies and practices, by research performing organisations, research funding organisations, learned societies and publishers that enhance reproducibility of scientific results. The action will support the mutual learning and dissemination of good practices between organisations across the European Union, as well as with relevant organisations outside the European Union, with broad disciplinary representation. It will build expertise and will support research organisations to develop and implement policies and interventions, and will coordinate efforts between stakeholders, notably between existing European national reproducibility networks. The action may facilitate the development of national networks in additional European

¹¹⁷ <https://data.europa.eu/doi/10.2777/341654>

countries. The action will support the development of training materials and training programmes, the mutual learning and exchange of practices and tools, and awareness raising, for researchers, reviewers and research organisations. The action will also put in place mechanisms to monitor the effects of policies and practices implemented, thus enabling future adaptations based on evidence gathered. In order to better achieve the expected outcomes, international cooperation is encouraged, in particular with third countries that are active in the development of policies and initiatives to increase the reproducibility of research results.

The action should build on the research results and recommendations from projects selected under call topic HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-41 that aims at understanding the underlying drivers of reproducibility and recommending effective interventions, as well as from other relevant projects and initiatives.

GENDER

With Horizon Europe, the Commission reaffirms its commitment to gender equality in research and innovation. The aim is to improve the European research and innovation system, create gender-equal working environments where all talents can thrive and better integrate the gender dimension in projects to improve research quality as well as the relevance to society of the knowledge, technologies and innovations produced.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA- 2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-10: Policy coordination to support all aspects of inclusive Gender Equality Plans and policies in the ERA

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.50 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Advanced and sustainable policy coordination support on ERA objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness among Member States and Associated Countries and through stakeholder and citizen engagement;
- Improved career paths and working conditions in European research and innovation organisations, including in the private sector, through enhanced policy dialogue on inclusive gender equality plans and policies;

- Increased research quality and societal responsibility and relevance of knowledge and innovations, through the integration of the gender and intersectional dimension in research and innovation content;
- Increased geographical inclusiveness by targeting less experienced countries and regions in terms of inclusive gender equality policies in research and innovation;
- Increased inclusion of underrepresented and socially disadvantaged persons in European research and innovation, through an intersectional lens on gender equality plans and policies.

Scope: As the new package adopted on 26 November 2021 on the European Research Area (ERA) framework¹¹⁸ reaffirms, there is a need for policy coordination to advance the implementation of the ERA gender equality and inclusiveness objectives within Member States, Associated Countries and among other ERA stakeholders, building on the commitment expressed through the Ljubljana Declaration on gender equality in research and innovation¹¹⁹.

Ensuring the active promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness entails opening up gender equality policies in R&I to diversity, and more specifically to: social categories and grounds for discrimination intersecting with gender, such as ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation or socio-economic status; ensuring geographical inclusiveness; and opening to the innovation and private sector. This new inclusive approach to gender equality is also embedded in the new European Commission Gender Equality Strategy 2020-2025.

This action focuses on the development of a sustainable network of national representatives from all EU Member States and Associated Countries, both from national bodies (e.g., ministries) and from national research funding organisations, to support the implementation of the gender equality and inclusiveness objectives of the ERA. It should build on related actions funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80 and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81, the European Gender Equality Competence Facility funded under the 2022 WIDERA work programme, as well as on projects funded under the Horizon 2020 Science with and for Society (SwafS) programme.

During its lifetime, the action should:

- Develop knowledge and build capacities, competences and expertise on the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of inclusive gender equality plans and policies in R&I with a variety of European and national stakeholders. Special consideration will be given to mutual learning exercises to enhance the competence of national gender equality representatives, including helping less experienced national gender equality representatives to acquire expertise;

¹¹⁸ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

¹¹⁹ [Ljubljana-Declaration-on-Gender-Equality-in-Research-and-Innovation- endorsed_final.pdf \(gov.si\)](#)

- Further the development of a transnational Community of Practice of R&I funding organisations for the promotion of an inclusive and gender-responsive culture change in R&I institutions across the European Union;
- A specific focus should be placed on developing joint activities with actors from the private, innovation and entrepreneurship sectors, from across the European Union;
- Develop various innovative engagement activities, connect citizens, experts and policy-makers, and contribute to policy making on inclusive gender equality in R&I at national and European administration level;
- The work by this action should be performed in coordination with ERA-related official groups, such as the ERA Forum, and in collaboration with the European Commission, in line with ERA objectives.

The participation of national representatives of at least 23 Member States, and in addition, of national representatives from Associated Countries, to the consortium, is strongly encouraged, and the project should engage and deploy activities with all EU Member States and, as much as possible, with all Associated Countries.

The action should also develop close cooperation with relevant ERA stakeholders, including umbrella organisations, sharing knowledge and evidence, and build as well on the outputs and recommendations of related initiatives funded under Horizon 2020-SwafS, such as GENDERACTION, ACT, GE Academy and the GEAR Tool, as well as recommendations from Horizon Europe funded initiatives, e.g. the Expert Group on the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-11: Support to the implementation of inclusive gender equality plans

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 0.50 and 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The scheme must involve at least one leading higher education institution, research organisation, or public body (e.g., ministry, funding agency) in terms of gender equality and inclusiveness, and at least three less

	advanced higher education institutions, research organisations or public bodies (e.g., ministry, funding agency) from Widening Countries.
--	---

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Enhance the reputation, attractiveness, inclusiveness and R&I excellence of less advanced organisations as a result of implementing inclusive gender equality plans;
- Transform R&I organisations to advance ERA policy objectives on gender equality and inclusiveness.

Scope: The institutional change strategy implemented through gender equality plans (GEPs) has had very positive impacts in many R&I organisations and been a catalyser at national and EU level, as attested by several reports¹²⁰. The introduction of a GEP eligibility criterion in Horizon Europe, for public bodies, research organisations and higher education institutions from Member States and Associated Countries, has increased the level of uptake of gender equality activities. However, there remains a heterogeneity in the implementation of GEPs across the EU and Associated Countries, particularly in the Widening countries. Furthermore, the new ERA framework established through the Council Recommendation and Council Conclusions adopted on 26 November 2021¹²¹, sets the implementation of inclusive GEPs as a core objective for the promotion of gender equality and inclusiveness.

This inclusion scheme aims to strengthen and go beyond the minimum GEP requirements as defined in Horizon Europe eligibility criterion and to support the implementation of inclusive GEPs and policies, in line with the new ERA policy agenda objectives. Advanced organisations will mentor less advanced organisations on best practices, processes, monitoring and actions to undertake in the inclusive GEPs.

Actions should clearly outline the approach for boosting gender equality strategies by addressing new areas, such as intersectionality and diversity, gender budgeting, gender and innovation, and the long-term impact of COVID-19 on gender equality in R&I, among others.

Proposals are expected to address the following:

- Methods for exchanging and implementing good practices and materials, tailored to individual organisations' needs for the development and monitoring of inclusive GEPs;
- Support for reinforcing their networking in the area of gender equality and inclusiveness, especially with already existing Communities of Practice;
- Activities such as on-site visits, on-site or virtual training; workshops; dissemination and outreach and capacity building activities;

¹²⁰ <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-1202-2021-INIT/en/pdf>

¹²¹ [Council Recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in Europe](#), and [ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024](#) annexed to the Council Conclusions on the future governance of the ERA

- Implementation of specific actions in the less advanced institutions specifically addressing the opening to intersectionality and diversity, targeting other underrepresented or socially disadvantaged groups, and including the integration of intersectional sex and gender analysis into R&I content.

Proposals should build on the knowledge and expertise developed through related Horizon 2020 projects and tools (e.g., GEAR Tool, ACT Communities of practice, GE Academy) as well as under projects funded through Horizon Europe call topics HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-80, HORIZON-WIDERA-2021-ERA-01-81, and HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-81.

The partners involved in the action are expected to revolve either around a specific thematic area or have widening partners with similar national/regional background, for a better contextualisation.

ETHICS

Ethics is an integral part of research from beginning to end, and ethical compliance is seen as pivotal to achieve real research excellence. Ethics challenges go from the production, sharing and use of scientific knowledge and data in designing and implementing responses to anticipating future global urgencies. It is key to preserve the ethics principles while supporting a rapid and effective response to a crisis and improving overall preparedness.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRP include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRP and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-12: Next generation AI and Human Behaviour: promoting an ethical approach

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, in addition to the minimum number of participants set out in the General Annexes, proposals must include at

	least two participants from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries non-associated to Horizon Europe. Participants from countries, which are not eligible for funding according to the General Annexes, may take part in the project as associated partners. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: The rules are described in General Annex G. Beneficiaries will be subject to the following additional obligations: Proposals must include budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the e-platform Embassy of Good Science¹²². The output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Expected Outcome: In order to promote a responsible, trustworthy, and human-centric design and development of the next generation of artificial intelligence (AI), proposed actions are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- The operationalisation of available general guidance on the ethics of AI into practical specific guidelines. These guidelines will focus on the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour. The guidelines must also address the ethics dimension of the study of human behaviour and cognition in developing and improving AI systems. The guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and development processes and take into account strategies for ensuring adequate participation of all those affected by the development, deployment and use of the relevant applications;
- Develop and validate education and training material reflecting the produced guidelines. This should be based on participatory processes involving all relevant stakeholders, including citizen groups and industry.

Scope: While the European Union has been a front runner in the global effort to formulate guidelines and regulate AI, it is certain that the road ahead will be full of challenges. One of the key challenges is that the meaning and appropriate interpretation of the key concepts and principles in AI guidelines will often be highly context specific. For example, the ethical risks related to the development or use of AI-based techniques for emotion recognition might be very different when applied for recruitment and selection purposes than when used for detecting levels of distress to assist in dealing with emergency calls or to detect situations of abuse. Similarly, AI-enabled differentiation based on physical characteristics may be unethical in the context of law enforcement but useful in a medical context.

¹²²

www.embassy.science

At the same time, research and development of AI-based application surges in all domains, from education, over measuring consumer behaviour, to assisting in making important decisions, such as supporting the mental health of people, promoting driver safety, and filtering job candidates.

Current developments and learning in the field of AI come from a strong collaboration of multidisciplinary teams working together to acquire further knowledge on human cognition and behaviour in order to understand, predict and impact human behaviour (e.g., for improving health or sustainability). To develop affective AI systems, researchers aim to improve their understanding of the way the human brain learns and transfers knowledge. Potentially, this understanding will help to build explainable, trustworthy, and human-centric AI systems and processes. However, while systems for automatic emotion recognition and sentiment analysis can be facilitators of enormous progress (e.g., in improving public health and commerce), they are also enablers of considerable harm (e.g., acting against dissidents, manipulating voters).

In addition to ensuring the protection of research participants, research ethics review plays a pivotal role in facilitating the integration of ethical concerns into research projects and protocols from the conception phase. While ensuring the development of ethical AI will require technical solutions - for example to improve transparency and explainability - guidance for the operationalisation of AI ethical principles (in a non-technical manner) needs to be developed and continuously evaluated in light of new developments in the field (in particular the increasing in-depth study of human behaviour in AI research and development).

Therefore, as policy-makers and AI actors around the world move from principles to implementation, the action should:

- To better understand the ethical challenges (1) associated with the study of human behaviour and cognition to support the development or improve AI systems and (2) related to the impact of AI on human cognition and behaviour, the current landscape should be reviewed and three chosen exemplary areas of research can be selected (such as of emotion recognition applications, deep learning and general intelligence);
- Establish specialised, inclusive networks of expertise, comprised of multidisciplinary teams (including, amongst others, engineers, data scientists, legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, researchers with expertise in other relevant areas, research administrators and policy experts);
- In collaboration with the networks of experts, and based on findings and case-studies, develop operational guidelines for AI systems that build on the study of human cognition and behaviour. These guidelines should incorporate ethics into the relevant research and design processes and facilitate the ethical assessment and auditing of research projects and outcomes (including toolboxes for algorithmic impact assessment). The guidelines should target the research community, with an emphasis on early career researchers as well as the ethics experts (e.g., members of ethics review committees) and project managers. The developed guidelines must adjust the ethics-by-design approaches (as

included in the guidelines *Ethics by Design and Ethics of Use Approaches for Artificial Intelligence*¹²³) to the relevant areas of study and development. These should include mechanisms to assess ‘ethics readiness levels’ for the relevant ‘technology readiness levels’ and encompass the relevant mechanisms to incorporate ethics-enhancing methods directly in the design of the research protocols and prototypes (e.g., privacy-enhancing technologies, explainability, human-centred approach in design);

- Develop a toolbox for international cooperation in AI research and development in the relevant areas, taking into account the regulatory and ethical landscape in key strategic partners (for example China, the Republic of Korea, Japan, Canada and the US). Incorporate principles of benefit sharing in AI research and development in accordance with the *Global Code of Conduct for Research in Resource-Poor Settings* (TRUST Code)¹²⁴;
- As a result of the above activities, this action should also produce innovative training material (reflecting the guidelines) for students, early career and experienced researchers. In addition, Framework Programme ethics appraisal scheme experts should be trained (250-300). Close attention should be paid to gender balance, as well as to gender equality- and diversity-related ethical aspects. Feedback of the trainees should be used to improve the trainings.

All activities proposed must be based on multidisciplinary, inclusive networks of expertise, including amongst others, engineers, data scientists, AI legal experts, ethicists, cognitive researchers, linguists and educators, as well as private sector representatives. Every effort should be made to achieve a 45% - higher- female participation, especially among students, researchers, and experts. This should also involve relevant ethics and integrity networks, such as ENERI (European Network of Research Ethics Committees and Research Integrity Offices)¹²⁵ and ENRIO¹²⁶ or (associations of) European networks of (early) career researchers and/or educators in the field of research ethics and integrity. In addition, in order to improve the impact of the expected output (such as effectiveness of training courses, guidelines, toolboxes etc.), cooperation with research management offices and ethics officers in Research Performing Organisations is highly recommended.

In order to achieve the expected outcomes, cooperation with at least two actors from Japan, China, the Republic of Korea and/or African countries not associated to Horizon Europe is required.

It is important to ensure that the publicly available results from relevant EU funded research projects (e.g., SHERPA, SIENNA, TechEthos)¹²⁷ and the TRUSTWORTHY AI project¹²⁸ are

¹²³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/horizon/guidance/ethics-by-design-and-ethics-of-use-approaches-for-artificial-intelligence_he_en.pdf

¹²⁴ https://ec.europa.eu/research/participants/data/ref/h2020/other/hi/coc_research-resource-poor-settings_en.pdf

¹²⁵ <http://eneri.eu/>

¹²⁶ <http://www.enrio.eu/>

¹²⁷ Detailed information of the mentioned EU-funded projects can be found on CORDIS website: <https://cordis.europa.eu/>

taken into account, and that cooperation is envisaged with the beneficiaries of the Call HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA2023 01-12 – The future role and format of research ethics review in the changing research environments”.

Consortia with EU partners or Associated Countries partners that have not previously collaborated are encouraged to participate.

Budgeted cooperation (including the necessary technical aspects) with the Embassy of Good Science must be included in the proposal, and the output material of the action must be made available on this e-platform.

Finally, the action should aim at valorising and widely disseminating the material produced beyond the community of ethics and integrity experts, in particular by promoting its use for the students and young researchers that will constitute the next generation of ethics experts and reviewers. The priorities of the EU Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)¹²⁹ should be taken into account. In this perspective, cooperation should be sought with large university/research networks in order to enrich the relevant ethics related curriculum with the material produced by the action. In addition, National Contact Points should be provided with all the materials relevant to support their advisory activities.

For all deliverables and academic publications produced in the context of the activities, an authorship contribution statement should be added, in accordance with a recognised standardised taxonomy developed for this purpose (e.g., CRediT).

Call - Enhancing the European R&I system

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02

Conditions for the Call

Indicative budget(s)¹³⁰

Topics	Type of Action	Budgets (EUR million)	Expected EU contribution per project (EUR million) ¹³¹	Indicative number of projects expected to be
		2024		

¹²⁸ <https://www.trustworthyaiproject.eu/framework-for-trustworthy-ai-education/>

¹²⁹ https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en

¹³⁰ The Director-General responsible for the call may decide to open the call up to one month prior to or after the envisaged date(s) of opening.

The Director-General responsible may delay the deadline(s) by up to two months.

All deadlines are at 17.00.00 Brussels local time.

The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

¹³¹ Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

				funded
Opening: 15 May 2024 Deadline(s): 25 Sep 2024				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01	CSA	2.00	Around 1.00	2
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02	CSA	6.00	Around 6.00	1
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03	CSA	20.00	1.00 to 2.00	15
Overall indicative budget		28.00		

General conditions relating to this call	
<i>Admissibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex A.
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

DEEPENING THE EUROPEAN RESEARCH AREA

The challenge of deepening the ERA includes Open Science, Higher Education and Researchers, Citizen Science, Science Education, Gender and Ethics. It aims at underpinning a new ERA benefitting from knowledge creation, circulation and use. This empowers higher education institutions and research organisations to embrace a transformative process; where a highly skilled workforce circulates freely; where research outputs are shared; where gender equality is assured; where the outcomes of R&I are understood, trusted and increasingly used, by educated informed scientists and citizens to the benefit of society.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-01: Experimentation and exchange of good practices for value creation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 1.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 2.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Value creation and transfer to the economy and society by increased interlinkages and cooperation between knowledge valorisation actors (academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens);
- New solutions to societal and economic challenges by stronger uptake and deployment of research results, including through the involvement of citizens and civil society;
- Improvements of structures, strategies, practices and skills for knowledge valorisation through sustainable reforms and new initiatives in line with the ERA Policy Agenda action 7 – Upgrade EU guidance for a better knowledge valorisation, and with the European Council Recommendation on the Guiding Principles for knowledge valorisation¹³².

Scope: To emerge stronger from the pandemic and address the challenges we are facing, such as climate change, and enable the twin transition, Europe needs to translate available scientific knowledge and research results to innovative solutions, including technological as well as non-technological and social innovations, in the market, in society and for better policy making. To bring existing good practices in knowledge valorisation to support value creation across Europe, we need more experimentation, peer learning and testing of new models as well as trying out good practices in different environments.

Replication and adaptation of best practices is a powerful way to support the design, implementation and evaluation of knowledge valorisation investments and measures that enhance the quality and extent of knowledge uptake at all levels. It involves identifying and taking inspiration from best practices developed across Europe, engaging in an exchange of experiences with peers and connecting to new partners, as well as driving and supporting the set-up of new measures or the reform of existing ones. Cross-border transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation is challenging because the corresponding strategies, initiatives or

¹³² Council Recommendation (EU) 2022/2415 of 2 December 2022 on the guiding principles for knowledge valorisation, ST/14448/2022/INIT; OJ L 317, 9.12.2022.

tools need to be adapted to a different context and legal and financial framework and take into account skills and competences available in the new setting.

Researchers can play an important role in engaging with citizens and bringing research results into communities that need innovative solutions. This can contribute to making research results more adapted to the needs of citizens and communities, and strengthen the uptake of research by society benefitting both the research communities and the citizens as users and co-creators.

Proposals should address at least one of the following challenges:

1. **Experimentation in knowledge valorisation**, developing innovative ways to strengthen channels of valorising knowledge and research results, in particular targeting activities that engage citizens together with researchers in producing and taking up innovative solutions.. Within the scope of the topic are schemes and incentives for researchers to engage with society and for citizens and citizens' groups to engage in knowledge valorisation and promote the co-creation of new solutions and uptake of research results. This can include means to incentivise researchers to engage with society, contributing to a stronger translation of research results to the economy and society through better adaptation to citizens' needs and collaboration with industry, as well as co-creation of innovation schemes so that citizens' needs are addressed from the beginning. The experimentation will highlight what works well and under what conditions and what are the barriers and opportunities for greater knowledge valorisation through the collaboration of researchers and citizens;
2. **Transfer of best practices in knowledge valorisation**, in the area of 'academia-industry/SME linkages' or 'quadruple helix-based innovation' (i.e., involving academia/research; industry/SMEs; public administration/policy-makers and society/citizens in an ecosystem approach). Consortia are expected to involve partners that implement one or several best practices and partners that plan to introduce a new practice or reform an existing one. The action will lead to tangible change in some or all participating entities in terms of strengthening knowledge valorisation capacities, be it at strategic and/or investment level and/or through the implementation of new or adapted instruments, tools, guidelines, trainings etc. The action can also help develop and prepare knowledge valorisation projects and investments that receive support from the European cohesion policy or the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF). If support from the European cohesion policy or the RRF is sought, the concrete measures planned to be taken should be described. Inspiration for best practices can be found in the repository on the [EU Knowledge Valorisation Platform](#).

The involvement of practitioners beyond academic institutions would allow to address the challenges appropriately.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-02: Science comes to town

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 6.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium including at least three legal entities, independent of each other, established in three different Member States or Associated countries, of which at least two are different Member States.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G. The following exceptions apply: This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000. Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

Expected Outcome: Part of the ambition of the new European Research Area is to increase societal responsibility, trust and commitment in science and innovation by engaging stakeholders, local communities and citizens in the design and implementation of R&I policies and by enhancing science communication activities. This action provides a unique opportunity to cities in Member States and Associated Countries to take centre stage in implementing this vision. It allows them to bring together their citizens and R&I communities to showcase the contribution of science in addressing the needs of citizens and its contribution to improving the wellbeing of citizens on a sustainable planet together with economic prosperity. The call topic invites a small group of cities to jointly design and implement a vibrant and engaging year-long programme of activities under the label “Science comes to town 2026” with impact at local, regional and European level. The programme should connect local R&I communities with a broad group of stakeholders and, most importantly, citizens around the topic of science and its role in society.

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

- A year-long programme of diverse events and activities with a robust concept and brand, jointly developed and organised by a group of cities, promoting R&I in Europe and fostering dialogue and exchange on science and its role in society.
- Improved communication of science to the public through regular activities showcasing the latest developments and results in R&I and their relevance to citizens and their lives, and through experimentation with innovative ways of connecting citizens and scientists, involving different age and social groups at local, regional and European level.
- Enhanced discussion and debate on the future of science and R&I policy in Europe, with emphasis on inclusive and participatory approaches, involving all relevant stakeholders within and outside the EU (e.g., researchers, research funders, policy-makers, publishers, citizens, civil society organisations).
- Improved appeal of younger generations to careers in R&I (in academia, industry or starting own business) through organising European-wide science competitions, including the European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) and the European Union Contest for early-career researchers (EU TalentOn), as well as other similar initiatives.

Scope: The new European Research Area (ERA) has the engagement of citizens, local communities and civil society at its core, seeking greater societal impact and increased trust in science. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – ‘Bring science closer to citizens’ through broad and inclusive engagement of all relevant stakeholders in a range of activities with a view to increasing the understanding, acceptance, uptake and impact of R&I in society.

The action supports a consortium involving cities to host a coordinated joint 1-year programme with focus on connecting citizens and scientists in the participating cities and beyond, including the following:

- A year-long programme of various events and activities, such as lectures, workshops, exhibitions, competitions or prizes, in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital, that highlights the contribution of science to society and the results of R&I projects supported by national/regional/EU funds, including the Horizon Europe programme.

In addition, the programme of activities must include the following two components:

- EUCYS 2026, the European Union Contest for Young Scientists, an annual science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds that brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location.

The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹³³. The participating city that the proposal designates as host for EUCYS 2026 must provide as part of the proposal the commitment from its respective National EUCYS Organiser to run the 2026 competition as part of the project.

- EU TalentOn 2026, the European Union Contest for Early Career Researchers, is a biennial science competition for 21- to 35-year-olds that brings together at least 100 early-career researchers to work on scientific solutions to societal challenges¹³⁴. The objective is to promote careers in research, facilitate cross-border and cross-sectoral collaboration among early-career researchers, and to promote entrepreneurship and opportunities in academia and industry. The researchers are divided into small teams, which should be gender-balanced and be as much as possible geographically and socially inclusive, to compete for prizes and awards. The teams are mentored by experts from academia, industry and SMEs. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in the field and are based on broader policy priorities.

The programmed activities should target a wide population of European citizens with impact at local, regional and European level, and involve participants of different ages and across social groups and actors (students, researchers, citizens, policymakers, business and third sector organisations).

Proposals should develop and test the overall concept and brand of “Science comes to town” with a view to future editions. Proposals are invited to experiment with new interactive and engaging formats across the programmed activities. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote science education and various forms of public engagement with science. The programme should take place in the participating cities, but proposers are encouraged to design and implement outreach activities that reach communities beyond the ones in the cities directly participating. Wherever possible, synergies should be sought with the European Researchers’ Night, Europe’s largest science communication and promotion event which brings together over 1,5 million visitors across Europe every year; as well as the Researchers at School initiative, both funded under the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions¹³⁵.

The programme of activities must take place in at least 3 cities of 3 different Members States and/or Associated Countries, with the majority being in Member States. The consortium can comprise different types of legal entities that can represent the host cities and/or join them in designing and implementing the activities. Applicants must provide with their proposal commitment letters from the public authorities of the selected cities (city council or similar). The inclusion of local partners that provide the link to science, research and innovation is strongly encouraged.

¹³³ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

¹³⁴ https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/eu-talenton_en.

¹³⁵ <https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu/actions/msca-citizens>

Applicants must submit as part of their proposal the overall concept for the annual programme of activities, including the vision for content (focus and scope of activities), outreach strategy, and contribution to long-term vision for the cities. The concept has to distinguish between:

- a) events, including EUCYS and TalentOn, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- b) activities, such as the overall coordination and communication activities, that will be funded partially or fully by the Union contribution;
- c) activities and events that will be financed by the participating cities; sponsorship and other resources (activities not funded by the Union contribution).

The consortium has to quantify in their proposal their commitment to mobilise substantial resources beyond the Union contribution. Monetary or in-kind sponsorships are encouraged to support and broaden the programmed activities, and further increase the impact of the action. Already established activities of the participating cities and other partners are encouraged to be included in the programme, but are excluded from funding under this action. The consortium has to report on the implementation of the activities and events not financed by the Union contribution, but not the related costs.

If participating cities wish to further expand the collaboration by engaging with other cities, e.g., with satellite events, they can consider to include them as partners without declaring costs in order to limit the administrative effort for them.

Priority activity for the successful applicants will be to co-design the detailed draft programme of activities. This will be a deliverable, due not later than 3 months before the formal launch of the “Science comes to town 2026”, subject to the approval of the Granting Authority.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes to the total amount of:

- EU TalentOn: €80,000
- EUCYS: €70 000

The amount awarded to individuals must not exceed €60 000.

The expected duration of the project is between 24 and 30 months.

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02-03: Talent ecosystems for attractive early research careers – pilot

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.00 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed

<i>project</i>	appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 20.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: The following additional eligibility criteria apply: Applications must be submitted by a consortium.

Expected Outcome: The 2020 Commission Communication on ‘A New ERA for Research and Innovation’ underlined the importance of adequate framework conditions to support research careers in Europe. Action 4 of the ERA Policy Agenda 2022-2024 – “Promote attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and inter-sectoral mobility across the ERA” - annexed to the November 2021 Council Conclusions on the ‘Future governance of the European Research Area’ foresees the development of a European framework for research careers, together with the upgrade of existing instruments and initiatives, including the revision of the Charter for Researchers. It also includes amongst its expected outcomes the development of new instruments to support research careers, such as the one proposed with this call topic.

This action will promote implementing the standards for attractive careers as laid down in the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers¹³⁶, responding to the political call for "labour market players to join forces for attractive careers". It will support cooperation between academic, private and public sector entities at organisational level to create ecosystems that ensure attractive early research careers perspectives, provide researchers with skill sets that match labour market requirements, thus providing the talent pool needed for a truly functioning internal market for knowledge. Projects are expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

- Establishment of ecosystems for research positions, in particular for early stage researchers, in academia, R&I performing institutions and businesses, connecting research training providers (in particular academia) and the researchers’ labour market (such as businesses, universities, research and technology organisations and government entities), supplying employers with skilled research talent that match labour market needs, including skills needs from the Green Deal, digital transition, and deep tech;
- Wide implementation of the standards for attractive researcher careers as laid out in the new Charter for Researchers, leading to more attractive, more diverse and more

¹³⁶ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

interoperable careers for researchers across all sectors, contributing to a better-balanced and sustainable circulation of skilled and entrepreneurial workforce;

- Improved early careers researchers' competences and employability within and beyond academia, as well as career interoperability between sectors.

Scope: The action supports consortia to create 'talent ecosystems' with a large pool of research and innovation positions operating under good training and working conditions in line with the new Charter for Researchers and the Council recommendation on a European framework for research careers, providing non-academic organisations, particularly businesses, with well-skilled researchers and other R&I talents, thereby increasing employability of early career researchers and improving interoperability of their careers between sectors.

This action particularly supports whole organisations and innovation ecosystems to implement the standards for attractive research careers laid down in the Charter for Researchers. A special focus is placed on organisational change in support of early career researchers¹³⁷, to offer them more and better career opportunities, including through strengthened coordination of measures at European, national, and regional level and increased cooperation between academia, industry, government and public sector.

The action is expected to be implemented by consortia consisting of both training providers (in particular academia) and employers of researchers (academia and organisations from non-academic sector, in particular businesses¹³⁸) from across the European Research Area, creating connected "talent ecosystems" that allow the free flow of talents and create attractive perspectives for researchers' careers within this ecosystem and beyond. A talent ecosystem for researchers is to be understood as a cohesive and interdependent system that encompasses various elements related to HR management of research talent. It can be thematic (e.g., targeted to R&I on climate, pharma, automotive, music industry) or have a more comprehensive target. It is designed to adapt to the evolving needs of the researcher labour market and the different occupations for researchers across sectors along the R1-R4 profiles, ensuring more customised training, career development and talent flowthrough. Such ecosystem is built around delivering a better employee experience and aligning with frequently changing priorities; it is agile and flexible to environmental shifts in the R&I system, such as changing labour market dynamics and skills needs. It provides distinct

¹³⁷ Early career researchers: First Stage Researchers, doing research under supervision up to the point of a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience, and Recognised Researchers, with a PhD or equivalent level of competence and experience who are not yet fully independent in their ability to develop their own research, attract funding, or lead a research group; R1 and R2 profiles in the Council recommendation (https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640). R1 and R2 profiles should be considered early-career researchers.

¹³⁸ *Non-academic sector* means any socio-economic actor not included in the academic sector e.g., industry, SMEs, independent research infrastructures (e.g., ERICs), government, non-academic public bodies, private research organisations, civil society organisations, international organisations, cultural institutions, hospitals, etc. *Academic sector* means public or private higher education establishments awarding academic degrees, public non-profit research organisations for whom one of the main objectives is to pursue research or technological development, and International European Research Organisations (IERO).

strategies for managing different research profiles, essential for competing in the global labour market, while delivering skilled research talent that match European labour market needs.

Consortia are expected to mainstream the Charter's principles and good working conditions across all participating organisations, which need to demonstrate in the application a high ambition as to the number of (new or existing) research positions that will benefit from the organisational change within the duration of the grant, ultimately leading to coverage of all its research staff. Participating organisations are expected to have received the HR Excellence in Research Award (HRS4R¹³⁹) or commit to apply the new Charter for Researchers and commit to its implementation (i.e., start the HRS4R process) within the grant duration, as far as relevant for their operations linked to the employment of researchers.

This action does not support salaries and mobility of individual researchers or teams of researchers. Instead, this action supports activities that lead to organisational change for more attractive research careers in line with the needs of R&I labour market players, towards the creation of sustainable talent ecosystems.

Funding will support implementation of good working conditions and reinforce flowthrough of talents between sectors, towards better employability of talent trained as researcher and increased interoperability of research careers between academia and non-academic sector entities. Activities can include (non-exhaustive list) the mapping of challenges, the development of action plans to bring the organisations in line with the new Charter for Researchers, scaling excellence in HR, and networking and relationship building for connecting the talent ecosystem partners. On a more practical level, activities could include the roll out of ResearchComp¹⁴⁰ in the organisational training and career development activities, the establishment of career services and training systems for early career researchers, the involvement of non-academic sector in the training of researchers, and relationship building between sectors for talent circulation.

This action is a pilot, testing the principles for a future investment strategy for attractive research careers at whole organisation and ecosystem level. Actions are therefore expected to provide policy feedback to the European Commission and Member States on the progress made, the success generated, and the obstacles encountered. Grants can have a duration of up to 3 years; a longer duration is possible if duly justified.

¹³⁹ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁰ ResearchComp: skills and competencies framework for researchers (https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/jobs-research/researchcomp-european-competence-framework-researchers_en).

OTHER ACTIONS NOT SUBJECT TO CALLS FOR PROPOSALS GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

PRIZES

1. Horizon Impact Award

Expected Outcomes:

- To celebrate the successful uptake and use of EU funded project results, thus boosting and promoting their achieved impact;
- To showcase best practices, create role models and inspire R&I beneficiaries to use their research results to create value for the society at large.

The Commission will award on an annual basis a recognition prize to reward beneficiaries that have successfully used their research results to create value for society. The beneficiaries must be able to show proof of effective exploitation and uptake of their research results. This action aims to illustrate the wider socio-economic benefits of the EU investment in R&I and to encourage project beneficiaries to best manage and use their research results.

In particular, six winners will be selected, by an evaluation jury, for their achievements. The prizes are monetary and each of the six winners will receive EUR 25.000.

Total of six prizes of EUR 0.025 each: EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget.

All applicants are required to submit letter(s) of support coming from the user community that can provide testimony on achieved impact.

Essential award criteria: The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestant(s) who in the opinion of the jury best addresses the following cumulative criteria:

1. Pathway from results to societal benefits:

Applicants will need to detail how the R&I results were directly or indirectly exploited after the lifetime of the project. They will need to describe the activities that were done to ensure that the R&I results lead to societal benefits. They will need to describe the scale and the sustainability of their actions.

2. Achieved impact:

Applicants will need to demonstrate the already existing impact and created societal benefits. They will need to detail concrete examples of how their research results have benefitted society and who are the user communities that have profited from it. The achieved impact must be already materialised. The letter of support will serve as a testimony of the described impact (but will not be evaluated).

Eligibility criteria:

The contest is open to all legal entities (i.e., natural or legal persons, including international organisations) or groups of legal entities that participated as beneficiaries in FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe. The projects must have ended by close of the contest. Legal entities receiving financial support to third parties under grants funded by FP7, Horizon 2020 or Horizon Europe, including under ERA-Net Co-fund (under Horizon 2020), Co-fund action (under Horizon Europe), EIT (under Horizon Europe), are also eligible. Natural persons such as ERC principal investigators or MSCA fellows and legal entities principally created by past beneficiaries for the exploitation of the project results, are also eligible.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

For the common Rules of Contest for Prizes please see the [Funding and Tenders Portal](#).

The specific Rules of Contest will be published in 2024 by the European Commission, which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prizes based on the judgement of independent experts¹⁴¹.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q1-3/4 2023 and Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.15 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.15 million from the 2024 budget

2. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2023 edition)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the creation of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP), and a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new ERA policy agenda, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the new Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

¹⁴¹ In 2022 and 2023 the Horizon Impact Award contests were cancelled, and therefore no prizes were awarded.

The Prize will be awarded to up to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- **Sustainable Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP;
- **Newcomer Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have recently started implementing a GEP and can demonstrate the most progress in its implementation and achieved results;
- **Inclusive Gender Equality Champions:** Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP addressing intersections with other social categories such as ethnicity, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million maximum in total from the 2023 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories and will have to provide proof of eligibility and a written presentation of their achievements, as well as support their applications with a link to a video. The submission consists of a complete application.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its GEP in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its GEP beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional, national and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender

equality through the implementation of its GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant demonstrates through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP. The applicant must support their claims with qualitative data, and quantitative data including performance measures and indicators, where relevant.
2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the innovative aspect as its inclusive GEP measures, such as, for example, new ideas not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴².

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will boost public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

¹⁴² In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget

3. EU Award for Gender Equality Champions (2024 and 2025 editions)

Expected Outcomes:

- Enable the development of a European community of academic and research champions in institutional transformation towards inclusive gender equality;
- Strengthening of the inclusiveness and connectivity objectives under the new European Research Area.

The “EU Award for Gender Equality Champions” is a recognition prize scheme meant as a booster and a complement to the requirement for higher education establishments, research organisations and public bodies applying to Horizon Europe to have in place a Gender Equality Plan (GEP)¹⁴³, and as a tool for advancing inclusive gender equality plans and policies in the framework of the new European Research Area (ERA) Policy Agenda.

The Award is also an enabler for the transformation agenda for universities set forth in the new ERA, in synergy with the European Education Area (EEA) and the European Higher Education Area (EHEA, Bologna process), and in line with the Communication on a European Strategy for Universities adopted on 18 January 2022.

The Prize will be awarded to four academic or research organisations, and contestants can apply to one among the following three prize categories:

- Sustainable Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that can demonstrate a significant and sustained record of activity and a high level of achievement through the implementation of their GEP(s);
- Newcomer Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have recently finalised the implementation of their first GEP and can demonstrate the most progress achieved through its implementation;
- Inclusive Gender Equality Champions: Organisations that have developed the most innovative inclusive GEP – i.e. a GEP addressing intersections between gender and at least two other social categories, such as racial or ethnic origin, social origin, sexual orientation and gender identity (LGBTIQ) or disability – and can demonstrate concrete results obtained through its implementation.

Each prize winner will receive EUR 0.1 million: EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.4 million in total from the 2025 budget.

Contestants can only apply to one of the three prize categories.

¹⁴³ See General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme (Gender equality plans and gender mainstreaming in Annex Part B – Eligibility)

In addition to the complete application, contestants may be asked at a later stage for further documents (*for legal entity validation, bank account validation, ethics review, declaration of honour, etc.*) or for a short video message on their achievements in the chosen Prize category. This video will be used for communication purposes only.

Essential award criteria: Eligible applications will be evaluated in each category by a jury consisting of a group of independent experts.

The prize will be awarded, after closure of the contest, to the contestants who in the opinion of the jury best address the following set of cumulative criteria set for each of the three prize categories:

Category “Sustainable Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Sustainable Impact** – The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples a high level of achievement and impact of its fully implemented GEP(s) in creating positive and sustainable institutional change towards gender equality, and covering all five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators, and show the sustainable anchoring of the GEP in the organisation and long-lasting improvements.
2. **Award criterion 2: Inspirational Model** – The applicant should demonstrate an influence of its fully implemented GEP(s) beyond the sole organisation, such as serving as an inspiration to other organisations e.g. through peer-mentoring, having an impact on policy at regional and/or national level and/or EU level.

Category “Newcomer Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress Achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards gender equality through the implementation of its GEP, and covering at least four of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative and quantitative data, including baselines, performance measures and indicators.
2. **Award criterion 2: Stakeholder engagement** – The applicant should demonstrate a high level of engagement of the organisation’s various internal stakeholders, including women and men from the different categories of staff (and student body for teaching institutions), in the design, implementation and assessment of its GEP.

Category “Inclusive Gender Equality Champions”:

1. **Award criterion 1: Progress achieved** - The applicant should demonstrate through concrete examples the progress achieved in creating positive institutional change towards inclusive gender equality through the implementation of its inclusive GEP, and covering at least three of the five thematic areas recommended in the Horizon Europe

GEP eligibility criterion. The applicant must support its claims with qualitative data, and as much as possible, with quantitative data including baselines, performance measures and indicators.

2. **Award criterion 2: Innovative Inclusiveness** – The applicant should demonstrate the impact of innovative actions implemented under its inclusive GEP such as, for example, new ideas or new tools not tested elsewhere, advanced participatory approaches, innovative partnerships, or else targeted innovative actions such as actions addressing the impact of COVID-19 on gender equality and inclusiveness, support schemes for endangered researchers, etc.

Eligibility criteria: The contestant must be a public or private research performing organisation, including a higher education establishment, located in an EU Member State or a country associated to Horizon Europe¹⁴⁴.

Applicants that have already received an EU or Euratom prize cannot receive a second prize for the same activities.

The specific rules of the contest will be published each year by the European Commission (on the [Funding & Tenders Portal](#) but also actively publicised elsewhere to maximise participation), which will directly launch and manage the contest and award the prize based on the judgement of independent experts.

Expected results: The prizes will increase public awareness of the importance of addressing gender equality in academic and research organisations through institutional change, incentivise a high degree of commitment to the implementation of inclusive GEPs, and create a community of champions inspiring other academic and research organisations into becoming gender equality champions themselves.

Form of Funding: Prizes

Type of Action: Recognition Prize

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.40 million from the 2025 budget

GRANTS TO IDENTIFIED BENEFICIARIES

1. European Science in the City next generation

Project results are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

¹⁴⁴ In accordance with the Horizon Europe Rules for participation, due to the specific policy requirements, to the nature and objectives of the action, the type of legal entity and the place of establishment are limited to research performing organisations among legal entities falling under the eligibility criterion on the requirement to have a Gender Equality Plan in place (see General Annexes to the Horizon Europe Work Programme).

- The 'European Science in the City' will bring together more than 5000 delegates from more than 50 countries within and outside the European Union;
- Showcase latest developments in research and innovation and offer open forum for lively discussion and debate on the future of European science, policy and innovation;
- Encompass three interconnected programmes: scientific research and innovation, science-to-business and scientific careers;
- Parallel Science in the City festival targets local citizens to extend and enhance dialog and exchange on science and its role in society;
- Organise European Talent Fair at the EuroScience Open Forum (ESOF) exhibition during public access day. This matchmaking event will bring together students, early career researchers, scholars, start-ups, industry and investors promoting talent, business and job opportunities across the EU.

Scope: In addition to the ESOF conference, the host city of ESOF 2024, should include the following two initiatives:

- A festival “European Science in the City” to be organised in close collaboration with the European Commission. The goal of the new event, associated with the more general “Science in the City” festival of ESOF, will be to showcase for the general public and European citizens the results of R&I projects supported by the European Commission, including the Horizon Europe programme. The “European Science in the City” festival will be promoted together with the ESOF conference;
- A year of events: the European City of Science (ECS) - a true all-year programme with various events and activities programmed by the host city in the spirit of the European Capital of Culture or the European Green Capital. In this perspective, the yearlong programme of the European City of Science will target a wide population of European citizens beyond simple local or regional impact.

Support offered to the organisers of ESOF 2024 and its associated events, notably the European City of Science (ECS) to ensure that a structured and expanded dialogue among all societal actors (researchers, citizens, policy-makers, business and third sector organisations, including all social groups) will be developed. In this context, special emphasis is placed on exploring and supporting citizen science as an important dimension of open science and as a way to promote further Responsible Research and Innovation through outreach activities, science education and various forms of public engagement with science. Moreover, as part of ESOF conference, a talent fair should be organised.

An inclusive and integrated combination of seminars, workshops, debates and round table discussions using new interactive and engaging formats is included and centred on Horizon Europe key societal challenges.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, bring science closer to citizens.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The City of Katowice and the University of Silesia in Katowice have a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice) - coordinator, ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget

2. Support to the further operation of cOAlition S

cOAlition S is an international consortium of research funding and performing organisations that are committed to making full and immediate open access to research publications a reality. cOAlition S has developed Plan S whereby research funders mandate that access to research publications generated through their research grants must be free to access on the day of publication.

The objective of supporting the further operation of cOAlition S is to monitor the impact of Plan S and explore future activities in support of open access to scientific publications.

This grant will support the further operation of cOAlition S by supporting activities aimed at:

1. Monitoring the impact of Plan S;
2. Providing recommendations on how to build on the achievements of Plan S;
3. Supporting cOAlition S work on open access to books and monographs by contributing to the upgrade of the OAPEN infrastructure.

The duration of this action is 24 months.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The European Science Foundation has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

European Science Foundation (ESF), 1, quai Lezay-Marnésia - BP 90015 67080 Strasbourg Cedex - France

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.20 million from the 2023 budget

3. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2023

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁵. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14 bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

¹⁴⁵ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

The starting date of the grant awarded under this topic may be as of 01 September 2022. Applicant must justify the need for a retroactive starting date in their application. Costs incurred from the starting date of the action may be considered eligible.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Jeunesses Scientifiques de Belgique (ASBL), Avenue Latérale 17 – 1180 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget

4. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER)

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement. Moreover, this action contributes to the implementation of Policy Agenda action 4 on ‘Promoting attractive and sustainable research careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA’.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017 and since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should provide a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives with European Research Area and ERA Policy Agenda.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations in the pension fund, provide advice to the board concerning the legal framework, coordinate the development and distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

'RESAVER Pension Fund OFP' (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 22, Rue de Pascale, 1040 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget

5. European Union Contest for early-career researchers

In order to attract more early-career researchers to a career in science and promote the opportunities not only in academia, but also industry and starting up own business, a special event for early-career researchers had been piloted as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science. The event had a clear European dimension, and the next edition planned to take place in Katowice should build on the work already done as part of Leiden 2022 European City of Science.

The event will bring together at least 100 early career researchers from across the European Union, researchers who should be gender-balanced, and as much as possible also reflect geographical and other diversity characteristics, divided in small teams, and mentors from academia, industry and SMEs in a competition to find scientific solutions to a set of challenges. Specific challenges are determined through a consultation with stakeholders in that particular field and are based on broader policy priorities. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission, and in promoting citizen science activities, thus attracting high levels of international media attention. In addition, the following legal entity may participate as associated partner:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2023 budget

6. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2024

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁶. This action supports ERA Policy Agenda action 14, Bringing science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The University of Silesia in Katowice has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission. In addition, the following legal entities may participate as associated partners:

- Miasto Katowice (City of Katowice), ul. Młyńska 4, 40-098 Katowice, Poland;
- Krajowy Fundusz na rzecz Dzieci (Polish Children's Fund), ul. Pasteura 7, 02-093 Warszawa, Poland.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

¹⁴⁶ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

Legal entities:

University of Silesia in Katowice, 12 Bankowa Street, 40-007 Katowice, Poland

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

7. Implementation of COST actions - Specific Grant under Framework Partnership Agreement

The European Commission funds almost the entire programme under a Framework Partnership Agreement (FPA) with underlying Specific Grant Agreements (SGAs). In the FPA and the SGAs the beneficiary COST Association commits to a mandatory conditionality to spend at least 50% of the budget at the benefit of researchers from Widening countries and to run 80% of the activities with a significant widening dimension. This specific grant agreement covers the expenditures for a duration of two years. The primary purpose of this grant is the implementation of the COST networking actions. Other services may be implemented as far as complementary and appropriate.

COST will reinforce and intensify its services and value adding activities to foster the career development of young researchers by dedicated activities such as COST Academy, leadership roles in COST networks, cross-cutting actions and potentially new initiatives in line with the general objectives and rules of the COST Framework. In particular, COST will update the training catalogue with new elements about ERA priorities, upskilling researchers to meet ERA policy objectives, and regularly communicate ERA policy developments to the COST scientific community in collaboration with the EC. This will be followed up by dedicated KPIs still to be defined.

The personnel costs operations incurred by the COST Association as the implementing structure are eligible as direct cost up to a maximum of 14,7 million Euro as far as they are necessary for the implementation of the COST networking actions and related other support activities. For the same purpose cost for other goods and services and subcontracting are eligible up to a cumulated maximum of 2,3 million Euro. COST networking actions will be implemented by third party grant holders using financial support to third parties.

The beneficiary may provide financial support to third parties in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party must be necessary to meet the objectives

of the SGA and will be fixed in the grant agreement in line with the COST Vademecum. It will be used for the implementation of networking tools defined in a closed list that is fixed in the description of the action.

The COST Association will organise competitive open calls and an independent evaluation and selection procedure according to its own rules in agreement with the European Commission. At proposal stage at least 50% of the participants must be located in Widening countries.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation

Legal entities:

COST Association, Avenue du Boulevard - Bolwerklaan 21, 1210 Brussels

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q2 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 120.00 million from the 2024 budget

8. Hungarian Presidency conferences with a European regional dimension - WIRE 2024

A two-day conference (WIRE) will be organised in 2024, under the Hungarian Presidency of the Council of the EU. WIRE - The Week of Innovative Regions in Europe is the main European policy forum for innovation and regional development. The event will gather actors active in the innovation and education ecosystem with the aim of improving science-based competitiveness.

The conference will debate knowledge based regional development and will offer potential solutions of streamlining resources aimed for this. Representatives of education organizations, research organizations, start-ups, clusters, policy makers and other related interested parties will exchange views and best practices that could lead to a higher impact of innovation across users and society at large. Best practices, trends and visions will be considered.

Legal entities:

National Research, Development and Innovation Office, 1077 Budapest, Kéthly Anna tér 1, Hungary

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1/2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

9. Support to Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions and research performing individuals (RESAVER) – 2025

As asserted in Article 22 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled to the realisation, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organisation and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights indispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. Nevertheless, social security in most member states is under pressure and mobile employees, researchers in particular, experience additional obstacles in accumulating an adequate amount of pension provisions. Most prominent issues experienced by mobile researchers in relation to the accumulation of occupational pensions (second pillar) are the vesting period, transferability of assets and administrative burden during the accumulation phase and at retirement.

The RESAVER Pension Fund has been created with the ambition to tackle the issues listed above by facilitating free circulation of researchers and removing pension as an obstacle to mobility, which corresponds to the strategic objectives of the Union policy as stipulated in Article 179 TFEU on the establishment of a European Research Area.

The RESAVER Occupational fund became operational in May 2017. Since then the fund has welcomed research organisations from Hungary, Austria, Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, Cyprus, Spain and France, making it already the occupational pension fund in the EU with the widest geographical coverage. In parallel with geographical expansion, RESAVER should engage in mutually beneficial collaborations with local occupational pension funds for the benefit of mobile employees. In order to answer to the needs of mobile researchers who do not receive occupational pension employee benefits, or receive an insufficient level of contributions, RESAVER should investigate providing a personal pension solution to mobile researchers. In addition, the investment strategy should be fine-tuned continuously in order to correspond to the specific needs of researchers and research performing organisations and should be aligned with the objectives of the European Research Area and the sustainable finance policy of the European Union. This action contributes to the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 – Promoting attractive and sustainable research

careers, balanced talent circulation and international, transdisciplinary and intersectoral mobility across the ERA.

In this context, the pension fund is expected to perform the following tasks: pension fund management, implementation of additional countries and organisations into the pension fund, communication and promotion activities, improve financial literacy, investigate the development and/or distribution of a third pillar solution, support the project in ad hoc tasks, contribute to the establishment of partnerships with local pension funds and coordination of investment strategy adjustments, actively engage with relevant stakeholders to create wide support to promote pan-European solutions that benefit researchers in general, and mobile researchers in particular.

Beneficiaries may provide financial support to third parties such as the RESAVER Consortium. The support to third parties can only be provided in the form of grants. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60.000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation. The RESAVER Pension Fund OFP has a proven record of working in a partnership mode with the European Commission.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

RESAVER Pension Fund OFP (Retirement Savings Vehicle for European Research Institutions), 10, Boulevard de l'Empereur, 1000 Brussels. Belgium

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 5.00 million from the 2025 budget

10. European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025

The European Union Contest for Young Scientists is a science competition for 14- to 20-year-olds. It brings together first prize winners of national science contests for pre-Higher

Education Institution school science projects to compete for prizes and awards. The contestants are judged by a jury of eminent scientists selected by the European Commission. The jury award 1st, 2nd and 3rd monetary prizes as well as other prestigious prizes donated to the contest by international research organisations and other similar bodies. The EU Contest takes place each year in a different location. This Contest provides additional stimulus to young people who have already demonstrated that they are applying science to solve problems. Many go on to become successful scientists. It attracts a considerable level of co-funding in the host country, and high levels of international media attention. The organisation of the contest is based on the General Guidelines on the organisation of the European Union Contest for Young Scientists and its Annex 1 – Rules of the contest. These are updated annually by the European Commission¹⁴⁷.

This action supports ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 14 – Bring science closer to citizens.

This action allows for the provision of financial support to third parties in the form of prizes. The maximum amount to be granted to each third party is EUR 60 000.

Subcontracting is not restricted to a limited part of the action.

This grant will be awarded without a call for proposals according to Article 195(e) of the Financial Regulation and Article 24(3)(b) of the Horizon Europe Regulation.

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be composed fully by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

National Centre for Education of the Republic of Latvia, Valņu iela 2, Rīga, LV-1050, Latvia

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

11. Danish Presidency Conference on Reforming Research Assessment

Expected outcomes: The event is expected to contribute to the following outcomes:

¹⁴⁷ https://ec.europa.eu/info/research-and-innovation/funding/funding-opportunities/eucys_en.

- Progress on the implementation of ERA Policy Agenda action 3 for “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the work undertaken by the signatories of the Agreement for Reforming Research Assessment, which signatories form the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA).
- Raised awareness among the scientific community and policy makers about the ERA Policy Agenda action on reforming research assessment, including the expected roles of different types of R&I actors.
- Drawing up a more coherent map of how to move ahead, using some first CoARA outcomes (expected in the fall 2025) as a stepping stone.
- Stimulating participation of the national/regional evaluation agencies and of the national research funders in the ERA Action, and providing a platform for exchanges with the CoARA members.
- Exchanging information on the design, piloting and implementation of reformed research assessment criteria, tools and processes.
- Highlighting the need for a global level playing field for R&I when it comes to research assessment principles.
- Assessing if there is a need for renewed political impetus or EU support measures.

Expected Impact: The proposal should set out a credible pathway to contributing to the impact of ERA Activity 3: “*Advance towards reforming the assessment system for research, researchers and institutions to improve their quality, performance and impact*” and of the Agreement vision that research assessment recognizes the diverse outputs, practices and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. Furthermore, the event must help promote alignment at a global level of the principles for research assessment and explore strategic and practical tools to diffuse the work of CoARA and measure the implementation of reforms to research assessment.

Scope: In today’s knowledge economies, universities are expected to translate and disseminate research and innovation broadly, contributing to growth, competitiveness, better regulation, and quality of life. To stimulate the broader impact and uptake of research-based products and advice, incentives and metrics need to be aligned. At this conference, the organisers together with the Danish Presidency and the European Commission will address the need for reforming research assessment, present progress on CoARA, and highlight drivers of change in the broader ecosystem of science, innovation, and technology.

Specific conditions:

Procedure: The evaluation committee will be fully composed by representatives of EU institutions.

Legal entities:

Aalborg University, Fredrik Bajers Vej 7K, 9220 Aalborg East, Denmark

Form of Funding: Grants not subject to calls for proposals

Type of Action: Grant to identified beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e) - Coordination and support action

The general conditions, including admissibility conditions, eligibility conditions, award criteria, evaluation and award procedure, legal and financial set-up for grants, financial and operational capacity and exclusion, and procedure are provided in parts A to G of the General Annexes.

Indicative timetable: Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.25 million from the 2025 budget

EXPERT CONTRACT ACTIONS

1. Use of individual experts in support of the new ERA's objectives

This action will support the provision of independent expertise to improve the evidence base and collect advice on various aspects related to the Reforming and Enhancing the European Union Research and Innovation System and the revitalised European Research Area. Individual experts will work in the following domains:

- Experts to contribute to monitoring of progress of the realisation of ERA's objectives;
- Experts on Human Resources and researchers' careers, experts on skills, experts on services for researchers such as those of the EURAXESS services network including the Charter & Code and HRS4R assessment process, social security and remuneration experts, experts in legal matters related to research careers and employment-related aspects, and experts in legal matters related to cross-border institutional cooperation, notably higher education institutions and public research organisations;
- Experts to contribute to the analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, to the development of these actions, and to the analysis of potential barriers.

The ERA Scoreboard will provide internationally comparable quantitative data and indicators to monitor progress on the realisation of the new ERA at EU and national level, revise priorities and actions in the ERA Roadmap and provide evidence and analysis for the European Semester. The Scoreboard will be issued on an annual basis.

For the European Framework for Research Careers and all areas linked to it, including reinforcing the human resources and skills dimensions in RPOs, an encompassing approach covering multiple expertise is expected to enable, among others, the current EURAXESS, HRS4R and RESAVER as well as any initiative covered by the Framework for Research

Careers, to tap into the competences and the resources of a single expert pool, thus avoiding unnecessary multiplication of roles and dispersion of financial and organisational resources. In addition, experts in cross-border institutional cooperation and mobility of R&I talents should allow gathering evidence and advice to facilitate cross-border cooperation between higher education institutions and between higher education institutions and other actors of the ecosystem, as well as facilitate circulation of talents.

A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.68 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.58 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.60 million from the 2025 budget

2. External expertise for ad hoc tasks related to the implementation of the HE Ethics Appraisal

This action will support the use of independent experts to advise on or assist with the implementation of the Horizon Europe Ethics Appraisal scheme in view of ensuring and maintaining its quality and effectiveness.

Since the above tasks require specialised knowledge in research ethics/integrity and the related national and European legal framework (e.g., Data protection and privacy, Informed Consent, Artificial Intelligence and Emerging technologies, Benefit sharing, etc.) a special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.10 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.10 million from the 2025 budget

3. External expertise for evaluation and monitoring of Widening and ERA actions

This action will support the use of appointed independent experts for the evaluation and monitoring of actions (grant agreement, grant decision, public procurement actions, financial instruments, evaluation) funded under Horizon Europe and previous Framework Programmes for Research and Innovation and where appropriate, include ethics checks as well as compliance checks regarding the Gender Equality Plan eligibility criterion. A special

allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 0.65 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.45 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 0.65 million from the 2025 budget

4. Monitoring experts for Horizon 2020 legacy

This action is for financing external experts in charge of reviewing legacy projects from Horizon 2020 related to SEWP and Swafs. A special allowance of EUR 450/day will be paid to the experts appointed in their personal capacity who act independently and in the public interest.

Form of Funding: Other budget implementation instruments

Type of Action: Expert contract action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023 to Q4 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.40 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 0.25 million from the 2024 budget

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

1. Development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) and the Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS)

Scope

This action will assure the continuation and further development of the European Innovation Scoreboard (EIS) which is already produced annually for almost two decades, as well as of the biennial Regional Innovation Scoreboard (RIS). The scoreboards provide European, national and regional policy-makers, innovation practitioners and all interested public with a solid, European Union-wide analytical tool to help measure, monitor, and benchmark the innovation performance of the European Union (EU), individual Member States and their regions as well as Associated Countries and other key international economic partners. The scoreboards identify the relative strengths and weaknesses of the research and innovation systems, and help the Member States to assess areas in which they need to concentrate their efforts in order to boost their innovation performance.

In addition, the action will explore further methodological advancements and R&I related topics not yet addressed to strengthen the analytical capacity of the tool and increase its robustness, usability and outreach.

The outcomes of the project are expected to provide a solid evidence base for tailored innovation policies aiming at supporting competitiveness, value creation, employment and prosperity in the European Union.

Expected outcomes

The services under this action cover the production of the EIS annually and of the RIS every two years for the period 2024-2027, as well as their underlying data and relating documents, such as the methodology report and the country profiles. The services will also cover methodological advancements of the analytical frameworks and the overall methodology, and exploratory research studies to address new challenges and priorities related to the innovation systems, not covered by the scoreboards.

Finally, the services will cover communication and dissemination activities, which will increase the uptake and visibility of the tools, including the maintenance, update and further development of the interactive tool, which allows customised visual comparisons of the innovation performance between countries and regions

A new framework contract will be concluded for a duration of 4 years, covering the EIS 2024 – 2027 including the above-described services and reports with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 2 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 0.80 million from the 2023 budget

2. EU data for R&I policy

The initiative allows Member States and the European Commission to share microdata related to R&I projects, and the progressive integration of R&I project data with other sources of related data, are fundamental to strengthen ERA and reinforce our research and innovation systems by informing better evidence-based policy making. The main tasks are: (1) Data sharing and interoperability of different sources of competitive or non-competitive Research and Innovation funding in the European Union, and integration with relevant external data sources; (2) Digital enabling infrastructure; (3) Data analysis and visualisation tools (The EU Dashboard); (4) Capacity building. These activities will be complemented with other data activities aimed at acquiring, interlinking and visualising R&I related data.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

3. Development, maintenance and promotion of the ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS and associated websites and tools + IS Coordinators

The ERA Talent Platform, including EURAXESS is one of the key initiatives enhancing researcher careers and, as such, is one of the operational instruments of the European Research Area (ERA). It particularly contributes to removing the barriers to mobility and making the European Union more attractive to researchers. As an ERA implementation measure, and an important instrument under ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4, the EURAXESS portal and instruments under its umbrella are expanded towards a comprehensive recruitment, career development and social networking web-platform, dedicated to researchers and institutions seeking for R&I talent or willing to improve their institutional talent management policies and practices.

This action will build on the work under the previous Work Programme ‘Science with and for Society’, in particular the Study on ERA Priority 3 and ERA TOP IV Extension, as well as on the current Work Programme, more specifically the action on the EURAXESS.

The portal is supporting institutional transformations on recruitment, working conditions and career development of researchers, and it is aligned to the reviewed European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers, as well as the updated Skills Agenda. It is also interoperable with other European websites and platforms such as EURES and the new Europass, and has adopted new functionalities required in line with the European Skills, Competences Qualifications and Occupations (ESCO), the enhanced framework of research careers, etc. The improved EURAXESS portal will be called ERA Talent platform.

Different activities will be undertaken to increase the capacity and ensure the user-friendliness of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools (among which EURAXESS, HRS4R, RESAVER). They also include technical maintenance, architectural developments, and graphical and functional enhancements related to the most recent political developments. These activities will also encompass services by external information system providers who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the EURAXESS portal and associated websites and tools.

The promotion activities will increase awareness about the ERA and its priorities. The promotion activities, among which stakeholder dialogues, events, workshops or conferences, such as the EURAXESS Conference, the HRS4R Info days, or the HR Strategy Mutual Learning seminars, will also address topics concerning the barriers to the mobility of researchers across borders, sectors and disciplines, with a focus on creating and stimulating conditions for open, transparent and merit-based recruitment, as well as attractive career options for researchers across the European Union and beyond.

The newly designed EURAXESS website should be seen as an interface that facilitates matching between researchers and employers, candidates and jobs, beneficiaries and benefits, research and funding. The action will also further develop activities to sections of the website and the instruments under its umbrella, *inter alia* additional modules for RESAVER and the upgrade of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) e-tool based on the Charter and Code future revisions and developments. The EURAXESS is also expected to integrate an additional online instrument - a portal gathering EU and national programmes and schemes for intersectoral mobility, which should provide easy access for individuals who want to engage in intersectoral mobility or want to be employed as intermediate between the academic and non-academic sector, notably businesses.

The newly designed website will improve automatised data gathering in order to allow the Commission to produce high quality data and evidence in support of future ERA policy developments, relevant legislation and actions.

This action requires collaboration with a large group of stakeholders, including EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations/National Coordinators, national portal administrators, EURAXESS Worldwide and other relevant stakeholders. Activities should also include services by external information system provider(s) who, on the basis of inputs provided by the responsible Commission services, guarantee the smooth running of the platform.

Web communication and online promotion activities with stakeholders related to the rollout of the newly designed platform and the portals and tools under its umbrella should also be foreseen as part of this action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q4 2023 and Q2 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

4. EURAXESS Worldwide - Implementation 2024-2026

The new ERA Communication outlines that EURAXESS services, network and portals will be broadened into an online one-stop shop with improved structure and governance. The Council Conclusions on the Future of the ERA calls on the Commission and Member States to develop EURAXESS to foster “inclusiveness” within the ERA to address existing barriers to unbalanced mobility pattern by supporting researchers in their career development within the ERA, connecting researchers and institutions and improving employability and talent absorption and mobility schemes.

The specific contracts implementing the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE Framework Contract cover the continued animation of the network and guarantee the continuity of the operations

of the Euraxess Worldwide Hubs in the different locations around the world, allowing for the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks as appropriate.

This action aims to complement the European dimension of EURAXESS with an additional dimension and module addressing international and European researchers living and working outside of the European Union. It is expected to consist of the development of a portfolio of support services and associated tools, designed to create transnational ties with researchers and scientific communities within the global R&I ecosystem.

This action will build on the EURAXESS Worldwide structure of international hubs and it is expected to be a physical and virtual networking, knowledge-sharing and advocacy platform of services and tools. It will serve as a diplomacy asset and it will promote European R&I instruments, and attract international talents to the European Union and European researchers back home.

This action should operate in solid alignment with the European dimension of EURAXESS. Collaboration is foreseen between EURAXESS Worldwide international hubs and EURAXESS Bridgehead Organisations, National Coordinators and centres across the European Union. The action is expected to bridge researchers working outside of the European Union to their peers working inside the European Union, activate scientific communities and connect them with business and professional associations, as well as R&I employers and funders.

The international dimension of EURAXESS should also be fostered through networking events, information sessions or training, as well as online instruments and tools, with a mission, inter alia to:

- Promote the European values and R&I landscape as a favourable environment for excellent research;
- Facilitate knowledge and skills transfer, scientific collaboration and recruiting processes, while lifting obstacles to return;
- Strengthen S&T links with home countries through policy feedback tools and dialogues, as well as;
- Improve data to a better understanding of European researchers living and working outside of the European Union, as well as on mobility and research careers policy in general;
- Support international researchers and innovators to exploit European possibilities to create future markets, leverage private finance and scale up their businesses by connecting them with regional and national innovation actors.

EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia & New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023, Q4 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 2.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 2.00 million from the 2025 budget

5. Monitoring gender equality in Research and Innovation - Development, implementation and dissemination of indicators (She Figures)

Gender equality as a priority has been strengthened progressively in the EU. In Research and Innovation (R&I), there is a need to better capture progress made towards the individual European Research Area (ERA) priorities and inform evidence-based policy-making. In cooperation with the Member States, the European Commission will continue collecting comparable sex and/or gender disaggregated data and monitoring, with appropriate indicators, the implementation of gender policies and actions at different levels - institutional, national, EU and, where available, world level. The study will update the collection of data and propose new indicators to show the progress towards gender equality in R&I, following the chronological journey of researchers from graduating from doctoral studies to participating in the labour market and acquiring decision-making roles, while exploring differences in women's and men's working conditions and research and innovation output.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.50 million from the 2024 budget

6. Eurobarometer on European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology

Fostering science and innovation is a central priority for the European Union (EU). EU support for research and innovation (R&I) aims to improve the quality and quantity of research and innovation conducted, ensure that the processes and outcomes of research and innovation align with the needs, values and expectations of society, and that it addresses the many pressing issues that face us as individuals, as society, and as a planet.

Increasing expectations are placed on R&I to develop social and technological solutions to pressing problems, for instance in the fields of public health, climate change and biodiversity loss, as R&I undergoes a transformation of its modus operandi towards open and responsible research and innovation. Yet ethical, research integrity, and other issues continue to damage the standing of science and scientific practice, innovations continue to be developed that are questioned or even rejected by society, and scientific knowledge – and support for research

and innovation – is highly unequally distributed across the European Union and its population.

Up-to-date and robust evidence is needed to understand societal trends, improve interactions and the relationship between science and society, and to inform the continued development of policy responses at different levels of governance.

This Eurobarometer will provide a snapshot of European citizens' knowledge and attitudes towards science and technology, ensuring time-series comparisons to important sets of questions in previous Eurobarometers. In addition, it will capture data needed for the continued monitoring of the evolution and benefits of open and responsible research and innovation, and the relationship between science and society more generally. Finally, it may focus on specific aspects that have not been covered or examined in detail in recent or previous exercises.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget

7. Studies and communication

Activities should support the Pact for Research and Innovation and the implementation of the ERA Policy Agenda and may include studies, support and communication activities that are needed to analyse and enhance the EU R&I environment, for example

- Collection of project feedback, in particular with respect to key exploitable results;
- Organisational support for consulting the R&I stakeholders community on R&I needs;
- Production and dissemination of communication material and the organisation of events related the ERA, synergies with the EEA, European R&I agendas and Horizon Europe;
- Support to Member States ensuring coherent communication activities on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda across target groups;
- Analysis of the expected impacts of the ERA Policy Agenda actions, and of potential barriers to their development.

The limited numbers of contracts may be implemented on the basis of framework contracts, in order to further ensure that the Commission is provided with appropriate and timely analyses, which in turn should facilitate the proper integration of policy studies into the preparation of new policy initiatives.

Cooperation with the presidencies of the Council of the European Union and stakeholders is envisaged and could include direct support to ERA-related presidency events.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2023-Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.00 million from the 2025 budget

8. Implementation of the ERA Monitoring Mechanism

The Council Conclusions on the Future Governance of the European Research Area (ERA) calls on the Commission and Member States to develop a new **ERA online policy platform** with the aim to have a consistent, robust and quality tested national reporting system, taking into account current instruments. Furthermore, the Council recommendation on a Pact for Research and Innovation in the European Union (Pact for R&I), defines that the platform should inform on (i) the implementation of the ERA policy agenda at Union and national level; and on (ii) other relevant investments, reforms and activities supporting the principles and ERA priority areas set out in the Pact for R&I. The Commission and the Member States should share information through the ERA policy online platform on their current and planned policies and programmes that contribute to implementing the ERA policy agenda, and more broadly contribute to the principles and priorities set out by the Pact for R&I. In that sense, the online platform could serve as a kind of “hub” for sharing information around the new ERA and ease exchange between all actors. The action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 19 – Establish an efficient and effective ERA monitoring mechanism.

Considering this, the online policy platform should be structured around the various elements that ensure the future monitoring of and reporting on the ERA implementation, including a scoreboard and dashboard and a tool for reporting from the Member States and the Commission on the implementation of the ERA policy agenda (e.g., annual reports to the Member States). Moreover, it should provide for easy access to and information on the priorities areas of the Pact for R&I, the ERA policy agenda, including its list of joint actions and their state of implementation, and on Member States. A clear structure should ensure compatibility and comparability of information per country and per action.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 1.00 million from the 2024 budget

9. EURAXESS Worldwide - Framework contract 2024-2027

The Directorate-General for Research and Innovation launched the EURAXESS Worldwide initiative (formerly called ERA Link) in 2006 with the aim of creating a networking of European researchers abroad giving them a virtual connection to the European Union and thus

maintaining them as a European resource even if they are not physically present in the European Union. This action was initially launched in the United States (2006), then in Japan (2008) and China (2009). EURAXESS WORLDWIDE officers are currently located in the following countries and regions: Africa, ASEAN, Australia and New Zealand, China, India, Japan, North America, South Korea, and Latin America. New countries could be opened during the implementation phase of the framework contract. The new framework contract will cover more countries or hubs during the contractual period.

EURAXESS is an initiative of the European Research Area (ERA) strategy that addresses barriers to the mobility of researchers and seeks to enhance scientific collaboration between the European Union and the rest of the world. The initiative strives to become the global support and career development tool for European and international researchers, not only for their mobility experience inside and outside the European Union, but also for their social networking with researchers from all over the world. Designed as a comprehensive toolset it provides access to a complete range of information and supports services.

The objective of the international arm of the EURAXESS initiative is to link the European Union to the rest of the world and to promote international collaboration of researchers, mobility and career development. Through their websites, monthly newsletters and activities the EURAXESS WORLDWIDE country representatives maintain the link between the European Union and the world. The aim is to promote the attractiveness of the European Union to undertake research both European and non-European researchers outside of the European Union.

This framework contract will guarantee the continuity of the operations of the network for the period 2024-2027 in the different destinations and allow the extension of the activities to new countries and tasks. Its estimated budget is EUR 9.5 million.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2 2023

10. Administrative management of the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)

The Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R)¹⁴⁸ is the implementation mechanism of the European Charter for Researchers¹⁴⁹, and is key to the career development of researchers as well as to generating, transferring, sharing and disseminating knowledge about Human Resources best practices. HRS4R supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 4 by contributing to the development of an attractive, open, and sustainable

¹⁴⁸ HR Excellence in Research Award: <https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs/hrs4r>.

¹⁴⁹ Charter for Researchers, annexed to the Council recommendation C/2023/1640 of 18 December 2023 on a European framework to attract and retain research, innovation and entrepreneurial talents in Europe (OJ C, C/2023/1640, 29.12.2023), https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:C_202301640.

European labour market for researchers, enhancing the commitment of research organisations' leadership towards human resources as well as improving the researcher-employer relationship.

The HRS4R is a structured and monitored auditing mechanism centred on a continuous assessment in three-year cycles for recognising with the "HR Excellence in Research Award" the institutions that make progress in aligning their human resources policies to the 40 principles of the Charter for Researchers, based on a customised action plan/HR strategy.

To date, over 700 institutions from 39 EU and associated countries have obtained the award and every year several new institutions enter the process.

The contractor will be responsible, in collaboration with the Commission, the applicant institutions and the experts, for organising the continuous assessment of applications, including the organisation of desk-based assessments and site visits, the selection of experts, the administrative validation of experts' reports and institutions' submissions, as well as managing the communication with applicants, promoting the award and providing feedback to the Commission for policy purposes.

A framework contract will be set up for a total duration of 4 years, covering the above-described services, with an estimated budget ceiling of EUR 7 million over the whole duration of the framework contract.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 3.00 million from the 2024 budget

11. Implementation of the Horizon Policy Support Facility

In order to make research and innovation deliver on their full potential to be the key drivers of economic growth and of the transition towards a sustainable society, ambitious policy reforms of national R&I systems are necessary. Through the Policy Support Facility (PSF), the Commission assists Member States and countries associated to Horizon Europe in developing and implementing those reforms. It offers, on a voluntary basis, high-level expertise and tailor-made advice to national public authorities. An overview of past activities can be found on a dedicated webpage¹⁵⁰. The PSF has demonstrated that it serves as an enabler for concrete policy changes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

¹⁵⁰ <https://ec.europa.eu/research-and-innovation/en/statistics/policy-support-facility>

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q1 2024 and Q1 2025

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2024 budget and EUR 1.50 million from the 2025 budget

12. Study on the R&I measures in the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)

The Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) is the core instrument of NextGenerationEU. It was established in February 2021 to provide large-scale financial support to Member States (EUR 338bn in grants and EUR 385.8bn in loans) in the context of the Covid-19 crisis. The RRF is a performance-based instrument and provides support for both investments and reforms. Member States have shown a strong commitment to R&I in their national Recovery and Resilience Plans (RRPs). All approved RRFs include measures supporting R&I (A total of 333 measures and EUR 47.4 billion in investment). This procurement will focus on the impacts and functioning of the R&I measures included in the RRFs and will assess the contribution of these measures to (1) achieving key EU objectives (such as fostering the twin transition, strengthening territorial cohesion and promoting gender equality); (2) advancing the ERA Policy Agenda and the New European Innovation Agenda; (3) creating synergies between the RRF and other R&I relevant European funds (notably Horizon Europe). It will also take into account the differences in the design of the RRF in comparison to other EU programmes and how this may affect its ability to deliver impact. This learning-oriented assessment will help draw initial conclusions that could be relevant for the future design of the new R&I programmes.

This action supports the ERA Policy Agenda (2022-2024) action 20 – Support to the prioritisation, coordination and direction of R&I investments and reforms.

Form of Funding: Procurement

Type of Action: Public procurement

Indicative timetable: Q2-Q3 2024

Indicative budget: EUR 0.35 million from the 2024 budget

INDIRECT MANAGEMENT

1. Research Careers Observatory – contribution agreement with OECD

To monitor the implementation of the European Framework for Research Careers and to provide evidence on the effectiveness of measures aiming at balanced talent circulation and strengthening research careers, Directorate-General Research and Innovation is establishing a Research Careers Observatory, to enable the tracking of researchers in terms of mobility, careers, skills, and working conditions. Anticipated outcomes are the following: ability to monitor the implementation of the Framework for Research Careers and system reform; shared understanding on support data needs of Member States and research performing

organisations; increased attractiveness of European research performing organisations for the best talents through accessible data.

The objective of this action is to put in place a European Research Careers Observatory that combines the best of the current EU data tools and capacities in one single place, in addition to collecting new data, while further enhancing their use and relevance for policy-makers, organisations, and researchers. In collaboration with the European Commission, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) will be responsible for the design, development and maintenance of the database, managing the data collection and dissemination process. The aim is also to fill the gaps in data related to certain focus areas of the Framework, such as digital and green skills, in order to provide relevant evidence for policy making at European and national level in a global context.

Conceptually, the observatory is proposed to monitor three dimensions of research careers: (i) skills and training, (ii) research jobs, and (iii) mobility and exchange. The Observatory will be accessible via the ERA Talent Platform / EURAXESS. The work should provide indicators on the attractiveness across the EU territory for research careers and talents, taking into account national schemes for observatory and monitoring. It should enable real-time monitoring of national systems of remuneration and employment conditions, social security policies, portability of grants and pensions, as well as research mobility patterns of researchers, both geographically and intersectoral mobility, paying particular attention to gender and intersectional differences in research careers. The agreement with OECD envisages annual reporting to feed the observatory, where feasible, and a duration from 2023 until up to 2028.

Legal entities:

OECD - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2 Rue André Pascal, 75016 Paris, France

Form of Funding: Indirectly managed actions

Type of Action: Indirectly managed action

Indicative timetable: Q1 2023

Indicative budget: EUR 1.50 million from the 2023 budget and EUR 2.20 million from the 2024 budget

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

Budget¹⁵¹

	Budget line(s)	2023 Budget (EUR million)	2024 Budget (EUR million)	2025 Budget (EUR million)
Calls				
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-01		16.00	158.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>16.00</i>	<i>158.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-02		140.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>140.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-03		54.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>54.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-04		20.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>20.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-05		5.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>5.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-06		40.00	40.00	
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>40.00</i>	<i>40.00</i>	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ACCESS-07		60.00		
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	<i>60.00</i>		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-ACCESS-01				270.00
	<i>from</i>			<i>270.00</i>

¹⁵¹ The budget figures given in this table are rounded to two decimal places.
The budget amounts are subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the general budget of the Union for years 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

	01.020401			
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-01		50.00	47.00	
	from 01.020401	50.00	47.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-TALENTS-02		8.00		
	from 01.020401	8.00		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-02			8.00	
	from 01.020401		8.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-TALENTS-03			40.00	
	from 01.020401		40.00	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2025-TALENTS-01				8.00
	from 01.020401			8.00
HORIZON-WIDERA-2023-ERA-01		34.70		
	from 01.020402	34.70		
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01			23.50	
	from 01.020402		23.50	
HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-02			28.00	
	from 01.020402		28.00	
Other actions				
Prize		0.55	0.55	0.40
	from 01.020402	0.55	0.55	0.40
Grant to identified		6.20	121.25	6.25

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

beneficiary according to Financial Regulation Article 195(e)	<i>from 01.020401</i>		120.25	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	6.20	1.00	6.25
Expert contract action		1.83	1.38	1.35
	<i>from 01.020401</i>	0.75	0.60	0.45
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.08	0.78	0.90
Public procurement		7.30	11.85	5.50
	<i>from 01.020401</i>		0.03	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	7.30	11.82	5.50
Indirectly managed action		1.50	2.20	
	<i>from 01.020402</i>	1.50	2.20	
Estimated total budget		445.08	481.73	291.50